

ACA Marketplace Shoppers (OEP) — Voices by Theme

Appendix to *ACA-Shoppers-Research*. For every measured theme, the most engaged voices (up to 20) in full, with replies and source links. Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/aca-shoppers/research/>

Tab 1 — Fears

Getting sick and not being able to pay · 53 documents · 20 voices

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future."

💙 "

— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— r/obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

"It is an issue that will explode in their faces this fall if they don't extend the credits. I can't stress enough how immediately impactful and obvious it will be once consumers start looking at their 2026 rates if we go back to the 400% FPL cliff and lower subsidies for everyone under 400%. You can't bluster away the premium increase that hits people directly."

— r/obamacare · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1n8oh6a/house_republicans_launch_bill_to_extend_health/ncghst2/

"A freaking nightmare. We have to enroll by Dec. 15 for Jan. 1 effective date. I have a decent silver plan, but the premium will increase by 300 percent without subsidies, which means I will just sign up for a cheaper bronze plan if there is no change by the 15th. People like me don't want to be stuck in a lowered plan if we find out after the 15th that we will get subsidies and we don't want to risk going without insurance for a period. Knowing the GOP, they will deliberately delay this if they are going to offer subsidies just for the opportunity to be cruel."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nqhi12x/

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · None

"It appears that expansion Medicaid will remain a viable pathway for many non-working households despite the new community engagement requirement. It appears that the income qualification pathway for compliance with the new community engagement requirement for expansion Medicaid will indeed be based on MAGI, not earned income or some other income calculation. This means that lower earning households who for some reason can not work need only have MAGI equal to 80 hours per month of the federal minimum wage in order to be considered qualified for the community engagement requirement. That is currently only \$580 per month. MAGI includes a broad array of income sources so this will help many segments of the current expansion Medicaid enrollment base. This will also keep people currently on expansion Medicaid from having to worry about boosting their MAGI in order to move into the bottom tier of the ACA. Those who wish to read the full details should start on page 41 of the PDF linked below. Sources: <https://www.federalregister.gov/public-inspection/current> <https://public-inspection.federalregister.gov/2026-11094.pdf> > Under new § 435.552(f)(2) and (g)(3), we establish that States must use the MAGI-based methodologies at § 435.603 when making income determinations for demonstrating community engagement. A contrary reading of the statute would require that States, after determining an individual income-eligible for the adult group, apply a separate and distinct income determination for such individuals in evaluating their demonstration of community engagement. There is no indication in section 1902(xx)(2) of the Act or elsewhere that the MAGI-based income provisions of section 1902(e)(14)(A) of the Act should not apply to the calculations under section 1902(xx)(2)(F) and (G) of the Act. Therefore, under § 435.552, we are interpreting section 1902(xx)(2)(F) and (G) of the Act in a manner that is consistent with section 1902(e)(14) of the Act. **We specify that States must use the individual's MAGI-based income as defined at § 435.603 in assessing an individual's monthly income for the purpose of determining if an individual demonstrates community engagement under § 435.552(f) or (g).**"

— r/obamacare · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tug9bm/it_appears_that_expansion_medicaid_will_remain_a/

"\$8000 for an ER visit?? I went for an infection on my leg, wouldn't heal. I had fallen off my bicycle. Try \$12,000 for that. They ultrasound my whole leg for some unknown reason. And they hooked me up to IV antibiotics. I wasn't even admitted. Of course my insurance didn't pay the full 12,000, I forget what they paid. My husband's triple bypass was over 300 K. It's insane. He was home on day five because he pushed himself. Then he was off for two months to heal, but we had saved so he could be off and we didn't have to worry about the bills. He just did everything they said, all the exercises from the pulmonologist because usually you are in bed longer and it affects your lungs and breathing. He refused pain meds after day two. He just wanted to get home because you don't rest in the hospital. He actually broke a record, no one had ever went home that fast. He was only 52 though. Inherited a bad heart from both parents. His twin had a pacemaker at age 40. One thing people aren't mentioning is if the ACA goes away, so does its protections. And the ACA protections are for those with ACA, employer based insurance, Medicaid, these protections are for anyone that has any type of insurance. And the biggest one is the insurance companies cannot deny us coverage because of pre-existing conditions. So if they dismantle the ACA, that will go away. And insurance companies would love if it did because that was a big reason for denial, before ACA came about. Your kids will not be able to be on your insurance until age 26 either, that is another protection given by the ACA. I'm all willing to listen to a new idea, but it has to address the pre-existing conditions for me to even consider it. If they do what Trump wants and just send the people the money, we have no power. Every insurance company would turn my husband and myself down because of his heart issues and my asthma issues. A lot of people do not realize what all the ACA does. A third thing is that it gives every woman a free wellness exam, every year. It doesn't matter what's your co-pay is or your deductible or out-of-pocket max, it doesn't matter because every woman gets one free wellness exam per year. That includes a Pap smear and a mammogram. I started getting mammograms at age 35 because I have extremely dense breast tissue. And every year it comes back bad and I have to go get it redone and then they ultrasound my breasts as well. Pap smears have been coming back bad for years too, and I had to get those done every six months. He finally let me go a year this time because even though, as he puts it, my toe is on the line, the cells themselves have not changed anymore. All this would be pre-existing if they end the ACA"

— r/obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p24ajw/universal_care/npul7vc/

"Help! ACA plan termination notice after reporting a change-in-life event I just received a notice today that my ACA plan has been terminated effective October stating "voluntary withdrawal" even though I never requested this, and I have always paid on time. For the life of me I cannot figure out why. The only thing I can figure out is that this is due to me reporting my daughter as married (by reporting the event as a change-of-life event). This was to remove just her, not all of us. I called Healthcare.gov and they are escalating this, but I'm worried that it won't get fixed. I asked the agent and she says this happens a lot so I'm wondering if anyone else has experienced this when it wasn't due to non-payment. Does anyone have any experience with this? My son is a hemophiliac and I'm worried that I need to start looking for a new job so that I can get other coverage. BTW: I'm not getting tax credits, in case that is relevant."

— r/HealthInsurance · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmwnck/help_aca_plan_termination_notice_after_reporting/

"I don't know. But I have some seriously rare illnesses that I did NOT get from not eating well. And I'm currently looking at a rare mitochondrial disease as the likely cause. And I am repeatedly hospitalized due to doctors who are afraid to properly treat me until I am literally critically ill. These are all things I have gone out of my way and begged for help to prevent. It is not my fault. There is no way I can go without health insurance. If I had actually had health insurance in my 20's I would almost certainly not be as sick as I am now and costing so much in health care. And I loathe and despise the absolute assholes in this country who think anyone who is sick is just a lazy person who deserves to be sick and die. I hope they reap what they sowed."

— r/obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh82ain/

"If I get a job part way through the year and cut off my ACA insurance right when my new insurance starts what happens as far as my tax credits? Update : I'm in Michigan I know we estimate for yearly income for the ACA but they wouldn't penalize me for not having or isn't ACA insurance for the months I'm covered by employer insurance right? As of right now I estimated my income higher due to making more money last year but business has taken a dive this year. I'm paying more per month because of that higher estimate and I'm looking for a new job with benefits because it's too unpredictable at this point. For what I've made for the first quarter of the year I prob would have been eligible for Medicaid so I'm also worried about getting screwed for that come tax time next year."

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s3qnb3/if_i_get_a_job_part_way_through_the_year_and_cut/

"[US] Health insurance as a solo small business owner is killing me financially, how are you handling it? Running a small boutique for a few years now and the one thing that never gets easier is health insurance. Coming from a corporate background where HR handled everything, I had no idea how brutal the individual market was until I was actually in it. Right now I'm paying more per month for my own coverage than I used to pay toward rent. And the deductibles aren't even that good. I looked at marketplace plans, looked at shortterm options, even went down the health sharing ministry rabbit hole for a while before deciding it felt too risky for my situation. What I keep running into is that the options are either expensive and okay, or cheaper and kind of terrifying. There's no middle ground that actually makes sense. For those of you running smaller operations, especially retail or service businesses where you're the only employee or close to it, what have you actually landed on? Did you find something through a professional association or a local chamber? Did you just accept the high premium and build it into your pricing? I track my finances pretty obsessively so I know exactly what this is costing me each year, and it's genuinely one of my biggest line items. Curious what other people have figured out."

— r/selfemployed · 10 upvotes · None

"Living off Cash (for a few years) I'll be 53 next year, and would like to quit my job and live off saved cash for 3-4 years before potentially rejoining the workforce. Since my income would be \$0 for those years, how would I go about getting health insurance? When I enter estimates in the ACA, they tell me to apply for medicaid. I also own a house that has an estimated value of 500k and have over 500k in retirement, but I don't want to touch the retirement until I'm 59. Would getting health insurance for my 3-4 years "off" be problematic because of my assets? And, would I have to receive medicaid or is there a way to still get a private insurance plan even with no income? I'm not trying to get "free healthcare," but if my income is zero for a few years, do I even have a choice? Thanks,"

— r/HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · None

"My bronze ACA plan (TX) has a flat \$50 office visit for my PCP. Specialist office visits are flat \$100. So, I wouldn't be afraid of getting a diagnosis based on office visit fees. As of 2026, all bronze ACA plans are HDHPs. Lab work and other diagnostic procedures are a different story: that's where the mystery hit to the wallet really happens."

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/on1gjxi/

"I agree with this, it's a nightmare if you do not understand all the ups and downs with copay, premiums, deductibles, ...etc. I Googled so many terms because of my confusion of same, and took notes when needed. I navigated to the silver plans. Check and see if your doctors are listed in that plan or which doctors. A note here, some doctors listed was no longer with the plan, and I found calling the Dr's office to confirm played a large part of picking plans, I don't want to drive 30 miles to see my pcp. Then on marketplace you can also enter your prescriptions you take, my spouse had a few expensive ones. It's a nightmare and you have to be thorough, I spent many evenings learning the terminology. With market place you can save maybe 4 plans to compare, which is a big help. At the end I had a plan picked and a backup plan. I called marketplace, gave my info and details, the rep came up with the same 2 plans. You need to understand Medicare too, by then I already had a much better understanding. When you talk to agents ask about things you don't understand."

— r/HealthInsurance · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pboicez/

"This is me. I have more health problems and see more specialists than the people I know/family I have who are in their late 70's, 80's and even more than my 98 year old grandmother. I am decades younger than that and terrified of what my health will be like at those ages, especially if my Medicaid is taken away. Not one of my health conditions is caused by poor choices like substance abuse or eating poorly or lack of exercise. I lost the genetic lottery and have terrible luck. I have written in my will that I wish to donate my body to science when I die because of the amount of "rare" diseases and syndromes I have. Literally every doctor I have ever had has said to me, "I have never seen this before". So that's been fun. I hope that by studying my body when I'm gone and won't need it, doctors and /or scientists will be able to learn how to help others with issues like mine someday. According to the current rules, despite being too sick to work, I have too many "assets" to qualify for SSI disability. So that will render me *not disabled* in the eyes of this new nightmare government and according to this evil bill. I gave up my teaching career when I was married when I became a stay at home mom/wife 25 years ago so I didn't pay into the social security system for decades which makes me ineligible for SSDI or social security disability. I am not qualified or trained to do any kind of job that would make enough money to be able to afford insurance and all the co-pays, deductibles, co-insurance, and prescriptions. I doubt anyone would even hire me, and I would likely get fired from all the sick days I would need. Prior to having children I was a teacher, and I would never go back to it the way society villainizes teachers for everything, not that my body could even tolerate the schedule and the stress. I cannot understand why they want you to sell your home and your car before you can qualify for SSI disability when you don't have enough work history for SSDI disability, so I don't receive benefits other than Medicaid and have been living solely off my investments which is my "retirement fund" that I started when I was 19. Every month I would contribute whatever I had, even if it was \$50, because I knew someday I wanted to be able to be home with my future children. Just in the short time since the orange monster has been in power. I have lost a scary amount of money and am terrified what I have won't last as long as I need it, thanks to his economic ineptitude. But if I sold my home and car, I would need assistance with housing and transportation. Make that make sense!? Even when it should be a slam dunk, it takes many people years, assistance from lawyers, and multiple attempts to qualify for disability. The system was broken before they came in with their plan to nuke it. I feel fortunate that I started planning for my future at such young age, but once I lose Medicaid, anything I have now will be gone in a very short amount of time, or I will die, which I think is what they want. I am terrified for people who don't have savings or investments, I'm terrified for all those of us who haven't had the energy, resources, or haven't been well enough for the battle to try to qualify for disability, and those of us who don't qualify for either type of disability, and I'm terrified for the elderly and really all of us who rely on this system to help us live. We are not worthless! Every one of us has value! We all have people who love us and rely on us. We are all someone's child and many are someone's parent. Like most people, I have contributed so much to this world, and still do in the ways I'm able to through teaching, my extensive volunteer work, my charitable contributions over the years, and by being a good citizen, friend, mother, daughter, sister, and human. My kids have grown up but are not in a position to help support me in their 20's and I have been single for almost 20 years now. I have no one to help me or take me in or who currently helps to care for me when I'm sick, let alone if I burn through all my savings for my medical care and lose my home, like so many millions of other people. And they don't give a single crap. Every time I see someone saying that we will just be getting what we voted for I want to scream!! I didn't vote for this!!! I actively worked to try to prevent it! It's cruel, immature, and absolutely incorrect to gloat and taunt that people in my shoes deserve it because we voted for it, when we didn't. I really wish people would stop saying that. I hope there is a special corner in hell waiting for every person who helped write this bill and every single one of them who helps to pass this bill for their cruelty and the evil they are intentionally inflicting on people less fortunate than them, apparently just because they can and apparently because they find it fun."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ln1zvj/senator_warren_big_beautiful_score_now_just_shy/n0ebfl4/

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Two straight years of income falling slightly below the minimum threshold. How worried should I be? I live in a state without expanded Medicaid and have only been making between 1k to 1500 monthly for the last two years. I estimated my income as best I could, which was right above the minimum for coverage eligibility. My 2024 final income ended up being at 90% of the FPL and 96% for 2025. One of my parents had a stroke last year, which caused me to miss about a full month of work in total. I didn't report this as a life change event, however looking back perhaps I should have. I'm worried that I might not be able to get advance premium tax credits next year after two years in a row of not making as much as I estimated and being below the minimum threshold. What is the most likely outcome and is there anything I can do now to avoid being penalized?"

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sh0wl7/two_straight_years_of_income_falling_slightly/

The premium they'll see this year · 28 documents · 20 voices

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— r/obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

"It is an issue that will explode in their faces this fall if they don't extend the credits. I can't stress enough how immediately impactful and obvious it will be once consumers start looking at their 2026 rates if we go back to the 400% FPL cliff and lower subsidies for everyone under 400%. You can't bluster away the premium increase that hits people directly."

— r/obamacare · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1n8oh6a/house_republicans_launch_bill_to_extend_health/ncghst2/

"I'm a transplant patient am terrified by the cost of my premiums and prescriptions. How many people are going to die because of this BS!?"

— r/obamacare · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojey71/any_selfemployed/nm2uj4z/

"The ACA was made for people like me and my husband. We are both self-employed and have been for a good chunk of our lives, for my husband it's actually his whole adult life. We don't qualify for Medicaid, we make too much. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, but not all of it. We couldn't get health insurance any other way. We can't do catastrophic plans, we have health conditions. So it hasn't been a Band-Aid for us, it was a lifesaver. When ACA first came out, I was skeptical and wouldn't even look. Then my husband went into the hospital for 21 days. A whole had started in his colon and it was almost completely torn through, but we got there in time and he sat there for 21 days getting pumped full of strong antibiotics. And that bankrupted us. And then I signed up for the ACA and I wanted to kick myself because for four years we went without it and we could've not filed bankruptcy Had we had it I know there are people that still are falling through the cracks. Because you have to make some money to get ACA but there is also the subsidy cliff. It literally saved us. Why do people don't realize that those extended subsidies also opened up ACH to a lot of people that would have otherwise not qualified. I'm all happy to help people but it's like now people don't want the means test applied at all. The ACA is going back to its original rules. No, I do not want people to see their premiums quadruple and more, but it simply going back to what it was before Covid and it still insured around 14 million people. That may be nothing to you, but it was our literal lifeline. We either get help with healthcare or my husband goes on disability. He doesn't want that, he enjoys working. But he needs his medication and access to his doctors to keep doing that. It may be a Band-Aid for some, but it wasn't for us"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nqibrvo/

"I agree with this, it's a nightmare if you do not understand all the ups and downs with copay, premiums, deductibles, ...etc. I Googled so many terms because of my confusion of same, and took notes when needed. I navigated to the silver plans. Check and see if your doctors are listed in that plan or which doctors. A note here, some doctors listed was no longer with the plan, and I found calling the Dr's office to confirm played a large part of picking plans, I don't want to drive 30 miles to see my pcp. Then on marketplace you can also enter your prescriptions you take, my spouse had a few expensive ones. It's a nightmare and you have to be thorough, I spent many evenings learning the terminology. With market place you can save maybe 4 plans to compare, which is a big help. At the end I had a plan picked and a backup plan. I called marketplace, gave my info and details, the rep came up with the same 2 plans. You need to understand Medicare too, by then I already had a much better understanding. When you talk to agents ask about things you don't understand."

— r/HealthInsurance · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pboicez/

"This is a fantastic write up, thank you! Do you have any advice as to how practical a catastrophic plan would be in 2026? From my googling, it appears as though my family could qualify for a hardship exemption as ACA costs will be higher than 7.97% of our income. I don't want to go the uninsured route, but we can't afford the -\$1300/month bronze plan without a subsidy. Thank you!"

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1m60tzo/important_obamacareaca_changes_to_know_heading/n4i9yli/

"This is me. I have more health problems and see more specialists than the people I know/family I have who are in their late 70's, 80's and even more than my 98 year old grandmother. I am decades younger than that and terrified of what my health will be like at those ages, especially if my Medicaid is taken away. Not one of my health conditions is caused by poor choices like substance abuse or eating poorly or lack of exercise. I lost the genetic lottery and have terrible luck. I have written in my will that I wish to donate my body to science when I die because of the amount of "rare" diseases and syndromes I have. Literally every doctor I have ever had has said to me, "I have never seen this before". So that's been fun. I hope that by studying my body when I'm gone and won't need it, doctors and /or scientists will be able to learn how to help others with issues like mine someday. According to the current rules, despite being too sick to work, I have too many "assets" to qualify for SSI disability. So that will render me *not disabled* in the eyes of this new nightmare government and according to this evil bill. I gave up my teaching career when I was married when I became a stay at home mom/wife 25 years ago so I didn't pay into the social security system for decades which makes me ineligible for SSDI or social security disability. I am not qualified or trained to do any kind of job that would make enough money to be able to afford insurance and all the co-pays, deductibles, co-insurance, and prescriptions. I doubt anyone would even hire me, and I would likely get fired from all the sick days I would need. Prior to having children I was a teacher, and I would never go back to it the way society villainizes teachers for everything, not that my body could even tolerate the schedule and the stress. I cannot understand why they want you to sell your home and your car before you can qualify for SSI disability when you don't have enough work history for SSDI disability, so I don't receive benefits other than Medicaid and have been living solely off my investments which is my "retirement fund" that I started when I was 19. Every month I would contribute whatever I had, even if it was \$50, because I knew someday I wanted to be able to be home with my future children. Just in the short time since the orange monster has been in power. I have lost a scary amount of money and am terrified what I have won't last as long as I need it, thanks to his economic ineptitude. But if I sold my home and car, I would need assistance with housing and transportation. Make that make sense!? Even when it should be a slam dunk, it takes many people years, assistance from lawyers, and multiple attempts to qualify for disability. The system was broken before they came in with their plan to nuke it. I feel fortunate that I started planning for my future at such young age, but once I lose Medicaid, anything I have now will be gone in a very short amount of time, or I will die, which I think is what they want. I am terrified for people who don't have savings or investments, I'm terrified for all those of us who haven't had the energy, resources, or haven't been well enough for the battle to try to qualify for disability, and those of us who don't qualify for either type of disability, and I'm terrified for the elderly and really all of us who rely on this system to help us live. We are not worthless! Every one of us has value! We all have people who love us and rely on us. We are all someone's child and many are someone's parent. Like most people, I have contributed so much to this world, and still do in the ways I'm able to through teaching, my extensive volunteer work, my charitable contributions over the years, and by being a good citizen, friend, mother, daughter, sister, and human. My kids have grown up but are not in a position to help support me in their 20's and I have been single for almost 20 years now. I have no one to help me or take me in or who currently helps to care for me when I'm sick, let alone if I burn through all my savings for my medical care and lose my home, like so many millions of other people. And they don't give a single crap. Every time I see someone saying that we will just be getting what we voted for I want to scream!! I didn't vote for this!!! I actively worked to try to prevent it! It's cruel, immature, and absolutely incorrect to gloat and taunt that people in my shoes deserve it because we voted for it, when we didn't. I really wish people would stop saying that. I hope there is a special corner in hell waiting for every person who helped write this bill and every single one of them who helps to pass this bill for their cruelty and the evil they are intentionally inflicting on people less fortunate than them, apparently just because they can and apparently because they find it fun."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ln1zvj/senator_warren_big_beautiful_score_now_just_shy/n0ebfl4/

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Two straight years of income falling slightly below the minimum threshold. How worried should I be? I live in a state without expanded Medicaid and have only been making between 1k to 1500 monthly for the last two years. I estimated my income as best I could, which was right above the minimum for coverage eligibility. My 2024 final income ended up being at 90% of the FPL and 96% for 2025. One of my parents had a stroke last year, which caused me to miss about a full month of work in total. I didn't report this as a life change event, however looking back perhaps I should have. I'm worried that I might not be able to get advance premium tax credits next year after two years in a row of not making as much as I estimated and being below the minimum threshold. What is the most likely outcome and is there anything I can do now to avoid being penalized?"

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sh0wl7/two_straight_years_of_income_falling_slightly/

"I'm two years away from Medicare age and self employed. I have a bronze HSA policy this year with an \$8k deductible. I pay \$750 a month with the subsidy....the premium is \$1500. I won't qualify for subsidies next year either and I'm afraid to see what the premium will be. I'll probably just drop health insurance until I qualify for Medicare and hope nothing happens. 🙄 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh6uh41/

"This is key. People like the commenter that you replied to can argue about the temporary nature of Covid subsidies all they want. At the end of the day, though, does it matter when there's a reasonably large portion the population that now find themselves in a spot where, because of accelerating cost of living increases, they make too much for any relief from escalating health care costs but not nearly enough to afford health care on their own? And from the anecdotal stories posted here and elsewhere, it seems like a lot of these people tend to be 50+, an age range where health starts to degrade and access to care becomes more necessary, yet also an age where they are years away from accessing Medicare. I'm dreading to see what my premiums will look like in a few years."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q6f1ge/obamacare_premiums_jump_114_overnight_why_48/ny7wkhs/

"I don't know what we will do, we have the Silver plan at 700 a month and a 12 000 deductible. My husband is a retired firefighter and I retired from the school system early to take care of my mom because nursing home care is terrible. At 63 years old just trying to hang on until Medicare age. My husband still works doing tile work to supplement his pension. Adding up our cost for insurance including home, cars etc we almost pay 1500 month for what it's. Gotta have it as my husband has had a couple blood clots. Kinda worried to be honest."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh72uuz/

"Thinking about my premiums going up \$1000 a month starting in December keeps me up at night."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1n0ntdb/republicans_could_take_midterm_hit_if_obamacare/navsgea/

"All he does is insult everyone's intelligence, every single day. We can look up was spent on the military, and we can get a rough figure of what Medicare for all would look like. If we can afford to do the things that he is doing, including a war, every person should have health insurance. I'm on the cusp of getting diagnosed with cancer and I'm extremely scared. But at least I don't have to worry because I have health insurance, but it's getting more and more unaffordable. For the first time in our adult lives, we had to ask for help. I tripped over a curb and it left an extremely bad wound on my leg that took about 10 weeks to heal. My feet were so swollen, both of them even though I only hurt one and I couldn't wear shoes, so I couldn't work. After insurance paid, we ended up owing about \$600 and we are just squeezed so tight at the moment. It hasn't been like this since my husband started his business. People aren't remodeling kitchens or bathrooms, they are also too scared to spend. And it's finally trickled down to us. But again, at least I have health insurance and some agency for people that need help pay that entire part of the Hospital bill that I owed. I was crying because I have never had help as an adult and we have donated so much, clothing, pet things, pet food, donations for back to school backpacks, we tried to give back what we had to take his children. We tried to pay that back as adults, but now here we are in need. I was very thankful we were approved. It's getting rough out here."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1w5ertv/trump_lies_that_medicare_for_all_would_cost/p7f20yz/

"With government you have only one plan nationwide and government establishes what they will pay for services. That guarantees significantly less cost per person compared what we have now ----scores of private insurance companies with hundreds of plans with is an administrative nightmare! And government doesn't need to generate profits, no need to advertise and CEOs don't get multimillion dollar pay!"

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s82y25/obamacare_is_transitionary_universal_healthcare/odf9wtx/

"Lost my job, I can likely qualify for Medicaid but wondering if it will have bad implications at tax time So I lost my main job this week. I do have a second little 1099 side hustle that's good for about \$400 a month which is only a little over half my mortgage cost and I have some savings I can dip into. My ACA premium ended up being my second highest monthly bill because I estimated my income higher and because of Trump screwing those of us that use the program. My question is can I switch to Medicaid halfway through the without having to worry about paying back the subsidy? I'm applying for Medicaid today but obviously won't have an approval decision before my premium is due on July 1st, so I will probably have to pay my July premium. It would hurt financially to have to keep paying this inflated amount for the premium till the end of the year when I'm no longer making anywhere near that but I don't want to create an even bigger financial headache come tax time. Any insight appreciated thanks 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ufejkl/lost_my_job_i_can_likely_qualify_for_medicare_but/

"I don't remember it that way, I remember rapidly rising costs, the constant worry that if we did get sick that our policy would be cancelled or without maximum out of pockets like we have now the constant worry of bankruptcy. Again, I've bought my own for the last 30 years. And I can't wait to get on the single payer plan. I understand, the marketplace does give more help or support to those in need but those in need really do need reasonable insurance they can barely get by as it is now. I support a single payer plan based on income for all."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1l44n8o/millions_would Lose_their_obamacare_coverage/mw97svn/

"I'm so sorry. I think so too. The crazy thing is even with the subsidies it's not like my insurance is super cheap. In any other wealthy country we wouldn't have to worry about affording healthcare."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1l44n8o/millions_would Lose_their_obamacare_coverage/mwbl47l/

"Actually, given I have pretty bad asthma, don't want to die, and currently have an Obamacare plan, my personal preference would be to maintain affordable healthcare coverage so I can live to see the next election. Estimated increases could be in the neighborhood of 114% for ACA plans. Private plans through your employers won't be as harsh, but will likely exceed any imposed hikes dating back to 2010, or potentially earlier if employers decide to pull back on cost sharing options - ie, WE all pay more as companies kneecap your ability to obtain medical care. Costs could further vary depending on your local conditions, industry, network population size, and any all the other factors that contribute to cost estimates."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv8lio/a_small_think_tanks_crusade_against_obamacare_is/nhbstrmw/

Medicaid churn and being accused of fraud · 13 documents · 13 voices

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"It appears that expansion Medicaid will remain a viable pathway for many non-working households despite the new community engagement requirement. It appears that the income qualification pathway for compliance with the new community engagement requirement for expansion Medicaid will indeed be based on MAGI, not earned income or some other income calculation. This means that lower earning households who for some reason can not work need only have MAGI equal to 80 hours per month of the federal minimum wage in order to be considered qualified for the community engagement requirement. That is currently only \$580 per month. MAGI includes a broad array of income sources so this will help many segments of the current expansion Medicaid enrollment base. This will also keep people currently on expansion Medicaid from having to worry about boosting their MAGI in order to move into the bottom tier of the ACA. Those who wish to read the full details should start on page 41 of the PDF linked below. Sources: <https://www.federalregister.gov/public-inspection/current> <https://public-inspection.federalregister.gov/2026-11094.pdf> > Under new § 435.552(f)(2) and (g)(3), we establish that States must use the MAGI-based methodologies at § 435.603 when making income determinations for demonstrating community engagement. A contrary reading of the statute would require that States, after determining an individual income-eligible for the adult group, apply a separate and distinct income determination for such individuals in evaluating their demonstration of community engagement. There is no indication in section 1902(xx)(2) of the Act or elsewhere that the MAGI-based income provisions of section 1902(e)(14)(A) of the Act should not apply to the calculations under section 1902(xx)(2)(F) and (G) of the Act. Therefore, under § 435.552, we are interpreting section 1902(xx)(2)(F) and (G) of the Act in a manner that is consistent with section 1902(e)(14) of the Act. **We specify that States must use the individual's MAGI-based income as defined at § 435.603 in assessing an individual's monthly income for the purpose of determining if an individual demonstrates community engagement under § 435.552(f) or (g).**"

— r/obamacare · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tug9bm/it_appears_that_expansion_medicaid_will_remain_a/

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · None

"Covered California is confusing me after adding my newborn — why does my baby suddenly qualify for Medi-Cal? I'm so confused and hoping someone can explain how this works. I recently gave birth and went on Covered California to add my newborn baby to our health plan. Before the baby was born, it was just me and my husband on the plan. We purchased our insurance through Covered California because we make well above the Medi-Cal income limit and did not qualify. Now that I added our baby, Covered California says my baby qualifies for Medi-Cal and is also telling us that we may qualify for Medi-Cal as a family. 😞 I don't understand how that's possible. The income limit I'm seeing is less than \$4,000/month for a family of 3, but our household income is higher than that. When I called, they told me that adding the baby "brings the income down a lot," but I don't understand what that means because adding another person doesn't actually reduce our income. I do NOT want Medi-Cal. We want to keep our Covered California plan and have our baby on the same insurance if possible. Why would my newborn qualify for Medi-Cal when we didn't qualify before the baby was born, and how does adding the baby change our eligibility so dramatically? Has anyone else gone through this with a newborn in California? I'd really appreciate an explanation because I'm completely confused. 🙄 "

— r/HealthInsurance · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wf92vf/covered_california_is_confusing_me_after_adding/

"If I get a job part way through the year and cut off my ACA insurance right when my new insurance starts what happens as far as my tax credits? Update : I'm in Michigan I know we estimate for yearly income for the ACA but they wouldn't penalize me for not having or isn't ACA insurance for the months I'm covered by employer insurance right? As of right now I estimated my income higher due to making more money last year but business has taken a dive this year. I'm paying more per month because of that higher estimate and I'm looking for a new job with benefits because it's too unpredictable at this point. For what I've made for the first quarter of the year I prob would have been eligible for Medicaid so I'm also worried about getting screwed for that come tax time next year."

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s3qnb3/if_i_get_a_job_part_way_through_the_year_and_cut/

"This is me. I have more health problems and see more specialists than the people I know/family I have who are in their late 70's, 80's and even more than my 98 year old grandmother. I am decades younger than that and terrified of what my health will be like at those ages, especially if my Medicaid is taken away. Not one of my health conditions is caused by poor choices like substance abuse or eating poorly or lack of exercise. I lost the genetic lottery and have terrible luck. I have written in my will that I wish to donate my body to science when I die because of the amount of "rare" diseases and syndromes I have. Literally every doctor I have ever had has said to me, "I have never seen this before". So that's been fun. I hope that by studying my body when I'm gone and won't need it, doctors and /or scientists will be able to learn how to help others with issues like mine someday. According to the current rules, despite being too sick to work, I have too many "assets" to qualify for SSI disability. So that will render me *not disabled* in the eyes of this new nightmare government and according to this evil bill. I gave up my teaching career when I was married when I became a stay at home mom/wife 25 years ago so I didn't pay into the social security system for decades which makes me ineligible for SSDI or social security disability. I am not qualified or trained to do any kind of job that would make enough money to be able to afford insurance and all the co-pays, deductibles, co-insurance, and prescriptions. I doubt anyone would even hire me, and I would likely get fired from all the sick days I would need. Prior to having children I was a teacher, and I would never go back to it the way society villainizes teachers for everything, not that my body could even tolerate the schedule and the stress. I cannot understand why they want you to sell your home and your car before you can qualify for SSI disability when you don't have enough work history for SSDI disability, so I don't receive benefits other than Medicaid and have been living solely off my investments which is my "retirement fund" that I started when I was 19. Every month I would contribute whatever I had, even if it was \$50, because I knew someday I wanted to be able to be home with my future children. Just in the short time since the orange monster has been in power. I have lost a scary amount of money and am terrified what I have won't last as long as I need it, thanks to his economic ineptitude. But if I sold my home and car, I would need assistance with housing and transportation. Make that make sense!? Even when it should be a slam dunk, it takes many people years, assistance from lawyers, and multiple attempts to qualify for disability. The system was broken before they came in with their plan to nuke it. I feel fortunate that I started planning for my future at such young age, but once I lose Medicaid, anything I have now will be gone in a very short amount of time, or I will die, which I think is what they want. I am terrified for people who don't have savings or investments, I'm terrified for all those of us who haven't had the energy, resources, or haven't been well enough for the battle to try to qualify for disability, and those of us who don't qualify for either type of disability, and I'm terrified for the elderly and really all of us who rely on this system to help us live. We are not worthless! Every one of us has value! We all have people who love us and rely on us. We are all someone's child and many are someone's parent. Like most people, I have contributed so much to this world, and still do in the ways I'm able to through teaching, my extensive volunteer work, my charitable contributions over the years, and by being a good citizen, friend, mother, daughter, sister, and human. My kids have grown up but are not in a position to help support me in their 20's and I have been single for almost 20 years now. I have no one to help me or take me in or who currently helps to care for me when I'm sick, let alone if I burn through all my savings for my medical care and lose my home, like so many millions of other people. And they don't give a single crap. Every time I see someone saying that we will just be getting what we voted for I want to scream!! I didn't vote for this!!! I actively worked to try to prevent it! It's cruel, immature, and absolutely incorrect to gloat and taunt that people in my shoes deserve it because we voted for it, when we didn't. I really wish people would stop saying that. I hope there is a special corner in hell waiting for every person who helped write this bill and every single one of them who helps to pass this bill for their cruelty and the evil they are intentionally inflicting on people less fortunate than them, apparently just because they can and apparently because they find it fun."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ln1zvj/senator_warren_big_beautiful_score_now_just_shy/n0ebfl4/

"I don't need to read it and I know that. Trump doesn't want to help every day Americans. If he could kick everybody off of every program, he would. Poor people are ick to him. Unless you're obscenely wealthy, you don't count. He doesn't care if you live or die. Our lives changed after we enrolled in ACA. I was skeptical for the first few years and wouldn't even look. My husband has been a small business owner almost just entire adult life and I have been self-employed for 20 years now. We were destitute trying to cover my asthma meds. Two inhalers cost \$1000 per month. I actually had friends that would give them to me, when they could. The ACA gave us the one thing we could not handle on our own, which was health insurance. We could afford paying some, but not all. People don't realize the protections the ACA gives anyone that has any health insurance and the biggest one is insurance companies cannot deny for pre-existing conditions. If the ACA goes under, the protections go with it And they can't get it repealed so they are trying to kill it. I always knew it would be on the chopping block, just a matter of when. He's touched Medicaid, food stamps, this one's a no-brainer. I don't need the money to get my own health insurance. I need the protections we have and some subsidy money, paid to the insurance company He would have some people that would just pocket the money, how are they going to check they actual used it for insurance? How was the not socialism?? Dr. Oz says they have a plan but they don't want to tip their cards. I don't believe it. They're scrambling to put some Quick, not thought out, goofy plan. The cheap ones would all be catastrophic plans. Again, he can't and won't understand because he's never had to worry about a medical bill. If we lose health insurance, we would be homeless, that is how greatly it would affect us. My husband has to have his heart medication. He's not obese, he is extremely active and he eats a big salad with every dinner. It's not anything he did, it's hereditary, from both sides. He would die without his medicine, and there is no way we can afford it on our own. But I would sell everything I own to keep him alive as long as I could. Every time he has chest pains, he has to go to the hospital. Because we can't take a chance. He had a triple bypass at age 52 but I know he has been in the hospital at least three times this year, he is always admitted. It's so great to have to worry about this shit on top of everything else in life. I have never hated anyone like I hate this man. I do, I explicitly, completely hate him. Because the cruelty is the point, it's punishment for not being obscenely wealthy"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1our4kv/obamacare_could_collapse_under_trumps_new_plan/noeif0f/

"Regarding the cliff: my husband and I are old genx'ers and are basically retired due to medical reasons. We live in a HCOL area. If we go ONE DOLLAR over \$84,600, our annual ACA premium will jump from approximately \$16,500 to just shy of \$34,000. IN WHAT UNIVERSE IS THAT FAIR OR LOGICAL? He just had a hip replacement that went wrong (thanks, doc), and his hospital bills are over \$200,000 and climbing. And he has to have his other hip replaced in 3 weeks! He's only 57, thin, in great shape, but had a bad luck of the draw. The worst part is that this is the "easy" stuff with our medical issues. The point is, how the hell can we have a 2-person MAGI of \$84.6k, ACA premiums of \$16.5k, max OOP of \$17k (which we have burned through), property taxes of \$15k, and not even get into the daily expenses of living? We thought we had *hopefully* saved enough for a very, very modest retirement, but since it's all in a pre-tax SEP-IRA, every withdrawal counts against our MAGI. With the dismal way things are looking, we're renovating our home now so we can sell it, cash out on the equity to have for our healthcare, and move to another state with a lower COL. That's effed up, but it's how scared we are for our future because of our upcoming medical needs. God, just re-reading everything I wrote makes me burst into tears again for the 1000th time. Maybe we should use his Canadian citizenship and head north... Sorry for the emotional post. It's been a really tough year. Hopefully someone can relate."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vgga4i/senate_dems_post_memo_on_reforms_to_make_health/p1y9oaf/

"> . It's not at all expensive if you work or are retired. LOL I'm trying to figure out if you're an idiot, insane, or just evil and pushing an agenda. After paying the highest taxes in the world towards healthcare, Americans pay the highest insurance premiums in the world, and still have the highest out of pocket costs in the world, leaving even the insured unable to afford needed healthcare in large numbers. In total, Americans are paying \$650,000 more for a lifetime of healthcare (PPP) than peers with universal healthcare on average, yet we have worse health outcomes than every single one. 36% of US households with insurance put off needed care [due to the cost](<https://www.commonwealthfund.org/publications/surveys/2023/oct/paying-for-it-costs-debt-americans-sicker-poorer-2023-affordability-survey>); 64% of households without insurance. One in four have [trouble paying a medical bill.](<https://www.kff.org/health-costs/issue-brief/data-note-americans-challenges-health-care-costs/>) Of [those with insurance one in five have trouble paying a medical bill](<https://www.kff.org/wp-content/uploads/2016/01/8806-the-burden-of-medical-debt-results-from-the-kaizer-family-foundation-new-york-times-medical-bills-survey.pdf>), and even for those with income above \$100,000 14% have trouble. One in six Americans has [unpaid medical debt on their credit report.](<https://www.healthaffairs.org/doi/full/10.1377/hlthaff.2018.0349>) [50% of all Americans](<https://news.gallup.com/poll/317948/fear-bankruptcy-due-major-health-event.aspx>) fear bankruptcy due to a major health event. [Tens of thousands](<https://pnhp.org/news/lack-of-insurance-to-blame-for-almost-45000-deaths-study/>) of Americans [die every year](https://www.sanders.senate.gov/wp-content/uploads/Fact-Sheet_Medicare-for-All-2023.pdf) for [lack of affordable healthcare](<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC2323087/>). With healthcare spending [expected to increase](<https://www.cms.gov/files/document/nhe-projections-forecast-summary.pdf>) from an already unsustainable \$16,570 in 2025, to an absolutely catastrophic \$24,200 by 2033 (with no signs of slowing down), things are only going to get much worse if nothing is done. >Spain and the UK all have free healthcare and deliver medical services so appallingly that most are forced to pay for private health insurance. Spain has the 19th best health outcomes in the world. The UK has the 23rd best outcomes. The US is 29th. [https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lancet/article/PIIS0140-6736\(18\)30994-2/fulltext](https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lancet/article/PIIS0140-6736(18)30994-2/fulltext) When asked about their healthcare system as a whole the US system ranked dead last of 11 countries, with only 19.5% of people saying the system works relatively well and only needs minor changes. The average in the other countries is 46.9% saying the same. Canada ranked 9th with 34.5% saying the system works relatively well. The UK ranks fifth, with 44.5%. Australia ranked 6th at 44.4%. The best was Germany at 59.8%. On rating the overall quality of care in the US, Americans again ranked dead last, with only 25.6% ranking it excellent or very good. The average was 50.8%. Canada ranked 9th with 45.1%. The UK ranked 2nd, at 63.4%. Australia was 3rd at 59.4%. The best was Switzerland at 65.5%. <https://www.cihi.ca/en/commonwealth-fund-survey-2016> And you're just wrong about most having private insurance, but even when they do it's still better than the US. For starters, they pay far less in taxes towards healthcare. With government in the US covering [65.7% of all health care](<https://ajph.aphapublications.org/doi/epdf/10.2105/AJPH.2015.302997>) costs (\$12,555 as of 2022) that's \$8,249 per person per year in taxes towards health care. The next closest is Germany at [\$6,930](<https://data.oecd.org/healthres/health-spending.htm>). The UK is \$4,479. Canada is \$4,506. Australia is \$4,603. That means over a lifetime Americans are paying over \$100,000 more in taxes compared to any other country towards health care. Most find that to be enough. For example in the UK only about 11% have private insurance (most as an employer perk). If they want private insurance, it's much cheaper than in the US. About \$20,000 a year cheaper for family insurance in the UK. And it covers more. I've got to say, it's impressive how much bullshit and propaganda you managed to get into one post."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nx1e4q/kff_survey_says_almost_60_of_gop_voters_support/nhq2z7p/

"Lost my job, I can likely qualify for Medicaid but wondering if it will have bad implications at tax time So I lost my main job this week. I do have a second little 1099 side hustle that's good for about \$400 a month which is only a little over half my mortgage cost and I have some savings I can dip into. My ACA premium ended up being my second highest monthly bill because I estimated my income higher and because of Trump screwing those of us that use the program. My question is can I switch to Medicaid halfway through the without having to worry about paying back the subsidy? I'm applying for Medicaid today but obviously won't have an approval decision before my premium is due on July 1st, so I will probably have to pay my July premium. It would hurt financially to have to keep paying this inflated amount for the premium till the end of the year when I'm no longer making anywhere near that but I don't want to create an even bigger financial headache come tax time. Any insight appreciated thanks 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ufejkl/lost_my_job_i_can_likely_qualified_for_medicaid_but/](https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ufejkl/lost_my_job_i_can_likely_qualify_for_medicaid_but/)

"Right all that doge stuff to spend more due to doge while Elmo was still the public clown of it. Trump wanted to cut 2.4 trillion, I didn't get the economics or math behind that and my friend sighed and said "maga doesn't know economics, math, how to read or think critically. I mean Greene voted for the bill. Then apparently she asked chatgtp what was in it or someone translated it to Neanderthal so the b6 ape 🦍 could understand and then she was against it. Like her next election comes along, Medicaid, Medicare, Ava cuts have closed hospitals and nursing homes, the Va isn't running or volunteers are trying to keep the doors open, and people have lost their homes, her voters, 97% of peoples taxes had a trump tax raise, read my big fat orange lips, I'm gonna cut taxes bigly! Well, bezos, Zuckerberg, Tim apple, etc might have kissed the ring and bought trump coin, but they do not need tax cuts as individuals. Trickle down economics is a farce rotten Ronnie started in the 1980s and it hollowed out the middle class, he did a ton of damage to unions taking power from workers and giving it to corporations, who do whatever for share holders, record profits? Fire 17,000 people, gotta have a higher stock price so you don't get sued by blackrock. That corporate tax cut Tim Apple got? Bezos and others? 10%? Like corporations pay less in taxes than individuals I'm pretty sure, I'd have to double check on a graph, if corporations... like instead of tariffs and tax cuts for corporations I would have worked with the world trade organization, the U, EU, Japan, China, the commonwealth countries etc, and set a global tax rate, perhaps 22-25%, require health and safety standards globally, agree to pension and health care standard as well as a minimum wage scaled to the local economy, Sweden and some European countries system of everyone being in local unions and setting local wage tiers collectively based on cost of living that the people voting on the pay live through. I mean someone who made 200 million from insider trading, or someone born with a golden spoon in his mouth that still uses it as a coke spoon on the resolute desk, they day it's a Diet Coke button, it's freuds little helper vitamin cocaine, but basically weave aside creepy Mike Johnson, when asked about preventing insider trading or perhaps it was any trading, he said, he'd consider it "BUT congress hadn't gotten a raise since 2016-2018 and this wage loss represented a 33% reduction in pay due to inflation and cost of living, so some trading should be allowed so..."(basically they couldn't get people in congress without a raise or insider trading or something, it's like ok Hb you all resign and give up your pay for life and go to Elon for a handout I hear that works really well... They make like 200,000, for life, they get free healthcare for life, that probably isn't getting cut, potus gets pay for life, then they're like oh we haven't had a raise we need to be able to buy and sell stock... even if they don't break the law of regular people as they do, but bc they make the law they should have it in a blind trust. Perhaps to save mo et cut the lifetime healthcare and pay, have them just pay into social security, need Medicare, and get a 3.4-5% matching 401k like some of us are lucky to have. I'll paste the Gemini quote about shifting from defined contribution, or pensions, peak 50% in the 1960s, due to private sector growth of /r/union jobs. Your mission rn, should you chose to accept it, is to start a discussion, keep it to one post and post your industry wage benefits, healthcare and retirement... Example: begin weave; I made 45k 2006-2008, I have 18,000 in my pension and like 6k in my 401k, my pension will pay 900/mo adjusted for inflation for two years of work for life! If I got hired 2.5 years earlier I'd have healthcare for life for free. I had a 35 hour work week, I had 18,000 in tuition reimbursement and job training money, the union said I could use the \$4000 in job training to take related classes to my job, and use the rest for other classes. I was on medication that made me easy to manipulate and an mba got in there and decided it'd be cheaper to get a temp in my job, I got a call offering 20,000 more in salary with similar vacation and benefits, but then the economy crashed and I got laid off, so I left my union job bc some incompetent bob, he did such a bad job they had to rename my formerly prestigious department, then wait until people forgot about the bob and change it back... biggest regret of my life walking into that trap, but I wanted to own a home, knew housing prices would skyrocket, and going from 45k to 65k was enough if the economy didn't crash. /end weave it's the richest 1-4% that get a tax cut or maybe 1-2% see a tax cut, tariffs might have sounded good to Greene, until the cost of wood, steel, everything went through the roof, food got much more expensive during Covid, Georgia meets federal snap 100% if you buy from Georgia farmers, like a lot of small maga and non maga farms alike went out of business in Georgia and locals could not

afford to outbid big agriculture. Big ag would just double a bid and look around like, ok, get the message? We always win... then they produce worse food bc it's to appease shareholders like blackrock Blackrock is suing united healthcare for providing too much healthcare! Like didn't someone retire to Cancun after United got found out? Usually you have to fire someone to make it look like you're doing something. I'm on Ssdi and section 8 Medicare and Medicaid in affordable housing on snap, that's why I kind of rambled in and out of policy to examples that turn into stories, my older brother died homeless and I'm worried these cuts might make it the same for me. Luckily I have hundreds of relatives and my whole generation are two income households to afford kids, the lucky part of that is who ever puts up an accessory dwelling unit and helps me get by would get daycare, I watched them when they were little, just realized this now, duh. Maybe I should talk to some of them about it. I'd be a lot less freaked out and worried if I wasn't in a position to end up on the street."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1l7mqzy/any_way_you_look_at_it_you_lose_medicaid_work/mwz1r8j/

"Confused So I currently work for a family business. Business is dying out. Looking like next year I will not be employed much longer. I have enough in savings to pay for insurance in NY as needed. Currently making just enough to be on the essential plan in NY. Don't want to get on Medicaid if I can help it. Can I still pay out of pocket for an ACA plan or am I forced to be on Medicaid? Edit: Sorry if this sounds stupid, just want to continue seeing my current doctors and getting my prescriptions without interruption"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wja6ah/confused/>

"Unfortunately not true in my case. I was left without confirmation of coverage for 10 days till my new insurance started. I could have taken a risk and gotten care at that time but I have no way of knowing if they would have reinstated my coverage. As of now I still haven't been contacted by the case manager. So no, they couldn't fix this and I spent those 10 days in fear of needing medical attention."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1st004d/aca_canceled_my_policy_without_my_permission_and/ok97i9z/

Income on paper: the MAGI cliff and paying credits back · 10 documents · 10 voices

"It is an issue that will explode in their faces this fall if they don't extend the credits. I can't stress enough how immediately impactful and obvious it will be once consumers start looking at their 2026 rates if we go back to the 400% FPL cliff and lower subsidies for everyone under 400%. You can't bluster away the premium increase that hits people directly."

— r/obamacare · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1n8oh6a/house_republicans_launch_bill_to_extend_health/ncghst2/

"It appears that expansion Medicaid will remain a viable pathway for many non-working households despite the new community engagement requirement. It appears that the income qualification pathway for compliance with the new community engagement requirement for expansion Medicaid will indeed be based on MAGI, not earned income or some other income calculation. This means that lower earning households who for some reason can not work need only have MAGI equal to 80 hours per month of the federal minimum wage in order to be considered qualified for the community engagement requirement. That is currently only \$580 per month. MAGI includes a broad array of income sources so this will help many segments of the current expansion Medicaid enrollment base. This will also keep people currently on expansion Medicaid from having to worry about boosting their MAGI in order to move into the bottom tier of the ACA. Those who wish to read the full details should start on page 41 of the PDF linked below. Sources: <https://www.federalregister.gov/public-inspection/current> <https://public-inspection.federalregister.gov/2026-11094.pdf> > Under new § 435.552(f)(2) and (g)(3), we establish that States must use the MAGI-based methodologies at § 435.603 when making income determinations for demonstrating community engagement. A contrary reading of the statute would require that States, after determining an individual income-eligible for the adult group, apply a separate and distinct income determination for such individuals in evaluating their demonstration of community engagement. There is no indication in section 1902(xx)(2) of the Act or elsewhere that the MAGI-based income provisions of section 1902(e)(14)(A) of the Act should not apply to the calculations under section 1902(xx)(2)(F) and (G) of the Act. Therefore, under § 435.552, we are interpreting section 1902(xx)(2)(F) and (G) of the Act in a manner that is consistent with section 1902(e)(14) of the Act. **We specify that States must use the individual's MAGI-based income as defined at § 435.603 in assessing an individual's monthly income for the purpose of determining if an individual demonstrates community engagement under § 435.552(f) or (g).**"

— r/obamacare · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tug9bm/it_appears_that_expansion_medicaid_will_remain_a/

"If I get a job part way through the year and cut off my ACA insurance right when my new insurance starts what happens as far as my tax credits? Update : I'm in Michigan I know we estimate for yearly income for the ACA but they wouldn't penalize me for not having or isn't ACA insurance for the months I'm covered by employer insurance right? As of right now I estimated my income higher due to making more money last year but business has taken a dive this year. I'm paying more per month because of that higher estimate and I'm looking for a new job with benefits because it's too unpredictable at this point. For what I've made for the first quarter of the year I prob would have been eligible for Medicaid so I'm also worried about getting screwed for that come tax time next year."

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s3qnb3/if_i_get_a_job_part_way_through_the_year_and_cut/

"Going into my fourth month without a job. I need to cancel my plan if i reach 6 months of no work right? i lost my job in December and thought id find a job by february but rhings fell through. its been really difficult finding a new job and i feel hopeless I'll find one soon. im scared I'll have to pay back if i exceed 6 months without a job so its recommended i cancel then right? then if i find a job I'll have to wait until enrollment but better than paying this shit back without having \$\$"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sigc4v/going_into_my_fourth_month_without_a_job_i_need/

"I'm adding to what Seaweed said in their post. I'm in a similar situation to you. I've been able to play with my assets to keep my income below 400%. Also, I only use about half my ACA credit so I don't have to worry about a repayment. Then at tax time, I receive the additional premium credit which helps fund the next year's monthly premium."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/o7kq8hw/

"Lost my job, I can likely qualify for Medicaid but wondering if it will have bad implications at tax time So I lost my main job this week. I do have a second little 1099 side hustle that's good for about \$400 a month which is only a little over half my mortgage cost and I have some savings I can dip into. My ACA premium ended up being my second highest monthly bill because I estimated my income higher and because of Trump screwing those of us that use the program. My question is can I switch to Medicaid halfway through the without having to worry about paying back the subsidy? I'm applying for Medicaid today but obviously won't have an approval decision before my premium is due on July 1st, so I will probably have to pay my July premium. It would hurt financially to have to keep paying this inflated amount for the premium till the end of the year when I'm no longer making anywhere near that but I don't want to create an even bigger financial headache come tax time. Any insight appreciated thanks 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ufejkl/lost_my_job_i_can_likely_qualify_for_medicaid_but/

"Right all that doge stuff to spend more due to doge while Elmo was still the public clown of it. Trump wanted to cut 2.4 trillion, I didn't get the economics or math behind that and my friend sighed and said "maga doesn't know economics, math, how to read or think critically. I mean Greene voted for the bill. Then apparently she asked chatgtp what was in it or someone translated it to Neanderthal so the b6 ape 🦍 could understand and then she was against it. Like her next election comes along, Medicaid, Medicare, Ava cuts have closed hospitals and nursing homes, the Va isn't running or volunteers are trying to keep the doors open, and people have lost their homes, her voters, 97% of peoples taxes had a trump tax raise, read my big fat orange lips, I'm gonna cut taxes bigly! Well, bezos, Zuckerberg, Tim apple, etc might have kissed the ring and bought trump coin, but they do not need tax cuts as individuals. Trickle down economics is a farce rotten Ronnie started in the 1980s and it hollowed out the middle class, he did a ton of damage to unions taking power from workers and giving it to corporations, who do whatever for share holders, record profits? Fire 17,000 people, gotta have a higher stock price so you don't get sued by blackrock. That corporate tax cut Tim Apple got? Bezos and others? 10%? Like corporations pay less in taxes than individuals I'm pretty sure, I'd have to double check on a graph, if corporations... like instead of tariffs and tax cuts for corporations I would have worked with the world trade organization, the U, EU, Japan, China, the commonwealth countries etc, and set a global tax rate, perhaps 22-25%, require health and safety standards globally, agree to pension and health care standard as well as a minimum wage scaled to the local economy, Sweden and some European countries system of everyone being in local unions and setting local wage tiers collectively based on cost of living that the people voting on the pay live through. I mean someone who made 200 million from insider trading, or someone born with a golden spoon in his mouth that still uses it as a coke spoon on the resolute desk, they day it's a Diet Coke button, it's freuds little helper vitamin cocaine, but basically weave aside creepy Mike Johnson, when asked about preventing insider trading or perhaps it was any trading, he said, he'd consider it "BUT congress hadn't gotten a raise since 2016-2018 and this wage loss represented a 33% reduction in pay due to inflation and cost of living, so some trading should be allowed so..."(basically they couldn't get people in congress without a raise or insider trading or something, it's like ok Hb you all resign and give up your pay for life and go to Elon for a handout I hear that works really well... They make like 200,000, for life, they get free healthcare for life, that probably isn't getting cut, potus gets pay for life, then they're like oh we haven't had a raise we need to be able to buy and sell stock... even if they don't break the law of regular people as they do, but bc they make the law they should have it in a blind trust. Perhaps to save mo et cut the lifetime healthcare and pay, have them just pay into social security, need Medicare, and get a 3.4-5% matching 401k like some of us are lucky to have. I'll paste the Gemini quote about shifting from defined contribution, or pensions, peak 50% in the 1960s, due to private sector growth of /r/union jobs. Your mission rn, should you chose to accept it, is to start a discussion, keep it to one post and post your industry wage benefits, healthcare and retirement... Example: begin weave; I made 45k 2006-2008, I have 18,000 in my pension and like 6k in my 401k, my pension will pay 900/mo adjusted for inflation for two years of work for life! If I got hired 2.5 years earlier I'd have healthcare for life for free. I had a 35 hour work week, I had 18,000 in tuition reimbursement and job training money, the union said I could use the \$4000 in job training to take related classes to my job, and use the rest for other classes. I was on medication that made me easy to manipulate and an mba got in there and decided it'd be cheaper to get a temp in my job, I got a call offering 20,000 more in salary with similar vacation and benefits, but then the economy crashed and I got laid off, so I left my union job bc some incompetent bob, he did such a bad job they had to rename my formerly prestigious department, then wait until people forgot about the bob and change it back... biggest regret of my life walking into that trap, but I wanted to own a home, knew housing prices would skyrocket, and going from 45k to 65k was enough if the economy didn't crash. /end weave it's the richest 1-4% that get a tax cut or maybe 1-2% see a tax cut, tariffs might have sounded good to Greene, until the cost of wood, steel, everything went through the roof, food got much more expensive during Covid, Georgia meets federal snap 100% if you buy from Georgia farmers, like a lot of small maga and non maga farms alike went out of business in Georgia and locals could not

afford to outbid big agriculture. Big ag would just double a bid and look around like, ok, get the message? We always win... then they produce worse food bc it's to appease shareholders like blackrock Blackrock is suing united healthcare for providing too much healthcare! Like didn't someone retire to Cancun after United got found out? Usually you have to fire someone to make it look like you're doing something. I'm on Ssd and section 8 Medicare and Medicaid in affordable housing on snap, that's why I kind of rambled in and out of policy to examples that turn into stories, my older brother died homeless and I'm worried these cuts might make it the same for me. Luckily I have hundreds of relatives and my whole generation are two income households to afford kids, the lucky part of that is who ever puts up an accessory dwelling unit and helps me get by would get daycare, I watched them when they were little, just realized this now, duh. Maybe I should talk to some of them about it. I'd be a lot less freaked out and worried if I wasn't in a position to end up on the street."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1l7mqzy/any_way_you_look_at_it_you_lose_medicaid_work/mwz1r8j/

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

"Does anybody know how ACA considers dividend funds like QQQI - say I buy 10k of it at the beginning of year 1. Then I get that the dividends I take out that year count as income. But with these funds the div are subtracted from initial cost - so in year 2 my cost basis is 10k minus 1500 so 8500. If I decide to sell these in year 2, does the 1500 count as "income" for Aca? It will count as capital gains for taxes (cause they don't tax dividends I think)... anybody in here knows what I'm talking about? I'd like to get 40k of qqqi for div income, but afraid of being stuck with huge "income" on paper that can ruin my ACA premium credits down the road if I ever need to sell..."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVywz5Ac7pA&lc=UgzjFs6wDCnH1cDhKXx4AaABAq>

↳ @tachikaze222 (0): "return of capital ia NOT considered income for ACA; check your 1099-DIV, box 3 income doesn't count for ACA"

"Yup, bascially my plan too ... keep ACA income at \$50k/yr via living small and maybe strategic HELOC draws for any big expenses that come up that I don't want to pull out of the Roth."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVywz5Ac7pA&lc=UgwMcou1-AaTNPj7HRR4AaABAq.AOfaGIMHv3HAWa_FCE_IT5

Losing coverage or the subsidy · 7 documents · 7 voices

"I'm terrified of losing my Obamacare I'm a one issue voter. I want to keep my Obamacare. Having this allowed me and my husband to quit our terrible soul sucking jobs and start small businesses. It's not perfect and it costs a lot but it's been a life saver. Literally. Now that you know what happened, will I have to get another horrible job that destroys my will to live just to have health insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,425 upvotes · None

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · None

"A freaking nightmare. We have to enroll by Dec. 15 for Jan. 1 effective date. I have a decent silver plan, but the premium will increase by 300 percent without subsidies, which means I will just sign up for a cheaper bronze plan if there is no change by the 15th. People like me don't want to be stuck in a lowered plan if we find out after the 15th that we will get subsidies and we don't want to risk going without insurance for a period. Knowing the GOP, they will deliberately delay this if they are going to offer subsidies just for the opportunity to be cruel."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nghi12x/

"This is a fantastic write up, thank you! Do you have any advice as to how practical a catastrophic plan would be in 2026? From my googling, it appears as though my family could qualify for a hardship exemption as ACA costs will be higher than 7.97% of our income. I don't want to go the uninsured route, but we can't afford the -\$1300/month bronze plan without a subsidy. Thank you!"

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1m60tzo/important_obamacareaca_changes_to_know_heading/n4i9yli/

"Just don't know what to do. Hey all. My husband and I are both self-employed. Currently, I'm still under 26 and on my parents' plan, though not for much longer. My husband is currently uninsured. We don't qualify for any subsidies, as our income is just over the 400% FPL limit. Despite this, we still live paycheck to paycheck as is, due to living in a high-cost of living area. Packing up and moving isn't really an option, as both of our businesses are based here. We simply can't afford to fork over hundreds to thousands of dollars each month for an ACA compliant plan. I've considered non-ACA, but everyone on this sub seems to think it's a terrible idea and they won't cover anything. At this point I'm just at a loss and don't know what to do. I worry about my husband being uninsured, and I'm considering giving up my business and getting a job that can provide us with insurance, though I really don't want to. Any advice is appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wfnwua/just_dont_know_what_to_do/

"Accidentally clicked "Report a Life Change" and had to go through whole application it seems. Did this mess anything up? Was on Healthcare Marketplace website logged in trying to look at some contact information to make sure it was right and accidentally clicked into the "Report a Life Change". It then made our 2026 application status go from "COMPELTE" to "IN PROGRESS". It basically had us go through the *entire* application again which gave the same determination as we got last year during PY2026 open enrollment (same premium tax credit amount). **I'm just worried and wanted to make sure I didn't mess any coverage up. Is it normal for the system to make you go through *everything* again? We are NOT making any changes to plan (not that we are eligible anyways since we are not in special enrollment period). Do I need to contact the health/dental plan to make sure they received the "updated" application? Just scared to potentially lose coverage. Thank you.**"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sfdqq9/accidentally_clicked_report_a_life_change_and_had/

"Will I have to refund the credit? I recently quit my job and my income for the rest of the year will be around 1500/mo but my total income for 2026 is much higher than that. How do the healthcare supplements work n healthcare.gov? I Applied for coverage on heath care.gov but when it came to choosing the plan, I didn't hit confirm because it says that if my 2026 tax returns are higher than I stated I would need to refund the stipend. I don't mind waiting a few months for 2027 without health insurance now, but what if I get the stipend in 2027 and then get a job and then my 2027 tax returns are also too high? So, if I'm making 1500/mo now in Sept 2026 and it takes me 6 months to get a job, will I have to refund the stipend? It's like \$800/months stipend for healthcare they offer but I won't be able to afford to pay that back once I get a job. Any advice?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wia2qt/will_i_have_to_refund_the_credit/

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

A plan they can actually use · 19 documents · 19 voices

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come of it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"NPR reporter wants to hear how you're prepping for next year's rate changes Hi there, I'm Selena Simmons-Duffin, a reporter who covers health policy at NPR. I'm hoping to talk to people about [next year's higher rates](<https://www.npr.org/sections/shots-health-news/2025/07/18/nx-s1-5471281/aca-health-insurance-premiums-obamacare-bbb-kff>) \-- how it might affect your coverage and costs and how you're feeling about it all. I'd love to hear from a variety of perspectives -- different ages and places and situations. Send me a message on Reddit, or you can reach me by email [selenasd@npr.org](mailto:selenasd@npr.org) or on Signal: selena.02 I'm happy to talk on background or anonymously, but I would love to hear from people who'd be willing to share what's going on with them on the record for my story. Thanks!"

— r/obamacare · 115 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mb9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/

"This is me. I have more health problems and see more specialists than the people I know/family I have who are in their late 70's, 80's and even more than my 98 year old grandmother. I am decades younger than that and terrified of what my health will be like at those ages, especially if my Medicaid is taken away. Not one of my health conditions is caused by poor choices like substance abuse or eating poorly or lack of exercise. I lost the genetic lottery and have terrible luck. I have written in my will that I wish to donate my body to science when I die because of the amount of "rare" diseases and syndromes I have. Literally every doctor I have ever had has said to me, "I have never seen this before". So that's been fun. I hope that by studying my body when I'm gone and won't need it, doctors and /or scientists will be able to learn how to help others with issues like mine someday. According to the current rules, despite being too sick to work, I have too many "assets" to qualify for SSI disability. So that will render me *not disabled* in the eyes of this new nightmare government and according to this evil bill. I gave up my teaching career when I was married when I became a stay at home mom/wife 25 years ago so I didn't pay into the social security system for decades which makes me ineligible for SSDI or social security disability. I am not qualified or trained to do any kind of job that would make enough money to be able to afford insurance and all the co-pays, deductibles, co-insurance, and prescriptions. I doubt anyone would even hire me, and I would likely get fired from all the sick days I would need. Prior to having children I was a teacher, and I would never go back to it the way society villainizes teachers for everything, not that my body could even tolerate the schedule and the stress. I cannot understand why they want you to sell your home and your car before you can qualify for SSI disability when you don't have enough work history for SSDI disability, so I don't receive benefits other than Medicaid and have been living solely off my investments which is my "retirement fund" that I started when I was 19. Every month I would contribute whatever I had, even if it was \$50, because I knew someday I wanted to be able to be home with my future children. Just in the short time since the orange monster has been in power. I have lost a scary amount of money and am terrified what I have won't last as long as I need it, thanks to his economic ineptitude. But if I sold my home and car, I would need assistance with housing and transportation. Make that make sense!? Even when it should be a slam dunk, it takes many people years, assistance from lawyers, and multiple attempts to qualify for disability. The system was broken before they came in with their plan to nuke it. I feel fortunate that I started planning for my future at such young age, but once I lose Medicaid, anything I have now will be gone in a very short amount of time, or I will die, which I think is what they want. I am terrified for people who don't have savings or investments, I'm terrified for all those of us who haven't had the energy, resources, or haven't been well enough for the battle to try to qualify for disability, and those of us who don't qualify for either type of disability, and I'm terrified for the elderly and really all of us who rely on this system to help us live. We are not worthless! Every one of us has value! We all have people who love us and rely on us. We are all someone's child and many are someone's parent. Like most people, I have contributed so much to this world, and still do in the ways I'm able to through teaching, my extensive volunteer work, my charitable contributions over the years, and by being a good citizen, friend, mother, daughter, sister, and human. My kids have grown up but are not in a position to help support me in their 20's and I have been single for almost 20 years now. I have no one to help me or take me in or who currently helps to care for me when I'm sick, let alone if I burn through all my savings for my medical care and lose my home, like so many millions of other people. And they don't give a single crap. Every time I see someone saying that we will just be getting what we voted for I want to scream!! I didn't vote for this!!! I actively worked to try to prevent it! It's cruel, immature, and absolutely incorrect to gloat and taunt that people in my shoes deserve it because we voted for it, when we didn't. I really wish people would stop saying that. I hope there is a special corner in hell waiting for every person who helped write this bill and every single one of them who helps to pass this bill for their cruelty and the evil they are intentionally inflicting on people less fortunate than them, apparently just because they can and apparently because they find it fun."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ln1zvj/senator_warren_big_beautiful_score_now_just_shy/n0ebfl4/

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO

and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

"Get government OUT of healthcare and insurance! Back when Obumer first messed with it and caused premiums to start to rise (both ACA and non ACA plans as the new costs for new required benefits, legal and regulatory compliance, etc has to be absorbed via any and all health insurance plans regardless of an ACA plan or not). We went from 3 people being covered on what would be about a "silver" on the ACA or a mid plan was \$238 per month. Today for two people it is over \$1,300 per month and there are areas that are even higher than the state and county / area that we live in. On a per covered basis our health insurance premiums are up 410%. Even a few years ago when we moved from one state to another we paid around \$492 per month....four years later, just over \$1,300. thank you government. Just the insurance premiums and rent (no power, water, food, gas, car insurance or any other expenses) costs me \$40,200 per year and that gets paid with after tax dollars so you do the math. just the fixed cost of a roof and insurance with nothing else and we need to earn around \$47,000 before taxes to cover that. God forbid we want to eat, have car insurance and other insurance, fuel for the car, car repairs, clothing, phone service, etc. Again, great work to the tick in Congress for screwing everyone over rather than just helping the few that need, ACTUALLY need the help. All the fraud out there so far should give everyone some idea of the money we flush down the drain. I wager if it was totaled up it would be around \$500 billion per year or more and that is already after the gubment makes so many other things artificially expensive....college tuition anyone? Nothing my insurance agent loves more than sitting across the table from me as we review the plans that, even after I spend \$16,000 per year on premiums for I still have very high deductibles making it really cost me around \$25,000 before insurance does anything when you add premiums and deductibles together (and no I don't count \$15 off some pharma scrip as mattering). What they need to do is allow, the law prevents this for most people - that's right the government is making it illegal for you to purchase certain types of plans less you fall into a small criteria. what am I ranting about? Disaster style policies. Everyone needs to be able to get those but for most plans you have to be under a certain income or under 30 years of age or just unemployed and need a bridge. My spouse and I don't need all the "benefits" we just want emergency coverage and disease treatment type stuff. There is so much that pad plans, even in hers (and she is almost 50!) still has all this child birthing stuff, breast feeding classes, etc. all for "free" even though she is almost 50 and also can't even have kids in the first place but, same risk pool as everyone else rather than being prices as an individual like with your car insurance."

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=UgzNhfDE0RdaDEBn28x4AaABAq>

↳ @bookmark692 (0): "The Messiah picked winners and losers with health insurance. F'D everyone, except the politicians."

"@HowToRetire I agree.Had my " moment of clarity " (I'm Irish)as an RN in Trauma ICU one day ,after a doctor ticked me off. Put in my papers ,retired,called out the last two weeks .Received all my monies due:pension,vacation,sick,comp time,extended illness,and pretax 457 B money. Glad I left,it saved my life.Got myself healthy.Have been receiving my pension since 2014, and claimed Social Security benefits at 62 last year. I was informed that I was missed by former coworkers.It's important to know when it's time to leave as 4 former coworkers died over the last 2 years. I realize I digressed,sorry. The first year post retirement at age 55, my monthly premium was & 663/ month which rose to \$ 677/ month. They wanted to jack it up to \$ 913/month when I turned 58.Went without health insurance for 5 yrs and am fortunate nothing catastrophic happened to me. However ,I used that money saved to get out of debt. I finally obtained a decent premium price for \$ 673/month ,after turning 62 and claiming Social Security. So it's a bit of a hit,but easier to withstand."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=UgxuDqz0nO2tXhXUNd4AaABA9Q3ovSLSXIZ9R1tiYo8C3j>

"Man I wish I was rich enough that \$600 a month in premiums for 30k deductible was on the same planet as reasonable. If something extreme happens to me or my wife, the difference between 30k and 250k is only how long I have to think about just filing for bankruptcy. Either way I just can't pay it. The "i can't afford the cheapest option so too bad for me if something bad happens I guess" layer feels kinda forgotten on this."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1riagjy/yikes_new_federal_health_insurance_rules_could/o86ats6/

"I don't think that's possible with ACA. The insurance company has to pay the agent fee if there is one but they don't give discounts if there isn't one. But I'd like it if there was because it's an expense in this shitty health care system that none of us can afford and while I'm sure it provides value to some people, it's not directly providing me care and I don't want/need/feel like paying for it."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rmyvm7/this_is_for_anyone_without_an_agent_on_their/o958isa/

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wjvhr9/please_help_best_insurance_in_nj_for_someone/

"FIRED in NY State. Seeking advice for a decent health plan Worked overseas in Asia for two and a half decades and had the opportunity (and luck) to retire early with decent savings and investments. Early-50s, no wife (yet), no kids (yet)- minimal expenses as I own my apartment, my biggest expense is essentially healthcare. I do volunteer work with NYCHA, the Y, and a few ambulance corps in NYS (Im a paramedic). I am on 3-4 brand name prescription meds and see 2-3 specialists but more importantly, i was raised by paranoid boomers & silenters who drilled that "comprehensive health insurance is the difference between a stress-free life and Skid Row" so I always try to buy the best insurance I can find rather than follow their example and work until im either dead or incapacitated (if only for the insurance bennies). I couldn't find anything decent on the NY Health Exchange - something that I could keep my doctors at Mount Sinai and Weil-Cornell-NYP - so right now I am buying a plan (Cigna Elite PPO) through a broker that put me into a union. Very confusing but apparently legal. The cost is ~\$2,000/month and I still fight tooth and nail for many procedures (and it doesn't cover vision, dental, mental health...) and it still has a \$1500 deductible and \$50/\$100 + co-pays up the wazoo... I also worry that if a catastrophe does occur, how will this "Cadillac plan through a union" pan out after year one or two? I have heard advice ranging from 1. "take a Bronze plan make sure you have good catastrophic coverage, do everything else in Asia or somewhere with normal pricing, youll save a ton of money" 2. "move your residence to where your family members live (Florida, Connecticut, Hawaii, Michigan) but honestly I prefer to keep my NYC residence. 3. "cancel all of that. wait until you qualify for Medicare. And pray you are still alive and healthy and Medicare still exists." Is there a better route to decent coverage for someone who doesnt qualify for Medicaid but needs decent health care for various ailments (normal for 50+ year olds) and does not have a retirement benefit? Thanks for any info."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wjeidw/fired_in_ny_state Seeking advice for a decent/

"@HowToRetire I had a consultant co-worker who decided not to have health insurance. Then one day he had chest pains and went to the doctor.... OUCH!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=UgyOjuOkcaM0z6bK5g94AaABAg.9XwB8pr8CYV9f6AiikU9Bv>

"The primary drawbacks and problems with ACA plans are: 1. ACA plans are not accepted and the leading cancer centers (MD Anderson) and clinics (Mayo, etc.). 93% of the best clinics and speciality hospitals in the US do not accept any ACA plans --so you better hope you don't get seriously ill and need a leading specialist. 2. The ACA tax credits (subsidies) are subverted in some states by "junk insurance" companies who offer dirt cheap plans with no networks, and tons of limitations, such as Ambetter. If a junk carrier offers a plan for \$300 a month, and everyone else (BCBS, Aetna, etc.) charge \$1200 a month, you will be forced to cover the difference. Most people on the exchange in my state get very little in terms of subsidies because of this. 3. ACA plans have sky-high deductibles"

— YouTube · The Pros and Cons of Obamacare · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-VR66gt_AqA&lc=UgxliwEfhL9hKKlxG_x4AaABAg

"better off choosing a catastrophic plan if available, or a high deductible plan if catastrophic not available. We are having to switch to a high deductible with \$16,000 deductible for the two of us because our current plan premiums increased from \$1,800 to \$3,067 per month in 2026. The HDHP premiums are \$2,100 per month 😬 - still INSANE but gonna choose it anyway and hope we dont have to use it much.... The fact that we have to pay \$41,000 out of pocket (premiums plus deductible) before getting any actual insurance in the USA is INSANE and should be illegal. Congress needs to choose their insurance from the ACA instead of getting cushy benefits - that is the only way things will change."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxm828/anyone_considering_a_health_share_in_place_of_aca/noz13li/

"I have Pivot short term insurance underwritten by Pan American, found through my insurance broker. It's for 3 years and costs much less monthly than ACA would cost me as I'm not eligible for subsidies (\$550 vs. \$947. I have no preexisting conditions, it has a high deductible and I have to pay a bit towards annual physical, etc. I hope to not ever have to really use it. It has good reviews online fwiw."

— r/obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/pavwcff/

"My income is about 38K and my premiums went from \$30/mo to \$290/mo. I'm in CA. I had to downgrade from the Silver plan to the Bronze plan because I can't afford those premiums. Let's hope I don't need to use it."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxFOClgepeTH-OzV4J4AaABAq>

↳ @DrJoshGuitar (0): "@Startingoveragain1234 isn't the bronze plan deductible like 4 or 5k per year?"

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "That's crazy!! At least you can use a HSA with the bronze plan! 😊 "

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "@DrJoshGuitar It can be!"

Affordable coverage that lets them be self-employed or retire early · 5 documents · 5 voices

"I retired at 47 and the ACA subsidies are returning to exactly the way they worked then. I surely didn't expect the enhanced subsidies to become permanent. I would love it if they did, but people who pursue early retirement have a plan for maximizing subsidies and this shouldn't be a major hurdle for them. Keeping your MAGI low as an early retiree isn't particularly hard and should have been planned for. I'm still hoping for the return of the enhanced subsidies as they make a lot more sense. The cliff was always such a terrible part of the original ACA."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oodemw/aca_the_cliff_is_a_big_is_sue/nn3h71t/

"The ACA was not ever intended for early retirement, so the pain of the enhanced subsidies going away is really self inflicted. Having said that I was really hoping the enhanced subsidies would be extended for the current early retirees but also the ACA was my plan. Now I will just think of another way!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzNb723lBr-pBKrcyJ4AaABAq

↳ @chrisforker7487 (1): "Or live on less than 85k a year!"

"Unsubsidized Health Insurance Premiums Ramp Up I know I can just change my age on [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) from now until 64 to get this and adjust for inflation, but does anyone know if the unsubsidized health insurance premium "ramp up" rate is available anywhere? I tried to Google it, but couldn't find any information. I'd like to use this information to estimate health insurance premium for the retirement software for scenarios where I continue to work my self-employed job earning way more than the subsidy "cliff" but also being able to contribute more into my retirement accounts, while my husband retires early."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · None

"Another government program that keeps people poor. I know so many people who won't start working full time because it would cost them more in 'benefits' than the increase in hours would gain them. So they just sit there, barely scraping by, sucking off the taxpayer teet for their whole life. I grew up in poverty and the cycle is atrocious. These programs are awful, the ACA is awful, every government program is fraught with fraud. The number of people I know on disability for 'headaches/migraines' and other made up crap is insane. The entire socialist system is godawful. You can try to convince me that I'm wrong, but you won't. I grew up around it and I've seen it my whole life and I decided to get out of that joke of a system. Now I just pay like 40% of my income to support the BS system. I was self employed when the ACA came out and my premium more than tripled. The only positive to the ACA is pre-existing conditions, which could be a standalone law. The health insurance companies benefited, not the people. Even if I do retire early, hell if I want hardworking taxpayers subsidizing my healthcare when I clearly don't need it."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyqLrllbAGmgEm0rb14AaABAq

"I haven't really heard too much about how the ACA works as a freelancer so I would love to learn more + research as much as I can. Also that 80K figure makes sense, I just assume that you get 1/3 of your paycheck taken out for tax purposes anyways. I feel like the longer you stay in the freelance world the more you realize that there are ways to write business expenses off and try to save on as much as you can in taxes."

— r/freelance · https://www.reddit.com/r/freelance/comments/k06s12/behind_the_scenes_of_a_small_freelance_editing/gdhrhuw/

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Children and dependents on the plan · 142 documents · 20 voices

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · None

"My daughter is a surg/tech student. The doctor stuck her with a needle during a procedure. My daughter has insurance but not for that hospital. Now she owes \$1800 for getting treated at the hospital where she got stuck. Not sure what to do. My daughter is a surgical tech student. During one of her procedures in February, the doctor accidentally stuck her with a dirty needle. The doctor told her to go down to the triage so she could get the proper care for sticks, which included a blood test (plus a follow-up test 2 weeks later). My daughter has healthcare thru the government (Obamacare, basically). She got a bill from her teaching hospital for her medical care for \$1800. Her insurance is denying it because she isn't covered at the hospital where she works. What should she do? This is such an unusual situation, and I can't find advice anywhere (other than 'call an attorney', which would cost more than the \$1800). Suggestions? (on a good note, the patient was tested for any diseases and came back clean, so no worries on that front)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 929 upvotes · None

"WOW! Looking at my 2026 insurance, its half my rent! I was covered thru work previously, just looked at 2026 for california with parital subsidy and for a single person, my monthly premium is \$1300! (cheapest was \$1100 - up to \$1800) that's half my already very expensive rent! Estimated income of \$80k Its a hit, but i don't know how people affords this! All the people getting new premiums in the mail in 2 weeks are in for a rude awakening as i was"

— r/HealthInsurance · 777 upvotes · None

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

"4X INCREASE in Premiums!! I made a post a few days ago about the price increase and I really didn't do a good job of showing it and some called it "cheap". This would be a plan for a household of two with 1 person applying for coverage at an income of \$90K. Their plan in 2025 was a \$0 ded Aetna bronze at \$587 a month. What I am showing on the screen is the CHEAPEST possible plan in their area for 2026. No filters no nothing just the straight cheapest option. WHAAAAT!??? That is a 4 times jump!! This is madness! I have had many of my low income clients jump from \$20-30 a month to \$400-500 plans. These are people close to the 100% of the FPL, way to crazy, no one is paying. What are your current prices looking like? 📌 "

— r/obamacare · 391 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1omjomk/4x_increase_in_premiums/

"What you can do if your marketplace premiums for 2026 are too high I've seen this topic come up in recent weeks and want to offer some advice for folks on marketplace plans with premium hikes. This could also work for folks with employer group plans. I realize that this won't work for everyone in every situation but if you've come to a place where you need to consider alternative ways to approach your healthcare costs, this may be helpful. 1. switch to the least expensive marketplace ACA-compliant bronze-level high deductible HSA-eligible insurance plan to cover only catastrophic events like hospitalization. Use this the way you would use your car insurance: sparingly or not at all. Note that going without insurance is a very, very bad idea for reasons that are covered in this sub on a regular basis. 2. Open and contribute to an HSA to get tax savings on money you'll spend toward medical expenses. 3. SKIP DENTAL AND VISION INSURANCE. Honestly this applies to everyone on marketplace plans but dental and vision "insurance" are just glorified payment plans. They are not regulated the same way as ACA health insurance plans so insurers are allowed to charge premiums on those products that guarantee profit margins > 20%. Instead, work with your favorite local dentist and optometrist to pay directly for all your services, and put the money you would have spent on these premiums into your HSA. 4. If you need care: 4a. If you are someone who needs more than 1-3 office visits a year, shop around for a direct primary care provider in your area. Memberships for these are generally pretty reasonable when you factor in what you might have spent toward premiums on a silver or gold tier marketplace plan. 4b. Google specialty care options. For example, Cove offers a monthly membership for treatment of migraines that, when you add it up, is less expensive than a single trip to the neurologist plus a monthly RX from Walgreens. Companies like this exist for nearly everything. 4c. Become a smart shopper for your rxs. There are so many options outside of traditional insurance that can help you save money: GoodRx, Mark Cuban Cost Plus, LillyDirect, Hers/Hims, Nurx. 4d: Think of memberships you may already have that come with pharmacy or healthcare benefits: Costco is an obvious one but comb through other areas of your life. For example, my electric company is a co-op and offers members a discount program for dental, prescriptions, and gym memberships. 4e. Ask your current providers about direct pay arrangements. If you're paying \$200/month in premiums so that your therapist is in-network, but your therapist will happily take \$150 cash per monthly session, you'll come out \$50/month ahead by paying directly. If anyone has other suggestions, because I'm sure I've missed plenty, add them!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 372 upvotes · None

"Sat through new job orientation in a deep red state and the cognitive dissonance was something else Just started a new job in a red state. Orientation day, 50+ new hires packed into a hall, and eventually we get to the health insurance and benefits section. That's when the room came alive. People complaining left and right about insurance companies ripping them off. My meds aren't covered. My deductible is insane. I can't get the care I actually need. Half the room had a story. And honestly, looking around, a lot of these folks clearly have real health issues and genuinely need coverage that works. Meanwhile HR is up there basically doing damage control, pitching workarounds and cheaper tiers like "this plan gets you more bang for your buck" which is corporate speak for "we know it's bad, here's how to make it slightly less bad." Here's the part that got me. Based on where I am and the conversations around me, most of this room votes red every single time. The same people furious about unaffordable meds and garbage coverage are voting for the party actively working to gut affordable healthcare. They'll rage at the insurance company all day but never connect it to the ballot they cast. Nobody in that room made the connection. Not one person. They see the symptom every day and keep voting for the disease. I just sat there quietly filling out my forms."

— r/obamacare · 325 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v5g93m/sat_through_new_job_orientation_in_a_deep_red/

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today- turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— r/HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · None

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"My employer dropped me from health insurance About a year and a half ago I became eligible for health insurance at my new job (one of the reasons I accepted position was for the benefits). After about a month or so of coverage I was asked to come in for a meeting. Our insurance broker was there along with the director of operations. The broker explained that if I continued coverage my coworker's premiums would go up so high that no one could afford them. He said that they could no longer cover me and he would send in someone to help me sign up for coverage on the marketplace (which someone did). I questioned if all this was legal and was told that because their policy is under-written then, yes, it is legal for them to drop me. I should also add that I am a breast cancer survivor. I still get preventative treatment monthly at a local cancer center. It was after the first claim was submitted by the center that this all went down. Was this legal?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 206 upvotes · None

"HDHPs suck if you actually need them. Because our subsidy expired, we are now paying \$1200 a month for 2 people for a bronze plan with an \$8000 deductible per person. CO, both 52, \$160k income. We went from \$1200 buying us great gold coverage to \$1200 and paying for our own care literally overnight. As it happens, for a bit of uterine bleeding, I actually need the insurance this year. All of the procedures I need – ultrasound, biopsy, and hysteroscopy – are subject to the deductible. And after the deductible, they're only covered at 40% by Select Health. What kind of insurance is this? We're basically paying high premiums for the privilege of paying for our own healthcare. This was the cheapest Obamacare option we could find. Where are all the HDHPs with lower premiums? We worked with a broker, and there weren't any. The contract company that employs my husband had an HDHP where the premium was even higher. At these prices, we can't even afford to fund an HSA. We didn't see any HDHPs on the exchange with premium is less than \$1000 a month. How are people affording this? HDHPs are not a bargain anymore, it seems. We make well over six figures, but since so much of our income is going to healthcare premiums, we have to drain our savings over any healthcare we need. And if you have HDHP insurance, you can't even pay a lower cash price to the facility. You have to pay the higher insurance negotiated price, even if you're paying 100% of the cost. And if I want sedation for these procedures (don't even get me started about how painful in office gynecology is), it's even more expensive. So basically, anything between a well-woman visit (free) and cancer (chemo meets that deductible pretty quick) is going to give you medical debt. This is indescribably unbelievable. Wow, this sucks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 199 upvotes · None

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.



— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · None

"My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise... what do I do? 27F, entry level job after graduating college, trying to buy a house and start a family. Bit of a rant here... You saw the title. My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise. I am flabbergasted. I can't afford to pay over \$200/month more for my health insurance because I make an extra \$160/month?!?! In what world does that make sense?! There is a PCP in my area that does not take insurance, but provides most of the services I require for a \$90/month subscription. It's what I want to go with. They suggested I go with a catastrophic health plan in case of car wreck, etc. He said it should be about \$90/month. When I researched catastrophic health plans, the lowest premium is over \$200/month. I can't afford this AND pay rent AND pay car payment AND pay car insurance AND pay all my other bills AND save money for house/ children/ emergencies. It's safe to say I'm panicking. I payed the insurance for January but I couldn't save anything. I can't keep this plan. I'm currently feeling very defeated by a system that seems to be set up to keep the majority down... I'm so tired of this. Where is universal healthcare? What should I do? Where can I find a catastrophic health plan for around \$100 a month?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 137 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

"My employer fired me after I challenged them of taking me off the health care insurance Hey everyone. I don't normally post stuff like this, but this whole situation has been insane and I could really use some outside perspective. I also want people to know how easily something like this can happen to them and the. The outcome of having health issues later. I worked for a company called Diamond Blade Warehouse (main office in Vernon Hills, IL, with multiple locations around the country). I was with them for almost three years. I left a different job to work there because I thought it'd be a good fit. Like any job, there were parts I liked good people on the sales side, some solid customers, but behind the curtain, it was a mess. I was a commission-based W-2 employee, meaning if I didn't hit commissions, I didn't get paid. No hourly, no base, no nothing. Just straight commission on a W-2... which already didn't sit right, but I needed the income. Earlier this year, out of nowhere, I was told I'd be switched to 1099. No paperwork, no conversation, no explanation. Just "you're 1099. "They just wanted the "benefits" of a contractor without actually making me one. Then on September 3rd, 2025, I got an email from accounting saying my health insurance coverage would end because they weren't applying my wages to the premium anymore. I replied, politely, that I wanted to keep my coverage and would pay out of pocket. I even jokingly said " I think you'd have to fire me to take away my benefits like that." Within ONE HOUR, my company email was disabled and I got a text message saying I was being terminated for "low sales." Convenient timing, right? And here's where it gets even worse. That same day, the COBRA plan administrator sent me a COBRA election notice that looked like it was printed off Google Images, wrong dates, wrong termination info, wrong deadlines. I tried responding, but their spam blocker was set so strict that my replies bounced. I literally had to switch email accounts just to contact them. They sent me a second COBRA notice the same day, also wrong. I asked for a corrected one and the administrator replied in ALL CAPS, basically yelling at me, demanding multiple months of payment upfront... even though the dates were wrong. Instead of fixing the spam blocker so I could communicate normally, management started relaying messages through my sales manager via text. It was like a weird game of corporate telephone. Completely unprofessional and honestly, absolutely ridiculous. Then comes the cherry on top: Months earlier, my manager texted me saying that the CFO, Bronwyn Jacobson, "didn't want me on the company's insurance" and was sweating him about it. In mid-August, she asked again if it was "ok to take me off." I never agreed. Two weeks later... terminated. I've already filed a complaint with the U.S. Department of Labor (EBSA) for COBRA violations, ERISA interference, retaliation, and misclassification. They're reviewing everything. I'm physically exhausted, financially strained, and emotionally worn down from dealing with this, but I'm speaking up because people deserve to know what companies pull when they think no one's looking. If any Redditors have advice, legal, emotional, or just practical, on navigating this, please drop it below. And if anyone's been through something similar, you're not alone. This one messed me up, and I don't want it happening to someone else."

— r/HealthInsurance · 105 upvotes · None

A spouse's job, health or income deciding the coverage · 93 documents · 20 voices

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance, same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · None

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— r/HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · None

"Someone please explain why I (or anyone) should pay a premium that costs more than the oop max The maths aren't mathing. Someone help me understand what I am missing here. We live in NY. I am a self-employed general contractor. Wife is an attorney and recently left her job to open her own firm so we lost great health insurance through her previous employer. Cobra would cost us around \$7k/ month for 2 healthy adults and our 8yo healthy son. Now we're shopping on the marketplace in what appears to be the worst time in history to be doing so. We make too much for any subsidies, so a silver plan is coming in around \$3k/month. Catastrophic is coming in around \$750/month. After a lot of research I can't understand why I would buy anything other than catastrophic. All ACA plans include the same preventive care at no cost. All ACA plans have the same out of pocket maximum limit. Aside from a catastrophe, we would maybe spend \$1k/ year at most seeking care that isn't covered under ACA preventive care. So why would I pay \$36k/year for a silver plan when I could just buy catastrophic for 1/4 the price and pay out of pocket for everything else, knowing I have the same oop cap as the silver \$36k/year plan?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 577 upvotes · None

"Please explain the Vance/Oz announcement yesterday about 700,000+ people being kicked off ACA Since my husband and I will need an ACA plan starting January, to bridge us from current expensive ex-employer COBRA to Medicare in November 2027. What the hell do they mean, people who never made a claim are being cancelled? It's literally the entire model insurance runs on: people paying their premiums but not needing to make claims! - that's the money needed to pay for the really expensive patients and of course to pay the C-suite execs and investors. Does anybody here have more information or insight into this latest news?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 417 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😬 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"A positive anecdote of using American/ACA health insurance We often hear mostly negative things regarding US health insurance online, particularly in regards to the ACA, so I thought I'd offer up a positive personal experience. Our daughter met with her new rheumatologist less than two weeks ago. Today we got the approval authorization for a year of her biologic infusion, which is off-formulary and medical exemption only. No arguing post-denial or justification to get insurance to pony up for an expensive drug that could easily make us net loss customers for them. Copay program from the manufacturer should bring our out-of-pocket cost down to \$0, but even without it our script-biased insurance would hold the drug copay to just \$300/year. This is also with a new insurer starting as a brand new patient. Took one week for her to get in to see her new PCP, took a few days for the referral to process, then three weeks for her to see the rheumatologist. This insurer and policy are also the absolute cheapest Silver in our market, meaning premium cost is significantly lower than even the benchmark plan. I appreciate more and more each year just how good of a healthcare/ACA market Austin has ended up being. Wife and I both needed to find a new PCP this year too due to switching insurance carriers and it only took a few weeks for us to get in as new patients. I hear people talk all the time about waiting months in other markets. Our new PCP was lovely too and didn't rush our new patient appointments at all despite us not really needing anything other than to establish service."

— r/obamacare · 46 upvotes · None

"Suggestions for ACA shopping: My process 2026 will be the third year my husband and I are on an ACA plan and the first year without enhanced subsidies. Because of ongoing marketplace changes, we will also be changing insurance companies for the third year in a row. I wanted to share my process for shopping in case this is helpful. I've done most of my research through Health Sherpa and some through healthcare.gov since window shopping opened. 1. After opening the portal, make a list in a notebook of insurance companies in your zip code. 2. Input your list of providers (and hospitals, if you want) into the website, which will then tell you who's in which plan. 3. Go back to your written list and write down which of your providers are contracted with each company. If you don't want to switch providers, you'll likely cross some plans off the list based on their networks. 4. Now go back to the portal and start sorting by whatever is most important to you - lowest premium, lowest deductible, etc. I find it helpful to only look at one insurance company at a time and sort by premium. I was able to eliminate more companies because their lowest premiums were too high. 5. Also look at star ratings. I wasn't going to choose a plan with only two stars. (I'm looking at you, Molina!) 6. Keep jotting down notes on insurance companies - not enough providers, premiums too high, low ratings, this one looks good, etc. 7. If you find a company that looks promising, run some comparisons. Health Sherpa allows you to compare up to, I believe, four plans at a time. Print out those reports, usually just a page or two. 8. Rinse and repeat for any other insurance companies that look promising. 9. Review your printouts, marking important details on each comparison report with a highlighter. 10. Jot down any more notes in your notebook - "four star ratings, but OOP max is high," etc. 11. At this point, you can hopefully narrow it down to one or two companies. 12. Go back to the most promising plans within your top two insurance companies. Look up the summary of benefits and coverage for each plan. You can print them, download them or both. These will provide you with additional details beyond what the "plan details" pages show. I suggest you also print out those plan details as well. 13. Bonus round: You can also input your medications to see what's covered. 14. At this point, a few plans should rise to the top. Then you can start weighing differences in premiums, deductibles, copays, OOP max, etc. I hope this helps! Within about 90 minutes, I was able to narrow down our options to three plans within a single company. Now we just need to choose a particular plan."

— r/obamacare · 34 upvotes · None

"As a 59 years old retiree, I pay \$2264 per month for COBRA health insurance for me and my wife. I just checked ACA rates for us, it was over \$1000 per month more. I don't qualify for subsidies. Something is wrong with the ACA when its so much more costly without government subsidies."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 29 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGPcfE&lc=UgzxjuSyfTqcBbN1kp4AaABAg>

↳ @beautyandplay (3): "probably better with private plans."

↳ @nata3467 (0): "how much are you and your wife making ?"

↳ @acevers (0): "That's because you were a productive person before retirement. Only bums and disabled people get deals and freebies, and your taxes pay for it. Sucks."

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"Does choosing not to renew marketplace coverage count as a QLE for joining my wife's employer plan outside of open enrollment? My wife's job is a small business that offers a subsidized plan for employees and children of employees. They offer a plan for spouses as well, but it isn't subsidized, so in the past it has been a little more expensive than what I can find on the marketplace. Her open enrollment is in October and when I saw prices this year I assumed I would still be able to find it cheaper through the marketplace. However, marketplace prices were higher this time, but I didn't discover this until after open enrollment closed through her employer. So now I'm trying to figure out if choosing not to renew my marketplace plan would qualify me for a special enrollment period through her employer. I know many of the answers will be "you need to talk to her employer," which unfortunately is easier said than done. Since it is a small business, there is no HR department, there is only her boss (the general manager and one of the owners), and in the past her boss has dragged her feet on answering any insurance related questions until we were practically begging her to reach out to her agent the day before my daughter was going to lose coverage. So I'm trying to avoid asking her boss unless I absolutely need to. It is a BCBS of TN plan if that helps answer my question."

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · None

"I pay health insurance for myself, my wife, and our son. Through a large employer. And I pay more than this every month for a PPO plan. Unless the actual coverage is buns, I do not see where you're being gouged or otherwise overcharged here."

— r/obamacare · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj7nbz/2026_aca_plans_this_is_criminal_look_at_this/nm1gkz/

"I am with you. Cancelled my ACA plan. Went from \$750 to \$2150 a month for my wife and I, and that is from a Gold plan to a crappy bronze plan with \$10K deductible. They can bite me."

— r/obamacare · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qil7n2/my_premium_went_from_200_to_1500_and_now/o0sa18a/

"\$8000 for an ER visit?? I went for an infection on my leg, wouldn't heal. I had fallen off my bicycle. Try \$12,000 for that. They ultrasound my whole leg for some unknown reason. And they hooked me up to IV antibiotics. I wasn't even admitted. Of course my insurance didn't pay the full 12,000, I forget what they paid. My husband's triple bypass was over 300 K. It's insane. He was home on day five because he pushed himself. Then he was off for two months to heal, but we had saved so he could be off and we didn't have to worry about the bills. He just did everything they said, all the exercises from the pulmonologist because usually you are in bed longer and it affects your lungs and breathing. He refused pain meds after day, two. He just wanted to get home because you don't rest in the hospital. He actually broke a record, no one had ever went home that fast. He was only 52 though. Inherited a bad heart from both parents. His twin had a pacemaker at age 40. One thing people aren't mentioning is if the ACA goes away, so does its protections. And the ACA protections are for those with ACA, employer based insurance, Medicaid, these protections are for anyone that has any type of insurance. And the biggest one is the insurance companies cannot deny us coverage because of pre-existing conditions. So if they dismantle the ACA, that will go away. And insurance companies would love it if it did because that was a big reason for denial, before ACA came about. Your kids will not be able to be on your insurance until age 26 either, that is another protection given by the ACA I'm all willing to listen to a new idea, but it has to address the pre-existing conditions for me to even consider it. If they do what Trump wants and just send the people the money, we have no power. Every insurance company would turn my husband and myself down because of his heart issues and my asthma issues. A lot of people do not realize what all the ACA does. A third thing is that it gives every woman a free wellness exam, every year. It doesn't matter what's your co-pay is or your deductible or out-of-pocket max, it doesn't matter because every woman gets one free wellness exam per year. That includes a Pap smear and a mammogram. I started getting mammograms at age 35 because I have extremely dense breast tissue. And every year it comes back bad and I have to go get it redone and then they ultrasound my breasts as well. Pap smears have been coming back bad for years too, and I had to get those done every six months. He finally let me go a year this time because even though, as he puts it, my toe is on the line, the cells themselves have not changed anymore. All this would be pre-existing if they end the ACA"

— r/obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p24ajw/universal_care/npul7vc/

"Covered California is confusing me after adding my newborn — why does my baby suddenly qualify for Medi-Cal? I'm so confused and hoping someone can explain how this works. I recently gave birth and went on Covered California to add my newborn baby to our health plan. Before the baby was born, it was just me and my husband on the plan. We purchased our insurance through Covered California because we make well above the Medi-Cal income limit and did not qualify. Now that I added our baby, Covered California says my baby qualifies for Medi-Cal and is also telling us that we may qualify for Medi-Cal as a family. 🙄 I don't understand how that's possible. The income limit I'm seeing is less than \$4,000/month for a family of 3, but our household income is higher than that. When I called, they told me that adding the baby "brings the income down a lot," but I don't understand what that means because adding another person doesn't actually reduce our income. I do NOT want Medi-Cal. We want to keep our Covered California plan and have our baby on the same insurance if possible. Why would my newborn qualify for Medi-Cal when we didn't qualify before the baby was born, and how does adding the baby change our eligibility so dramatically? Has anyone else gone through this with a newborn in California? I'd really appreciate an explanation because I'm completely confused. 🙄 "

— r/HealthInsurance · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wf92vf/covered_california_is_confusing_me_after_adding/

"Oscar health: who TF are they I'm in Missouri, had CVS Aetna through marketplace, they pulled out of the state and was auto switched to Oscar Gold EPO for 2026 if I want. Premium is about the same as my old plan but higher deductible and max oop. Never heard of Oscar, from what I gathered they are a tech forward company, and I'd have access to 24/7 telehealth. Anyone have experience with them? I'm self employed and so is wife, I don't use any of the credits as I did that one year and had to pay it all back, I hate this time of year and always end up fighting with the wife over this shit. Any information would be appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"I think something will happen. I think enough for Republicans know that they will lose the house if they don't help the people with yet another Trump expense. Even then, I'm not sure they can hang onto it. Unlike Trump, many of them know how unaffordable surviving has become, well the ones that listen to their constituents know. I guess whether they care is TBD. He sure made sure the wealthy people got their tax cut in his big baby bill, nice and early. Meanwhile, the average American has had everything go up and health insurance is a biggie, some of these increases are huge and they simply can't afford it. Trump likes to threaten to primary people. Trump will be gone in roughly 3 years. He won't rule the GOP forever and that is a simple fact. And even as they try to gerrymander their way into forever wins, they aren't winning all of those and some are TBD. I also find it ironic that Trump always talks about states, states should take the burden of everything. He means everything financial because otherwise, he's still very much wants to tell them what to do. And this is where things get kind of muddy. We elect people to do this in that, but we also don't know what the laws say about what they want to do. I guess you could look them up, but they are painting pretty broad strokes at that point, it would be difficult to pinpoint laws. I didn't know that you could read district on a whim, I always thought it was done only after a census. I think things like this should be left to the people, as California did. If they didn't just ramrod it through, they went to the people and asked what they wanted. I use ACA as does my husband and it has remained affordable for us, but we do a lot of things with our income to keep from meeting that subsidy Cliff. We are self-employed and that is the only way we can get insurance. We cannot get Medicaid, we make too much. And honestly, I don't want it. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, we just can't afford to pay it all. We want to pay part of it. Many people don't realize they ended up on ACA just because of Covid. It wasn't just extended subsidies that were enacted during Covid, it also opened the ACA up to people making up to 700% of the poverty level, that is why the ACA ballooned and they too, got the extended subsidies. I have to wonder what they did before. But I do believe healthcare should be a right. If my husband doesn't have health insurance, he files for disability. He has to. Inherited a bad heart from both parents. His twin had a pacemaker at age 40. My husband had a stent at age 46 and a triple bypass at age 52. He's not overweight, he eats healthy, exercise exercises, but his blood pressure was always an issue and then things got worse. The triple bypass was about 300 K and there is no way we could've paid that. But if we get help with insurance, my husband gets to see his doctors, have his meds and continues to work. To me that seems like the better decision., To help with one thing to keep him off of being totally disabled. Sorry, I went on a rant, I get so stressed by all of this. All right, hike wasn't too bad but I still feel for the people that have had a huge rate hike. It's scary not having insurance. It's scary being hurt or sick and you can't go to the doctor. We are such a wealthy country and so damn great, yet people can't afford health insurance. Right there, that part alone, screams that America is not great."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pazpk6/aca_in_the_senate/nrn7tOf/

"When November 1 rolls around, head to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and review your options. You're a bit stuck right now since it's not open enrollment season quite yet. You will need to figure out if insurance through your employer is affordable for *just you* and then split up your coverage if so (meaning you stay on your employer's policy, your spouse picks up a plan through healthcare.gov). In 2027, a health plan will be considered "affordable" using updated affordability metrics. If the employer-based policy costs *you* more than 10.77% of your gross household income, it's unaffordable. So if coverage for *just you* will cost more than \$296/mo., you are likely eligible for subsidies through [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) along with your spouse. I'm going to wager that adding your spouse to the plan through your employer adds significant cost, so while affordability does come into play, I'm going to bet that it's a non-issue given the numbers you're talking about here (because currently, your health premiums are roughly 41% of your gross household income, which is wildly beyond the ACA's affordability threshold. TL;DR, check [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) on 11//1, ensure that your employer policy is *not* affordable, and proceed from there. Note, the affordability metric only applies to the cheapest plan that meets ACA compliance, so if you've purchased up to a higher plan, you need to disregard that and only calculate on the least expensive one."

— r/HealthInsurance · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wk2jaz/best_insurance_for_spouse_and_i/pangxb2/

"It's the extended tax credits, for those above 400% of poverty level. Biden raised the subsidy cliff and that is scheduled to expire this year. It would shut out people above that level for any subsidy. For example I believe 400% is around \$80,000 for two people. So my husband and I right now pay \$527 a month for our plan on \$72k of income. If our small business became more profitable or if I work more, we would be shut out. Our plan is \$2800 a month without the subsidy. That's unsustainable. For lower income persons on the marketplace the loss of enhanced subsidies will mean that many of the Silver plans with cost sharing and zero to no premium will go up substantially. This will disproportionately affect Medicaid non expansion states where ACA enrollment is high. It will have a tremendous impact on a lot of folks."

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1kminjg/obamacare_in_trouble/msawz3h/

Parents or relatives they help with coverage · 34 documents · 20 voices

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · None

"ACA Subsidies ending Hey all, my mom is losing her insurance at the end of 2025 due to the new bill ending ACA subsidies, raising her monthly payments from \$500 to \$1300 if she loses all the subsidies, which she cannot afford, she can't really afford to lose any of it. Does anyone have any suggestions or weird loopholes on what to do? For some context we are all born in the U.S., we live in Texas, she is in her 50s and is divorced from my father, income less than 62k"

— r/HealthInsurance · 531 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.



— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · None

"How is anyone able to afford ACA marketplace insurance currently? I'm 25, I'll be aging out of my parent's health insurance in April 2027, so I've been doing my research on ACA Marketplace plans in case I'll have to apply for it. I've been trying to look for a full-time job with benefits for quite a while but the job market is so bad right now for everyone. It has me wondering how are others getting by at all? Layoffs are happening in the thousands at every company and sector so lots of people are off their employer's coverage. And ACA monthly premiums are so high with deductibles nearing 10K just for a single individual. Plus im sure others have additional monthly payments to cover like cars, groceries, and mortgages. How is ANYONE able to pay for the marketplace currently? Are people just rawdogging it and hoping nothing bad happens? Will marketplace premiums go down?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 125 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"My sister is battling an aggressive cancer on an Obamacare plan. It's definitely not the best. They covered one breast in a double mastectomy. I'm concerned her coverage is at risk. These people are evil."

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0ye59x/

"18 currently unemployed and need insurance To start off I've never used Reddit really so I'm not sure if this is appropriate here but it seems like the place to go. I turned 18 in June and haven't had health insurance for YEARS. It honestly wouldn't be a crazy issue for me if I wasn't dealing with some reproductive health issues and wanting birth control. I used to just go to the ER when things happened or visit Planned Parenthood but my mom seems against it now because of money. It'd be over \$1,000 per month for me to just be placed on her own plan so I'm at a wall. I went to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and I was told that I qualified for a marketplace plan yet open enrollment has closed. I don't believe I account for a special enrollment period because I never really had insurance to begin with. I don't understand what to do in my case. I still live with my mother, I have a job interview lined up but everything feels like a waiting game except I never actually get the medical attention I really need. I'm frustrated and just want to see an GYN or somebody that can help me, I'm very tired."

— r/HealthInsurance · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wdtqmh/18_currently_unemployed_and_need_insurance/

"Your father will be looking at Medicare at age 65. He can apply 3 months in advance of turning 65. My spouse at age 65 went with traditional Medicare which is Part A (hospital), Part B (doctor visits/medical), Part D (prescriptions), and a Medigap/supplemental plan. Medicare does have costs. We pay (all in) about \$600 per month for all of the above-mentioned parts. I am on an ACA/marketplace/healthcare.gov plan because am younger than 65. Your father's spouse should be able to get a [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) plan because she holds a green card. Pricing is dependent on estimated household income. I will add it's not inexpensive. We spend over \$30,000 per year in premiums/prescriptions. That does not include medical care for me."

— r/HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wl5g7i/options_after_retirement/paw92in/

"First of all ACA wasn't meant for just low income. The premise is everyone has to have insurance which makes the pool large and insures there is insurers can cover and actually make money. Unfortunately the Republicans gutted this piece which was critical. It was a way to create transparent competition which the insurance industry has been lacking. At 7 x the FPL which is 85,000 by the way, You probably could get a policy for \$2500 per month with no subsidies. That's 30,000 a year. Your take home is about 60,000. So 50% of your income should be used for insurance? That's why the subsidies were expanded. What the Republicans have always wanted was for everyone to have only catastrophic insurance and HSA savings accounts. Unfortunately with our style of medicine for profit and lack of transparency around costs(how do you shop procedures etc) this doesn't work. All it does is keep people from using the preventative health care and only going to the emergency room which actually raises health care costs for all."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pd4kh7/fed_up_with_fake_news/ns2zyd6/

"My husband's stepmom and father both died last year. We live 2,000 miles away, and my husband was an only child. On top of that, his dad was incapacitated by a stroke right before his wife died, so we had to petition for guardianship because no one had the authority to pay his bills or make decisions on his behalf once she passed away. When she was sick, I flew there for two weeks and helped take care of her. Flew back here after her funeral and then flew there again in July and stayed for 5 months by myself. My husband had to stay here and keep working so we'd keep our health insurance. The nursing facility was 3 hours from my FIL's house, but I couldn't afford to get a hotel nearby for five months, so I stayed in his house and would make the 6-hour round trip to the facility on Saturdays. We are extremely fortunate that we were able to afford to have the two of us live separately for that long. Dad's funds covered his mortgage and utilities, but I was paying for my own groceries and putting gas in the car to get around. The only reason this worked is because I have health problems that make it impossible for me to work full-time, so I am self-employed and was able to work from a different state while I took care of everything there. Most people would not have been able to make it work due to finances, and those are the people who are going to be screwed by these cuts. Because it's very difficult to do caregiving while also trying to pay your own bills."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lflzs7/i_think_the_medicaiddestroying_bill_will_pass/mypshha/

"Having recently gone through this process in florida, I had the best success with the following process: 1. Make a list of which companies offer plans on the exchange. 2. Do a high level screening to determine which insurers are accepted at the good facilities. For example, I know where I'd go if I ended up with cancer. And most ACA insurers aren't accepted there. 3. Download the CSV file of ACA plans into Excel. Delete all rows except for those in your county, state. Then keep only the rows for the insurer(s) identified in step 2. At this point, I had about 140 rows in my Excel file. 4. Next I started modeling annual expense scenarios by adding columns to the file and using equations. $12 \times \text{annual premium} + 4 \text{ pcp visits} + 1 \text{ specialist visit} \dots \text{etc etc}$. Use whatever scenario fits your past medical usage. 5. Then do Rx. Figure out the Good Rx annual cost, local mom and pop cash price, and cost with insurance. Then add the lowest value here to what you determined in step 4. 6. Calculate the five year total cost of ownership. I assumed four "normal" years to one OOP Max year. You do what makes sense for your health and history. So $4 \times \text{value from Step 5} + \text{OOP Max}$. As you go through this process, it will become wildly obvious which plans to eliminate. So I kept filtering out more and more rows until I ended up with a bronze BCBS plan that was the best balance of recurring cost and risk."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wjedw/fired_in_ny_state Seeking advice for a decent/pal8qar/

"Need clarification on underestimating income I plan on enrolling my mother in law for 2026 but not sure how to approach her income. I had spoken to broker and I was informed she should show 22k before deductions to get tax credit for 2026. Before I was able to show her income as 2400 a year and get the aca credits. I read posts saying that the repayments of credits are for those who overestimate income not underestimate. Also read the other way around. If I were to sign her up saying her income projected is 22k but let's say at end of 2026 it's 3k. Since the income was underestimated will she need to payback the subsidies? she doesnt qualify for medicaid because she been in USA 2.5 years and you need to be living 5 years to qualify for that"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Really? My friend's husband is an executive at health insurance company. A few days after the ACA passed, she and I went to lunch and she told me that her husband came very close to throwing their TV through a window because he was so pissed that the ACA passed. I wouldn't say insurance companies loved it. Since so much of the ACA has been dismantled since January 1, 2014, I'm not sure how insurance companies feel currently. (While some provisions, such as allowing young adults to stay on parents' plans, began in 2010, the major reforms including the launch of insurance marketplaces, premium subsidies, and the individual mandate, officially started on January 1, 2014)"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s2bz1r/why_did_the_aca_not_abolish_the_employer/oc8j5v6/

"All he does is insult everyone's intelligence, every single day. We can look up was spent on the military, and we can get a rough figure of what Medicare for all would look like. If we can afford to do the things that he is doing, including a war, every person should have health insurance. I'm on the cusp of getting diagnosed with cancer and I'm extremely scared. But at least I don't have to worry because I have health insurance, but it's getting more and more unaffordable. For the first time in our adult lives, we had to ask for help. I tripped over a curb and it left an extremely bad wound on my leg that took about 10 weeks to heal. My feet were so swollen, both of them even though I only hurt one and I couldn't wear shoes, so I couldn't work. After insurance paid, we ended up owing about \$600 and we are just squeezed so tight at the moment. It hasn't been like this since my husband started his business. People aren't remodeling kitchens or bathrooms, they are also too scared to spend. And it's finally trickled down to us. But again, at least I have health insurance and some agency for people that need help pay that entire part of the Hospital bill that I owed. I was crying because I have never had help as an adult and we have donated so much, clothing, pet things, pet food, donations for back to school backpacks, we tried to give back what we had to take his children. We tried to pay that back as adults, but now here we are in need. I was very thankful we were approved. It's getting rough out here."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1w5ertv/trump_lies_that_medicare_for_all_would_cost/p7f20yz/

"Just don't know what to do. Hey all. My husband and I are both self-employed. Currently, I'm still under 26 and on my parents' plan, though not for much longer. My husband is currently uninsured. We don't qualify for any subsidies, as our income is just over the 400% FPL limit. Despite this, we still live paycheck to paycheck as is, due to living in a high-cost of living area. Packing up and moving isn't really an option, as both of our businesses are based here. We simply can't afford to fork over hundreds to thousands of dollars each month for an ACA compliant plan. I've considered non-ACA, but everyone on this sub seems to think it's a terrible idea and they won't cover anything. At this point I'm just at a loss and don't know what to do. I worry about my husband being uninsured, and I'm considering giving up my business and getting a job that can provide us with insurance, though I really don't want to. Any advice is appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wfnwua/just_dont_know_what_to_do/

"I live in Virginia and back in 2020 had to be hospitalized from uterine fibroid bleeding that was so severe even the ER nurse said, "Im glad you came in, because you may have died if you didn't." Needed 4 blood transfusions to be classified as stable. I had no income and lived with my mom although I aged out of her insurance. They did not offer me a cent off through any charity care program told me apply for emergency Medicaid coverage or there's nothing that can be done. I have not been able to get a hysterectomy to cure me from risk of this happening again. What do they expect someone like me to do? I only got covered by the expansion by the skin of my teeth timing wise. I could not work in that severely anemic state I couldn't even get around Walmart by myself. But doesn't count for official disability...and I'm young,31."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lki09f/key_gop_senator_warns_medicaid_cuts_could_spell/mzu50yw/

"ACA Marketplace help Our family has been on a marketplace plan over a year now since I became a stay at home mom and my husbands job does not have health insurance. We do not qualify for a subsidy so for our family of 3 we are paying about \$2000 a month for our insurance and I'm due to have another baby next month. We would really like to find a way to save some money in this area and since I don't plan on delivering another baby next year we plan to go for a higher deductible plan but unsure how much different cost that will be. Basically I just need all your tips and tricks because \$2000 a month is outrageous."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wpbl8e/aca_marketplace_help/

"You might feel differently if your health insurance costs were increasing from \$1000 / month to \$3000 / month. Apparently, \$36,000 a year for a retired couple to have access to healthcare (nothing is actually covered) is "fair" in this country. But hey, we get to have guns, so freedom!"

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1njh7e7/government_funding_battle_brewing_over_enhanced/nex5qb8/

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

'Use a broker, it costs nothing' · 13 documents · 13 voices

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😬 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. 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I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. 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spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"NC - losing medicaid for medically complex child Any moms on here with children on medicaid with congenital heart conditions/complex medical needs? I need your advice... I've just been told my daughter's medicaid won't be renewed even though my income has decreased from last year's renewal period. Marketplace coverage will cost \$600/mo and covers nothing. Her annual tests will cost upwards close to \$7-\$9,000 assuming her conditions stay stable and without issues. I called the tailored plan brokers and they told me it only covers behavioral/developmental conditions and that if our medicaid expires at the end of the month then there's no way she'd qualify. Am I missing any other outlets or resources? My case worker explains nothing as to why we're being rejected even though our income was much higher last year."

— r/Medicaid · 14 upvotes · None

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😊 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/

"It is not open enrollment for ACA, so you would need a life event to enroll right now. And I hope no one sees this and uses it because I would be too afraid of what it might be. I'm trying to be kind. I used a broker many years to sign up for ACA, but they don't do much of what you told me, they just helped me pick a plan that might be best for me. I have no idea what they get, but I worked with the same one for years and her name happened to be the same as mine."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rmyvm7/this_is_for_anyone_without_an_agent_on_their/o94hc0r/

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

"Used a friend's broker, told them I would soon be overqualified for my essential plan, just to wind up being enrolled in a different essential plan Hey, I'm not opposed to having low costs on things, and would rather not start paying \$200+ on a plan (if I can even find one with a monthly rate that low), but I'm trying to avoid trouble at tax time since I'll be making more than the \$31,920 limit. I could have just stayed on my current essential plan and just re-enrolled with the same (underestimated) income information. I'm probably just going to remove this broker from my NY marketplace account and figure this out on my own if I can, unless if it seems better to just stay on the essential plan anyway. I have a chronic illness and consider working less/switching careers often, and my income fluctuates a lot in the service industry so I really have to ballpark it every year, I just don't wanna get dinged for underestimating years in a row. I already had to fight my insurance a ton for meds, treatments etc so switching seems like it's gonna be a pain in the ass no matter what, I just don't know what's best."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woj8ho/used_a_friends_broker_told_them_i_would_soon_be/

"He told me that he told the agent he only makes \$40,000 a year. He has a business that is constantly accepting 10s of thousands of dollars. Last year, the net income was \$110,000 and whe didn't even have as much work as he has had this year. He is claiming that he is only going by how much cash he has drawn out of his account. That is not rational either because as of August 29, he has drawn out \$56,920.00. The cap for highest income on ACA is \$62,600.00. So you tell me?!"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1w0bhas/my_husband_54m_just_signed_up_for_health/p6xywy1/

"Need help understanding ACA Subsidies My parents immigrated to nj a few months ago and I am trying to buy some insurance for them, they will have cash jobs and will be filing tax returns. One broker told me the horizon bronze is about 2300 per month and another one said 55 per month Oscar. And my understanding is Trump has taken away the subsidies, so how can it be \$55 per month. Too good to be true. Can anyone help explain?"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

'Go on the marketplace and check' · 8 documents · 8 voices

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. 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spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · None

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😊 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/

"I live in Virginia and back in 2020 had to be hospitalized from uterine fibroid bleeding that was so severe even the ER nurse said, "I'm glad you came in, because you may have died if you didn't." Needed 4 blood transfusions to be classified as stable. I had no income and lived with my mom although I aged out of her insurance. They did not offer me a cent off through any charity care program told me apply for emergency Medicaid coverage or there's nothing that can be done. I have not been able to get a hysterectomy to cure me from risk of this happening again. What do they expect someone like me to do? I only got covered by the expansion by the skin of my teeth timing wise. I could not work in that severely anemic state I couldn't even get around Walmart by myself. But doesn't count for official disability...and I'm young,31."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lki09f/key_gop_senator_warns_medicaid_cuts_could_spell/mzu50yw/

"This is kind of ridiculous, but I also have Health First and if I was receiving one cent Health premium bills, I would be calling when I got the first one to see if this was an error or if I truly needed to pay it and then I would pay it if I did owe it I have debited \$.57 before at the store, so I know it's possible to debit a penny or to charge a penny per month So sorry, I can't have that much sympathy for her when she received bills and even a letter that her insurance was ending and she decided to ignore it and think it was a rounding error or an error on their part You don't mess around with insurance because it can snowball. You need to become an expert and your insurance plan and that's exactly what I have done. I've had Health First for about five years now and a couple years ago, I knew I had paid too much. They kept saying I hadn't, Health First. So I filed a grievance and I listed out every payment I had made to any doctor or any prescription. They still wouldn't admit fault, but I got a check for the exact amount. I said I had overpaid by. What changed is you used to go to the doctor and you would pay your co-pay if you had one but other than that, they would bill you. Because they would build the insurance and see what it would be paid and if there was anything left over that was owed, then they would bill you. Now they're trying to collect everything upfront. That year I had went to a dermatologist and when I left and went through the checkout part, they told me it was \$143.50. I had had a full body check and I had had two moles removed. I knew I had reached my out-of-pocket maximum. And I told them that. So then they say I had to pay \$30 which is my co-pay for a specialist. I didn't want to do that, but I caved and did it. I go home and call my insurance company and they say no, you are right, you have met your out-of-pocket max, you didn't owe anything. It took my insurance nearly 3 weeks to get a hold of their billing department and they wanted to give me a credit. How do they know I'm coming back next year??? they don't Send me a check. And they did. But it is your job to know your insurance plan and if you don't, you need to be calling and asking. And I know they don't make it easy. Part of your insurance coverage is on this website and your prescriptions are on a different website and something else is on a different website, they do not make it easy. But it's in your best interest to learn it. So I do see it that it was this woman's fault, she should've called, on that First bill that she got this set of Penny, I would never assume anything with insurance. To me, she looks like a fool for losing her insurance over a penny a month or five cents a month or whatever it was. She tanked herself by not paying that. I would've sent a check every month for a Penny. Or I would've debited it or put it on a credit card. I have the hospital here try to go after me over \$.57. I paid it and I had the confirmation page because I print all of that out. It turns out they decided to take that \$.57 and put it on something else, even though on the screen it showed me it was going towards the bill that I owed \$.57 for. Oh, I got on the phone and raised hell and they actually ended up just erasing the \$.57 altogether. It turns out even though it's showing me that that \$.57 went towards the \$.57 bill I owed, but if you owed anything prior, they can change it and put it towards that. And I didn't know anything prior, it all had just crossed in the mail. The minute I get a bill for something healthwise, it gets paid and goes back out in the mail the next day. I don't like doing online payments when it comes to health bills. I prefer to send a check still."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s8bxnc/an_insurer_canceled_a_womans_coverage_over_a_odismhs/

"Hmo help with selecting obgyn I've never had an hmo before, so this is all new and scary to me. Any advice is appreciated! I have an hmo with Blue Shield of California, through the marketplace. My PCP has been changed multiple times this year (side rant, why are Drs allowed to change networks mid year but we aren't?!) so I've never actually met the man. I got pregnant through a fertility clinic and they are getting ready to release me to an obgyn. I called my insurance to check that I don't need a referral (California law) but they told me I did. Ok, fine, whatever. I got an appointment with my PCP, and he said I didn't need a referral, but he'd go ahead and submit one anyway. Now I'm lost as to what my next step is. Do I just browse the blue shield website until I find an obgyn I like? Am I restricted to only certain doctors? No one's really explaining anything, and then when they do they seem to be incorrect and uninformed. If anyone knows how this stuff actually works I'd really appreciate the help! I definitely won't be doing an hmo again, no matter the cost savings"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wpd1hx/hmo_help_with_selecting_obgyn/

"You need to look it up. I believe the cheapest work plan for the employee only has to cost more than 9.96% of your income to be unaffordable, but I'm not 100% sure on all the specifics there, this is off the top of my head. BUT I don't know what metric they are using to calculate income in that instance, and you need to know for sure what you are figuring up 9.96% of. As in, does the plan have to be more than 9.96% of your MAGI, which is what you use to determine ACA subsidies, or what? And is it only going by the employee only plan, which is what I think I read before, or the cost of a family plan? That's why I say, I'd look it up, get the exact metric to follow, and even then, if you believe your insurance meets the "unaffordable" standard, I'd call the Marketplace CS to verify this. It is a world of hurt if you get that wrong. Also, I have no idea what the family glitch is."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wggh2p/can_i_make_my_healthcare_any_more_affordable/pa11ax3/

'Watch your income' · 7 documents · 7 voices

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"Covered California is confusing me after adding my newborn — why does my baby suddenly qualify for Medi-Cal? I'm so confused and hoping someone can explain how this works. I recently gave birth and went on Covered California to add my newborn baby to our health plan. Before the baby was born, it was just me and my husband on the plan. We purchased our insurance through Covered California because we make well above the Medi-Cal income limit and did not qualify. Now that I added our baby, Covered California says my baby qualifies for Medi-Cal and is also telling us that we may qualify for Medi-Cal as a family. 😞 I don't understand how that's possible. The income limit I'm seeing is less than \$4,000/month for a family of 3, but our household income is higher than that. When I called, they told me that adding the baby "brings the income down a lot," but I don't understand what that means because adding another person doesn't actually reduce our income. I do NOT want Medi-Cal. We want to keep our Covered California plan and have our baby on the same insurance if possible. Why would my newborn qualify for Medi-Cal when we didn't qualify before the baby was born, and how does adding the baby change our eligibility so dramatically? Has anyone else gone through this with a newborn in California? I'd really appreciate an explanation because I'm completely confused. 🙏 "

— r/HealthInsurance · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wf92vf/covered_california_is_confusing_me_after_adding/

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😊 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/

"I am currently on an ACA Bronze plan and have had this the past two years that I've been retired. I have noticed the Silver plans are quite a bit more in my state. Also Bronze plans (at least for this year) allow for HSA deposits. Not sure if you can do that with Silver. I'm afraid to drop vision and dental because I wear glasses and have had big dental bills in the past. I'll check the math though. And I'm paying about twice as much as you are for one person (health+vision only). At open enrollment I'll look again. Also will see if I can maybe lower my MAGI. I told them \$62K for this year (which is near the max for a single person and still get a subsidy). Lowering this to \$35K or \$40K might be possible but it would require withdrawals from my Roth IRA to make up the difference."

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=Ugz860t4k73b15uGt_x4AaABAq

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (5): "Yes. your MAGI is very important and if you can control it and keep it lower you will get better pricing."

↳ @sunnybrookfm-75 (3): "The last 5 years I worked before actually retiring I had to provide my own health insurance the first year where I worked. I used the subsidies like you and paid approximately what you are. In my case it was 180 dollars per month since I'm single. I was earning 15 dollars an hour. I was working 2 jobs. I also had really cheap places to live. We were unionized too thank goodness. When the year was up I got the union healthcare for \$5 a week plus I was on part a of Medicare. The employer had a huge amount of employees so you can do what I'm talking about. I am a retired paralegal and nurse. In addition I have vision problems that caused me to have cataract issues. I had to have them removed from both eyes in my late 50s. I also went completely blind in both eyes for 6 weeks. Some vision came back in 1 eye. I was disqualified from disability because 1 eye functions pretty well. At any rate my vision problems are considered a medical condition. The good news is my doctor tells me my condition has stabilized and I now qualify for low vision benefits. Most of those I would have to pay for out of pocket so I just go along the best I can with what I have. I'm allowed to drive and restrict myself to daytime driving. I go to discount eyeglass providers and pay about 50% less than I would if I went to my doctor for eyeglasses. When I retired I went from health insurance plus pt A Medicare to Medicare and a high deductible medigap plan. I was able to keep health insurance plus pt A Medicare until 67 because my store had a huge amount of employees and had somewhat decent health insurance thru the union. Because of this loophole I was entitled to keep my \$5 dollar a week health insurance until I retired at 67. I am now 73. My retirement age was 66. I eventually added dental insurance I figure if I need implants I can be a dental tourist and get them done abroad if I need to. So far my blood pressure has come down into the normal range now that I'm not working as well. And I've not had to take any medication for my blood pressure. Yay! I'm just taking care of myself. Now mind you this is also because I'm exceptionally frugal. I live on 21k and save 5k a year. Furthermore at the age of 72 I came into a nestegg of 325k from 2 individuals in my life and my own savings. My family left me the 325k. I've not had to touch a nickel of it. And since the 21k is technically my only source of income I owe zero dollars in taxes. Bonus for me 😊😊 . I pay 825 dollars a month in rent and have a small 20 pound dog. My best friend bought my house outright and rents it to me. It is 850 sq ft of heaven. I live in a home built in 1950 that is constantly undergoing renovations. And I live a very simple modest lifestyle. My neighborhood is a working class neighborhood in a downtown area. I live in a wealthy county outside a large metropolitan city. My city has a population of 100k approximately. It is peaceful and quiet. Yes when you are pricing out your healthcare check out both federal and state laws."

↳ @richard1113 (0): "@sunnybrookfm-75 Thank you for sharing your story. It sounds like you're doing ok!"

Tab 5 — Frustrations

Insurance companies and the system as a scam · 125 documents · 20 voices

"The scariest part... from someone who works at a health insurance company I work at a large health insurance company, and lately all I hear about is the potential end of ACA subsidies, rising premiums, and skyrocketing healthcare costs. But the part no one's talking about? This could become the new normal. When has any industry ever raised prices and then actually brought them back down once people got used to paying more? Even if healthcare costs drop (and that's a big if), what incentive do insurers have to lower premiums when people are already paying the higher rates? It's like gas... people used to complain about \$2.50 a gallon. Now we celebrate it. That's the scary part. Prices rise, we adapt, and eventually we forget what "reasonable" even looked like. Unless wages start catching up, we're all in serious trouble."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2,664 upvotes · None

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · None

"Sat through new job orientation in a deep red state and the cognitive dissonance was something else Just started a new job in a red state. Orientation day, 50+ new hires packed into a hall, and eventually we get to the health insurance and benefits section. That's when the room came alive. People complaining left and right about insurance companies ripping them off. My meds aren't covered. My deductible is insane. I can't get the care I actually need. Half the room had a story. And honestly, looking around, a lot of these folks clearly have real health issues and genuinely need coverage that works. Meanwhile HR is up there basically doing damage control, pitching workarounds and cheaper tiers like "this plan gets you more bang for your buck" which is corporate speak for "we know it's bad, here's how to make it slightly less bad." Here's the part that got me. Based on where I am and the conversations around me, most of this room votes red every single time. The same people furious about unaffordable meds and garbage coverage are voting for the party actively working to gut affordable healthcare. They'll rage at the insurance company all day but never connect it to the ballot they cast. Nobody in that room made the connection. Not one person. They see the symptom every day and keep voting for the disease. I just sat there quietly filling out my forms."

— r/obamacare · 325 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v5g93m/sat_through_new_job_orientation_in_a_deep_red/

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today- turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— r/HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · None

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"Why all of the "I can't believe how much health insurance costs" comments are misguided With recent increases in both the cost of employer sponsored health insurance and ACA plans, especially for those who lose the enhanced subsidies, this sub has been flooded with people shocked and frustrated with the impact. Understandably so. But all of the comments that this is caused by the existence of health insurers or the profit model completely miss the point. Those same posters claiming that universal healthcare, single payer or Medicare for all is the solution equally miss the larger point. That point is that healthcare is and has increasingly gotten more (too) expensive. The US healthcare spend is about \$5 trillion. That equates to about \$15,000 per person per year. Or \$1250 per individual per month. Think \$2500 a month for a couple for health insurance is expensive? That's actually the average of what it costs to deliver healthcare services. So let's get rid of health insurance companies- I'm certainly not a big fan of them. By law they have to spend 85% on actual care. So 15% goes to administration (and those hated executive salaries). So get rid of that admin expense and the \$2500 for the couple drops to \$2125. Feel affordable all of the sudden? Of course not. So how about some form of universal healthcare? All that does is change who pays for it. And definitely not what's paid. We already have some universal healthcare between Medicaid and Medicare. A significant portion of the US insured population uses these programs. And guess what, costs are going up. The government hasn't demonstrated any ability to manage or control costs. Now it's fair to argue that some taxpayers should pay more so that others have to pay less for healthcare but let's at least have an honest discussion about that instead of pretending that if the government pays for it is free. Employers and ACA utilize insurance companies to manage costs. The track record of cost management there isn't really any better. The core issue is that there is a virtually unlimited demand for healthcare. And it's impossible to supply that without spending more and more. "Let the decision on treatment be between the doctors and their patients" - uh sure. Except that whoever actually pays is going to want to weigh in. Pretty logically. Even the successful universal healthcare countries are struggling to fund the efforts and the complaints are often attributed to underfunding. Because fully funding is impossible- demand is too unlimited. You will never change demand. That's human nature (though changing behaviors over time like smoking cessation can help). So someone is going to be in charge of rationing the care people get. Might be the government (Medicare/Medicaid) or might be a private insurer. Unless you are willing to pay directly for your own care, someone else is going to be in a position to say yes or no to it. Uncomfortable fact of life. So what can be done to corral the untenable rise in costs? The providers of care - physicians, facilities, pharmaceutical companies must be driven to charge less (and this may be the best argument for single payer as this best enables the government to dictate what will be paid). And perhaps some of the "innovative but costly treatments" must be foregone (rationed away). But make no mistake, unless we have the political will to pay providers less and ration care more (something the US population has never exhibited), we will continue to have this problem and have to find a new bogeyman after solving the last bogeyman."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · None

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😊) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday. **UPDATE:** I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😊) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the

amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 😊 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 😊 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting , failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an"

— r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · None

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

"My employer fired me after I challenged them of taking me off the health care insurance Hey everyone. I don't normally post stuff like this, but this whole situation has been insane and I could really use some outside perspective. I also want people to know how easily something like this can happen to them and the. The outcome of having health issues later. I worked for a company called Diamond Blade Warehouse (main office in Vernon Hills, IL, with multiple locations around the country). I was with them for almost three years. I left a different job to work there because I thought it'd be a good fit. Like any job, there were parts I liked good people on the sales side, some solid customers, but behind the curtain, it was a mess. I was a commission-based W-2 employee, meaning if I didn't hit commissions, I didn't get paid. No hourly, no base, no nothing. Just straight commission on a W-2... which already didn't sit right, but I needed the income. Earlier this year, out of nowhere, I was told I'd be switched to 1099. No paperwork, no conversation, no explanation. Just "you're 1099. "They just wanted the "benefits" of a contractor without actually making me one. Then on September 3rd, 2025, I got an email from accounting saying my health insurance coverage would end because they weren't applying my wages to the premium anymore. I replied, politely, that I wanted to keep my coverage and would pay out of pocket. I even jokingly said "I think you'd have to fire me to take away my benefits like that." Within ONE HOUR, my company email was disabled and I got a text message saying I was being terminated for "low sales." Convenient timing, right? And here's where it gets even worse. That same day, the COBRA plan administrator sent me a COBRA election notice that looked like it was printed off Google Images, wrong dates, wrong termination info, wrong deadlines. I tried responding, but their spam blocker was set so strict that my replies bounced. I literally had to switch email accounts just to contact them. They sent me a second COBRA notice the same day, also wrong. I asked for a corrected one and the administrator replied in ALL CAPS, basically yelling at me, demanding multiple months of payment upfront... even though the dates were wrong. Instead of fixing the spam blocker so I could communicate normally, management started relaying messages through my sales manager via text. It was like a weird game of corporate telephone. Completely unprofessional and honestly, absolutely ridiculous. Then comes the cherry on top: Months earlier, my manager texted me saying that the CFO, Bronwyn Jacobson, "didn't want me on the company's insurance" and was sweating him about it. In mid-August, she asked again if it was "ok to take me off." I never agreed. Two weeks later... terminated. I've already filed a complaint with the U.S. Department of Labor (EBSA) for COBRA violations, ERISA interference, retaliation, and misclassification. They're reviewing everything. I'm physically exhausted, financially strained, and emotionally worn down from dealing with this, but I'm speaking up because people deserve to know what companies pull when they think no one's looking. If any Redditors have advice, legal, emotional, or just practical, on navigating this, please drop it below. And if anyone's been through something similar, you're not alone. This one messed me up, and I don't want it happening to someone else."

— r/HealthInsurance · 105 upvotes · None

"What I'm doing My crappy bronze policy (\$7500ded;\$17,000 moop) is set to cost \$29,000 per year + Dental \$1500. I have a family of five. I make around \$85k in div/interest. I'm going to purposely limit my work to make less than \$120k/year. Then I'm going to put \$9750 in HSA, \$40k 401k. With business write offs, including insurance premiums, I'm going to do everything I can to reduce our MAGI to less than \$150,000 (400% FPL for family of 5). I'll save \$20,000 in premiums by doing this. Fck Health Insurance Companies. I guess this was supposed to go in /rants."

— r/obamacare · 94 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pdcs2k/what_im_doing/

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— r/HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · None

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— r/obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

"Let me continue my rant. I have a friend who is a mid level executive at a health insurance company. He let it slip that his total compensation package is \$750k/year. A giant reason insurance costs so much is the expansion of administrative costs to deliver Healthcare."

— r/obamacare · 42 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pdcs2k/what_im_doing/ns44o46/

"Florida also had the most enrollments in the ACA to begin with. I'm in Florida, we signed back up, ours jumped about \$80 a month. Not ideal, but we will figure it out because we have to. My husband inherited a bad heart from both parents, his twin had a pacemaker at age 40 and my husband had a triple bypass at age 52. He's not overweight, he eats healthy, he has a physically demanding job. He just inherited a bad heart. His meds would be well over two grand a month without insurance. And I have severe asthma on my plate. My two inhalers alone are nearly \$700 a month without insurance. We are both self-employed and we didn't have insurance before this. The ACA saved us, it saved my husband's life at least twice. It's not a perfect healthcare plan, I'm all for improvements, but Trump's idea of sending us the money is a bad one. If the ACA ends, which I think they are trying to do by picking it apart, everyone loses certain protections, and the biggest one is the fact that insurance companies can no longer deny you because of pre-existing conditions and that came about because of the ACA, a.k.a. Obama care. I know we wouldn't be able to get insurance. And even if we could, we wouldn't have that group rate because it would just be us. I'm all open to ideas, but they have to be good ideas and better than ACA, not worse. Him sending the money directly to the people, it still goes back to the insurance company or the pharmacy benefit managers. It will end up in the same place, just buy a different means of getting it there. And you can't even use HSA accounts to pay premiums. So his plan solves absolutely nothing except getting it off the fed plate which he seems to want to do with everything. He wants to push it to the states, but then they want to control certain things, even after pushing it to the states. A classic moron, a classic control freak and a classic daddy paid my way through college case. There is no way this man could write the number of papers you have to in order to get a college degree because he writes like a 10-year-old. And actually 10-year-olds have a better vocabulary than he does. But I am open to ideas, no matter which side they come from, but they have to be better than the ACA. You've learned from what has been done and you improve upon it. He likes to take the easy road and just throw it to the states, throw it to the people, let them deal with it. No wonder he's shrinking the federal government, won't need them because he's pushing everything to the states or the people."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qi2ehs/florida_leads_the_nation_in_the_drop_in_obamacare/o0o8c4e/

"Suggestions for ACA shopping: My process 2026 will be the third year my husband and I are on an ACA plan and the first year without enhanced subsidies. Because of ongoing marketplace changes, we will also be changing insurance companies for the third year in a row. I wanted to share my process for shopping in case this is helpful. I've done most of my research through Health Sherpa and some through healthcare.gov since window shopping opened. 1. After opening the portal, make a list in a notebook of insurance companies in your zip code. 2. Input your list of providers (and hospitals, if you want) into the website, which will then tell you who's in which plan. 3. Go back to your written list and write down which of your providers are contracted with each company. If you don't want to switch providers, you'll likely cross some plans off the list based on their networks. 4. Now go back to the portal and start sorting by whatever is most important to you - lowest premium, lowest deductible, etc. I find it helpful to only look at one insurance company at a time and sort by premium. I was able to eliminate more companies because their lowest premiums were too high. 5. Also look at star ratings. I wasn't going to choose a plan with only two stars. (I'm looking at you, Molina!) 6. Keep jotting down notes on insurance companies - not enough providers, premiums too high, low ratings, this one looks good, etc. 7. If you find a company that looks promising, run some comparisons. Health Sherpa allows you to compare up to, I believe, four plans at a time. Print out those reports, usually just a page or two. 8. Rinse and repeat for any other insurance companies that look promising. 9. Review your printouts, marking important details on each comparison report with a highlighter. 10. Jot down any more notes in your notebook - "four star ratings, but OOP max is high," etc. 11. At this point, you can hopefully narrow it down to one or two companies. 12. Go back to the most promising plans within your top two insurance companies. Look up the summary of benefits and coverage for each plan. You can print them, download them or both. These will provide you with additional details beyond what the "plan details" pages show. I suggest you also print out those plan details as well. 13. Bonus round: You can also input your medications to see what's covered. 14. At this point, a few plans should rise to the top. Then you can start weighing differences in premiums, deductibles, copays, OOP max, etc. I hope this helps! Within about 90 minutes, I was able to narrow down our options to three plans within a single company. Now we just need to choose a particular plan."

— r/obamacare · 34 upvotes · None

"Something is irreparably broken with the way things are right now. No way should my healthy, middle-class family of 5 be expected to pay \$3,000+/month for a high-deductible insurance plan with pitiful coverage that's not accepted by most quality providers. Even if the subsidies are extended, I still have a huge issue with government tax dollars being funneled to health insurance companies to pay for these ridiculously high premiums. We've had to switch to cash pay with no insurance in the past, and cash-pay prices are reasonable, especially as compared to what's billed to insurers."

— r/obamacare · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1olugzl/thoughts_on_howwhen_the_shutdown_will_end_now/nmkopxl/

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"Paxlovid \$1600? Anthem ACA in Indiana is pretty terrible -- the cheap "negotiated rate" for 5 days of the anti-COVID medication paxlovid is nearly \$1600. I'm skipping it since I can't afford it even with the \$1000 one-time use coupon from Pfizer. The whole year has been basically Anthem denying all my medications or offering a price that's way higher than those weird "discount cards" like GoodRx. Pretty terrible. Anyone else angry yet are ready for actual universal health care? I retired early and this is literally the only insurance plan available to me in my state. These insurance company scammers and big pharma scammers need to be fixed. Things are getting unsustainable. I understand that there's an active movement to dismantle and destroy ACA without any replacement, so that's part of the problem, but really we need actual universal healthcare and to tear down the existing scam organizations."

— r/HealthInsurance · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj8crd/paxlovid_1600/

"Total healthcare coverage for everyone would be simple. Just switch everyone to Medicare with Plan G. Charge a flat rate and the money would be there and the insurance companies would be cut off at the knees from their current theivery of our money and our tax money thru subsidies. They currently get BILLIONS of dollars in subsidies to cover people. Thru the ACA AND thru the Medicare Advantage plans. That money would be better spent just covering everyone and cut out the damn middle man. The flat fee could be something very small like maybe 50 dollars. Or if that sounds too simple, put it on a sliding scale. or Use the IRMA rule. But this has been so obvious to me since I started getting coverage thru the marketplace and found out that my subsidy is about 1400 a MONTH that taxes are being paid to these scammers. And I have to jump thru all sorts of hoops to just get a damn test."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwKReZ8eEKFhxX5ehx4AaABAg>

↳ @wtmayhew (4): "I had to buy Obamacare for two years because I retired before I turned 65. The red stste where I lived decided to do nothing on its own and took the default government site. There were only two silver plans available which had over 1000/month premiums just for myself. I had to get back surgery and even with the silver plan I had there was still a 5000 hospitalization deductible. I'm glad I had a silver plan or it would have been a lot worse. Still, my health care bills for that year were almost 20K. That year federal subsidies cut off completely if your AGI was one penny over 49K the prior year. Affordable Health Care Act, my foot!"

↳ @TheJetstream10 (2): "You can thank the Republican Senate and Orin Hatch for pushing this through Congress--Medicare Advantage--they wanted a slice for private industry to get and they got it, guaranteed government subsidies for coverage and death panels for people who need care."

↳ @bugsy2902 (0): "The subsidies are great if you are poor! But once you make over 400% of poverty you are cut off entirely and good luck getting health insurance then. Mine increased from around \$800 monthly to over \$1300 monthly when I turned 60. Luckily, I'm able to keep my taxable income low thru using a Roth Ira, HSA and have low expenses. Plus, I have a HELOC for emergencies I got before I retired."

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

Premiums that doubled or tripled · 64 documents · 20 voices

"The scariest part... from someone who works at a health insurance company I work at a large health insurance company, and lately all I hear about is the potential end of ACA subsidies, rising premiums, and skyrocketing healthcare costs. But the part no one's talking about? This could become the new normal. When has any industry ever raised prices and then actually brought them back down once people got used to paying more? Even if healthcare costs drop (and that's a big if), what incentive do insurers have to lower premiums when people are already paying the higher rates? It's like gas... people used to complain about \$2.50 a gallon. Now we celebrate it. That's the scary part. Prices rise, we adapt, and eventually we forget what "reasonable" even looked like. Unless wages start catching up, we're all in serious trouble."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2,664 upvotes · None

"My family's health insurance is set to go from \$170 per month in 2025 to \$1560 in 2026 due to expiring ACA credits. A few clarifying points: - I earn approx \$125k as the sole provider for my family of 4 - I am self employed - This is the cheapest possible plan I could find anywhere - Coverage for this plan is terrible and helps me exactly \$0 with our family's actual health expenses I don't even know how I'm supposed to form thoughts around this. I can barely breathe let alone wrap my mind around this. How the hell am I supposed to survive in this country the way it is now? It seems like the world is actively punishing people who have families, or anyone who is not a multimillionaire. This is just one problem in a cornucopia of financial disasters handed to me as a millennial parent. This is not even mentioning how the new student loan rulings will add hundreds of dollars per month of financial burden, nor how I will forever be priced out of the housing market and am doomed to ever increasing rent month after month, or how food costs have practically doubled for my family over the past 5 years. How bad is it to go without health insurance in the new year? I literally have no idea what else to do..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 776 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄"

— r/obamacare · 586 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1olp6mh/virginia_aca_rates_posted_today_share_your/

"4X INCREASE in Premiums!! I made a post a few days ago about the price increase and I really didn't do a good job of showing it and some called it "cheap". This would be a plan for a household of two with 1 person applying for coverage at an income of \$90K. Their plan in 2025 was a \$0 ded Aetna bronze at \$587 a month. What I am showing on the screen is the CHEAPEST possible plan in their area for 2026. No filters no nothing just the straight cheapest option. WHAAAAT!??? That is a 4 times jump!! This is madness! I have had many of my low income clients jump from \$20-30 a month to \$400-500 plans. These are people close to the 100% of the FPL, way to crazy, no one is paying. What are your current prices looking like? 🙄"

— r/obamacare · 391 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1omjomk/4x_increase_in_premiums/

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

""Get Covered Illinois"--2026 premium notices sent out today. This year, Illinois switched over to its own program, rather than using Healthcare.gov. 2026 premiums hit the street today. The unsubsidized premium for me and my wife (both in our early to mid-60s) is \$2,915.99. This represents a 17% premium increase from 2025. In Illinois, my carrier, Blue Cross/Blue Shield, had gotten approved for an average 27% premium increase across all of its policy forms; I'm not sure why we got the smaller percentage increase. I had thought that people our age would have been hit with the highest percentage increase in premiums. The automatic renewal letter that I got described my projected monthly subsidy, and my "monthly premium" (in other words, the subsidized premium). I figured out the total unsubsidized premium by adding those figures together. Because of the way that the numbers were laid out in the letter, it appears that the people who run the Illinois program believe that Federal subsidies will be renewed for 2026."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · None

"Georgia - just got my estimate on rate increase. Guess I'll be doing without. I've been using Ambetter for a few years with a few hiccups but overall it worked. Make around 23k per year. Had a Silver plan for around \$150.00. Just got my notice via the GA marketplace. Similar plan that no longer includes the vision and dental I had in the old plan, will be \$479.00. Guess I'll be doing without this year and hope for the best. Multiple health issues and prescriptions. Can't get Medicaid here. Welcome to the new world."

— r/HealthInsurance · 82 upvotes · None

"ACA not very affordable anymore ACA is not really affordable without the extra subsidy, but California fines you 100 per month for not having it. It's not really fair to fine people who truly can't afford it. I work front desk hotel. The cheapest plan for me is 200 per month. I have to pay 100% out of pocket until I reach 7200 for the year. Just 2 visits to the dermatologist is costing me 1400 on top of the 200 I already pay. If I want something with normal co-pays, it's going to cost me 400 per month. I make between 45K-50K, but the cost of living is so high in California that there isn't much left for stuff like health insurance. It's really not fair that California fines you at this point when the premiums have literally doubled in price. It's very frustrating."

— r/obamacare · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/

"People were getting ready to get hungry. The system is broken very broken. It's been broken for a long time. Once the individual mandate was killed the ACA was a goner. Ten percent plus premium increases a year are untenable. What we need is wide spread health care reform. Which no one will do because lobbying and campaign donations. I don't understand why working people are cheering the lack of subsidies. In Nj (I don't get subsidies) my plan is 2400 a month, 9k deductible, 18k out of pocket max. That's 50k a year for a couple in early/mid 50s. For a routine ER visit, expect a 2k balance bill. It is simply not sustainable."

— r/obamacare · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ot4yde/aca_vote_in_december/no2ky2e/

"It is an issue that will explode in their faces this fall if they don't extend the credits. I can't stress enough how immediately impactful and obvious it will be once consumers start looking at their 2026 rates if we go back to the 400% FPL cliff and lower subsidies for everyone under 400%. You can't bluster away the premium increase that hits people directly."

— r/obamacare · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1n8oh6a/house_republicans_launch_bill_to_extend_health/ncghst2/

"A freaking nightmare. We have to enroll by Dec. 15 for Jan. 1 effective date. I have a decent silver plan, but the premium will increase by 300 percent without subsidies, which means I will just sign up for a cheaper bronze plan if there is no change by the 15th. People like me don't want to be stuck in a lowered plan if we find out after the 15th that we will get subsidies and we don't want to risk going without insurance for a period. Knowing the GOP, they will deliberately delay this if they are going to offer subsidies just for the opportunity to be cruel."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nghi12x/

"Most people's health insurance costs will double or triple in the marketplace without the enhanced subsidies. We were paying \$1100 a month before, now \$588."

— r/obamacare · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lp1un7/if_the_bbb_passes_and_the_aca_is_gutted_what_are/n0rjo91/

"I remember. I have to point this fact out to people all the time. There is a whole group, mostly MAGA, who think the ACA caused it to happen. Prior to the ACA I had years of 30%+ premium increases."

— r/obamacare · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1urupru/aca_insurers_propose_doubledigit_premium_hikes/owk0052/

"Self-employed independent white male. My premiums tripled. It's a big deal. I'll send you my address so you can make up the difference. I'll refund it when the 10 year (and counting) congressional fix that you refer to is implemented."

— r/obamacare · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ps7j5o/premiums_triple_congress_goes_homes/nv7gfuq/

"This \$2,000 is supposed to be just for health services as opposed to insurance premiums. Therefore, if you can't afford the premiums, you are so much deeper in the hole. With fewer people able to afford the premiums, the carriers are just going to keep raising premiums on others to make up the difference. They knew that they would lose a lot of customers in 2026 due to the expiration of subsidies this year, which is why our rates for next year have skyrocketed. My premium will increase by 300 percent next year due to loss of subsidies."

— r/obamacare · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oyyvlk/lawmakers_are_racing_to_ward_a_middecember/np8lib6/

"Most of my rate increase will be directly related to the loss of the enhanced subsidy. Going up \$50/month isn't hard to swallow; my groceries have risen more than that. But going up \$600/mo I can't swallow."

— r/obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oh07yi/people_in_here_should_be_aware_that_market_rates/nlks5ti/

"27M, COBRA premium increased from \$610 to \$950 after one month. Please help. I'm really in a bind here and just want some clarification and guidance to figure out what my next best steps are. My premium was increased by more than 50%, and I wasn't alerted until today that it would also apply for the September payment. My new insurance won't kick in until the end of October. I haven't made any Cobra payments yet but did "opt in", but I haven't needed to use it yet. But now my body doesn't feel right and I've found a growth. If this turns into a bigger and drawn out health issue, I really don't know how I can make that payment work, but I also don't think I can put this off for another month. I've never had any major health issues before so I really have no clue what I'm in for. Are there any quick to enroll and less expensive health insurance alternatives? Or is this just what I have to work with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wo35q1/27m_cobra_premium_increased_from_610_to_950_after/

"You might think so. I hoped for something similar coming out of covid when millions of people were at risk of losing their employer tied health insurance during a major medical crisis. Unfortunately, that didn't seem to inspire any action. Maybe people seeing premiums skyrocketing will do the trick."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qxil1k/us_healthcare_needs_fixing_but_theres_no/o3wrmjk/

Politics deciding their premium · 63 documents · 20 voices

"My daughter is a surg/tech student. The doctor stuck her with a needle during a procedure. My daughter has insurance but not for that hospital. Now she owes \$1800 for getting treated at the hospital where she got stuck. Not sure what to do. My daughter is a surgical tech student. During one of her procedures in February, the doctor accidentally stuck her with a dirty needle. The doctor told her to go down to the triage so she could get the proper care for sticks, which included a blood test (plus a follow-up test 2 weeks later). My daughter has healthcare thru the government (Obamacare, basically). She got a bill from her teaching hospital for her medical care for \$1800. Her insurance is denying it because she isn't covered at the hospital where she works. What should she do? This is such an unusual situation, and I can't find advice anywhere (other than 'call an attorney', which would cost more than the \$1800). Suggestions? (on a good note, the patient was tested for any diseases and came back clean, so no worries on that front)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 929 upvotes · None

"Girlfriend had \$0 monthly premium; now will be \$890. She doesn't make \$700 a month... We're in Alabama. She has BCBS Blue Standardized Silver EPO. I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts. Apparently she is in the "Medicaid gap"... Not entirely sure what to do except tell her to drop it until we can find a better solution, as much as I hate saying that. We weren't planning on getting married, but I'm beginning to consider it so my employer can get her on family coverage under my policy... Next November...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 780 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA PLANS... THIS IS CRIMINAL!!!! Look at this This is a plan for my client (family of 5) with an income of \$83,000. In 2025, they were paying \$14.97 a month for a bronze \$0 deductible plan. The cheapest plan now with a \$0 deductible is freaking \$487 A MONTH!!! That is just insane!!! Not only are Americans going to suffer with their health insurance this year but this will also affect many agents like me and I feel like that is also not being talked about enough. Already have a few that say they won't be renewing. This is criminal, the enhanced subsidies need to be extended!"

— r/obamacare · 603 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj7nbz/2026_aca_plans_this_is_criminal_look_at_this/

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

"ACA Subsidies ending Hey all, my mom is losing her insurance at the end of 2025 due to the new bill ending ACA subsidies, raising her monthly payments from \$500 to \$1300 if she loses all the subsidies, which she cannot afford, she can't really afford to lose any of it. Does anyone have any suggestions or weird loopholes on what to do? For some context we are all born in the U.S., we live in Texas, she is in her 50s and is divorced from my father, income less than 62k"

— r/HealthInsurance · 531 upvotes · None

"HEALTHCARE PRICE CUTS ACT supposedly coming out of the White House tomorrow/soon for the ACA. Details are still sparse, but thus far I have seen the following being floated from anonymous admin officials: * 2-year extension of enhanced subsidies with max MAGI pushed to 700% FPL, kicks issue past the midterms * Portion of unused enhanced subsidies funneled into HSA/FSA, encourages buying more value-priced plans * Resumption of direct appropriation of CSR subsidies, end of Silver loading (will raise costs in many markets for the people who aren't in the top subsidy tiers) * Minimum monthly payment, no more \$0/month plans as a fraud prevention tactic This would also be close enough to a straight extension that many/most insurers may either reprice their rate requests quickly or authorize state insurance regulators to use their alternate scenario rate requests already submitted (enhancement extended, CSR appropriation resumed)."

— r/obamacare · 230 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p5m294/healthcare_price_cuts_act_supposedly_coming_out/

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"HDHPs suck if you actually need them. Because our subsidy expired, we are now paying \$1200 a month for 2 people for a bronze plan with an \$8000 deductible per person. CO, both 52, \$160k income. We went from \$1200 buying us great gold coverage to \$1200 and paying for our own care literally overnight. As it happens, for a bit of uterine bleeding, I actually need the insurance this year. All of the procedures I need – ultrasound, biopsy, and hysteroscopy – are subject to the deductible. And after the deductible, they're only covered at 40% by Select Health. What kind of insurance is this? We're basically paying high premiums for the privilege of paying for our own healthcare. This was the cheapest Obamacare option we could find. Where are all the HDHPs with lower premiums? We worked with a broker, and there weren't any. The contract company that employs my husband had an HDHP where the premium was even higher. At these prices, we can't even afford to fund an HSA. We didn't see any HDHPs on the exchange with premium is less than \$1000 a month. How are people affording this? HDHPs are not a bargain anymore, it seems. We make well over six figures, but since so much of our income is going to healthcare premiums, we have to drain our savings over any healthcare we need. And if you have HDHP insurance, you can't even pay a lower cash price to the facility. You have to pay the higher insurance negotiated price, even if you're paying 100% of the cost. And if I want sedation for these procedures (don't even get me started about how painful in office gynecology is), it's even more expensive. So basically, anything between a well-woman visit (free) and cancer (chemo meets that deductible pretty quick) is going to give you medical debt. This is indescribably unbelievable. Wow, this sucks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 199 upvotes · None

"The Congressional Republicans let the subsidies expire, but even less known but as impactful a 2 person household making the income cap (around \$80K annually) had to pay like \$2,400 a month for a bronze plan. A couple making \$40K each a year are far from rich. Thanks Trump."

— r/obamacare · 61 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uhcq23/millions_drop_obamacare_health_coverage_after/ou761no/

"I mean, to get the CBO score they needed and the Billionaire Taxcuts, they had to end the ACA subsidies. The Subsidy cut is paying for the tax cut."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oo84sq/can_someone_explain_to_me_why_democrats_expanded/nn2lzdu/

"Something is irreparably broken with the way things are right now. No way should my healthy, middle-class family of 5 be expected to pay \$3,000+/month for a high-deductible insurance plan with pitiful coverage that's not accepted by most quality providers. Even if the subsidies are extended, I still have a huge issue with government tax dollars being funneled to health insurance companies to pay for these ridiculously high premiums. We've had to switch to cash pay with no insurance in the past, and cash-pay prices are reasonable, especially as compared to what's billed to insurers."

— r/obamacare · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oluqzl/thoughts_on_howwhen_the_shutdown_will_end_now/nmkopxl/

"As a 59 years old retiree, I pay \$2264 per month for COBRA health insurance for me and my wife. I just checked ACA rates for us, it was over \$1000 per month more. I don't qualify for subsidies. Something is wrong with the ACA when its so much more costly without government subsidies."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgznxjuSyfTqcBbN1kp4AaABAg

↳ @beautyandplay (3): "probably better with private plans."

↳ @nata3467 (0): "how much are you and your wife making ?"

↳ @acevers (0): "That's because you were a productive person before retirement. Only bums and disabled people get deals and freebies, and your taxes pay for it. Sucks."

"If I submit ACA application now and enhanced subsidies come back in the coming weeks, can I still get them? I want to see what my updated pricing would be under current circumstances. I've updated my application, but I just want to make sure that if the subsidies come back before open enrollment ends, that I haven't ruled myself out of getting them. I won't actually sign up for a plan yet, just want to submit my application so I can get an idea what I'm working with. Does anybody know whether that's ok without putting myself at risk of missing out if they come back?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · None

"Crazy idea - what do you think? Hi, there. Without being too wordy (happy to elaborate if needed), I wanted to ask for input on this idea I have. We make too much money to qualify for ANY subsidies next year (we're not "rich", but we're above the cutoff). Because of this, our health insurance is going to go from \$900 a month for the two of us (already outrageously expensive for the high deductible, bronze plan we have) to \$3,500 PER MONTH. Yes, per month. That comes to \$42,000 per year. And again, that's before paying for any of the actual medical expenses we may incur. I have confirmed this with an insurance agent so it's not just me miscalculating (and yes, I plan to discuss this with the agent as well, but I love the Reddit forums so here I am). I'm thinking there might be something I'm not understanding, but here's my idea - couldn't we just not have health insurance and if something catastrophic comes up (cancer diagnosis, for example), we could move (we have the option to change residency because we do own a home in another state) and then use the special enrollment period to get insurance? I mean, remember - we're talking \$42,000 per year otherwise - and that's before anything even happens. Thanks for your input."

— r/HealthInsurance · 24 upvotes · None

"ACA plans versus just enrolling through private insurer I cannot seem to find an answer to this anywhere I estimate my MAGI to be around ~40k next year. I am not offered health insurance through employer bc I work part time. I have decent amount of assets so I don't have trouble paying higher premiums each month (it also makes my income less predictable with dividends, capital gains etc but i try to keep it as close to 40k as possible with 401k contributions, trad IRA etc.) My question is -- If I go with [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and get a plan there with a subsidy, at the end of the year does it all even out if I were to just pay the higher premium and get the tax rebate when I file taxes? My accountant complains about [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) plans when I file taxes and recommends I just get it directly with the insurer. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · None

"they big question i have is why are the premium so dang high with out ACA i have a family of 5 and we get crushed . we need to take a look at the real issue . these insurance companies are making record profits on us . and the government is helping subsidize it . we need to fix this system ."

— r/obamacare · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/nm42d26/

"I'm not sure how this helps those of us who have never received subsidies. In September my state was predicting a 13% rise in costs for 2026. Then, when the enhanced subsidies weren't extended they increased my cost 26%, almost \$200. Their 'day late and dollar short' legislating is useless for many."

— r/obamacare · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q9mpvb/republican_senators_are_pushing_to_get_enhanced/nyx40ox/

"I sure wish Senator Schumer wouldn't have caved last fall when the enhanced subsidies expired"

— r/obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ve7xqg/obamacare_premiums_suggested_this_year_a_new/p1ga97z/

"Journalist seeking NYers concerned about ACA subsidies Hi I'm Caroline Lewis, a health care reporter with the NYC public radio station WNYC. I'm working on a story about how ACA insurance subsidies will be reduced if enhanced tax credits are allowed to expire at the end of this year. I'm looking to speak with NYC residents who have insurance through the state's ACA exchange (known here as New York State of Health) and who are concerned about their plans becoming less affordable. If you are interested in speaking with me, please send me a message here or email me at clewis@wnyc.org. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"Absolutely. However it's American citizens committing the fraud. Florida and New York have the highest rate of corruption from small time medical distributors who file false claims. The Patient's aren't the Frauds, it's the people behind the process. And this government does not care about Medicare Fraud or Obamacare Fraud. How many medical distributors have made away with MILLIONS and not get caught. Makes me sick to my stomach. I was on Obamacare twice in my life (Corporate layoffs. 2x) and because the unemployment is \$250 a week where I live (RED LAND) I did receive and NEED the supplement help. Why isn't Anyone looking at the Insurance Companies??? Or PBMs??? I paid taxes for 40 years, I Earned that subsidy!"

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wnlono/trump_officials_eject_750000_from_obamacare/pbgjwzf/

Deductibles so high the plan is useless · 62 documents · 20 voices

"ACA premiums.... What's going on with ACA Marketplace insurance right now is absurd. The same plan I pay \$77 for (with tax credit) is now \$368. I currently have a \$150 deductible, \$1500 OOP max, \$250 ER copay, \$1 primary care visits, \$1-\$15 prescriptions, and a \$30 specialist, imaging and surgery copay. The same plan for 2026 now has a \$2700 deductible, \$8250 OOP max, \$1,000 ER copay AFTER deductible, \$30 primary care visit, and \$80 specialist, imaging and surgery copay... for almost quadruple the price. Without the tax credit, the plan premium is \$696.46 for next year. If someone hit their OOP max for the year with this plan without a tax credit, their healthcare would cost about \$16,000 for the year. If someone hit their OOP max with a similar tax credit as mine for the year, their healthcare would cost \$12,666. For the record, the projected income I gave on my application was \$38,000....."

— r/HealthInsurance · 665 upvotes · None

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA PLANS... THIS IS CRIMINAL!!!! Look at this This is a plan for my client (family of 5) with an income of \$83,000. In 2025, they were paying \$14.97 a month for a bronze \$0 deductible plan. The cheapest plan now with a \$0 deductible is freaking \$487 A MONTH!!! That is just insane!!! Not only are Americans going to suffer with their health insurance this year but this will also affect many agents like me and I feel like that is also not being talked about enough. Already have a few that say they won't be renewing. This is criminal, the enhanced subsidies need to be extended!"

— r/obamacare · 603 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj7nbz/2026_aca_plans_this_is_criminal_look_at_this/

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🍊 "

— r/obamacare · 586 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1olp6mh/virginia_aca_rates_posted_today_share_your/

"My new ACA premiums and deductible - considering just not having health insurance for a few years. So I had a life event last month that required me to get ACA. My monthly premium was \$485 and my deductible was \$7600. Just got an email saying my current health insurance will not be offered next year. Instead my new premium will be about \$560 and my deductible will be about \$11000. Also it seems many of my co-insurance will be higher by about \$70. And I'm not sure what else has changed for the worse. At this point I'm seriously considering not having health insurance for a few years. It seems cheaper to just plan a 3-week trip overseas and get better healthcare for much cheaper. You heard me - better! I just don't want to enable this defunct healthcare system anymore. If I'm in an accident I hope EMTALA saves my broke behind - in both senses of the phrase. I'll pay what I can then declare bankruptcy. If not life threatening, I'll take it overseas. A roundtrip ticket to India costs \$1500, \$1000 if you wait a month or so. That's less than three months premium. Over a year I can save up \$7000 in premiums. Saving up for one year buys me a full check up and a vacation trip. What do you think? Anyone considering the same thing? For those with kids - you have my sympathies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 574 upvotes · None

"\$2600/mth, \$6k deductible for wife and I Blue Shield Bronze HSA PPO w/ \$6k deductible is looking like \$2650/mth for 2026, for wife and I (middle aged, in good health). This is a CoveredCA ACA plan, and I'm self-employed. This is completely unaffordable. Having already cut all our costs to the bone, I only have one option, which is to raise my rates, and hope that my competitors will also be raising theirs too so mine aren't extortionate. The only other thing I could do it seems is to become younger, which I'll try and organize, but seems to have some complex issues. This is going to massively, massively spike inflation."

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · None

"Sat through new job orientation in a deep red state and the cognitive dissonance was something else Just started a new job in a red state. Orientation day, 50+ new hires packed into a hall, and eventually we get to the health insurance and benefits section. That's when the room came alive. People complaining left and right about insurance companies ripping them off. My meds aren't covered. My deductible is insane. I can't get the care I actually need. Half the room had a story. And honestly, looking around, a lot of these folks clearly have real health issues and genuinely need coverage that works. Meanwhile HR is up there basically doing damage control, pitching workarounds and cheaper tiers like "this plan gets you more bang for your buck" which is corporate speak for "we know it's bad, here's how to make it slightly less bad." Here's the part that got me. Based on where I am and the conversations around me, most of this room votes red every single time. The same people furious about unaffordable meds and garbage coverage are voting for the party actively working to gut affordable healthcare. They'll rage at the insurance company all day but never connect it to the ballot they cast. Nobody in that room made the connection. Not one person. They see the symptom every day and keep voting for the disease. I just sat there quietly filling out my forms."

— r/obamacare · 325 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v5g93m/sat_through_new_job_orientation_in_a_deep_red/

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · None

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

"Going back to school for student medical insurance Many of us have increasing insurance costs, in my case it went from \$660/month last year with enhanced subsidies to \$1425/month this year with no subsidies so if retired or underemployed it becomes difficult to justify the costs. In my case I am a few years away from 65 but not wanting to work full-time (I am fortunate) due to my volunteer work I started looking for part time jobs with benefits. I was chasing a rabbit down a hole and found that as a part-time student within the UNC system I was eligible to also get student coverage. Some of the rules \-Have to be in a degree program \-Must attend on Campus \-Part-time = 6 credits Some numbers Not a student- ACA \$17,100/annual, \$2000 deductible max OOP \$8200 As a student \-Tuition/fees annually \$3872 (6 credits/semester) \-Medical insurance \$3168 (12-months) \$500 deductible max OOP \$4000 , campus clinic use unlimited with \$0 co-pay Total annual = \$7040 Additional student benefits (mandatory fees) \-Access to fitness center/pool \-Access to library \-Student discounts By going back to school I will save just under \$10k/annually So I enrolled and was accepted into a GIS program starting in Aug 26, not only will I be saving money but for me the structure of a schedule will help me fill in my week. Even if I became a full-time my annual costs would be \$11k/annual which would still be a savings over ACA only. I am fortunate to not need to work so YMMV, but thought I would share my adventure."

— r/HealthInsurance · 92 upvotes · None

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— r/HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · None

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— r/obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

"I need OP to sit down as this may shock them. This is better than my current 2025 plan. I have no children, so just for me. I have zero health issues, and never go to the doctor. Even fifteen years ago I was spending \$150/month for \$3000 deductible as a young person. The idea of a \$15/month plan has never been close to a reality for me. I've never seen a \$0 deductible plan. My genuine concern is my plan will jump to \$600, \$700, even \$800/month and my deductible will go from \$12000 to \$15000 or more. This is back breaking to strained budgets."

— r/obamacare · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj7nbz/2026_aca_plans_this_is_criminal_look_at_this/nm1cx41/

"Yes, it's true. I am assuming from your numbers that you are single and I see from one of your replies that you are in Ohio. Your numbers are from last year though. They update for inflation each year. Ohio is an expansion Medicaid state, which means income up to 138% of the Federal Poverty Level (\$21,597 for a single this year) will qualify you for expansion Medicaid. Starting next year that benefit comes with a part-time community engagement requirement of 20 hours per week in work, volunteering, or part-time enrollment as a student. That's one option open to you. If you keep your income between 138% FPL and 150% FPL (\$21,598 to \$23,474), then you will qualify for a CSR Silver 94 plan with maximum premium subsidies and maximum cost sharing reduction subsidies. You can see 2026 prices (pre and post-subsidy) and plans in your county with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. You would be looking at around \$80/month or less for either the benchmark or under-benchmark Silver plan in your county, those being the least and second least expensive Silvers on offer in your county. Untaxed Roth withdrawals do not add to your income for ACA purposes, so you will need another source in order to develop qualifying income. That could be interest, dividends, employment, stock sales that produce cap gains, Roth conversions, traditional retirement account withdrawals, or your SS and pension income once they start. For context, we've been using the ACA for 12 years now and have had a CSR Silver 94 that entire time. Our policy this year has a \$7/month premium, \$0 deductible, a \$2,400 MaxOOP, and is with the top-rated ACA insurer in our state. It's a great policy, though all of our CSR Silver 94 policies have been just fine."

— r/obamacare · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti1dc8/manipulating_income_for_silver_plan_w_csr/omrfr9z/

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"Job offer new health insurance cost \$\$\$ So I've been interviewing for a job I really wanted after the final interview she mentions the health insurance is a little high as the company only covers 1/2. I look at it and I'm shocked ! \$359.39 bi weekly so \$ 718.78 a month (& that's after the company covering half ??) The difference a year is around \$5,400 more to pay for health insurance. Are they even offering insurance at that point ? I've paid cobra less than that in the past. I pushed back on the recruitment asking if they can cover the difference & his response was "no one has ever said anything about the health insurance costing too much." My current job is a smaller and this is supposed to be an upgrade? Is this normal ? To add I am single, 36 years old NYC and the salary is 120,000. Bi weekly - Employee: \$359.39 W/ \$2,000 deductible (my current plan is \$4,000 which is sometimes hit) The other option is an HSA at \$467.68 bi weekly w/ \$1,700 deductible ... **UPDATE** * They retracted the offer for asking for additional coverage. Nice"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wpgvgj/job_offer_new_health_insurance_cost/

"I'm not sure how this helps those of us who have never received subsidies. In September my state was predicting a 13% rise in costs for 2026. Then, when the enhanced subsidies weren't extended they increased my cost 26%, almost \$200. Their 'day late and dollar short' legislating is useless for many."

— r/obamacare · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q9mpvb/republican_senators_are_pushing_to_get_enhanced/nyx40ox/

"My school is utterly useless, they just direct me to the marketplace."

— r/HealthInsurance · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/p9titod/

"Not for me. \$3400/mo. But at least the deductible is only \$4000 and OOPM is \$5200. Personally I'm planning to gtfo of this failed nation and enjoy life in a nice country that cares about its residents and the healthcare costs are actually reasonable."

— r/obamacare · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vi9mvg/aca_versus_cobra_payments_cobra_is_cheaper/p2ek4a8/

"I'm a single person, age 60, using the ACA without subsidies, because I don't "qualify"... for just medical it costs me \$1000 per month with a \$6000 annual deductible... which means, I have to spend \$18,000 a year to just utilize the insurance. Totally unsustainable and unacceptable for a "first-world" country."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvyzBI8&lc=Ugzy4GSnFfdMqq7huXR4AaABAg.AVBMLSyqO-AVBbxqPVAdu>

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Managing income to keep the subsidy · 89 documents · 20 voices

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"My health insurance just went to \$60,000 a year for a silver PPO Prepare for sticker shock. Just checked the IL exchange today, and my BCBS HDHP went from \$1200 a month after subsidies to \$2925 after subsidies (**the plan cost is 60k per year**) the reasons for this are two-fold 1. Expiration of enhanced subsidies 2. The site allowing junk insurers to claim SLC status (benchmark) with plans no one can use. For my area it is an OSCAR HMO which virtually no hospital system or doctor accepts. OSCAR has a 1 star rating from the BBB and dozens of lawsuits against it for failure to pay claims. so I now have to hunt around for a HMO, and my family will lose its doctors. The PPACA as originally passed prevented insurance premiums from eating up more than a certain percentage of your annual income. At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments so I will lose my doctor(s) at the very least and pay way beyond what the law said I was going to. pretty sure I am seeing why some politicians are saying we should tear up the PPACA altogether, because it clearly isn't working, and made a bad situation worse"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,000 upvotes · None

"ACA premiums.... What's going on with ACA Marketplace insurance right now is absurd. The same plan I pay \$77 for (with tax credit) is now \$368. I currently have a \$150 deductible, \$1500 OOP max, \$250 ER copay, \$1 primary care visits, \$1-\$15 prescriptions, and a \$30 specialist, imaging and surgery copay. The same plan for 2026 now has a \$2700 deductible, \$8250 OOP max, \$1,000 ER copay AFTER deductible, \$30 primary care visit, and \$80 specialist, imaging and surgery copay... for almost quadruple the price. Without the tax credit, the plan premium is \$696.46 for next year. If someone hit their OOP max for the year with this plan without a tax credit, their healthcare would cost about \$16,000 for the year. If someone hit their OOP max with a similar tax credit as mine for the year, their healthcare would cost \$12,666. For the record, the projected income I gave on my application was \$38,000....."

— r/HealthInsurance · 665 upvotes · None

"Fuck this country's health insurance I've dislocated both my kneecaps, now they're loose and unstable. I genuinely cannot mentally or emotionally go through that type of pain again. I've been desperately trying to buy health insurance, I missed the united healthcare deadline to enroll for 2025 because I didn't have the fucking money, I don't qualify for medicaid, I have health insurance offered through my job but didn't accept it because the insurance is \$240 (9.02% of my income) at the cheapest, and i'm barely scraping by as it is. But that gives me the kicker of not qualifying for tax credits for healthcare marketplace insurances. I genuinely have not taken my knee braces off for more than 20 minutes in three days, I cry nearly every night because of this shit. I feel like i have no choice or the ones i have are absolute shit. Pay \$300+ in health insurance, pay out of pocket for all healthcare costs and go into medical debt that i can't pay, or wait over six months and just let my knee issues get worse before i can enroll into my jobs health insurance again. I am 20 years old and have done no sports, nothing, absolutely nothing, to cause issues in my knees. And now, i live in constant fucking fear that i will end up screaming on the ground again and apparently can't do shit about it. What in the actual fuck is america"

— r/HealthInsurance · 614 upvotes · None

"4X INCREASE in Premiums!! I made a post a few days ago about the price increase and I really didn't do a good job of showing it and some called it "cheap". This would be a plan for a household of two with 1 person applying for coverage at an income of \$90K. Their plan in 2025 was a \$0 ded Aetna bronze at \$587 a month. What I am showing on the screen is the CHEAPEST possible plan in their area for 2026. No filters no nothing just the straight cheapest option. WHAAAAT!??? That is a 4 times jump!! This is madness! I have had many of my low income clients jump from \$20-30 a month to \$400-500 plans. These are people close to the 100% of the FPL, way to crazy, no one is paying. What are your current prices looking like? 📌 "

— r/obamacare · 391 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1omjomk/4x_increase_in_premiums/

"ACA isn't so affordable Long story short, we'll be losing our healthcare come June. My wife has inherited a long list of health issues, and has been hospitalized 5x since January, anywhere from a week to 2 at a time. Essentially she's been hospitalized for 2 of the last 3 months in total. There's no end in sight for this. I make 62,500 a year, and she made 70,000 a year prior to this, providing insurance from her job as well. She'll be down to whatever SSDI is come June, and has made 60% of her normal wages thus far. I estimate our income at about 90k per year after this. My job is for a semi small family company, and our insurance is ok, but asks about pre-existing conditions. I tried marketplace which said if our income was below 108k per year we qualified for discounts! Yeah no. It's at a minimum \$12k per year in premiums, plus \$18k max out of pockets. I don't know about you, but it's a bit difficult paying 30 grand per year on a 90k income BEFORE taxes. And she will absolutely max the out of pocket week one. These stays are ICU stays, we're already in the millions. If you factor out taxes, we're left with about \$70k, giving me 40k for her, myself, and our 1 year old. This sucks. My only other option would be a divorce, and since her only income would be social security she would then qualify for Medicaid, but I guess that takes 2 years after you have a disability."

— r/HealthInsurance · 323 upvotes · None

"HDHPs suck if you actually need them. Because our subsidy expired, we are now paying \$1200 a month for 2 people for a bronze plan with an \$8000 deductible per person. CO, both 52, \$160k income. We went from \$1200 buying us great gold coverage to \$1200 and paying for our own care literally overnight. As it happens, for a bit of uterine bleeding, I actually need the insurance this year. All of the procedures I need – ultrasound, biopsy, and hysteroscopy – are subject to the deductible. And after the deductible, they're only covered at 40% by Select Health. What kind of insurance is this? We're basically paying high premiums for the privilege of paying for our own healthcare. This was the cheapest Obamacare option we could find. Where are all the HDHPs with lower premiums? We worked with a broker, and there weren't any. The contract company that employs my husband had an HDHP where the premium was even higher. At these prices, we can't even afford to fund an HSA. We didn't see any HDHPs on the exchange with premium is less than \$1000 a month. How are people affording this? HDHPs are not a bargain anymore, it seems. We make well over six figures, but since so much of our income is going to healthcare premiums, we have to drain our savings over any healthcare we need. And if you have HDHP insurance, you can't even pay a lower cash price to the facility. You have to pay the higher insurance negotiated price, even if you're paying 100% of the cost. And if I want sedation for these procedures (don't even get me started about how painful in office gynecology is), it's even more expensive. So basically, anything between a well-woman visit (free) and cancer (chemo meets that deductible pretty quick) is going to give you medical debt. This is indescribably unbelievable. Wow, this sucks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 199 upvotes · None

"I was fraudulently signed up in 2020. Someone got an ACA plan under my name in the state of Florida. I do not live anywhere near Florida. They claimed I had no income. I didn't catch it until I went to file my taxes and it flagged for not having the ACA form. It was a nightmare to rectify. I was never unemployed, never applied for anything anywhere like ACA coverage and had commercial insurance the entire time. They also applied for unemployment in the state I live in during that timeframe but that was caught as fraudulent."

— r/HealthInsurance · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbnyis1/

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

"IF they extend the subsidies and get rid of the 400% cliff am I better off to overestimate next year's income if I am close to the 400%??? What about this year, can I make changes? I read Hakeem Jeffries said they may pass an extension..I realize thats a big IF. We may be close to the 400% next year and if we go over we will owe all the subsidy back. If they continue subsidies beyond the 400% would I be better to estimate my income at 450% next year so I don't owe back 100% if I do hit 450%? If I don't reach that amount will I get a refund for having overestimated? We may have to do a large withdrawal from IRA as we have an issue that may come up requiring extra \$ next year. Along the same line, I underestimated this year. I still have 10 days to change my income for 2025. Will I save any \$ if I raise my estimated income for this year ? Is it too late?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 26 upvotes · None

"ACA plans versus just enrolling through private insurer I cannot seem to find an answer to this anywhere I estimate my MAGI to be around ~40k next year. I am not offered health insurance through employer bc I work part time. I have decent amount of assets so I don't have trouble paying higher premiums each month (it also makes my income less predictable with dividends, capital gains etc but i try to keep it as close to 40k as possible with 401k contributions, trad IRA etc.) My question is -- If I go with [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and get a plan there with a subsidy, at the end of the year does it all even out if I were to just pay the higher premium and get the tax rebate when I file taxes? My accountant complains about [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) plans when I file taxes and recommends I just get it directly with the insurer. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · None

"NY has it's own exchange as well. One problem I have getting an estimate is, if my income is below 250% FPL (about \$39k), they don't exactly tell you what you get because instead of a subsidy for a 'qualified plan', you get put on the 'Essential Plan'....basically a co-pay version of Medicaid. But w/ the new Medicaid eligibility rules - like working 80 hrs/mo - I technically won't qualify. So not sure if that means I get a bigger subsidy towards a 'qualified plan' or what happens. It's almost like when the passed ACA - you have to apply to find out what you get. Either way, I am looking at about \$35k, so I'll just have to put it in and see what it comes up with."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxxgNqdW1muZXeoJsaN4AaABAq>

↳ @Dave_D. (1): "@HappyonMonday If I put in \$40k, the low end where subsidies start, it will be fine, I've already played around w/ it a bunch - just drives me nuts that they can't tell you what happens below that level until you 'send it'."

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "It's crazy how different each state is! Fingers crossed for you that you get a good deal! 🍀 "

↳ @Dave_D. (0): "@TaishaKirkendall I could just say \$40k and know what I'll pay for a qualified plan....but I think I will go lower (I can control my income so that's not a problem) and just see what happens if they put me on essential but I don't qualify due to the new medicaid qualifications. I figure worst case, it would be the same subsidy as \$40k, best case it's free w/ co-pay, or, somewhere in the middle (bigger subsidy)."

"Covered California is confusing me after adding my newborn — why does my baby suddenly qualify for Medi-Cal? I'm so confused and hoping someone can explain how this works. I recently gave birth and went on Covered California to add my newborn baby to our health plan. Before the baby was born, it was just me and my husband on the plan. We purchased our insurance through Covered California because we make well above the Medi-Cal income limit and did not qualify. Now that I added our baby, Covered California says my baby qualifies for Medi-Cal and is also telling us that we may qualify for Medi-Cal as a family. 😞 I don't understand how that's possible. The income limit I'm seeing is less than \$4,000/month for a family of 3, but our household income is higher than that. When I called, they told me that adding the baby "brings the income down a lot," but I don't understand what that means because adding another person doesn't actually reduce our income. I do NOT want Medi-Cal. We want to keep our Covered California plan and have our baby on the same insurance if possible. Why would my newborn qualify for Medi-Cal when we didn't qualify before the baby was born, and how does adding the baby change our eligibility so dramatically? Has anyone else gone through this with a newborn in California? I'd really appreciate an explanation because I'm completely confused. 😞 "

— r/HealthInsurance · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wf92vf/covered_california_is_confusing_me_after_adding/

"Ours is actually quite a bit worse, probably due to age (late 50's). If we careen over the cliff of \$84,600 due to not having quite enough expenses or whatever, it will cost us an additional \$19,200 / year. Our anticipated income is just very, very close to the cliff, and that's best case scenario with a bronze plan and full HSA funding to get our MAGI to \$80k. If we topple over, we will pay over \$24,000 / year in premiums for a bronze plan + \$10,750 to fund the HSA. That's 41% of our gross income before we even visit a doctor or fill a prescription, not to mention federal and state taxes. Not much left. WTF, America?"

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojey71/any_selfemployed/nm32690/

"Thanks for posting. This is a lot to take in. We are all in a waiting game. We got notice a month or so ago that our provider is not participating in the VA marketplace next year. So we have to choose a new plan. Damn this is frustrating. Fortunately we have been able to control our income this year. So we should get affordable premiums."

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1m60tzo/important_obamacare_a_changes_to_know_heading/n4g5n76/

"Yep; retired at 61 and controlled my MAGI such that I paid \$0 for a Silver plan. Benefit of being conservative over many years and having enough in brokerage / savings to cover expenses, vacations, etc. for four years before Medicare kicked in. (So now I actually pay more (~\$300/mo) for Medicare + plan premium than when on ACA. 🤔)"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg

↳ @u8805a8cee (3): "I retired before the ACA, very young. Males in my family don't live long lives, so I shifted "retirement" to occur earlier, before I expect to die. I "retired" before the ACA existed, so it wasn't part of any planning. OTOH, my prior health insurance was \$150/month before the ACA started making it double almost every year. I still had cash savings in the first few years after the ACA was passed, which meant my income/MAGI was below the FPL and full payment for ACA plans was the rule. After a few years of paying \$500, \$600, \$700, then \$800/month for the cheapest ACA Marketplace coverage, finally figured out that my annual income/MAGI needed to appear to be at least the poverty level and had to pick a more expensive plan. After fixing those 2 issues, health insurance became affordable again. The full monthly premium is over \$1200 now, but about \$1150 of that is paid by the Feds, because I control the MAGI. I expect to pay my fair share of taxes, but not 1 penny more. I'm not looking forward to being forced off the ACA and onto Medicare at age 65. Monthly health insurance premiums will raise about 6x, it appears now and that's not counting MediGAP insurance. Definitely need to use the ACA as part of your early retirement plans. Wish I'd realized it a few years earlier before paying tens of thousands to health insurance unnecessarily."

"The rest of the ACA is not being gutted, although it will be fraught with issues. My plan is: \- for 2025, have an income of 148.9% of poverty (I had already notified the state Medicaid office that I had a random, high-income month in January 2025, which should suffice for me not having to notify them again. \- in March 2026, re-apply for Medicaid (April is the anniversary month), which will use the 2024 tax form income (which is below 100%), taking that attitude that I believe my income for 2026 will be below 138% of poverty \- file 2025 tax form after getting approved for Medicaid \- in November 2026, apply for coverage year 2027 ACA Silver-94% plan, using the 2025 tax form as the "data source" \- for 2026 on forward, have an income of 139.1%, so as to maximize the PTC; the loss of PTC seems to be equivalent to a 6% tax rate, which would mean a net 9% tax rate (I am in the 0% federal tax rate schedule, having regular income right at the standard deduction, and long-term capital-gains on top) \- if my family size were ever to change, I would reapply with an income of 139.1% of whatever the income would be based on the poverty level being higher (it appears that the Senate version of the Big Bill allows for a stated change of income if family size changes). \- Bleed off Roth for whatever cash I need if I am up against the total income limit (for any year)"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lp1un7/if_the_bbb_passes_and_the_aca_is_gutted_what_are/n0s7jut/

"Living off Cash (for a few years) I'll be 53 next year, and would like to quit my job and live off saved cash for 3-4 years before potentially rejoining the workforce. Since my income would be \$0 for those years, how would I go about getting health insurance? When I enter estimates in the ACA, they tell me to apply for medicaid. I also own a house that has an estimated value of 500k and have over 500k in retirement, but I don't want to touch the retirement until I'm 59. Would getting health insurance for my 3-4 years "off" be problematic because of my assets? And, would I have to receive medicaid or is there a way to still get a private insurance plan even with no income? I'm not trying to get "free healthcare," but if my income is zero for a few years, do I even have a choice? Thanks,"

— r/HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · None

Medicaid, CHIP or going without · 72 documents · 20 voices

"Fuck this country's health insurance I've dislocated both my kneecaps, now they're loose and unstable. I genuinely cannot mentally or emotionally go through that type of pain again. I've been desperately trying to buy health insurance, I missed the united healthcare deadline to enroll for 2025 because I didn't have the fucking money, I don't qualify for medicaid, I have health insurance offered through my job but didn't accept it because the insurance is \$240 (9.02% of my income) at the cheapest, and i'm barely scraping by as it is. But that gives me the kicker of not qualifying for tax credits for healthcare marketplace insurances. I genuinely have not taken my knee braces off for more than 20 minutes in three days, I cry nearly every night because of this shit. I feel like i have no choice or the ones i have are absolute shit. Pay \$300+ in health insurance, pay out of pocket for all healthcare costs and go into medical debt that i can't pay, or wait over six months and just let my knee issues get worse before i can enroll into my jobs health insurance again. I am 20 years old and have done no sports, nothing, absolutely nothing, to cause issues in my knees. And now, i live in constant fucking fear that i will end up screaming on the ground again and apparently can't do shit about it. What in the actual fuck is america"

— r/HealthInsurance · 614 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"Why all of the "I can't believe how much health insurance costs" comments are misguided With recent increases in both the cost of employer sponsored health insurance and ACA plans, especially for those who lose the enhanced subsidies, this sub has been flooded with people shocked and frustrated with the impact. Understandably so. But all of the comments that this is caused by the existence of health insurers or the profit model completely miss the point. Those same posters claiming that universal healthcare, single payer or Medicare for all is the solution equally miss the larger point. That point is that healthcare is and has increasingly gotten more (too) expensive. The US healthcare spend is about \$5 trillion. That equates to about \$15,000 per person per year. Or \$1250 per individual per month. Think \$2500 a month for a couple for health insurance is expensive? That's actually the average of what it costs to deliver healthcare services. So let's get rid of health insurance companies- I'm certainly not a big fan of them. By law they have to spend 85% on actual care. So 15% goes to administration (and those hated executive salaries). So get rid of that admin expense and the \$2500 for the couple drops to \$2125. Feel affordable all of the sudden? Of course not. So how about some form of universal healthcare? All that does is change who pays for it. And definitely not what's paid. We already have some universal healthcare between Medicaid and Medicare. A significant portion of the US insured population uses these programs. And guess what, costs are going up. The government hasn't demonstrated any ability to manage or control costs. Now it's fair to argue that some taxpayers should pay more so that others have to pay less for healthcare but let's at least have an honest discussion about that instead of pretending that if the government pays for it is free. Employers and ACA utilize insurance companies to manage costs. The track record of cost management there isn't really any better. The core issue is that there is a virtually unlimited demand for healthcare. And it's impossible to supply that without spending more and more. "Let the decision on treatment be between the doctors and their patients" - uh sure. Except that whoever actually pays is going to want to weigh in. Pretty logically. Even the successful universal healthcare countries are struggling to fund the efforts and the complaints are often attributed to underfunding. Because fully funding is impossible- demand is too unlimited. You will never change demand. That's human nature (though changing behaviors over time like smoking cessation can help). So someone is going to be in charge of rationing the care people get. Might be the government (Medicare/Medicaid) or might be a private insurer. Unless you are willing to pay directly for your own care, someone else is going to be in a position to say yes or no to it. Uncomfortable fact of life. So what can be done to corral the untenable rise in costs? The providers of care - physicians, facilities, pharmaceutical companies must be driven to charge less (and this may be the best argument for single payer as this best enables the government to dictate what will be paid). And perhaps some of the "innovative but costly treatments" must be foregone (rationed away). But make no mistake, unless we have the political will to pay providers less and ration care more (something the US population has never exhibited), we will continue to have this problem and have to find a new bogeyman after solving the last bogeyman."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · None

"Any self-employed? I don't know how anyone will be able to cover the increase. I have read some will be forced to go without coverage. How will you manage the sticker shock? This is unfathomable, scary, and needless to say, appalling to hear a country as big as the US is forcing people to do this."

— r/obamacare · 98 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojey71/any_selfemployed/

"A positive anecdote of using American/ACA health insurance We often hear mostly negative things regarding US health insurance online, particularly in regards to the ACA, so I thought I'd offer up a positive personal experience. Our daughter met with her new rheumatologist less than two weeks ago. Today we got the approval authorization for a year of her biologic infusion, which is off-formulary and medical exemption only. No arguing post-denial or justification to get insurance to pony up for an expensive drug that could easily make us net loss customers for them. Copay program from the manufacturer should bring our out-of-pocket cost down to \$0, but even without it our script-biased insurance would hold the drug copay to just \$300/year. This is also with a new insurer starting as a brand new patient. Took one week for her to get in to see her new PCP, took a few days for the referral to process, then three weeks for her to see the rheumatologist. This insurer and policy are also the absolute cheapest Silver in our market, meaning premium cost is significantly lower than even the benchmark plan. I appreciate more and more each year just how good of a healthcare/ACA market Austin has ended up being. Wife and I both needed to find a new PCP this year too due to switching insurance carriers and it only took a few weeks for us to get in as new patients. I hear people talk all the time about waiting months in other markets. Our new PCP was lovely too and didn't rush our new patient appointments at all despite us not really needing anything other than to establish service."

— r/obamacare · 46 upvotes · None

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

"I've just realized that my Ambetter ACA plan is dogsh1t First I see a primary care physician who doesn't want to continue to prescribe the maintenance sleep Rx that I have been on for over 30 years, telling me that I should see a psychiatrist. So I call up Ambetter saying this, but what do you know, there are only 3 psychiatrists in the plan, and none of them want to deal with anyone having insomnia issues. I have put in an escalation with healthcare.gov to allow me to get another plan (Blue Cross), which although it is \$300/m more, has my current primary-care physician in network. I have escalated wthis with Ambetter, and they are "working on it:, although they have not found a psychiatrist that will work out. I will be seeing my old doc as self-pay (\$130), also getting the Rx on my own. What the h3ll am I paying the \$80/mo for my plan for such garbage. And the ironic thing is that when I was on Medicaid, my primary-care physician was in network (I still had to pay for my Rx, since Medicaid doesn't pay for that Rx either)."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · None

"NY has it's own exchange as well. One problem I have getting an estimate is, if my income is below 250% FPL (about \$39k), they don't exactly tell you what you get because instead of a subsidy for a 'qualified plan', you get put on the 'Essential Plan'....basically a co-pay version of Medicaid. But w/ the new Medicaid eligibility rules - like working 80 hrs/mo - I technically won't qualify. So not sure if that means I get a bigger subsidy towards a 'qualified plan' or what happens. It's almost like when the passed ACA - you have to apply to find out what you get. Either way, I am looking at about \$35k, so I'll just have to put it in and see what it comes up with."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxxgNqdW1muZXeoJsaN4AaABAq>

↳ @Dave_D. (1): "@HappyonMonday If I put in \$40k, the low end where subsidies start, it will be fine, I've already played around w/ it a bunch - just drives me nuts that they can't tell you what happens below that level until you 'send it'."

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "It's crazy how different each state is! Fingers crossed for you that you get a good deal! 🍀 "

↳ @Dave_D. (0): "@TaishaKirkendall I could just say \$40k and know what I'll pay for a qualified plan....but I think I will go lower (I can control my income so that's not a problem) and just see what happens if they put me on essential but I don't qualify due to the new medicaid qualifications. I figure worst case, it would be the same subsidy as \$40k, best case it's free w/ co-pay, or, somewhere in the middle (bigger subsidy)."

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · None

"NC - losing medicaid for medically complex child Any moms on here with children on medicaid with congenital heart conditions/complex medical needs? I need your advice... I've just been told my daughter's medicaid won't be renewed even though my income has decreased from last year's renewal period. Marketplace coverage will cost \$600/mo and covers nothing. Her annual tests will cost upwards close to \$7-\$9,000 assuming her conditions stay stable and without issues. I called the tailored plan brokers and they told me it only covers behavioral/developmental conditions and that if our medicaid expires at the end of the month then there's no way she'd qualify. Am I missing any other outlets or resources? My case worker explains nothing as to why we're being rejected even though our income was much higher last year."

— r/Medicaid · 14 upvotes · None

"How many Americans are on PPO health insurance that covers seeing specialists/doctors across state lines compared to being on insurance that only covers within the state? I'm on Medicaid in Rhode Island for disability and it's frustrating dealing with out of state approvals. Any advice welcomed. I've had long-term neurological issues like neuropathy, muscle pain, and memory issues for nearly 6 years that neurologists in my state (and in Connecticut) haven't been able to definitively diagnose. I am on SSI for disability, which means I get Neighborhood Health Plan of Rhode Island as my primary insurance, with Medicaid as the secondary. I was told by a neurologist I saw across the border in Connecticut recently (Some doctors in CT take my insurance it seems) that being seen at a bigger hospital like Mass General may lead to a definitive diagnosis. From what I was told by his office after they tried referring me to the hospital, Mass General/MGH is no longer accepting my insurance even with prior authorization, when a few years ago i was told by Mass General they were taking my insurance with those stipulations. I was told by MGH's neurology department staff (who were very nice and compassionate about my situation, to be fair to them) that it's possible the hospital chose not to contract with my insurance this year, hence the change, and that because I am on Medicaid, I couldn't even choose to self-pay to go there. They said it's possible in the future the contractual issue could change, and they also told me to try contacting Neighborhood Health myself and explain the situation and see if they could somehow get me approved to be seen at Mass General. I will be calling them this upcoming week. I was curious as to how often Americans are on health insurance plans that cover seeing specialists across state lines, how difficult it is for them to be approved to see specialists in different states, etc. I find it frustrating that my insurance doesn't work across state lines considering this is the smallest state in the country. Not every specialist is going to be here. Logistically it seems to make sense to me that CT/MA should have a deal with RI insurance to cover people if they at least get prior authorization/approval. As of right now Mass General wouldn't take me no matter what, which I find very concerning and depressing. I have had multiple neurologists say I should be seen in a place like Boston to possibly get a definitive diagnosis, why is that not enough to be seen there? That makes no sense to me."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uheytb/how_many_americans_are_on_ppo_health_insurance/

"18 currently unemployed and need insurance To start off I've never used Reddit really so I'm not sure if this is appropriate here but it seems like the place to go. I turned 18 in June and haven't had health insurance for YEARS. It honestly wouldn't be a crazy issue for me if I wasn't dealing with some reproductive health issues and wanting birth control. I used to just go to the ER when things happened or visit Planned Parenthood but my mom seems against it now because of money. It'd be over \$1,000 per month for me to just be placed on her own plan so I'm at a wall. I went to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and I was told that I qualified for a marketplace plan yet open enrollment has closed. I don't believe I account for a special enrollment period because I never really had insurance to begin with. I don't understand what to do in my case. I still live with my mother, I have a job interview lined up but everything feels like a waiting game except I never actually get the medical attention I really need. I'm frustrated and just want to see an GYN or somebody that can help me, I'm very tired."

— r/HealthInsurance · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wdtqmh/18_currently_unemployed_and_need_insurance/

"My self paid insurance was \$150 a month when they started Obamacare. I have the same insurance, no medical conditions, and 5k deductible. It cost \$786 a month now. Thanks, Barry!"

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=Ugy2-KWeXwafTnN1nOd4AaABAg>

↳ @jltsowdycjltsowdyc1076 (4): "Oh heavens, I'm afraid you failed to understand, that thing you were paying \$150/month for was not insurance. It was a product used to make people think they had insurance, and was very affordable, but in reality, they would have simply kicked you out if you ever needed to use expensive care. You know, like cancer, a heart problem or some pre-existing condition. But after watching this video, I'm not sure why you have to pay so much? Julie seems to be paying very little. If only there was somebody out there trying to get those costs lower... the irony is thick."

↳ @jerryrichardson2799 (2): "Nope, more like thanks Trump. You might have had a legitimate gripe if you had a "Cadillac" plan, the ACA did charge a premium on those plans, but I can tell from your description you didn't have one of those."

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "Yikes that's gone up a lot! 🤔 "

Bronze, silver or gold: picking the tier · 71 documents · 20 voices

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄 "

— r/obamacare · 586 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1olp6mh/virginia_aca_rates_posted_today_share_your/

"Someone please explain why I (or anyone) should pay a premium that costs more than the oop max The maths aren't mathing. Someone help me understand what I am missing here. We live in NY. I am a self-employed general contractor. Wife is an attorney and recently left her job to open her own firm so we lost great health insurance through her previous employer. Cobra would cost us around \$7k/ month for 2 healthy adults and our 8yo healthy son. Now we're shopping on the marketplace in what appears to be the worst time in history to be doing so. We make too much for any subsidies, so a silver plan is coming in around \$3k/month. Catastrophic is coming in around \$750/month. After a lot of research I can't understand why I would buy anything other than catastrophic. All ACA plans include the same preventive care at no cost. All ACA plans have the same out of pocket maximum limit. Aside from a catastrophe, we would maybe spend \$1k/ year at most seeking care that isn't covered under ACA preventive care. So why would I pay \$36k/year for a silver plan when I could just buy catastrophic for 1/4 the price and pay out of pocket for everything else, knowing I have the same oop cap as the silver \$36k/year plan?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 577 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

"Just canceled my 2026 health insurance through Covered CA My situation is i made more money this year than i expected and now my insurance is about 450 \$ for the bronze plan the problem is everything went up for me, my car insurance went from 280 to 400 this year, my rent went up by 100 \$, my utilities went absolutely crazy, i am living in the studio apartment and used to pay 80-100 \$ max, but now every month is more and more, this month it got to 250 \$...and my apt manager said it's shared so it's not me lol So yeah, even tho i made more money than i expected, i don't have more money on hands, i used to pay 100 \$ per month for insurance and it was ok, but 450 \$ for bronze plan ??? I just can't do it... Can you guys recommend any other good alternatives in LA ? i have good health, nothing chronical and don't take any meds ? Thanks"

— r/HealthInsurance · 307 upvotes · None

"HDHPs suck if you actually need them. Because our subsidy expired, we are now paying \$1200 a month for 2 people for a bronze plan with an \$8000 deductible per person. CO, both 52, \$160k income. We went from \$1200 buying us great gold coverage to \$1200 and paying for our own care literally overnight. As it happens, for a bit of uterine bleeding, I actually need the insurance this year. All of the procedures I need – ultrasound, biopsy, and hysteroscopy – are subject to the deductible. And after the deductible, they're only covered at 40% by Select Health. What kind of insurance is this? We're basically paying high premiums for the privilege of paying for our own healthcare. This was the cheapest Obamacare option we could find. Where are all the HDHPs with lower premiums? We worked with a broker, and there weren't any. The contract company that employs my husband had an HDHP where the premium was even higher. At these prices, we can't even afford to fund an HSA. We didn't see any HDHPs on the exchange with premium is less than \$1000 a month. How are people affording this? HDHPs are not a bargain anymore, it seems. We make well over six figures, but since so much of our income is going to healthcare premiums, we have to drain our savings over any healthcare we need. And if you have HDHP insurance, you can't even pay a lower cash price to the facility. You have to pay the higher insurance negotiated price, even if you're paying 100% of the cost. And if I want sedation for these procedures (don't even get me started about how painful in office gynecology is), it's even more expensive. So basically, anything between a well-woman visit (free) and cancer (chemo meets that deductible pretty quick) is going to give you medical debt. This is indescribably unbelievable. Wow, this sucks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 199 upvotes · None

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😊) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday. **UPDATE:** I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😊) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the

amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 😊 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 😊 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting , failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an"

— r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · None

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— r/HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · None

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— r/obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

"A freaking nightmare. We have to enroll by Dec. 15 for Jan. 1 effective date. I have a decent silver plan, but the premium will increase by 300 percent without subsidies, which means I will just sign up for a cheaper bronze plan if there is no change by the 15th. People like me don't want to be stuck in a lowered plan if we find out after the 15th that we will get subsidies and we don't want to risk going without insurance for a period. Knowing the GOP, they will deliberately delay this if they are going to offer subsidies just for the opportunity to be cruel."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nghi12x/

"Crazy idea - what do you think? Hi, there. Without being too wordy (happy to elaborate if needed), I wanted to ask for input on this idea I have. We make too much money to qualify for ANY subsidies next year (we're not "rich", but we're above the cutoff). Because of this, our health insurance is going to go from \$900 a month for the two of us (already outrageously expensive for the high deductible, bronze plan we have) to \$3,500 PER MONTH. Yes, per month. That comes to \$42,000 per year. And again, that's before paying for any of the actual medical expenses we may incur. I have confirmed this with an insurance agent so it's not just me miscalculating (and yes, I plan to discuss this with the agent as well, but I love the Reddit forums so here I am). I'm thinking there might be something I'm not understanding, but here's my idea - couldn't we just not have health insurance and if something catastrophic comes up (cancer diagnosis, for example), we could move (we have the option to change residency because we do own a home in another state) and then use the special enrollment period to get insurance? I mean, remember - we're talking \$42,000 per year otherwise - and that's before anything even happens. Thanks for your input."

— r/HealthInsurance · 24 upvotes · None

"Agreed. I pay \$100 more per month for a Gold plan with a \$1K deductible. I would rather pay \$1200 more than get hit with a \$7K plus bill. I don't ration care this way either."

— r/obamacare · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v4frri/seems_like_a_good_deal_to_me_what_am_i_missing/ozaw6l6/

"IL started Get Covered IL last year in anticipation of these subsidies going away. It migrated those already on the marketplace for 2026 and mine only increased by .26 for 2026. I have a high deductible and it's an HMO. When I checked on the marketplace, it would've been \$188 more per month."

— r/obamacare · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1omsjln/will_large_states_like_california_create_public/nmrqp1n/

"Ours is actually quite a bit worse, probably due to age (late 50's). If we careen over the cliff of \$84,600 due to not having quite enough expenses or whatever, it will cost us an additional \$19,200 / year. Our anticipated income is just very, very close to the cliff, and that's best case scenario with a bronze plan and full HSA funding to get our MAGI to \$80k. If we topple over, we will pay over \$24,000 / year in premiums for a bronze plan + \$10,750 to fund the HSA. That's 41% of our gross income before we even visit a doctor or fill a prescription, not to mention federal and state taxes. Not much left. WTF, America?"

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojey71/any_selfemployed/nm32690/

"Yep; retired at 61 and controlled my MAGI such that I paid \$0 for a Silver plan. Benefit of being conservative over many years and having enough in brokerage / savings to cover expenses, vacations, etc. for four years before Medicare kicked in. (So now I actually pay more (~\$300/mo) for Medicare + plan premium than when on ACA. 🙄)"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg

↳ @u8805a8cee (3): "I retired before the ACA, very young. Males in my family don't live long lives, so I shifted "retirement" to occur earlier, before I expect to die. I "retired" before the ACA existed, so it wasn't part of any planning. OTOH, my prior health insurance was \$150/month before the ACA started making it double almost every year. I still had cash savings in the first few years after the ACA was passed, which meant my income/MAGI was below the FPL and full payment for ACA plans was the rule. After a few years of paying \$500, \$600, \$700, then \$800/month for the cheapest ACA Marketplace coverage, finally figured out that my annual income/MAGI needed to appear to be at least the poverty level and had to pick a more expensive plan. After fixing those 2 issues, health insurance became affordable again. The full monthly premium is over \$1200 now, but about \$1150 of that is paid by the Feds, because I control the MAGI. I expect to pay my fair share of taxes, but not 1 penny more. I'm not looking forward to being forced off the ACA and onto Medicare at age 65. Monthly health insurance premiums will raise about 6x, it appears now and that's not counting MediGAP insurance. Definitely need to use the ACA as part of your early retirement plans. Wish I'd realized it a few years earlier before paying tens of thousands to health insurance unnecessarily."

"The ACA was made for people like me and my husband. We are both self-employed and have been for a good chunk of our lives, for my husband it's actually his whole adult life. We don't qualify for Medicaid, we make too much. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, but not all of it. We couldn't get health insurance any other way. We can't do catastrophic plans, we have health conditions. So it hasn't been a Band-Aid for us, it was a lifesaver. When ACA first came out, I was skeptical and wouldn't even look. Then my husband went into the hospital for 21 days. A whole had started in his colon and it was almost completely torn through, but we got there in time and he sat there for 21 days getting pumped full of strong antibiotics. And that bankrupted us. And then I signed up for the ACA and I wanted to kick myself because for four years we went without it and we could've not filed bankruptcy Had we had it I know there are people that still are falling through the cracks. Because you have to make some money to get ACA but there is also the subsidy cliff. It literally saved us. Why do people don't realize that those extended subsidies also opened up ACH to a lot of people that would have otherwise not qualified. I'm all happy to help people but it's like now people don't want the means test applied at all. The ACA is going back to its original rules. No, I do not want people to see their premiums quadruple and more, but it simply going back to what it was before Covid and it still insured around 14 million people. That may be nothing to you, but it was our literal lifeline. We either get help with healthcare or my husband goes on disability. He doesn't want that, he enjoys working. But he needs his medication and access to his doctors to keep doing that. It may be a Band-Aid for some, but it wasn't for us"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/ngibrvo/

"What do you do for Health Insurance? As someone who is self employed, how do you cover insurance? I have a High Deductible Health Plan through the marketplace. My plan this year is over \$1k a month and has a household out of pocket of \$11k before the insurance pays out anything. That means I pay a minimum of \$12k per year. I would have to spend \$23k before any help for medical bills would be provided. 😬 I don't have a PCP because I'm super healthy & 30 years old and almost never see a doctor. If I do have a reason to visit, I run by a walk in clinic and pay out of pocket. I keep the insurance in case of an emergency, but that is SOOO MUCH MONEY just in case of an emergency. Does anyone have any better options?"

— r/selfemployed · 10 upvotes · None

"62f small business owner (sole proprietor). Located in GA, which has its own exchange. AGI \$38,000 after schedule C write-offs. This year I pay \$38/mo, \$3600 MOOP, silver plan. \$15 copay for PCP, \$15 copay for mental health weekly (therapy), \$30 copay specialist. My colon ruptured out of the blue June 18. Emergency abdominal surgery, 10 days in hospital. The main hospital bill was \$90,000, my portion was \$10. I owe the surgeon \$800 and the hospital another \$3500, which I'm paying \$191/mo on a payment plan. The govt subsidy on my '24 taxes was \$816/mo. I have no idea what '26 will look like for my monthly premium. I certainly can't afford \$800+/mo! And I can't go without insurance 😞 "

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh749pf/

"I just needed the ACA for a little more than a year before I qualify for Medicare in 2026. I recently bought a bronze plan which is more basic than I am used to, and paying 900/month, excluding vision and dental and that is with a monthly supplement. Without the supplement, it will be closer to 1200/month. My ACA plan is so scaled down that it won't cover a bone density screening, so I am postponing it. I can pay the increased rate for a limited period of time until I get Medicare, but it will be tight. With rising costs in all areas of the economy- groceries, utilities, etc.- we will definitely be cutting back across the board so I can make it to Medicare. All of that being said, it's so aggravating that healthcare in this country is deemed a privilege. It really should be a basic human right but somehow, in the richest country on earth, we can't "afford it". The US is becoming unaffordable for everyone except the rich."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mbsi9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/n5py1yp/

"This depends on where you live. I have not compared plans yet this year, but previously, there was not a huge difference in premium despite the significantly higher out of pocket for bronze."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nqhnnld/

"I'm confused why the same plan my girlfriend and I choose went up for her, but stayed the same for me? We both signed up for Oscar Gold Elite last year and each have our incomes which are unfortunately low. Same jobs and same income for this year... But for some reason my premium for the same plan stayed at the exact same price of \$40, but hers more than doubled to \$100. We use our premium tax credits but she uses the insurance more than I do because she had asthma but does that have anything to do with it? I'm a bit confused because I don't understand this stuff very well despite watching many videos on it. Any help is greatly appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · None

HealthCare.gov or the state exchange on their own · 67 documents · 20 voices

"ACA isn't so affordable Long story short, we'll be losing our healthcare come June. My wife has inherited a long list of health issues, and has been hospitalized 5x since January, anywhere from a week to 2 at a time. Essentially she's been hospitalized for 2 of the last 3 months in total. There's no end in sight for this. I make 62,500 a year, and she made 70,000 a year prior to this, providing insurance from her job as well. She'll be down to whatever SSDI is come June, and has made 60% of her normal wages thus far. I estimate our income at about 90k per year after this. My job is for a semi small family company, and our insurance is ok, but asks about pre-existing conditions. I tried marketplace which said if our income was below 108k per year we qualified for discounts! Yeah no. It's at a minimum \$12k per year in premiums, plus \$18k max out of pockets. I don't know about you, but it's a bit difficult paying 30 grand per year on a 90k income BEFORE taxes. And she will absolutely max the out of pocket week one. These stays are ICU stays, we're already in the millions. If you factor out taxes, we're left with about \$70k, giving me 40k for her, myself, and our 1 year old. This sucks. My only other option would be a divorce, and since her only income would be social security she would then qualify for Medicaid, but I guess that takes 2 years after you have a disability."

— r/HealthInsurance · 323 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise... what do I do? 27F, entry level job after graduating college, trying to buy a house and start a family. Bit of a rant here... You saw the title. My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise. I am flabbergasted. I can't afford to pay over \$200/month more for my health insurance because I make an extra \$160/month?!?! In what world does that make sense?! There is a PCP in my area that does not take insurance, but provides most of the services I require for a \$90/month subscription. It's what I want to go with. They suggested I go with a catastrophic health plan in case of car wreck, etc. He said it should be about \$90/month. When I researched catastrophic health plans, the lowest premium is over \$200/month. I can't afford this AND pay rent AND pay car payment AND pay car insurance AND pay all my other bills AND save money for house/ children/ emergencies. It's safe to say I'm panicking. I payed the insurance for January but I couldn't save anything. I can't keep this plan. I'm currently feeling very defeated by a system that seems to be set up to keep the majority down... I'm so tired of this. Where is universal healthcare? What should I do? Where can I find a catastrophic health plan for around \$100 a month?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 137 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"I don't have that obamacare , I got mine on the exchange /s"

— r/obamacare · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ofrwiw/the_new_aca_rates_will_post_next_saturday_and_all/nlbnrvr/

"Is It Better to not Have Health Insurance or Choose a Very Expensive Plan? So these are the issues that we're facing if we have to choose a marketplace plan. Would you guys rather risk it and go without, or pay a lot for a plan? Here's my potential plan with a 50k income: BCBS PPO, 700/month, 9800 deductible, 11000 max oop. It would eat up my income, but if I don't have any major surgeries or a trip to the ER, then I'd be fine without. However, I'd hate to be uninsured if something happens. Realistically, what would you do? Can hospitals negotiate the price down if a bill is very expensive?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 47 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

"I've just realized that my Ambetter ACA plan is dogshit First I see a primary care physician who doesn't want to continue to prescribe the maintenance sleep Rx that I have been on for over 30 years, telling me that I should see a psychiatrist. So I call up Ambetter saying this, but what do you know, there are only 3 psychiatrists in the plan, and none of them want to deal with anyone having insomnia issues. I have put in an escalation with healthcare.gov to allow me to get another plan (Blue Cross), which although it is \$300/m more, has my current primary-care physician in network. I have escalated wthis with Ambetter, and they are "working on it:, although they have not found a psychiatrist that will work out. I will be seeing my old doc as self-pay (\$130), also getting the Rx on my own. What the h3ll am I paying the \$80/mo for my plan for such garbage. And the ironic thing is that when I was on Medicaid, my primary-care physician was in network (I still had to pay for my Rx, since Medicaid doesn't pay for that Rx either)."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/

"ACA rates went down for us?? My wife and I have used healthcare.gov for 4 years now. This past year our rates were \$620 a month. We just Checked and according to healthcare.gov our new rates for the same insurance (ambetter gold tier) is \$295 a month. I was expecting it to rise substantially. We are in Arkansas, 63 and 61 yrs old. Anyone else see a decrease???"

— r/HealthInsurance · 30 upvotes · None

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · None

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · None

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceous of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance Carrier strongly recommending that I don't purchase insurance through healthcare.gov I just got off the phone with sales agent of the largest health insurance carrier in my state. I had previously applied through healthcare.gov and confirmed that I was ineligible for any tax credits/subsidies but found a plan I like. I then contact the health insurer directly to see if there was any difference in premiums by applying directly through them. The price is identical but I was told to purchase the plan directly anyway because there could be "miscommunication" between the marketplace exchange and the insurer. That seemed odd to me. As someone who supports the ACA and wants to ensure it lasts and improves, I would like to enroll through healthcare.gov. My thinking is that the program's success is measured in part by the number of users who shop/purchase through healthcare.gov. Is there any real downside to using the marketplace exchange?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 16 upvotes · None

"Help! ACA plan termination notice after reporting a change-in-life event I just received a notice today that my ACA plan has been terminated effective October stating "voluntary withdrawal" even though I never requested this, and I have always paid on time. For the life of me I cannot figure out why. The only thing I can figure out is that this is due to me reporting my daughter as married (by reporting the event as a change-of-life event). This was to remove just her, not all of us. I called [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) and they are escalating this, but I'm worried that it won't get fixed. I asked the agent and she says this happens a lot so I'm wondering if anyone else has experienced this when it wasn't due to non-payment. Does anyone have any experience with this? My son is a hemophiliac and I'm worried that I need to start looking for a new job so that I can get other coverage. BTW: I'm not getting tax credits, in case that is relevant."

— r/HealthInsurance · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmwnck/help_aca_plan_termination_notice_after_reporting/

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"18 currently unemployed and need insurance To start off I've never used Reddit really so I'm not sure if this is appropriate here but it seems like the place to go. I turned 18 in June and haven't had health insurance for YEARS. It honestly wouldn't be a crazy issue for me if I wasn't dealing with some reproductive health issues and wanting birth control. I used to just go to the ER when things happened or visit Planned Parenthood but my mom seems against it now because of money. It'd be over \$1,000 per month for me to just be placed on her own plan so I'm at a wall. I went to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and I was told that I qualified for a marketplace plan yet open enrollment has closed. I don't believe I account for a special enrollment period because I never really had insurance to begin with. I don't understand what to do in my case. I still live with my mother, I have a job interview lined up but everything feels like a waiting game except I never actually get the medical attention I really need. I'm frustrated and just want to see an GYN or somebody that can help me, I'm very tired."

— r/HealthInsurance · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wdtqmh/18_currently_unemployed_and_need_insurance/

"Thanks for posting. This is a lot to take in. We are all in a waiting game. We got notice a month or so ago that our provider is not participating in the VA marketplace next year. So we have to choose a new plan. Damn this is frustrating. Fortunately we have been able to control our income this year. So we should get affordable premiums."

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1m60tzo/important_obamacare_a_changes_to_know_heading/n4g5n76/

"What do you do for Health Insurance? As someone who is self employed, how do you cover insurance? I have a High Deductible Health Plan through the marketplace. My plan this year is over \$1k a month and has a household out of pocket of \$11k before the insurance pays out anything. That means I pay a minimum of \$12k per year. I would have to spend \$23k before any help for medical bills would be provided. 🤔 I don't have a PCP because I'm super healthy & 30 years old and almost never see a doctor. If I do have a reason to visit, I run by a walk in clinic and pay out of pocket. I keep the insurance in case of an emergency, but that is SOOO MUCH MONEY just in case of an emergency. Does anyone have any better options?"

— r/selfemployed · 10 upvotes · None

"I agree with this, it's a nightmare if you do not understand all the ups and downs with copay, premiums, deductibles, ...etc. I Googled so many terms because of my confusion of same, and took notes when needed. I navigated to the silver plans. Check and see if your doctors are listed in that plan or which doctors. A note here, some doctors listed was no longer with the plan, and I found calling the Dr's office to confirm played a large part of picking plans, I don't want to drive 30 miles to see my pcp. Then on marketplace you can also enter your prescriptions you take, my spouse had a few expensive ones. It's a nightmare and you have to be thorough, I spent many evenings learning the terminology. With market place you can save maybe 4 plans to compare, which is a big help. At the end I had a plan picked and a backup plan. I called marketplace, gave my info and details, the rep came up with the same 2 plans. You need to understand Medicare too, by then I already had a much better understanding. When you talk to agents ask about things you don't understand."

— r/HealthInsurance · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pboicez/

COBRA or a spouse's employer plan · 58 documents · 20 voices

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"As a 59 years old retiree, I pay \$2264 per month for COBRA health insurance for me and my wife. I just checked ACA rates for us, it was over \$1000 per month more. I don't qualify for subsidies. Something is wrong with the ACA when its so much more costly without government subsidies."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzxjuSyfTqcBbN1kp4AaABAg

↳ @beautyandplay (3): "probably better with private plans."

↳ @nata3467 (0): "how much are you and your wife making ?"

↳ @acevers (0): "That's because you were a productive person before retirement. Only bums and disabled people get deals and freebies, and your taxes pay for it. Sucks."

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · None

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"ACA healthcare made it possible for me to retire. I keep my taxable income low and receive Gov subsidies on premiums. I consider the subsidies getting back some of the taxes I paid into the systems for the last 48 years. I had employer healthcare insurance for 30 years and never used one penny of it. Insurance companies made a mint off of my employer and me for decades. I never went to the Doctor until I turned 60 when I got Covid."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgzT3TgVH2azwWzdsxx4AaABAq>

↳ @DonaldSharpe-u9o (3): "I completely relate! It's amazing how planning your income and using the ACA effectively can make early retirement feasible. I went through a similar path, keeping taxable income low while investing in a few index funds and it helped me feel secure financially while also getting affordable healthcare coverage."

↳ @drcornelius8275 (0): "Well great for you that has little income but ACA is killing my family. Not only did we pay the same or more taxes than you have over the years, now we get to pay for your insurance too because ACA sticks us with huge premiums. Do you think that's fair? Why don't I just give you some of my belongs too while we're talking Communism."

↳ @bestieswladys251 (0): "@drcornelius8275 I thought that depended on the states. Some states chose to expand their Medicaid, which helps supplement the tax breaks for the ACA and some states decided not to. Are you paying an insurance directly or does it come from your employer (i'm not asking for anything personal or specific. I'm just curious in the broad sense of the word). I'm open to correction if I'm wrong!!!"

"So a big nothing burger, that's what I expected. PBM's are not going to change. But they are a big driver of health insurance costs. I just went through it with an asthma maintenance medication. I can't stay on the one they pre-authorized. I am now on one that cost 3x as much. It makes absolutely no sense. I do care if it's effective and I don't know that yet because I haven't started it. The insurance company tried to blame a new act of Congress and then actually called me incompetent. There is no new act of Congress, they told me a bold faced lie. The act they are quoting was passed in 2022. It's because they want me on a certain medicine. It's likely not even a Dr on the insurance end, making these decisions. I think it's because the PMB managers, the middleman, get a bigger cut if it's certain prescriptions. I got a 90 day supply for zero dollars, as long as it works, I don't care. I'm at my deductible and out-of-pocket max in February 2025. I will never understand it. My husband has had 8 or 9 surgeries. He gets zero pushback and I know he's cost them well over \$1 million. And I swear every year, they go through and axe another one of my meds. I mostly just get routine care and meds, I've only had 3 operations in life and they were all 30 years ago. I had employer based health insurance then. You can't even get me to go to the ER, my husband went at least 4 times last year, by ambulance because of his heart. We don't fool around when it comes to that, his dad died at age 49 from a Widowmaker heart attack. My husband found him. They want to talk about reigning in insurance rates when they are the ones that approve them. I started looking it up on who approves the 26% average increase we have for 2026. This is above and beyond any subsidies. It is the state and federal governments that approve insurance rates. It makes no sense. And I would also guess that the CEOs/executive level people donate to political campaigns. I'd like to see what they've donated to Trump and the Republicans and even Democrats"

— r/obamacare · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pm9zyz/house_gop_unveils_health_care_measure_that_does/ntyfph9/

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"Getting blood work on ACA plans Not a huge deal in the grand scheme of things, but I generally get blood work once a year, so it's a predictable medical expense. This year it cost \$286 and I had to pay \$36 out of pocket with my employer provided health care plan. My doctor's office has a sign that basically says they test the blood in house but will provide a script if you want it sent to Quest or Lab Corp. When I look at my claims, the provider name is different than my doctor's office despite what the sign says. When I look up those providers, only one insurance company in the marketplace covers those. So I assume that means on the other plans, they would be out of network and I'd have to pay the full cost since they are HMOs and don't cover out of network. Is it possible there will be a discount even though it's out of network? I then looked up Quest on the marketplace, it looks like every city's location is listed and I see some are covered and some aren't with some plans (some don't cover any locations). But I assume I don't have control over which location my blood is sent to. So is there any way to ensure they are going to be covered. Is there any practical tips for how to handle this with the ACA plans or does it just depend on which insurance company we pick and can you figure out which is the best before you sign up?"

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vdjrvh/getting_blood_work_on_a_ca_plans/

"yup me too. and this letter was actually when I had employer health insurance but it was a "self funded plan" which basically meant they spent a lot of time trying to find reasons to deny you."

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lz67ob/reminder_what_life_was_like_before_affordable/n2zug9e/

"I just talked to my Insurance broker last week (I'm on Cobra until 2/2027). FYI, the ACA only has HMO plans, no more PPO plans, she told me. I can't find any doctors who take the HMO plans, even the top tier ones."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwScHrO5XRAM7MD7Cp4AaABAq

↳ @TracyMadsen-rx2fu (0): "I think you might need a different broker, that's not true. I have a silver plan PPO, have had it for about 7 years"

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

"Covered california. I always supported aca for the pre existing conditions alone. Never thought i would need it but when i got laid off in 2019 i used it for 6 months because Cobra was ridiculous and unaffordable."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o5lrn3/the_media_is_reporting_majority_of_people_on_the/njcf5yg/

"I wish employers would get on board and put pressure on govt to reform the system too. Half of Americans rely on employer-sponsored healthcare. And employers, in their never-ending drive to save a buck and provide a bigger dividend to their shareholders (rather than actually innovate and produce like we used to) have been continually cutting health benefits for at least the last twenty years (my working adult years.) Premiums go up every year, percentage of cost shifted to employees grows every year, employees are made to jump through more hoops to get their spouse and children covered, covered services are reduced each year. Lately I've experienced employers offering to reimburse employees 20-30% of the cost of ACA insurance rather than offering their own sponsored plan. Further removing healthy people from the system and driving up costs. I get that business is competitive. But if this employer-sponsored healthcare system is unsustainable for employers, then they Also need to be lobbying for healthcare for all. It takes a Huge burden off the employers, who have to spend hours and effort every year reviewing and rolling out new plans. It allows them to shift at least some of their savings to higher wages, leading to happier and less-stressed employees. Another portion of savings could be pivoted to actual innovation and real production as opposed to paper profits that only benefit shareholders and CEOs. Plus happier and healthier employees are shown to be more productive for their employers, leading to more growth and greater future revenue. More retention, less turnover = more \$ Happy, healthy employees = more \$ How can we have so many gd MBAs in this country yet no exec can figure this out?!"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p24ajw/universal_care/npv3rvm/

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO

and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

"Question about tax credit Excuse some of my ignorance because I only switched to ACA plan for my family of 3 about six months ago after switching employers. I didn't pay a lot of attention to it before because I was on a workplace health plan for 10+ years, so I've been playing catch up. My wife and I are both commission workers so I had to estimate our income when first applying. It came out to about 102k/year, and it seemed that I was told that we did not qualify for the APTC, although now I see that the limit is 106k. Our final gross income from 2025 may end up being lower than my estimation. It's possible that I was confused but I'm currently paying 700\$/mo right now, and my plan is going up to around 840\$/mo next year, but the eligibility summary is telling me that I actually am eligible for up to 247\$/mo from the APTC (as well as currently eligible, I think?). So I guess my question is, I am I think understanding now that the tax credit is only going away for those making over 400% of the federal poverty line, does that mean that I could still claim the 247\$/mo next year, as was as retroactively claim it for the previous 6 months or so when I do my taxes next year? I currently am not receiving any advanced payments. Thanks, sorry if this is a dumb basic question I should know already, but just trying to understand better."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Broken leg might be okay with cash pay but cancer would surely be financially devastating. I was hoping catastrophic insurance changes would help. As of today, all people (not just those <30 years old) who don't qualify for subsidies are eligible for catastrophic coverage. I woke up early to look at what premiums would be for ACA catastrophic coverage only - \$2100/month for my family with a \$21,500 deductible 😞 Luckily, I have employer-sponsored health insurance through my employer right now but the job is very unstable. My husband and I decided today that our family will have to go without health insurance again if I lose my job. We had to go without health insurance for many years before I got this job because ACA premiums were too high - and they're now about 2x as high than the last time I checked our ACA options. We know our providers offer reasonable cash prices and I've discovered a whole network of cash-pay services, labs, and imaging facilities. There's even a hospital that only offers surgery for cash-pay (<https://surgerycenterok.com>) that's within driving distance and could affordably repair broken bones, etc. But cancer or a catastrophic event would bankrupt us."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oluqzl/thoughts_on_howwhen_the_shutdown_will_end_now/nml2egf/

"Still only \$100 a month more than the last time I had private coverage in 2012. And half the price if I had coverage through my current employer. You're point?"

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mmpvpr/why_young_americans_dread_turning_26_health/n81ogw3/

"Family currently on ACA but spouse got new job with healthcare but too expensive for family plan - please advise We are currently on a family health insurance plan on the ACA with generous subsidies (have been for several years now) as my spouse's old employer didn't offer insurance (I'm self employed and we have a kid in college). The business is closing so my spouse found a new job that offers insurance. They only offer one plan and it seems like decent insurance as it's better than what we have. The issue is that it's not affordable at all for all 3 of us to be on. For just my spouse it's around \$280ish per month but when adding all 3 of us that balloons to almost \$1900 per month which is insane to me:(After doing some research (thanks internet) it sounds like my wife pretty much has to take the insurance for herself as it shows as being affordable for us when using the online calculators. Of course when adding all of us on the employers insurance it comes back as not affordable. It doesn't make sense for my spouse to not take the employer insurance as doing so would cause us to lose the ACA subsidies it sounds like. Can my wife take the insurance from her employer and our kid and I stay on our ACA plan? I'm not sure we she can get on the employer's insurance immediately or if there is some sort of waiting period. We will have to find that out as maybe she can't sign up until 2027? Her new job also comes with a nice pay bump but it sounds like her income would still need to be included in the ACA subsidy calculation even though she would no longer but on an ACA plan correct? If so, the subsidy we currently receive would drop quite a bit but something is better than nothing I guess and it would still be way cheaper than having the 3 of us on her employer plan. It sure seems like her employer is subsidizing some of her insurance premium but not for any other family members - I guess that's par for the course these days? I think I have it correct in what we need to do here but I guess we need to get her all signed up for employer healthcare before dropping her from the ACA plan. Her income increase will most likely change our ACA subsidy amount for the rest of the year but I'll reconcile that at tax time I guess. Also we also get our dental benefits through the ACA but I believe my wife's new job offers dental but we didn't see any mention of it in the portal we were in. To be fair though, we backed out of the portal once we saw the pricing for the family plan, lol. If they do offer dental through her employer I would assume she's also obligated to take that as well and we could just drop her off the ACA dental plan we currently have? I'm not sure if there are affordability guidelines for dental offered through an employer so I guess that's another thing I have to look into. Honestly this all pretty overwhelming and frustrating so any help and guidance anyone can provide would be greatly appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1whx8qz/family_currently_on_aca_but_spouse_got_new_job/

A broker or agent · 18 documents · 18 voices

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"Crazy idea - what do you think? Hi, there. Without being too wordy (happy to elaborate if needed), I wanted to ask for input on this idea I have. We make too much money to qualify for ANY subsidies next year (we're not "rich", but we're above the cutoff). Because of this, our health insurance is going to go from \$900 a month for the two of us (already outrageously expensive for the high deductible, bronze plan we have) to \$3,500 PER MONTH. Yes, per month. That comes to \$42,000 per year. And again, that's before paying for any of the actual medical expenses we may incur. I have confirmed this with an insurance agent so it's not just me miscalculating (and yes, I plan to discuss this with the agent as well, but I love the Reddit forums so here I am). I'm thinking there might be something I'm not understanding, but here's my idea - couldn't we just not have health insurance and if something catastrophic comes up (cancer diagnosis, for example), we could move (we have the option to change residency because we do own a home in another state) and then use the special enrollment period to get insurance? I mean, remember - we're talking \$42,000 per year otherwise - and that's before anything even happens. Thanks for your input."

— r/HealthInsurance · 24 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance Carrier strongly recommending that I don't purchase insurance through healthcare.gov I just got off the phone with sales agent of the largest health insurance carrier in my state. I had previously applied through healthcare.gov and confirmed that I was ineligible for any tax credits/subsidies but found a plan I like. I then contact the health insurer directly to see if there was any difference in premiums by applying directly through them. The price is identical but I was told to purchase the plan directly anyway because there could be "miscommunication" between the marketplace exchange and the insurer. That seemed odd to me. As someone who supports the ACA and wants to ensure it lasts and improves, I would like to enroll through healthcare.gov. My thinking is that the program's success is measured in part by the number of users who shop/purchase through healthcare.gov. Is there any real downside to using the marketplace exchange?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 16 upvotes · None

"NC - losing medicaid for medically complex child Any moms on here with children on medicaid with congenital heart conditions/complex medical needs? I need your advice... I've just been told my daughter's medicaid won't be renewed even though my income has decreased from last year's renewal period. Marketplace coverage will cost \$600/mo and covers nothing. Her annual tests will cost upwards close to \$7-\$9,000 assuming her conditions stay stable and without issues. I called the tailored plan brokers and they told me it only covers behavioral/developmental conditions and that if our medicaid expires at the end of the month then there's no way she'd qualify. Am I missing any other outlets or resources? My case worker explains nothing as to why we're being rejected even though our income was much higher last year."

— r/Medicaid · 14 upvotes · None

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, than 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and than switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

"I just talked to my Insurance broker last week (I'm on Cobra until 2/2027). FYI, the ACA only has HMO plans, no more PPO plans, she told me. I can't find any doctors who take the HMO plans, even the top tier ones."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwScHrO5XRAM7MD7Cp4AaABAq

↳ @TracyMadsen-rx2fu (0): "I think you might need a different broker, that's not true. I have a silver plan PPO, have had it for about 7 years"

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Need clarification on underestimating income I plan on enrolling my mother in law for 2026 but not sure how to approach her income. I had spoken to broker and I was informed she should show 22k before deductions to get tax credit for 2026. Before I was able to show her income as 2400 a year and get the aca credits. I read posts saying that the repayments of credits are for those who overestimate income not underestimate. Also read the other way around. If I were to sign her up saying her income projected is 22k but let's say at end of 2026 it's 3k. Since the income was underestimated will she need to payback the subsidies? she doesnt qualify for medicaid because she been in USA 2.5 years and you need to be living 5 years to qualify for that"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Get government OUT of healthcare and insurance! Back when Obumer first messed with it and caused premiums to start to rise (both ACA and non ACA plans as the new costs for new required benefits, legal and regulatory compliance, etc has to be absorbed via any and all health insurance plans regardless of an ACA plan or not). We went from 3 people being covered on what would be about a "silver" on the ACA or a mid plan was \$238 per month. Today for two people it is over \$1,300 per month and there are areas that are even higher than the state and county / area that we live in. On a per covered basis our health insurance premiums are up 410%. Even a few years ago when we moved from one state to another we paid around \$492 per month....four years later, just over \$1,300. thank you government. Just the insurance premiums and rent (no power, water, food, gas, car insurance or any other expenses) costs me \$40,200 per year and that gets paid with after tax dollars so you do the math. just the fixed cost of a roof and insurance with nothing else and we need to earn around \$47,000 before taxes to cover that. God forbid we want to eat, have car insurance and other insurance, fuel for the car, car repairs, clothing, phone service, etc. Again, great work to the tick in Congress for screwing everyone over rather than just helping the few that need, ACTUALLY need the help. All the fraud out there so far should give everyone some idea of the money we flush down the drain. I wager if it was totaled up it would be around \$500 billion per year or more and that is already after the gubment makes so many other things artificially expensive....college tuition anyone? Nothing my insurance agent loves more than sitting across the table from me as we review the plans that, even after I spend \$16,000 per year on premiums for I still have very high deductibles making it really cost me around \$25,000 before insurance does anything when you add premiums and deductibles together (and no I don't count \$15 off some pharma scrip as mattering). What they need to do is allow, the law prevents this for most people - that's right the government is making it illegal for you to purchase certain types of plans less you fall into a small criteria. what am I ranting about? Disaster style policies. Everyone needs to be able to get those but for most plans you have to be under a certain income or under 30 years of age or just unemployed and need a bridge. My spouse and I don't need all the "benefits" we just want emergancy coverage and disease treatment type stuff. There is so much that pad plans, even in hers (and she is almost 50!) still has all this child birthing stuff, breast feeding classes, etc. all for "free" even though she is almost 50 and also can't even have kids in the first place but, same risk pool as everyone else rather than being prices as an individual like with your car insurance."

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=UgzNhfDE0RdaDEBn28x4AaABAg>

↳ @bookmark692 (0): "The Messiah picked winners and losers with health insurance. F'D everyone, except the politicians."

"A few years ago when my wife passed I went to an agent as I was clueless about health insurance. He walked me through and explained everything I was looking at. I've since become more comfortable with the process but still list him as my agent in appreciation for how he helped me."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rmyvm7/this_is_for_anyone_witho_ut_an_agent_on_their/o95pinv/

"Trust your insurer even less than ACA. They don't know shit. I've had pre-authorization for a medicine for years. Last December I go to fill it and it's like \$175 and I had already met my deductible and out-of-pocket maximum in January. I hadn't paid anything for it since January 2025. I call my insurance company, and I get an agent telling me it's a new law that Congress passed, and I called her out immediately because I follow politics closely, so I asked her to tell me what the law was, the new long she kept telling me I was incompetent. Even though she couldn't tell me the law of Congress had passed she just kept repeating it passed one. I don't usually do this, but I asked for her superior. She flat out told me that no, this is not a new congressional law, although it is a congressional law, but it was passed in 2022. I knew I was right. They had given me prior authorization for years, but only because the namebrand was cheaper than the generic. Then the generic lowered their price so low that they stopped covering the namebrand. I tried the generic and it was ineffective, and I had my first asthma attack in decades. I'm not trying to be picky, all my other meds are generics and it all is fine but this particular one, it just did not work for me. It's a maintenance asthma inhaler. So I have this prior authorization and it is useless. The pharmacy is even baffled by it. It's a DAR law, dispense as written. Well, of course it's going to be dispensed as written because I have a prior authorization. If I want that medicine, I have to pay \$175 for it, every month. So now I am on a different one and I will be going on blood pressure meds soon because it raises my blood pressure. I don't have high blood pressure, I never have until I started this medicine. It is effective, but I have to go on another medicine but it's a cheap one. They don't care about my health, they just care about the cost. I hate insurance. It is sorely needed. I had it almost all of my life and then we decided to move to Florida. I retired from my cushy corporate job, but I lost my insurance and I didn't have it for years. So I know what it's like to go without it and even though it's a pain in the ass, I would rather have it than not And I am hoping that nothing comes up for you in the next 10 days or so. My other message was a bit snarky and I apologize. I hate dealing with anything health insurance wise, no matter who I'm dealing with. They make it so much harder than it actually is"

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1st004d/aca_canceled_my_policy_without_my_permission_and/ohpu0tq/

"It is not open enrollment for ACA, so you would need a life event to enroll right now. And I hope no one sees this and uses it because I would be too afraid of what it might be. I'm trying to be kind. I used a broker many years to sign up for ACA, but they don't do much of what you told me, they just helped me pick a plan that might be best for me. I have no idea what they get, but I worked with the same one for years and her name happened to be the same as mine."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rmyvm7/this_is_for_anyone_witho_ut_an_agent_on_their/o94hc0r/

"I've been in the insurance business since 2011 and remember the first open enrollment on October 1, 2013. Many agents thought they would make a lot of money enrolling entire families with full subsidies and promised compensation. But just months later, many left the market when commissions went unpaid. This happened early in my career and left a lasting impression on how I view the ACA. I don't understand why so many agents invest so much time in ACA today. I know it will eventually improve, but in the meantime, why not focus on selling Medicare plans, which offer more reliable income and better persistency than ACA? The ACA market is too volatile—caught in political power struggles—and you can lose a client simply because they got a new job with health benefits or got married. I have an ACA plan (self-employed insurance agent) with no subsidies and pay \$550 for mediocre health insurance. I just received notice that my Aetna CVS ACA plan is leaving the Texas market at the end of the year."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m2m8ak/important_aca_changes_to_know_heading_into_2026/n3xeep4/

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wjvhr9/please_help_best_insurance_in_nj_for_someone/

"I have a very good broker I've worked with since 2021. For 2026 I went with an Ambetter higher deductible bronze plan with a lower monthly premium then purchased a gap plan from UBA to cover the high deductible should something happen. I am generally healthy and do wellness visits that are covered. So my monthly expense went up from 7.50 a month in 2025 for my Silver plan to 40.00 per month for this selection in 2026. It also has better prescription coverage than I've had in 2025."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxjMpss4oRZv7Vk8qt4AaABAq>

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "That's awesome! With the bronze plan you can now use an HSA too! 😊"

"As an ACA marketplace broker, I have to do this with customers periodically. Looks legit to me"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wogzsr/legit_or_scam_help/pbxzcl1/

"That's horrible, try to see if you can get an off exchange plan, I was paying around \$1500 for a group plan with an Ichra through marketplace (no subsidies) last year got on a private plan with a United Healthcare PPO with a \$7k max out of pocket. We had to get approved with underwriting, (they basically checked prescription records) but it cut my premiums in half to \$780 ish. I used a broker "My Private Health Insurance"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1txq1je/drowning_in_monthly_health_insurance_payments/oqcf5j2/

"I have Pivot short term insurance underwritten by Pan American, found through my insurance broker. It's for 3 years and costs much less monthly than ACA would cost me as I'm not eligible for subsidies (\$550 vs. \$947. I have no preexisting conditions, it has a high deductible and I have to pay a bit towards annual physical, etc. I hope to not ever have to really use it. It has good reviews online fwiw."

— r/obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/pavwcff/

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Wishing premiums matched what they can pay · 35 documents · 20 voices

"My health insurance just went to \$60,000 a year for a silver PPO Prepare for sticker shock. Just checked the IL exchange today, and my BCBS HDHP went from \$1200 a month after subsidies to \$2925 after subsidies (**the plan cost is 60k per year**) the reasons for this are two-fold 1. Expiration of enhanced subsidies 2. The site allowing junk insurers to claim SLC status (benchmark) with plans no one can use. For my area it is an OSCAR HMO which virtually no hospital system or doctor accepts. OSCAR has a 1 star rating from the BBB and dozens of lawsuits against it for failure to pay claims. so I now have to hunt around for a HMO, and my family will lose its doctors. The PPACA as originally passed prevented insurance premiums from eating up more than a certain percentage of your annual income. At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments so I will lose my doctor(s) at the very least and pay way beyond what the law said I was going to. pretty sure I am seeing why some politicians are saying we should tear up the PPACA altogether, because it clearly isn't working, and made a bad situation worse"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,000 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA PLANS... THIS IS CRIMINAL!!!! Look at this This is a plan for my client (family of 5) with an income of \$83,000. In 2025, they were paying \$14.97 a month for a bronze \$0 deductible plan. The cheapest plan now with a \$0 deductible is freaking \$487 A MONTH!!! That is just insane!!! Not only are Americans going to suffer with their health insurance this year but this will also affect many agents like me and I feel like that is also not being talked about enough. Already have a few that say they won't be renewing. This is criminal, the enhanced subsidies need to be extended!"

— r/obamacare · 603 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj7nbz/2026_aca_plans_this_is_criminal_look_at_this/

"I think they are simply looking for a reason not to extend the subsidies."

— r/obamacare · 65 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oujl86/republicans_demand_tougher_abortion_restrictions/noc5hwc/

"My income should have no relevance to the cost of my health insurance. My premiums exceed \$2000/month and I'm completely healthy. Those commercials of people saying they have a plan for \$53/month infuriates me!! This is back door redistribution of wealth and simply evil."

— YouTube · Health Insurance for Self Employed: Beyond Marketplace Insurance! · 43 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=allOvX_0uhs&lc=Ugwmv_5XeJls_p5gABt4AaABAg

↳ @iHealthBrokers (3): "Brent, have you considered a short term medical plan? If you are completely healthy, you may be able to get a plan with a MUCH lower premium that still meets your needs."

↳ @johnafagerquist8235 (1): "@iHealthBrokers You are the first person explaining health insurance options, that I've seen, who did not say to stay away from short term coverage as though it was an active serial killer. I am 55 (today 😊) and striking out on my own. I want to have health insurance for my wife and my son in college, as we move forward. That's why I'm researching."

↳ @iHealthBrokers (1): "@johnafagerquist8235 Hahaha! Yes, they have improved dramatically in the past few years. People usually have strong opinions because your experience with STM is really based on your needs. i.e. if you want to become pregnant, they are not a great option because they won't cover pregnancy! Feel free to give us a call if you'd like to discuss all of your options as you prepare to make to leap! 888-410-0344. Best of luck with your new business!"

"OP, if you are just over the cliff (up to about 440% FPL), then you have an out due to a change in the OBBBA. Select a Bronze during open enrollment, commit to fully funding the accompanying HSA the Bronze will make you eligible for, and you can reduce your estimated MAGI at application by the full HSA contribution amount. This can pull you back into subsidy eligibility, which will cap your costs for the benchmark Silver at just under 10% of your MAGI, which right near the cliff for a household of two should be about \$700/month. Bronzes are cheaper than the benchmark, so you might be looking at \$400 to \$550/month for the Bronze. You can further reduce your AGI by making contributions to non-Roth retirement accounts if you aren't already doing so. Better to put \$16K into accounts for yourself than pay half or more of that amount in avoidable health insurance premiums."

— r/obamacare · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh6z70y/

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · None

"I completely empathize re the cost but I still think it's worth having. I absolutely have to have it because I have a serious illness. I'm 44f. My monthly is \$605 and my deductible is 12k which I will probably hit after a hospital visit last month. It completely sucks but not having it would suck 1000x more. As it is I try so hard to stay out of the hospital. Last week I collapsed in an urgent care because I waited too long to get help. Thankfully it's attached to a hospital so they called a code blue on me and brought me over lickity split. But I was focused on how much it would cost and whether I could get through it myself, not what I reasonably should have been considering. When I was on the floor of the hospital staring at the ceiling I was thinking oops. Guess I let this go too far. But I try hard to avoid it because it's so freggin expensive. That same visit I left AMA because it's so much more expensive if they admit me."

— r/obamacare · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/ospvrf7/

"That's the reason I only accept to work even with lower pay with a company with health insurance since plans on ACA are outrageous with extreme high deductibles and limited network . They need to have An option where people can purchase Medicare without subsidies at a younger age"

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1urupru/aca_insurers_propose_doubledigit_premium_hikes/owj2vkw/

"I think it'll end next week after the election. I'm expecting there to be a compromise of some sort in the weeks following on the enhanced subsidies, if only to push it out past the midterms. No idea on how long the extension might be or what reforms/changes might be agreed to in exchange for continued enhanced subsidies. A larger concern is more broad reform of the ACA itself next year in reconciliation. They did Medicaid this time around, but left the ACA mostly alone. I doubt that will continue unless they feel very solid going into the midterms."

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oluqzl/thoughts_on_howwhen_the_shutdown_will_end_now/nmkmjdv/

"I just needed the ACA for a little more than a year before I qualify for Medicare in 2026. I recently bought a bronze plan which is more basic than I am used to, and paying 900/month, excluding vision and dental and that is with a monthly supplement. Without the supplement, it will be closer to 1200/month. My ACA plan is so scaled down that it won't cover a bone density screening, so I am postponing it. I can pay the increased rate for a limited period of time until I get Medicare, but it will be tight. With rising costs in all areas of the economy- groceries, utilities, etc.- we will definitely be cutting back across the board so I can make it to Medicare. All of that being said, it's so aggravating that healthcare in this country is deemed a privilege. It really should be a basic human right but somehow, in the richest country on earth, we can't "afford it". The US is becoming unaffordable for everyone except the rich."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mbsi9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/n5py1yp/

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"But are subsidies the answer. I do think we need to plug the hole in the damn for now but insurance costs are only going to get higher in the current system... the subsidies will need to be higher... and then we start the cycle all over again. We need to fix the healthcare costs, then the insurance then the subsidies. Without fixing the healthcare costs, the overall will continue to bloom - the insurance companies will continue to make their margin... people MUST look at that side of the equation otherwise this is only a house of cards."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oodemw/aca_the_cliff_is_a_big_is_sue/nn3ey2k/

"All he does is insult everyone's intelligence, every single day. We can look up was spent on the military, and we can get a rough figure of what Medicare for all would look like. If we can afford to do the things that he is doing, including a war, every person should have health insurance. I'm on the cusp of getting diagnosed with cancer and I'm extremely scared. But at least I don't have to worry because I have health insurance, but it's getting more and more unaffordable. For the first time in our adult lives, we had to ask for help. I tripped over a curb and it left an extremely bad wound on my leg that took about 10 weeks to heal. My feet were so swollen, both of them even though I only hurt one and I couldn't wear shoes, so I couldn't work. After insurance paid, we ended up owing about \$600 and we are just squeezed so tight at the moment. It hasn't been like this since my husband started his business. People aren't remodeling kitchens or bathrooms, they are also too scared to spend. And it's finally trickled down to us. But again, at least I have health insurance and some agency for people that need help pay that entire part of the Hospital bill that I owed. I was crying because I have never had help as an adult and we have donated so much, clothing, pet things, pet food, donations for back to school backpacks, we tried to give back what we had to take his children. We tried to pay that back as adults, but now here we are in need. I was very thankful we were approved. It's getting rough out here."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1w5ertv/trump_lies_that_medicare_for_all_would_cost/p7f20yz/

"Those extended subsidies also allowed people to get a subsidy that normally would not get one. Some of these people never knew their price before extended subsidies because they didn't have ACA. I'm not saying the subsidies should be yanked, but I am one for the truth. Everything has gotten so costly, ending them would now be unaffordable for them. I also believe that a health plan should be put to the people, as a vote. I do not want the money sent to the people. The ACA gives us a lot of protections and one of them is pre-existing conditions. If they did away with the ACA, those protections go with it, and there are other others, I just mentioned the biggest one. Many people would not be able to be insured at all because of pre-existing conditions, which is how it was prior to the ACA. Even if we could have afforded health insurance, we would've been denied if that protection wasn't there. Husband has heart condition and I have severe asthma, both were diagnosed prior to ACA. We can't only focus on premiums because there are other things that are just as important"

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nqib284/

"As I replied separately to OP, if you are just over the cliff (up to about 450% FPL for a late 50s couple), then you have an out due to a change in the OBBA. Select a Bronze during open enrollment, commit to fully funding the accompanying HSA the Bronze will make you eligible for, and you can reduce your estimated MAGI at application by the full HSA contribution amount. This can pull you back into subsidy eligibility, which will cap your costs for the benchmark Silver at just under 10% of your MAGI, which right near the cliff for a household of two should be about \$700/month. Bronzes are cheaper than the benchmark, so you might be looking at \$400 to \$550/month for the Bronze."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh70kui/

"Family currently on ACA but spouse got new job with healthcare but too expensive for family plan - please advise We are currently on a family health insurance plan on the ACA with generous subsidies (have been for several years now) as my spouse's old employer didn't offer insurance (I'm self employed and we have a kid in college). The business is closing so my spouse found a new job that offers insurance. They only offer one plan and it seems like decent insurance as it's better than what we have. The issue is that it's not affordable at all for all 3 of us to be on. For just my spouse it's around \$280ish per month but when adding all 3 of us that balloons to almost \$1900 per month which is insane to me:(After doing some research (thanks internet) it sounds like my wife pretty much has to take the insurance for herself as it shows as being affordable for us when using the online calculators. Of course when adding all of us on the employers insurance it comes back as not affordable. It doesn't make sense for my spouse to not take the employer insurance as doing so would cause us to lose the ACA subsidies it sounds like. Can my wife take the insurance from her employer and our kid and I stay on our ACA plan? I'm not sure we she can get on the employer's insurance immediately or if there is some sort of waiting period. We will have to find that out as maybe she can't sign up until 2027? Her new job also comes with a nice pay bump but it sounds like her income would still need to be included in the ACA subsidy calculation even though she would no longer but on an ACA plan correct? If so, the subsidy we currently receive would drop quite a bit but something is better than nothing I guess and it would still be way cheaper than having the 3 of us on her employer plan. It sure seems like her employer is subsidizing some of her insurance premium but not for any other family members - I guess that's par for the course these days? I think I have it correct in what we need to do here but I guess we need to get her all signed up for employer healthcare before dropping her from the ACA plan. Her income increase will most likely change our ACA subsidy amount for the rest of the year but I'll reconcile that at tax time I guess. Also we also get our dental benefits through the ACA but I believe my wife's new job offers dental but we didn't see any mention of it in the portal we were in. To be fair though, we backed out of the portal once we saw the pricing for the family plan, lol. If they do offer dental through her employer I would assume she's also obligated to take that as well and we could just drop her off the ACA dental plan we currently have? I'm not sure if there are affordability guidelines for dental offered through an employer so I guess that's another thing I have to look into. Honestly this all pretty overwhelming and frustrating so any help and guidance anyone can provide would be greatly appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1whx8qz/family_currently_on_aca_but_spouse_got_new_job/

"As nice as it is, the ridiculous gulf between with subsidy monthly premium cost at 400% FPL and 400% FPL+\$1 cliff needs to be addressed. My Bronze plan if under 400% FPL is around \$50/month. One dollar over the 400% FPL it jumps to \$1048/month. Jesus Christ how regressive can you get that me making \$62,601 (a buck over the 400% threshold) pays the same amount as someone making \$10,000,000 a year for the same plan? Sure, if it would really help the program charge me \$100/month at less than 400% FPL, and drop the insane cliff bullshit. Say add 10% to the cost for every \$10k above the 400% FPL? This madness is going to kill a lot of people as it stands; shit even with a low cost premium, so many can not cover the deductible, co-pays, etc."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pupkpu/hakeem_jeffries_says_obamacare_subsidy_extension/nvftjt4/

"Man I wish I was rich enough that \$600 a month in premiums for 30k deductible was on the same planet as reasonable. If something extreme happens to me or my wife, the difference between 30k and 250k is only how long I have to think about just filing for bankruptcy. Either way I just can't pay it. The "i can't afford the cheapest option so too bad for me if something bad happens I guess" layer feels kinda forgotten on this."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1riagjy/yikes_new_federal_health_insurance_rules_could/o86ats6/

"yes! We just got our info and it's just over \$2000 a month now for our family of 4. It went up over \$500 for next year. Something needs to be done to fix things. I wish they could extend the subsidies and work on some kind of better plan!"

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o1yxz3/this_house_republican_is_no_troublemaker_but_shes/njdt1iu/

"Things are changing on the ACA. I've been on ACA for 10 years now. I've had the same plan for the last five. I get a pre-authorization for a certain asthma maintenance medication. It's called Symbicort. I've gotten pre-authorization for years. And suddenly they won't cover it. Even though I have pre-authorization. I have appealed it and they won't budge. There are five other meds in that category and I have tried them all. 4 are not effective. One of them does work, but it causes my blood pressure to go sky high. So I actually had to go on blood pressure pills because I have to have some kind of maintenance medication. You can't just use your rescue inhalers as maintenance, you will run out very quickly. Then I finally told me the only reason why they had covered it. All of these other years was because it was cheaper than the generic. But then the generic makers, drop their prices super low and now they won't cover what I need. And I don't think you can switch plans without a qualifying event, which is usually a new job, moving -like across states, not in the same state, marriage, a baby. Otherwise, I think you have to wait until normal renewal time. I think that's why they aren't really answering you. And I guarantee if you call healthcare.gov, they will tell you that it was your job to check to make sure your doctors and your meds were covered. And they do have a field to search for that, when you enroll. But I'll tell you that it's not correct. It said that none of my husband's doctors were in network, yet he called all of his doctors and yes, they were still taking his insurance. Nothing changed, but that stupid place where you search for doctors and meds, it came back with all wrong results. We have always had good luck with ACA. My husband continues to have good luck, but I have had lots of issues. The kicker is all I need is doctors and meds, my husband has had 10 surgeries, at least, a few of them being major surgeries. One was close to \$1 million and they don't bat an eye. They fight me on medicines every single year."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omuq5mx/

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Care that worked when it mattered · 52 documents · 20 voices

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.



— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · None

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

"Going back to school for student medical insurance Many of us have increasing insurance costs, in my case it went from \$660/month last year with enhanced subsidies to \$1425/month this year with no subsidies so if retired or underemployed it becomes difficult to justify the costs. In my case I am a few years away from 65 but not wanting to work full-time (I am fortunate) due to my volunteer work I started looking for part time jobs with benefits. I was chasing a rabbit down a hole and found that as a part-time student within the UNC system I was eligible to also get student coverage. Some of the rules \-Have to be in a degree program \-Must attend on Campus \-Part-time = 6 credits Some numbers Not a student- ACA \$17,100/annual, \$2000 deductible max OOP \$8200 As a student \-Tuition/fees annually \$3872 (6 credits/semester) \-Medical insurance \$3168 (12-months) \$500 deductible max OOP \$4000 , campus clinic use unlimited with \$0 co-pay Total annual = \$7040 Additional student benefits (mandatory fees) \-Access to fitness center/pool \-Access to library \-Student discounts By going back to school I will save just under \$10k/annually So I enrolled and was accepted into a GIS program starting in Aug 26, not only will I be saving money but for me the structure of a schedule will help me fill in my week. Even if I became a full-time my annual costs would be \$11k/annual which would still be a savings over ACA only. I am fortunate to not need to work so YMMV, but thought I would share my adventure."

— r/HealthInsurance · 92 upvotes · None

"I don't know if it's changed, but when I was on the marketplace a decade ago, the application hard stopped if you didn't put in an SSN. So how are there applications without SSN's? Which is one problem I have with the statement they made about it. Also, if they identify problematic brokers, why not kick them off but still allow new brokers to sign up especially this close to open enrollment for the year. This is going to cause a restriction and how many agents are allowed to assist people. I feel like this is just going to hurt consumers more than the potentially fraudulent brokers. Usually, when I heard stories about fraudulent brokers signing people up for the marketplace, it wasn't people that never existed. It was people that came to them looking for plans and then they would either back out of getting a marketplace plan and then the broker still just enrolled them, especially if they qualified for a full subsidy or close to a full subsidy. Or they would encourage people to understate their income so that they would get a bigger subsidy and people would be more inclined to sign up and then get surprised at tax time."

— r/HealthInsurance · 89 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbmia90/

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— r/HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · None

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · None

"Ding ding ding. I already get a bronze plan to stretch my subsidy further. If the subsidy goes to the hsa instead I'll be on the hook for a ton of money in premiums because the subsidy doesn't cover the full bronze premium. Not even close. This is all a trick to offer LESS money overall to consumers and to place them on a health plan that puts more of the out of pocket costs on their own wallet."

— r/obamacare · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p6p4cm/why_health_savings_accounts_arent_the_fix/nqs1rtf/

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"Getting blood work on ACA plans Not a huge deal in the grand scheme of things, but I generally get blood work once a year, so it's a predictable medical expense. This year it cost \$286 and I had to pay \$36 out of pocket with my employer provided health care plan. My doctor's office has a sign that basically says they test the blood in house but will provide a script if you want it sent to Quest or Lab Corp. When I look at my claims, the provider name is different than my doctor's office despite what the sign says. When I look up those providers, only one insurance company in the marketplace covers those. So I assume that means on the other plans, they would be out of network and I'd have to pay the full cost since they are HMOs and don't cover out of network. Is it possible there will be a discount even though it's out of network? I then looked up Quest on the marketplace, it looks like every city's location is listed and I see some are covered and some aren't with some plans (some don't cover any locations). But I assume I don't have control over which location my blood is sent to. So is there any way to ensure they are going to be covered. Is there any practical tips for how to handle this with the ACA plans or does it just depend on which insurance company we pick and can you figure out which is the best before you sign up?"

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vdjrvh/getting_blood_work_on_a_ca_plans/

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

"Looking to possibly leave my job to start an in home daycare with my wife. The plan is to have my wife start off first while I still work and analyze if the income coming in makes sense and if leaving my current position will boost our income if I help her full time by bringing in more children. The only way I leave is if we work numbers and the amount at the end of every month is more than what I am making right now at a steady consistent rate. The biggest fear factor I have is that I have health/dental/vision insurance for all of my family. Leaving hurts my gut because while I was shopping around for healthcare for my family the least expensive one I found was around 805/month and that was just for HEALTH insurance."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Options for the Self Employed or Are Leaving Your Job · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ceyE3F7SK1k&lc=UgwaUBI9OyGnjyDellN4AaABAg>

↳ @MaximizingEcommerce (3): "Thank you for sharing your story. Depending on your beliefs (and health background), you may want to look into a cost sharing ministry as opposed to traditional health insurance. Regarding the risk, the question I would ask myself in your shoes is whether or not this opens doors to potentially additional profit/income opportunities..."

↳ @thehealthinsuranceguide (0): "Hi Manchester - How is the home daycare working out? Depending on your situation now (since it has been two years) your options may vary, and yes, health coverage can be pricey on the private side compared to a company plan that pays a lot of the cost for you. First check would be to see if you'd qualify for a significant subsidy. If not, or the subsidy is minimal, I'd check out the private underwritten plans. There are a couple that are available with lower premiums and better benefits because you have to be healthy enough to qualify to get on them. Did you get the health coverage all figured out? What did you end up going with?"

"I wish employers would get on board and put pressure on govt to reform the system too. Half of Americans rely on employer-sponsored healthcare. And employers, in their never-ending drive to save a buck and provide a bigger dividend to their shareholders (rather than actually innovate and produce like we used to) have been continually cutting health benefits for at least the last twenty years (my working adult years.) Premiums go up every year, percentage of cost shifted to employees grows every year, employees are made to jump through more hoops to get their spouse and children covered, covered services are reduced each year. Lately I've experienced employers offering to reimburse employees 20-30% of the cost of ACA insurance rather than offering their own sponsored plan. Further removing healthy people from the system and driving up costs. I get that business is competitive. But if this employer-sponsored healthcare system is unsustainable for employers, then they Also need to be lobbying for healthcare for all. It takes a Huge burden off the employers, who have to spend hours and effort every year reviewing and rolling out new plans. It allows them to shift at least some of their savings to higher wages, leading to happier and less-stressed employees. Another portion of savings could be pivoted to actual innovation and real production as opposed to paper profits that only benefit shareholders and CEOs. Plus happier and healthier employees are shown to be more productive for their employers, leading to more growth and greater future revenue. More retention, less turnover = more \$ Happy, healthy employees = more \$ How can we have so many gd MBAs in this country yet no exec can figure this out?!"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p24ajw/universal_care/npv3rvml

"This is key. People like the commenter that you replied to can argue about the temporary nature of Covid subsidies all they want. At the end of the day, though, does it matter when there's a reasonably large portion the population that now find themselves in a spot where, because of accelerating cost of living increases, they make too much for any relief from escalating health care costs but not nearly enough to afford health care on their own? And from the anecdotal stories posted here and elsewhere, it seems like a lot of these people tend to be 50+, an age range where health starts to degrade and access to care becomes more necessary, yet also an age where they are years away from accessing Medicare. I'm dreading to see what my premiums will look like in a few years."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q6f1ge/obamacare_premiums_jump_114_overnight_why_48/ny7wkhs/

"For real, I just had to dump my ACA plan due to job loss and the amount of time I had to spend making around 20-25 phone calls was ridiculous. At least a third of those calls were due to "well you got some tiny bit of information slightly wrong so we denied you and you'll have to start all over" not to mention I called on a Monday to pick a health plan and since something got messed up had to go through another waiting game till authorization went through. Called back Friday to pick the health plan and "oh sorry you missed the cut off by 3 hours so your health plan doesn't kick in till October 1st instead of September 1st" insurance companies are just full of assholes and morons, often both traits in one person."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1w5ertv/trump_lies_that_medicare_for_all_would_cost/p7f15rs/

"It's the only affordable option for many people, especially if you are self employed, as I am. I have never had an issue with my plan and I'm grateful for the subsidy, without it my premium would be \$2800 a month."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1l3a4v4/republicans_seek_major_obamacare_rollback_in/mw1sdnv/

"ACA Michigan — Anyone using a high-deductible plan + drug assistance program (Ocrevus) to hit OOPM early? Hi all, We're a family of three living in Michigan, income around \$95K, and buy coverage on HealthCare.gov. **I am self-employed, wife cannot work due to disability.** My wife has **multiple sclerosis** and needs **Ocrevus infusions twice a year**, so we always max out our deductible and OOPM. To lower monthly premiums, I'm thinking of switching to a **high-deductible Bronze plan** and relying on the **Ocrevus Copay Assistance Program** to cover most of the deductible right away in January. If those assistance payments count toward our OOPM, we'd essentially reach full coverage after that first infusion. The problem is that many insurers (like BCBSM and UHC) use **copay accumulator programs**, which block manufacturer assistance from counting toward deductible/OOPM. However, **Priority Health's** 2026 SBCs don't have that clause, so they **might** still allow this. Has anyone here successfully pulled this off — using a specialty drug assistance program to hit your OOPM early under an ACA plan? Any advice on confirming with the insurer before enrolling? Appreciate any insights — this could make a big difference in how we budget for my wife's care."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"I also have an income that fluctuates. During previous ACA enrollments, we are asked to provide estimated income for the upcoming year to determine tax subsidy eligibility. When I file my taxes a year later, (and include the data from my 1095-A form) any deviation in my estimated income will result in a change to my tax liability. If for some reason I made more than what my estimated income was, I will pay back that portion/percentage of the tax subsidy(and vice versa if I make less). The BBB has changed it to any income overage over the estimated income given upon application will trigger a FULL repayment of the ENTIRE subsidy. I'm having difficulty even finding information on what the subsidies will be next year when they expire. Let alone what the actual policy costs are jumping up to."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mbsi9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/n5p4pr7/

Covered and affordable for the year · 41 documents · 20 voices

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

"Going back to school for student medical insurance Many of us have increasing insurance costs, in my case it went from \$660/month last year with enhanced subsidies to \$1425/month this year with no subsidies so if retired or underemployed it becomes difficult to justify the costs. In my case I am a few years away from 65 but not wanting to work full-time (I am fortunate) due to my volunteer work I started looking for part time jobs with benefits. I was chasing a rabbit down a hole and found that as a part-time student within the UNC system I was eligible to also get student coverage. Some of the rules \-Have to be in a degree program \-Must attend on Campus \-Part-time = 6 credits Some numbers Not a student- ACA \$17,100/annual, \$2000 deductible max OOP \$8200 As a student \-Tuition/fees annually \$3872 (6 credits/semester) \-Medical insurance \$3168 (12-months) \$500 deductible max OOP \$4000 , campus clinic use unlimited with \$0 co-pay Total annual = \$7040 Additional student benefits (mandatory fees) \-Access to fitness center/pool \-Access to library \-Student discounts By going back to school I will save just under \$10k/annually So I enrolled and was accepted into a GIS program starting in Aug 26, not only will I be saving money but for me the structure of a schedule will help me fill in my week. Even if I became a full-time my annual costs would be \$11k/annual which would still be a savings over ACA only. I am fortunate to not need to work so YMMV, but thought I would share my adventure."

— r/HealthInsurance · 92 upvotes · None

"I don't know if it's changed, but when I was on the marketplace a decade ago, the application hard stopped if you didn't put in an SSN. So how are there applications without SSN's? Which is one problem I have with the statement they made about it. Also, if they identify problematic brokers, why not kick them off but still allow new brokers to sign up especially this close to open enrollment for the year. This is going to cause a restriction and how many agents are allowed to assist people. I feel like this is just going to hurt consumers more than the potentially fraudulent brokers. Usually, when I heard stories about fraudulent brokers signing people up for the marketplace, it wasn't people that never existed. It was people that came to them looking for plans and then they would either back out of getting a marketplace plan and then the broker still just enrolled them, especially if they qualified for a full subsidy or close to a full subsidy. Or they would encourage people to understate their income so that they would get a bigger subsidy and people would be more inclined to sign up and then get surprised at tax time."

— r/HealthInsurance · 89 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbmia90/

"i don't think you'll be happy with what the people will "decide" if they don't see the impact of no subsidies, on them personally, in their mailbox, before the election. far too many people have to learn the hard way."

— r/obamacare · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nuqwj9/the_obamacare_subsidy_fight_is_already_splitting/nh39vkr/

"Ding ding ding. I already get a bronze plan to stretch my subsidy further. If the subsidy goes to the hsa instead I'll be on the hook for a ton of money in premiums because the subsidy doesn't cover the full bronze premium. Not even close. This is all a trick to offer LESS money overall to consumers and to place them on a health plan that puts more of the out of pocket costs on their own wallet."

— r/obamacare · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p6p4cm/why_health_savings_ac_counts_arent_the_fix/nqs1rtf/

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"Ours is actually quite a bit worse, probably due to age (late 50's). If we careen over the cliff of \$84,600 due to not having quite enough expenses or whatever, it will cost us an additional \$19,200 / year. Our anticipated income is just very, very close to the cliff, and that's best case scenario with a bronze plan and full HSA funding to get our MAGI to \$80k. If we topple over, we will pay over \$24,000 / year in premiums for a bronze plan + \$10,750 to fund the HSA. That's 41% of our gross income before we even visit a doctor or fill a prescription, not to mention federal and state taxes. Not much left. WTF, America?"

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojey71/any_selfemployed/nm32690/

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

"It sucks, but most everyone pays the whole premium. It's just hidden in their gross total compensation from work. We would probably get true reform in healthcare if employees covered at work received their full pay and had to write a 20k check every year. Personally, I will probably just downgrade from silver to bronze."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh7argt/

"Im also Gen X. Im deeply ashamed about how little money i am making right now. Ive worked hard my whole life and i still do, but my cervical spine is a mess and neuro thinks surgery will make things much worse for me, so ive had to slow down my work schedule. Its depressing. Im grateful i can still get a tax credit, but my policy has changed so much for the worse, and ill still be paying almost 90% more than i was for the premium alone., not to mention copays, deductible, and medications 😞 This country is a mess. Our government really could care less if we live or die. I cry alot these days too. Im just so sad about all of this. And i feel worse for people with cancer or other terminal illnesses that are being priced out of having healthcare. So many people will die because of this ❤️ "

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pazpk6/aca_in_the_senate/nrnv53w/

"This is key. People like the commenter that you replied to can argue about the temporary nature of Covid subsidies all they want. At the end of the day, though, does it matter when there's a reasonably large portion the population that now find themselves in a spot where, because of accelerating cost of living increases, they make too much for any relief from escalating health care costs but not nearly enough to afford health care on their own? And from the anecdotal stories posted here and elsewhere, it seems like a lot of these people tend to be 50+, an age range where health starts to degrade and access to care becomes more necessary, yet also an age where they are years away from accessing Medicare. I'm dreading to see what my premiums will look like in a few years."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q6f1ge/obamacare_premiums_jump_114_overnight_why_48/ny7wkhs/

"I retired at 47 and the ACA subsidies are returning to exactly the way they worked then. I surely didn't expect the enhanced subsidies to become permanent. I would love it if they did, but people who pursue early retirement have a plan for maximizing subsidies and this shouldn't be a major hurdle for them. Keeping your MAGI low as an early retiree isn't particularly hard and should have been planned for. I'm still hoping for the return of the enhanced subsidies as they make a lot more sense. The cliff was always such a terrible part of the original ACA."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oodemw/aca_the_cliff_is_a_big_issue/nn3h71t/

"It's the only affordable option for many people, especially if you are self employed, as I am. I have never had an issue with my plan and I'm grateful for the subsidy, without it my premium would be \$2800 a month."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1l3a4v4/republicans_seek_major_obamacare_rollback_in/mw1sdnv/

"I also have an income that fluctuates. During previous ACA enrollments, we are asked to provide estimated income for the upcoming year to determine tax subsidy eligibility. When I file my taxes a year later, (and include the data from my 1095-A form) any deviation in my estimated income will result in a change to my tax liability. If for some reason I made more than what my estimated income was, I will pay back that portion/percentage of the tax subsidy(and vice versa if I make less). The BBB has changed it to any income overage over the estimated income given upon application will trigger a FULL repayment of the ENTIRE subsidy. I'm having difficulty even finding information on what the subsidies will be next year when they expire. Let alone what the actual policy costs are jumping up to."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mbsi9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/n5p4pr7/

"Thank you! I'm happy your mom has been able to afford her medicine. It's so sad that we pay so much and get so little in return. I try not to stress about it but fuck it's so hard not too. Then I'm scared it might go up next year and regardless i need my insurance for my family. I make too much for Medicaid I'm stuck in the middle. With my insurance my Ozempic is 800 and Farxiga is 400"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vnce2d/a_shocking_92_percent_of_us_adults_are_not_going/p3ii1am/

"After I was laid off, my husband and I were both denied health insurance due to preexisting conditions -mine was arthritis. In the meantime my right hip deteriorated to the point that I couldn't function. Then, thanks to the Affordable Care Act we got coverage, I was able to get the surgery I needed in order to walk, and was able (because I could walk without constant pain) to start a business that is thriving all these years later. If not for the ACA I would be on government assistance for both healthcare coverage and full disability. Now I contribute to the economy, employ people, am non disabled and fully ambulatory. Health insurance under the ACA is certainly more expensive than I'd like, but is far less expensive than pre-ACA insurance. Edited for clarity"

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lqpjeb/it_will_pass/n1c7p0x/

"This is what I'm doing. I'm retiring at 60 (right around the corner). We recently stopped contributing to 401k and are stockpiling cash instead. This and other non-taxable or low-taxable assets will supplement our income before 65 so we will draw less from pre-tax retirement accounts, keeping AGI below the cliff level (~84,000/couple). ACA premiums will be \$700/month instead of \$3,000/month. I think we can swing this for at least two years, so, COBRA first 18 months, then this for two years, then might have to suck it up and pay the full ACA premiums. Unless Dems are able to restore the subsidies, which might change the equation."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1woyyo6/for_people_retiring_before_65_how_are_you/pbrf0s3/

Free to work for themselves or retire early · 7 documents · 7 voices

"Reasons why I love the freelancing hiring process So I just finished my first project and I'm in consideration for three more. This journey started after another round of disappointing job interviews plagued by office politics, nepotism and cheapskates. Say what you will about certain clients freelancing, but at least most are being upfront from the get go. Before freelancing I spent a good portion of the past five years applying to jobs and I believe that process is ultimately broken beyond repair. You won't get anywhere these days unless you have a network, and even if you do have an established network at some corporation, the nephew of the CEO could still get the job over you. Here are a couple of reasons I find freelancing a much better fit for me and my personality: * Things move much more quickly and everything is out in the open * You know the rate (salary) range!!!! * I was pretty aggressive applying to full time jobs and I find it quite easy to find freelancing opportunities that fit my skillset and pays well. * You don't have to wait weeks or even months to get hired * You don't have to go through skills assessments and personality exams * You set your rates and clients honor it * Clients don't try re-negotiate or go for a cheaper option like what's happened to me in the job hiring process * You generally know where you are in the hiring process and how many people you are competing against. I seem to have to pry this information out of people in the job hiring process and it always changes * Freelancing helps you build out your skills and gets you in touch with that missing network * If clients like you they will continue to give you work * If you don't fit the culture, no big deal you know the contract is temporary * You get paid for the work you do, I constantly find projects for a couple of hundred dollars that I would have done at my salary job for free just so that I can "impress the boss," these little projects around the office would not have netted a raise. I was always afraid of contract positions because I wouldn't get benefits, but even that freedom of not having health insurance tied to a corporation is pleasing to me on some level. I'm looking forward to saying sayonara to my dehumanizing and dangerous retail job by the end of the month."

— r/freelance · 68 upvotes · None

"Feel like I've failed I feel like a failure. I've been self employed with a part time job for the past couple years (the part time job is very part time and I love it too much to quit). I've recently hit a very rough point in my life and the lack of health insurance has finally become too much. I'm talking to a recruiting agency about a contract job and then I may have them find me a permanent job. I know it means giving up what I love doing and I feel like I've failed. I've made the mistake of shifting my focus as other people suggested to me. I should have stuck to what *I* know I can do and do well. I still don't know how I'd handle the lack of health insurance, but it'd be easier to figure out, at least. Anybody else hit a point like this?"

— r/freelance · 65 upvotes · None

"I retired at 47 and the ACA subsidies are returning to exactly the way they worked then. I surely didn't expect the enhanced subsidies to become permanent. I would love it if they did, but people who pursue early retirement have a plan for maximizing subsidies and this shouldn't be a major hurdle for them. Keeping your MAGI low as an early retiree isn't particularly hard and should have been planned for. I'm still hoping for the return of the enhanced subsidies as they make a lot more sense. The cliff was always such a terrible part of the original ACA."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oodemw/aca_the_cliff_is_a_big_is_sue/nn3h71t/

"My husband's stepmom and father both died last year. We live 2,000 miles away, and my husband was an only child. On top of that, his dad was incapacitated by a stroke right before his wife died, so we had to petition for guardianship because no one had the authority to pay his bills or make decisions on his behalf once she passed away. When she was sick, I flew there for two weeks and helped take care of her. Flew back here after her funeral and then flew there again in July and stayed for 5 months by myself. My husband had to stay here and keep working so we'd keep our health insurance. The nursing facility was 3 hours from my FIL's house, but I couldn't afford to get a hotel nearby for five months, so I stayed in his house and would make the 6-hour round trip to the facility on Saturdays. We are extremely fortunate that we were able to afford to have the two of us live separately for that long. Dad's funds covered his mortgage and utilities, but I was paying for my own groceries and putting gas in the car to get around. The only reason this worked is because I have health problems that make it impossible for me to work full-time, so I am self-employed and was able to work from a different state while I took care of everything there. Most people would not have been able to make it work due to finances, and those are the people who are going to be screwed by these cuts. Because it's very difficult to do caregiving while also trying to pay your own bills."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lflzs7/i_think_the_medicaiddestroying_bill_will_pass/myphsha/

"This is a phenomenal video as I quit my job and am going self-employed full time. I was offered COBRA for over \$1,000 a month which seems excessive. I'm 28 years old with no major health issues and live a pretty healthy lifestyle. Do you recommend the DPC + Ancillary? Or the DPC + super high deductible plan + Ancillary? Are DPC and Ancillary tax deductible for the business? Or is it just PPO plans? Ideally I'd like to save as much as possible insurance-wise. Thanks for the fantastic informative video!"

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed | TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=UgziSV3pZsrOnR-oKh4AaABAq>

↳ @7Tcfisher (2): "If you are still in this same situation I specialize in relatively healthy families/individuals as well as self employed/ small business owners as a 28 year old male you should pay no more than \$250 for a low deductible as well as a PPO network because you are a low risk. If you'd like to hear more about options tailored towards your situation to get the best possible rate and most coverage at the same time let me know!"

↳ @VictoriaDorsano (1): "Great questions! If I were in your shoes, I'd either go for DPC + Ancillary (which is a little higher risk, but lower monthly cost), or super high deductible HMO plan + ancillary (lower risk, but higher monthly cost usually). If there's an independent health insurance agent in your area - might be worth consulting with them :) I'm not 100% sure on DPC or ancillary being tax deductible, but since you're going self-employed - you will probably need an accountant anyways - so I'd check in with them on that question. Here's an article from DPC frontier on tax treatment: <https://www.dpcfrontier.com/tax-treatment> For ancillary insurance - this is what I used: <https://natgenhealth.com/individual.php#accident-and-critical-illness> . If you call them, they can advise you if it may be tax deductible as well. Hope this helps!"

↳ @YugiohTube (1): "@VictoriaDorsano This was absolutely fantastic thank you so much. Lastly, have you heard of HSAs and would you recommend I use a HSA with the super high deductible plan? I've heard a lot of good stuff regarding HSAs...again thank you so much for your help. You've definitely got my subscription!"

"I was self-employed for a decade and I finally was able to get insurance because of it. I have been denied for an issue. My doctor agreed was minor, but they didn't care, they refused to give me insurance ever."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1l44n8o/millions_would Lose_their_obamacare_coverage/mw8kwni/

"I am self-employed and we just lost the insurance that we had through my husband's work because he's gonna work for a business full-time. It does not make sense to get insurance by our self cobra is out of the question it's outrageous and we are a family of three we have a daughter that's in college and we told them we wanted insurance that was comparable to what we had which was United healthcare and it was a PPO, which was pretty decent insurance. The only thing I could find that was even close to that was gonna run us \$2200 a month! That is just asinine. We have decided to go without insurance and pay our Dr. bills as we go."

— YouTube · How to Get Health Insurance When Self-Employed · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G eUdFzjUKcw&lc=UgxMbjRicce5YKnjQNR4AaABAq>

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Working around the coverage · 45 documents · 20 voices

"WOW! Looking at my 2026 insurance, its half my rent! I was covered thru work previously, just looked at 2026 for california with parital subsidy and for a single person, my monthly premium is \$1300! (cheapest was \$1100 - up to \$1800) that's half my already very expensive rent! Estimated income of \$80k lts a hit, but i don't know how people affords this! All the people getting new premiums in the mail in 2 weeks are in for a rude awakening as i was"

— r/HealthInsurance · 777 upvotes · None

"What you can do if your marketplace premiums for 2026 are too high I've seen this topic come up in recent weeks and want to offer some advice for folks on marketplace plans with premium hikes. This could also work for folks with employer group plans. I realize that this won't work for everyone in every situation but if you've come to a place where you need to consider alternative ways to approach your healthcare costs, this may be helpful. 1. switch to the least expensive marketplace ACA-compliant bronze-level high deductible HSA-eligible insurance plan to cover only catastrophic events like hospitalization. Use this the way you would use your car insurance: sparingly or not at all. Note that going without insurance is a very, very bad idea for reasons that are covered in this sub on a regular basis. 2. Open and contribute to an HSA to get tax savings on money you'll spend toward medical expenses. 3. SKIP DENTAL AND VISION INSURANCE. Honestly this applies to everyone on marketplace plans but dental and vision "insurance" are just glorified payment plans. They are not regulated the same way as ACA health insurance plans so insurers are allowed to charge premiums on those products that guarantee profit margins > 20%. Instead, work with your favorite local dentist and optometrist to pay directly for all your services, and put the money you would have spent on these premiums into your HSA. 4. If you need care: 4a. If you are someone who needs more than 1-3 office visits a year, shop around for a direct primary care provider in your area. Memberships for these are generally pretty reasonable when you factor in what you might have spent toward premiums on a silver or gold tier marketplace plan. 4b. Google specialty care options. For example, Cove offers a monthly membership for treatment of migraines that, when you add it up, is less expensive than a single trip to the neurologist plus a monthly RX from Walgreens. Companies like this exist for nearly everything. 4c. Become a smart shopper for your rxs. There are so many options outside of traditional insurance that can help you save money: GoodRx, Mark Cuban Cost Plus, LillyDirect, Hers/Hims, Nurx. 4d: Think of memberships you may already have that come with pharmacy or healthcare benefits: Costco is an obvious one but comb through other areas of your life. For example, my electric company is a co-op and offers members a discount program for dental, prescriptions, and gym memberships. 4e. Ask your current providers about direct pay arrangements. If you're paying \$200/month in premiums so that your therapist is in-network, but your therapist will happily take \$150 cash per monthly session, you'll come out \$50/month ahead by paying directly. If anyone has other suggestions, because I'm sure I've missed plenty, add them!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 372 upvotes · None

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😬 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"Are everyone's premiums so high? Hello. I'm applying for insurance using healthcare.gov, and while it might just be me, the premiums I'm being offered seem very steep, around \$460 or more. I'm a student and work part time, so I'm not able to afford a \$460 monthly premium. Does anyone know if I did something wrong or if I need to continue with the process?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 142 upvotes · None

"Employer Won't Sign Me Up For Insurance Until Apr 2026 I started a new job today and I was talking to the HR rep about health insurance. She said that the OE period passed in Apr and I wouldn't be able to sign up again until next Apr. Cue me freaking out because I have conditions that need to be managed with meds. I pushed back because any job I worked at you were always allowed to enroll after the probation period. She said she has to check with I guess the insurance broker. She then told me since I'm losing my coverage at my previous job what going on COBRA, which I would think any HR rep would know how ridiculous of a question that is. I just want to make sure I'm right about them needing to allow me to enroll before Apr 2026. **UPDATE:** it is 90 days so I just have to hold out until Oct. HR rep is new and needs to learn the job better."

— r/HealthInsurance · 136 upvotes · None

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · None

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"NC - losing medicaid for medically complex child Any moms on here with children on medicaid with congenital heart conditions/complex medical needs? I need your advice... I've just been told my daughter's medicaid won't be renewed even though my income has decreased from last year's renewal period. Marketplace coverage will cost \$600/mo and covers nothing. Her annual tests will cost upwards close to \$7-\$9,000 assuming her conditions stay stable and without issues. I called the tailored plan brokers and they told me it only covers behavioral/developmental conditions and that if our medicaid expires at the end of the month then there's no way she'd qualify. Am I missing any other outlets or resources? My case worker explains nothing as to why we're being rejected even though our income was much higher last year."

— r/Medicaid · 14 upvotes · None

"If I get a job part way through the year and cut off my ACA insurance right when my new insurance starts what happens as far as my tax credits? Update : I'm in Michigan I know we estimate for yearly income for the ACA but they wouldn't penalize me for not having or isn't ACA insurance for the months I'm covered by employer insurance right? As of right now I estimated my income higher due to making more money last year but business has taken a dive this year. I'm paying more per month because of that higher estimate and I'm looking for a new job with benefits because it's too unpredictable at this point. For what I've made for the first quarter of the year I prob would have been eligible for Medicaid so I'm also worried about getting screwed for that come tax time next year."

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s3qnb3/if_i_get_a_job_part_way_through_the_year_and_cut/

"Journalist seeking NYers concerned about ACA subsidies Hi I'm Caroline Lewis, a health care reporter with the NYC public radio station WNYC. I'm working on a story about how ACA insurance subsidies will be reduced if enhanced tax credits are allowed to expire at the end of this year. I'm looking to speak with NYC residents who have insurance through the state's ACA exchange (known here as New York State of Health) and who are concerned about their plans becoming less affordable. If you are interested in speaking with me, please send me a message here or email me at clewis@wnyc.org. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"I have a seasonal job that includes health insurance, it's great, but that means every year on May 1st I lose my insurance and have to file for a special enrollment period, which means I get even less selection from the normal shitty list. I'm so tired..."

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1twsb7i/dr_oz_says_roughly_35_of_enrollments_are_not_legit/opr9x4u/

"In Florida you can't even get Medicaid if you're homeless with \$0 income. You must also be either *determined* disabled by DCF (meaning you need extensive and current medical records), under the age of 18, or over the age of 65. (Pregnancy and having a child under 18 makes some people temporarily eligible as well.) *Then* you must meet the income limits of usually ~\$1100/month or less (this amount includes support from family and any other unearned income) and a hard asset limit of \$2000 total or less. To qualify to buy a plan on the marketplace here, you must make over \$15,000/year in employment income, so family support/unearned doesn't count towards that. Your only option if you fall between these gaps is to shop directly with the insurance agencies for PPOs. I was quoted \$1750/month when I attempted this, for enough coverage for my specialists and medications. (I've been disabled and out of work for 8 years and was only approved for Medicaid last year. My ssdi claim is still ongoing.)"

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1kminjg/obamacare_in_trouble/msawdn9/

"Yea, this was my situation last year. I lost my job due to a health issue and had to enroll with a marketplace plan. I had no clear indicator on what my income was going to be for the full year - as it wasn't clear when I would be returning to work. I hadn't yet made 15k (FPL) for the year, but on my estimate for income I just assumed I'd be out of work for 2 months and calculated that way. Figured that if I went back to work earlier, or got a better job - I'd just pay them the difference on my taxes. But after 4 major surgeries, I didn't work again at all last year (meaning I did not earn enough to 'qualify' for the program and would need to pay back the subsidies in their entirety if this provision was in place). After a couple months, I attempted to apply for short term disability, but was delayed/denied repeatedly. Under this provision, I would have ended up owing \$6,000+ on my taxes in addition to all of my other financial hardships."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0yyfl6/

"Two straight years of income falling slightly below the minimum threshold. How worried should I be? I live in a state without expanded Medicaid and have only been making between 1k to 1500 monthly for the last two years. I estimated my income as best I could, which was right above the minimum for coverage eligibility. My 2024 final income ended up being at 90% of the FPL and 96% for 2025. One of my parents had a stroke last year, which caused me to miss about a full month of work in total. I didn't report this as a life change event, however looking back perhaps I should have. I'm worried that I might not be able to get advance premium tax credits next year after two years in a row of not making as much as I estimated and being below the minimum threshold. What is the most likely outcome and is there anything I can do now to avoid being penalized?"

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sh0wl7/two_straight_years_of_income_falling_slightly/

"Looking to possibly leave my job to start an in home daycare with my wife. The plan is to have my wife start off first while I still work and analyze if the income coming in makes sense and if leaving my current position will boost our income if I help her full time by bringing in more children. The only way I leave is if we work numbers and the amount at the end of every month is more than what I am making right now at a steady consistent rate. The biggest fear factor I have is that I have health/dental/vision insurance for all of my family. Leaving hurts my gut because while I was shopping around for healthcare for my family the least expensive one I found was around 805/month and that was just for HEALTH insurance."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Options for the Self Employed or Are Leaving Your Job · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ceyE3F7SK1k&lc=UgwaUBI9OyGnjvDellN4AaABAg>

↳ @MaximizingEcommerce (3): "Thank you for sharing your story. Depending on your beliefs (and health background), you may want to look into a cost sharing ministry as opposed to traditional health insurance. Regarding the risk, the question I would ask myself in your shoes is whether or not this opens doors to potentially additional profit/income opportunities..."

↳ @thehealthinsuranceguide (0): "Hi Manchester - How is the home daycare working out? Depending on your situation now (since it has been two years) your options may vary, and yes, health coverage can be pricey on the private side compared to a company plan that pays a lot of the cost for you. First check would be to see if you'd qualify for a significant subsidy. If not, or the subsidy is minimal, I'd check out the private underwritten plans. There are a couple that are available with lower premiums and better benefits because you have to be healthy enough to qualify to get on them. Did you get the health coverage all figured out? What did you end up going with?"

"I'm confused why the same plan my girlfriend and I choose went up for her, but stayed the same for me? We both signed up for Oscar Gold Elite last year and each have our incomes which are unfortunately low. Same jobs and same income for this year... But for some reason my premium for the same plan stayed at the exact same price of \$40, but hers more than doubled to \$100. We use our premium tax credits but she uses the insurance more than I do because she had asthma but does that have anything to do with it? I'm a bit confused because I don't understand this stuff very well despite watching many videos on it. Any help is greatly appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · None

"It sucks, but most everyone pays the whole premium. It's just hidden in their gross total compensation from work. We would probably get true reform in healthcare if employees covered at work received their full pay and had to write a 20k check every year. Personally, I will probably just downgrade from silver to bronze."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh7argt/

"I wish employers would get on board and put pressure on govt to reform the system too. Half of Americans rely on employer-sponsored healthcare. And employers, in their never-ending drive to save a buck and provide a bigger dividend to their shareholders (rather than actually innovate and produce like we used to) have been continually cutting health benefits for at least the last twenty years (my working adult years.) Premiums go up every year, percentage of cost shifted to employees grows every year, employees are made to jump through more hoops to get their spouse and children covered, covered services are reduced each year. Lately I've experienced employers offering to reimburse employees 20-30% of the cost of ACA insurance rather than offering their own sponsored plan. Further removing healthy people from the system and driving up costs. I get that business is competitive. But if this employer-sponsored healthcare system is unsustainable for employers, then they Also need to be lobbying for healthcare for all. It takes a Huge burden off the employers, who have to spend hours and effort every year reviewing and rolling out new plans. It allows them to shift at least some of their savings to higher wages, leading to happier and less-stressed employees. Another portion of savings could be pivoted to actual innovation and real production as opposed to paper profits that only benefit shareholders and CEOs. Plus happier and healthier employees are shown to be more productive for their employers, leading to more growth and greater future revenue. More retention, less turnover = more \$ Happy, healthy employees = more \$ How can we have so many gd MBAs in this country yet no exec can figure this out?!"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p24ajw/universal_care/npv3rvm/

"They want us to become drug dealers and criminals to fill their prisons. Go figure Trump admin has deep deep ties to the prison industrial complex... This is all 100% about causing hopelessness and desperation. Then we will "act out" whether that be protesting or other means and then ICE will be there to arrest you. If they weren't arresting US citizens I could believe otherwise but they DEF ARE. The goal is the same as Putin's: cause chaos...then they can say "the left" has caused us to cancel mid term elections. At the very least they will cheat again while we are all distracted simply trying to SURVIVE. My insurance is cut also and I couldnt afford it on the market place even BEFORE the premium hike! I work full time and have my own side business. I work 7 days a week from march to November. 5 days a week the rest. Still cant even cover the interest on my student loans so my principle goes up every single year. literally will never pay them off, and yes I'm on every low income payment plan you can be for each of them. This is not sustainable yet I've been doing it since I graduated college in 2014 somehow. I really need to work 7 days a week with at least 65-75 hours per week JUST TO BREAK EVEN and not end up with a higher loan balance at the end of the year. But even if I did that THIRTY YEARS I still won't have my loans paid off bc how much my balance has increased due to not being able to cover the interest every quarter for the last 12 years. Plus burnout is real. By the time November comes I desperately need a day off! This is what they want. They want us barely able to survive, running in place FOREVER. Then there's no time for dissent/protest. If I miss ONE day of work, just one, I'm behind TWO weeks at least. God forbid I get sick and need two days off work, which requires a doctors note, which I have to pay \$175 for urgent care to get. So if I do get really sick I'll ALSO LOSE MY JOB bc I can't pay friggin almost \$200 just to see a doctor for a note! There should be a cheap clinic where you pay \$25 literally just to get a note. Some doctor could make a KILLING doing that! TLDR: when you take all of the supposed "flaws" in the system to account you realize they are not FLAWS inherent in the system at all; they are deliberate choices made by our overlords to control us. In no world is it okay to have to work this hard and STILL not be able to afford basic healthcare! They pretend it's because "there's no easy solution" so nothing changes. They KNOW the solution, it's purposefully not put into action. The solution def IS NOT CORPORATE WELFARE while I can't even get ebt! I work full time and eat from a food bank! Like WHAT THE FCK! I don't have a fancy car, big house, I DIY everything. I have no credit cards, so it's not like I'm doing this to myself. This system is a house of cards all built on corporate handouts/bailouts while the rest of us cant afford to poop!"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qil7n2/my_premium_went_from_200_to_1500_and_now/o12uapd/

Checking the marketplace and doing the math · 31 documents · 20 voices

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"Dropping our ACA plan Today is the day my family is dropping our ACA plan. Our options were to stay on our same plan and be financially strained, or switch to a different plan with an absurdly high deductible. Neither option made sense for us. Luckily, my family is healthy right now. I'm just posting this for solidarity with all the other individuals and families in the same boat. Obviously, not having health insurance comes with a risk, but for us, that risk made more sense than continuing to pay into a broken system. We found a Direct Primary Care (DPC) provider near us, so we know we'll at least have basic, and great care. We are exploring other alternatives as well. Oh, and for those of you who are also exiting the marketplace this year, you must proactively do this or you will be automatically re-enrolled. Happy last day to enroll everyone!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 763 upvotes · None

"Healthcare.gov's Cheapest option is HALF the yearly income?! [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is quoting my partner for their cheapest monthly option being \$605 a MONTH. That comes out to almost half her yearly income. We aren't married yet, so my yearly income isn't factored. There is no way that this is something normal people are paying???"

— r/HealthInsurance · 360 upvotes · None

"My HR just asked me to willingly get marketplace insurance I'm on some very expensive medications. Without this medication I wouldn't be functional and able to work. My HR is setting up open enrollment and just called and asked me to look into marketplace insurance. I've never not had insurance through my job. I understand I'm a liability. Do I have to? How expensive will that be? Will I be able to get my medication? Talk to me like I'm 2 because I have no clue. Thank you."

— r/HealthInsurance · 238 upvotes · None

""Get Covered Illinois"--2026 premium notices sent out today. This year, Illinois switched over to its own program, rather than using Healthcare.gov. 2026 premiums hit the street today. The unsubsidized premium for me and my wife (both in our early to mid-60s) is \$2,915,99. This represents a 17% premium increase from 2025. In Illinois, my carrier, Blue Cross/Blue Shield, had gotten approved for an average 27% premium increase across all of its policy forms; I'm not sure why we got the smaller percentage increase. I had thought that people our age would have been hit with the highest percentage increase in premiums. The automatic renewal letter that I got described my projected monthly subsidy, and my "monthly premium" (in other words, the subsidized premium). I figured out the total unsubsidized premium by adding those figures together. Because of the way that the numbers were laid out in the letter, it appears that the people who run the Illinois program believe that Federal subsidies will be renewed for 2026."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · None

"2026 Marketplace or wait until December 14th? I apologize if this has been answered elsewhere. I'm seeking some guidance. Should I enroll now (November 14th) for 2026 marketplace insurance or wait until December 14th on the chance that the enhanced subsidy is renewed? The level of subsidy will impact medical & dental insurance choices. Is it easy to change plans before January 15th if the enhanced subsidy is renewed?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 80 upvotes · None

"Just got booted from my insurance Not sure what to do now. Just got cut off of medicaid after they looked at my most recent tax return. I live in Michigan and I make like \$1,700 more than their limit on average they say. I work as a school bus attendant and I make \$17/hr. My hours suck. I follow the school year calendar for both public schooling and special education. I go from working a 30 hour week, 4 times a month to working 20 hours 1 week, than 15, than 30, than 20 just because of how many days I have off due to weather or teacher education days or just randomly scheduled off days which are way too numerous. Still trying to find a secondary job or just a better primary job and having trouble with that. I'm 22 years old with a medical history large enough to fill up a old timey vacuum box if it was all printed out. I need health insurance as a constant. Now I'm looking at insurance plans and I'm not sure what to pick. Realistically I know that the numbers it's showing me are not something I can pay every month consistently since it says \$330/month starting out for plans with a \$10,600 deductible. I did not click the premium tax credit because it's confusing as heck and my tax returns are usually pretty small every year. Not sure what to do at this point or who to ask at this point to try and figure all this out. Edit and update: Thanks to everyone's advice I was able to find a plan that suits me for health, but also partially covers dental and vision for only \$49/month"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wenhgc/just_got_booted_from_my_insurance/

"Yes, it's true. I am assuming from your numbers that you are single and I see from one of your replies that you are in Ohio. Your numbers are from last year though. They update for inflation each year. Ohio is an expansion Medicaid state, which means income up to 138% of the Federal Poverty Level (\$21,597 for a single this year) will qualify you for expansion Medicaid. Starting next year that benefit comes with a part-time community engagement requirement of 20 hours per week in work, volunteering, or part-time enrollment as a student. That's one option open to you. If you keep your income between 138% FPL and 150% FPL (\$21,598 to \$23,474), then you will qualify for a CSR Silver 94 plan with maximum premium subsidies and maximum cost sharing reduction subsidies. You can see 2026 prices (pre and post-subsidy) and plans in your county with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. You would be looking at around \$80/month or less for either the benchmark or under-benchmark Silver plan in your county, those being the least and second least expensive Silvers on offer in your county. Untaxed Roth withdrawals do not add to your income for ACA purposes, so you will need another source in order to develop qualifying income. That could be interest, dividends, employment, stock sales that produce cap gains, Roth conversions, traditional retirement account withdrawals, or your SS and pension income once they start. For context, we've been using the ACA for 12 years now and have had a CSR Silver 94 that entire time. Our policy this year has a \$7/month premium, \$0 deductible, a \$2,400 MaxOOP, and is with the top-rated ACA insurer in our state. It's a great policy, though all of our CSR Silver 94 policies have been just fine."

— r/obamacare · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti1dc8/manipulating_income_for_silver_plan_w_csr/omrfr9z/

"Does choosing not to renew marketplace coverage count as a QLE for joining my wife's employer plan outside of open enrollment? My wife's job is a small business that offers a subsidized plan for employees and children of employees. They offer a plan for spouses as well, but it isn't subsidized, so in the past it has been a little more expensive than what I can find on the marketplace. Her open enrollment is in October and when I saw prices this year I assumed I would still be able to find it cheaper through the marketplace. However, marketplace prices were higher this time, but I didn't discover this until after open enrollment closed through her employer. So now I'm trying to figure out if choosing not to renew my marketplace plan would qualify me for a special enrollment period through her employer. I know many of the answers will be "you need to talk to her employer," which unfortunately is easier said than done. Since it is a small business, there is no HR department, there is only her boss (the general manager and one of the owners), and in the past her boss has dragged her feet on answering any insurance related questions until we were practically begging her to reach out to her agent the day before my daughter was going to lose coverage. So I'm trying to avoid asking her boss unless I absolutely need to. It is a BCBS of TN plan if that helps answer my question."

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · None

"When November 1 rolls around, head to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and review your options. You're a bit stuck right now since it's not open enrollment season quite yet. You will need to figure out if insurance through your employer is affordable for *just you* and then split up your coverage if so (meaning you stay on your employer's policy, your spouse picks up a plan through healthcare.gov). In 2027, a health plan will be considered "affordable" using updated affordability metrics. If the employer-based policy costs *you* more than 10.77% of your gross household income, it's unaffordable. So if coverage for *just you* will cost more than \$296/mo., you are likely eligible for subsidies through [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) along with your spouse. I'm going to wager that adding your spouse to the plan through your employer adds significant cost, so while affordability does come into play, I'm going to bet that it's a non-issue given the numbers you're talking about here (because currently, your health premiums are roughly 41% of your gross household income, which is wildly beyond the ACA's affordability threshold. TL;DR, check [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) on 11//1, ensure that your employer policy is *not* affordable, and proceed from there. Note, the affordability metric only applies to the cheapest plan that meets ACA compliance, so if you've purchased up to a higher plan, you need to disregard that and only calculate on the least expensive one."

— r/HealthInsurance · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wk2jaz/best_insurance_for_spouse_and_i/pangxb2/

"18 currently unemployed and need insurance To start off I've never used Reddit really so I'm not sure if this is appropriate here but it seems like the place to go. I turned 18 in June and haven't had health insurance for YEARS. It honestly wouldn't be a crazy issue for me if I wasn't dealing with some reproductive health issues and wanting birth control. I used to just go to the ER when things happened or visit Planned Parenthood but my mom seems against it now because of money. It'd be over \$1,000 per month for me to just be placed on her own plan so I'm at a wall. I went to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and I was told that I qualified for a marketplace plan yet open enrollment has closed. I don't believe I account for a special enrollment period because I never really had insurance to begin with. I don't understand what to do in my case. I still live with my mother, I have a job interview lined up but everything feels like a waiting game except I never actually get the medical attention I really need. I'm frustrated and just want to see an GYN or somebody that can help me, I'm very tired."

— r/HealthInsurance · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wdtqmh/18_currently_unemployed_and_need_insurance/

"This depends on where you live. I have not compared plans yet this year, but previously, there was not a huge difference in premium despite the significantly higher out of pocket for bronze."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nqhnnld/

"Looking to possibly leave my job to start an in home daycare with my wife. The plan is to have my wife start off first while I still work and analyze if the income coming in makes sense and if leaving my current position will boost our income if I help her full time by bringing in more children. The only way I leave is if we work numbers and the amount at the end of every month is more than what I am making right now at a steady consistent rate. The biggest fear factor I have is that I have health/dental/vision insurance for all of my family. Leaving hurts my gut because while I was shopping around for healthcare for my family the least expensive one I found was around 805/month and that was just for HEALTH insurance."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Options for the Self Employed or Are Leaving Your Job · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ceyE3F7SK1k&lc=UgwaUBI9OyGnjyDellN4AaABAq>

↳ @MaximizingEcommerce (3): "Thank you for sharing your story. Depending on your beliefs (and health background), you may want to look into a cost sharing ministry as opposed to traditional health insurance. Regarding the risk, the question I would ask myself in your shoes is whether or not this opens doors to potentially additional profit/income opportunities..."

↳ @thehealthinsuranceguide (0): "Hi Manchester - How is the home daycare working out? Depending on your situation now (since it has been two years) your options may vary, and yes, health coverage can be pricey on the private side compared to a company plan that pays a lot of the cost for you. First check would be to see if you'd qualify for a significant subsidy. If not, or the subsidy is minimal, I'd check out the private underwritten plans. There are a couple that are available with lower premiums and better benefits because you have to be healthy enough to qualify to get on them. Did you get the health coverage all figured out? What did you end up going with?"

"Imperial problems and ACA So my dermatologist has been unable to communicate with my ACA insurance (Imperial) to get the necessary approval to biopsy some spots. The doctor's office basically came back to me saying they have done all they can do and are giving up and i was "welcome to self pay". I have called imperial to get answers to other questions and have gotten false information or "We don't know and we don't have a department either we or you can talk to to find out". I requested a manager callback and received none. Any suggestions on how to deal with this? Is there some kind of oversight organization or patient advocate organization I can go to to complain? Is there a path to being able to switch insurance via marketplace mid year? I tried calling the marketplace today, but they are closed for the holiday....I intend to follow up there but wanted to also cast a net here in case people have info that can help. Thank you in advance!"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tnbh0m/imperial_problems_and_a_ca/

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO

and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

"Yes. Currently a broker can enroll a fictitious client for a maximally subsidized Silver 94 with \$0 premium. This results in a cash commission for the broker, a huge premium payment for the insurer, and the cost falls on the Treasury. Due to there being no cost or hard verification, this ghost enrollee can sit active on the ACA rolls for multiple years. A minimum monthly payment would mean that fraud would have to be much more structured as they would have to setup payment systems and each fraudulent monthly payment would be a separate federal crime. This sort of fraud is also a big part of why some of the verification and auto-reenrollment changes were made in the OBBA. They are irritating, but usually meaningless hurdles for most actual subsidy-eligible people, but they are harder roadblocks for ghost enrollments. I've seen estimates that as much as 20-25% of \$0 enrollments in huge ACA states like Texas and Florida are ghost accounts. There are large volumes of current \$0 ACA enrollees who have a peculiar cluster of habits like having all mail sent to a PO Box, never using any healthcare services, never changing their insurance selection, and not filing the mandatory IRS paperwork each year. It's a lucrative scam for brokers and insurance companies alike and it is draining billions in ACA funding each year that could otherwise be put to better use for real ACA subscribers. Nearly 80% of all Healthcare.gov policy registrations were broker-assisted/conducted last year. There is a lot of potential for abuse and the financial rewards can be quite high for the savvy."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o81hzm/now_taxing_the_poor_more_than_some_billionaires/njt9be8/

"Really? My friend's husband is an executive at health insurance company. A few days after the ACA passed, she and I went to lunch and she told me that her husband came very close to throwing their TV through a window because he was so pissed that the ACA passed. I wouldn't say insurance companies loved it. Since so much of the ACA has been dismantled since January 1, 2014, I'm not sure how insurance companies feel currently. (While some provisions, such as allowing young adults to stay on parents' plans, began in 2010, the major reforms including the launch of insurance marketplaces, premium subsidies, and the individual mandate, officially started on January 1, 2014)"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s2bz1r/why_did_the_aca_not_abolish_the_employer/oc8j5v6/

"Mathematically, it doesn't matter. Your taxes will be the same either way. The difference is just timing. You will pay more for insurance every month, and maybe get a tax refund or pay less for insurance every month and maybe have a balance due with your taxes. Roth IRAs should not produce any income. Personally, my income is somewhat variable and I do not take the advanced Premium Tax Credit, and instead just take whatever credit I'm entitled to (if any) on my tax return. Yes, I am paying more every month for insurance, but since I am self employed it avoids an annoying recursive tax calculation, and it all works out in the end."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/o7mgorh/

"On politicians? I don't care for politicians any more than the next guy, but the estimated income was much too low. And it's very clear when the estimate is made that if it changes update then to adjust the premium assistive. It's clear they goofed, deceived or trusted the wrong agent. By the way, ACA premiums didn't increase more than private plans, both group and individual. That is just a deceptive political talking point. All health insurance is skyrocketing even higher than the already sky high prices. One difference is that ACA hasn't lowered the coverages offered by the different plan categories, whereas most employer plans have and therefore have lower premiums than they would had they kept the plans the same, so often the comparison to ACA is apples to oranges. I've been buying my own health insurance since before ACA. It always sucks, but ACA made it easier to understand what you're buying. Other than that, they are just private plans like I bought before ACA. BTW - I've never qualified for premium assistance, but know how it works - a year or two I was close. Hell another year healthcare.gov even changed the forms asking what I made in November and extrapolated that to the year. November is always a terrible month for me my worst, but I dutifully answered. Sure enough, I qualified, but I knew that was wrong and only because that just asked about November. I redid the form and entered for November a twelfth of what I'd make in a year, and I was back to no support."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rkj61c/obamacare_400_fpl/o8l8wfi/

"Did 17 months of COBRA and switched to Obamacare during ACA marketplace open enrollment. I manipulate MAGI to get the highest possible ACA tax credit. Obamacare is dying just in time for me to start medicare and medicare supplements. Of course medicare supplements are dying too. Once medicare supplements get too expensive, I will leave the U.S. to live in an underdeveloped country and pay cash for medical treatment. My wife will be on Obamacare for several more years. As she is still in her 50s, Obamacare should still be cheaper for a while. Once it gets too expensive, that will be another potential trigger to leave the U.S. With Canada getting Associate EU membership, if that comes with a Schengen passport for Canadians, then because I hold a Canadian passport too, we will relocate to Canada for several years while my wife goes through the process to become a Canadian citizen. Then after that, if Obamacare and medicare supplements are still broken, will move to the EU, say Portugal, Malta, or Greece, warm places where English speakers don't have a hassle."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1woyyo6/for_people_retiring_before_65_how_are_you/pbrm9kq/

Private Worries

Premiums they can't pay (subsidy loss, doubling) · 80 documents

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise... what do I do? 27F, entry level job after graduating college, trying to buy a house and start a family. Bit of a rant here... You saw the title. My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise. I am flabbergasted. I can't afford to pay over \$200/month more for my health insurance because I make an extra \$160/month?!?! In what world does that make sense?! There is a PCP in my area that does not take insurance, but provides most of the services I require for a \$90/month subscription. It's what I want to go with. They suggested I go with a catastrophic health plan in case of car wreck, etc. He said it should be about \$90/month. When I researched catastrophic health plans, the lowest premium is over \$200/month. I can't afford this AND pay rent AND pay car payment AND pay car insurance AND pay all my other bills AND save money for house/ children/ emergencies. It's safe to say I'm panicking. I payed the insurance for January but I couldn't save anything. I can't keep this plan. I'm currently feeling very defeated by a system that seems to be set up to keep the majority down... I'm so tired of this. Where is universal healthcare? What should I do? Where can I find a catastrophic health plan for around \$100 a month?"

— HealthInsurance · 137 upvotes · None

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

"ACA not very affordable anymore ACA is not really affordable without the extra subsidy, but California fines you 100 per month for not having it. It's not really fair to fine people who truly can't afford it. I work front desk hotel. The cheapest plan for me is 200 per month. I have to pay 100% out of pocket until I reach 7200 for the year. Just 2 visits to the dermatologist is costing me 1400 on top of the 200 I already pay. ​ If I want something with normal co-pays, it's going to cost me 400 per month. I make between 45K-50K, but the cost of living is so high in California that there isn't much left for stuff like health insurance. It's really not fair that California fines you at this point when the premiums have literally doubled in price. It's very frustrating."

— obamacare · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_a_nymore/

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · None

"Paxlovid \$1600? Anthem ACA in Indiana is pretty terrible -- the cheap "negotiated rate" for 5 days of the anti-COVID medication paxlovid is nearly \$1600. I'm skipping it since I can't afford it even with the \$1000 one-time use coupon from Pfizer. The whole year has been basically Anthem denying all my medications or offering a price that's way higher than those weird "discount cards" like GoodRx. Pretty terrible. Anyone else angry yet are ready for actual universal health care? I retired early and this is literally the only insurance plan available to me in my state. These insurance company scammers and big pharma scammers need to be fixed. Things are getting unsustainable. I understand that there's an active movement to dismantle and destroy ACA without any replacement, so that's part of the problem, but really we need actual universal healthcare and to tear down the existing scam organizations."

— HealthInsurance · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj8crd/paxlovid_1600/

"These tax credits weren't part of the original ACA/Obamacare. They were added during the pandemic and then extended in the Inflation Reduction Act to help lower-middle class families who don't qualify for Medicaid but still struggle to afford the Obamacare premiums. When these tax credits expire people who earn more than ~\$12,00/year but less than ~\$60,000/year (as a single person— the income limits vary based on how much your state hates poor people and your family size) in some states will see an ~80% increase in their health insurance premiums. In most blue states a person earning under ~\$21,000 is eligible for Medicaid but in many red states the income limit for Medicaid eligibility is much lower. So in those states the people who are working at or near minimum wage won't be eligible for Medicaid but also have **really** tight budgets so even the ACA plans are too expensive without the additional tax credits and many will choose to risk being uninsured. This policy change will disproportionately affect those in deep red states that have resisted Medicaid expansion under the ACA because they hate their lower-income citizens (who, I'm sure by total coincidence, also tend to be people of color) and they hate Obamacare for... reasons. Alabama, Georgia, Florida, Mississippi, South Carolina, etc. These expiring subsidies were essentially a way to give Medicaid expansion to those resistant states temporarily during the pandemic and to close the "coverage gap" that exists in the states that hate their own citizens so much they won't take free money from the federal government. So really this is the story of two evils: the evil republicans in the state governments who refuse to expand healthcare coverage for their own citizens and their evil republican colleagues in the federal government who refuse to help the people who have been abandoned by their state representatives. But at least the billionaires will get a tax break! /s"

— obamacare · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1kminjg/obamacare_in_trouble/msamy5r/

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"Self-employed independent white male. My premiums tripled. It's a big deal. I'll send you my address so you can make up the difference. I'll refund it when the 10 year (and counting) congressional fix that you refer to is implemented."

— obamacare · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ps7j5o/premiums_triple_congress_goes_homes/nv7gfug/

"I thought the same. I feel for you, I'm over here ticked about paying \$427 a month. It is Ambetter. And I like it. Had cancer treatment in '24 and '25. No complaints. It was \$220 a month before we lost the subsidies."

— obamacare · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omssbpq/

"This \$2,000 is supposed to be just for health services as opposed to insurance premiums. Therefore, if you can't afford the premiums, you are so much deeper in the hole. With fewer people able to afford the premiums, the carriers are just going to keep raising premiums on others to make up the difference. They knew that they would lose a lot of customers in 2026 due to the expiration of subsidies this year, which is why our rates for next year have skyrocketed. My premium will increase by 300 percent next year due to loss of subsidies."

— obamacare · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oyyvlk/lawmakers_are_racing_toward_a_middecember/np8lib6/

"Thank you. Cobra will be way too expensive and I don't qualify for Medicaid."

— HealthInsurance · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wpgg7y/husband_passed_away_and_i_no_longer_have/pbv8blb/

"I think something will happen. I think enough for Republicans know that they will lose the house if they don't help the people with yet another Trump expense. Even then, I'm not sure they can hang onto it. Unlike Trump, many of them know how unaffordable surviving has become, well the ones that listen to their constituents know. I guess whether they care is TBD. He sure made sure the wealthy people got their tax cut in his big baby bill, nice and early. Meanwhile, the average American has had everything go up and health insurance is a biggie, some of these increases are huge and they simply can't afford it. Trump likes to threaten to primary people. Trump will be gone in roughly 3 years. He won't rule the GOP forever and that is a simple fact. And even as they try to gerrymander their way into forever wins, they aren't winning all of those and some are TBD. I also find it ironic that Trump always talks about states, states should take the burden of everything. He means everything financial because otherwise, he's still very much wants to tell them what to do. And this is where things get kind of muddy. We elect people to do this in that, but we also don't know what the laws say about what they want to do. I guess you could look them up, but they are painting pretty broad strokes at that point, it would be difficult to pinpoint laws. I didn't know that you could read district on a whim, I always thought it was done only after a census. I think things like this should be left to the people, as California did. If they didn't just ramrod it through, they went to the people and asked what they wanted. I use ACA as does my husband and it has remained affordable for us, but we do a lot of things with our income to keep from meeting that subsidy Cliff. We are self-employed and that is the only way we can get insurance. We cannot get Medicaid, we make too much. And honestly, I don't want it. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, we just can't afford to pay it all. We want to pay part of it. Many people don't realize they ended up on ACA just because of Covid. It wasn't just extended subsidies that were enacted during Covid, it also opened the ACA up to people making up to 700% of the poverty level, that is why the ACA ballooned and they too, got the extended subsidies. I have to wonder what they did before. But I do believe healthcare should be a right. If my husband doesn't have health insurance, he files for disability. He has to. Inherited a bad heart from both parents. His twin had a pacemaker at age 40. My husband had a stent at age 46 and a triple bypass at age 52. He's not overweight, he eats healthy, exercise exercises, but his blood pressure was always an issue and then things got worse. The triple bypass was about 300 K and there is no way we could've paid that. But if we get help with insurance, my husband gets to see his doctors, have his meds and continues to work. To me that seems like the better decision., To help with one thing to keep him off of being totally disabled. Sorry, I went on a rant, I get so stressed by all of this. All right, hike wasn't too bad but I still feel for the people that have had a huge rate hike. It's scary not having insurance. It's scary being hurt or sick and you can't go to the doctor. We are such a wealthy country and so damn great, yet people can't afford health insurance. Right there, that part alone, screams that America is not great."

— obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pazpk6/aca_in_the_senate/nrn7t0f/

"27M, COBRA premium increased from \$610 to \$950 after one month. Please help. I'm really in a bind here and just want some clarification and guidance to figure out what my next best steps are. My premium was increased by more than 50%, and I wasn't alerted until today that it would also apply for the September payment. My new insurance won't kick in until the end of October. I haven't made any Cobra payments yet but did "opt in", but I haven't needed to use it yet. But now my body doesn't feel right and I've found a growth. If this turns into a bigger and drawn out health issue, I really don't know how I can make that payment work, but I also don't think I can put this off for another month. I've never had any major health issues before so I really have no clue what I'm in for. Are there any quick to enroll and less expensive health insurance alternatives? Or is this just what I have to work with?"

— HealthInsurance · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wo35q1/27m_cobra_premium_increased_from_610_to_950_after/

"The ACA was made for people like me and my husband. We are both self-employed and have been for a good chunk of our lives, for my husband it's actually his whole adult life. We don't qualify for Medicaid, we make too much. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, but not all of it. We couldn't get health insurance any other way. We can't do catastrophic plans, we have health conditions. So it hasn't been a Band-Aid for us, it was a lifesaver. When ACA first came out, I was skeptical and wouldn't even look. Then my husband went into the hospital for 21 days. A whole had started in his colon and it was almost completely torn through, but we got there in time and he sat there for 21 days getting pumped full of strong antibiotics. And that bankrupted us. And then I signed up for the ACA and I wanted to kick myself because for four years we went without it and we could've not filed bankruptcy Had we had it I know there are people that still are falling through the cracks. Because you have to make some money to get ACA but there is also the subsidy cliff. It literally saved us. Why do people don't realize that those extended subsidies also opened up ACH to a lot of people that would have otherwise not qualified. I'm all happy to help people but it's like now people don't want the means test applied at all. The ACA is going back to its original rules. No, I do not want people to see their premiums quadruple and more, but it simply going back to what it was before Covid and it still insured around 14 million people. That may be nothing to you, but it was our literal lifeline. We either get help with healthcare or my husband goes on disability. He doesn't want that, he enjoys working. But he needs his medication and access to his doctors to keep doing that. It may be a Band-Aid for some, but it wasn't for us"

— obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nqibrvo/

"I really cannot fathom this mindset... The premium tax credit forms are *confusing*, so shit, I guess my only options are to go without healthcare that I need or to pay premiums that I absolutely can't afford! What should I do??? Like bro you should figure it the fuck out and get the tax credit. This system was designed for every idiot in America, I'm sure you can manage it if you put your mind to it. Go ask Claude for help if you need to."

— HealthInsurance · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wenhgc/just_got_booted_from_my_insurance/p9fj2j4/

"62f small business owner (sole proprietor). Located in GA, which has its own exchange. AGI \$38,000 after schedule C write-offs. This year I pay \$38/mo, \$3600 MOOP, silver plan. \$15 copay for PCP, \$15 copay for mental health weekly (therapy), \$30 copay specialist. My colon ruptured out of the blue June 18. Emergency abdominal surgery, 10 days in hospital. The main hospital bill was \$90,000, my portion was \$10. I owe the surgeon \$800 and the hospital another \$3500, which I'm paying \$191/mo on a payment plan. The govt subsidy on my '24 taxes was \$816/mo. I have no idea what '26 will look like for my monthly premium. I certainly can't afford \$800+/mo! And I can't go without insurance 😞 "

— obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh749pf/

"It's the extended tax credits, for those above 400% of poverty level. Biden raised the subsidy cliff and that is scheduled to expire this year. It would shut out people above that level for any subsidy. For example I believe 400% is around \$80,000 for two people. So my husband and I right now pay \$527 a month for our plan on \$72k of income. If our small business became more profitable or if I work more, we would be shut out. Our plan is \$2800 a month without the subsidy. That's unsustainable. For lower income persons on the marketplace the loss of enhanced subsidies will mean that many of the Silver plans with cost sharing and zero to no premium will go up substantially. This will disproportionately affect Medicaid non expansion states where ACA enrollment is high. It will have a tremendous impact on a lot of folks."

— obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1kminjg/obamacare_in_trouble/msawz3h/

Paying the subsidy back at tax time · 30 documents

"Oops..incurred significant LT capital gains and now being asked to pay back subsidy for 2025. Can anything be done? I am retired at 54 filing jointly and our only income is through investments and dividends. I didn't think about the income estimate for my healthcare plan / subsidy in December when I sold some long terms stocks to reset my cost basis and take advantage of the 0% tax on LTCG. As I am now doing my taxes, I am being asked to pay back nearly \$10,000 in subsidies that I received through the year. Any ideas on how to reduce the MAGI and offset gains to future years? Thanks!"

— obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rzuj96/oopsincurred_significant_lt_capital_gains_and_now/

"Paying for ACA (Obamacare) We're about to go on ACA with no subsidies, it'll be about \$20k a year, \$1600 a month. [Healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov/>) hands the billing off to the insurance carrier (e.g., Blue Cross, Oscar, United, Kaiser). Does anyone have experience using a credit card for full yearly prepayment, or split monthly payments (for example using multiple cards to split the monthly payment) with specific carriers?"

— HealthInsurance · 13 upvotes · None

"Is it beneficial to slightly overestimate projected income, to avoid possibly having to pay back subsidies at tax return time? I am trying to get ready to pull the trigger and retire at 62.5 years old. I plan to calculate my income from my Roth IRA (and a tiny part time job). Is it safer to slightly overestimate my income when signing up for ACA, to hopefully avoid the potential of having to pay back anything if I go over what I projected?"

— obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, than 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and than switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

"pleasant surprise but want no surprise in tax planning re aca just finished with my 2025 taxes and i will be getting a massive refund while i was expecting to owe a small check to irs 2025 was my full year of r/fire : i have no w2 income and relied on my investment dividends, tax free interests. i fired in mid 2024; so i had half year of w2 income and when i enrolled for aca in late 2024 for 2025 plans i wasn't sure what to put in my income and i only put in estimated total for qualified dividends and omitted (tax free municipal) interest which made a big chunk of my total cash for the year. i believe that i got subsidized aca rate for 2025. later in 2025 during my tax planning session i understood that i was to include tax free interest when enrolling aca. as a result i anticipated that i would be repaying the aca subsidies when i file 2025 return. but i was getting a big tax credit instead; my refund has been approved. when looking over the return i can see that a large portion of the refund is labeled medical and i didn't itemized any medical expenses; i only included the "standard" (i forgot the form number now) sent by aca does anyone understand this? for 2026 enrollment my aca premium is big and totally unsubsidized i believe because i enter a bigger (including tax free interest) income compared to 2025. should i expect at least some credit when 2026 return is filed?"

— obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sx0pb6/pleasant_surprise_but_want_no_surprise_in_tax/

"Yes, and that was the huge benefit of the Enhanced Tax Credit. I had to pay back the APTC 2 years in a row, almost \$60k total for family of 4 at the time, because went over MAGI by about \$2k both years. After the 2nd year it all but wiped out our savings."

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wjwjed/planning_to_retire_at_62_have_you_priced_the_3/pakbti3/

"Yea, this was my situation last year. I lost my job due to a health issue and had to enroll with a marketplace plan. I had no clear indicator on what my income was going to be for the full year - as it wasn't clear when I would be returning to work. I hadn't yet made 15k (FPL) for the year, but on my estimate for income I just assumed I'd be out of work for 2 months and calculated that way. Figured that if I went back to work earlier, or got a better job - I'd just pay them the difference on my taxes. But after 4 major surgeries, I didn't work again at all last year (meaning I did not earn enough to 'qualify' for the program and would need to pay back the subsidies in their entirety if this provision was in place). After a couple months, I attempted to apply for short term disability, but was delayed/denied repeatedly. Under this provision, I would have ended up owing \$6,000+ on my taxes in addition to all of my other financial hardships."

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0yyfl6/

"Going into my fourth month without a job. I need to cancel my plan if i reach 6 months of no work right? i lost my job in December and thought id find a job by february but rhings fell through. its been really difficult finding a new job and i feel hopeless I'll find one soon. im scared I'll have to pay back if i exceed 6 months without a job so its recommended i cancel then right? then if i find a job I'll have to wait until enrollment but better than paying this shit back without having \$\$"

— obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sigc4v/going_into_my_fourth_month_without_a_job_i_need/

"I also have an income that fluctuates. During previous ACA enrollments, we are asked to provide estimated income for the upcoming year to determine tax subsidy eligibility. When I file my taxes a year later, (and include the data from my 1095-A form) any deviation in my estimated income will result in a change to my tax liability. If for some reason I made more than what my estimated income was, I will pay back that portion/percentage of the tax subsidy(and vice versa if I make less). The BBB has changed it to any income overage over the estimated income given upon application will trigger a FULL repayment of the ENTIRE subsidy. I'm having difficulty even finding information on what the subsidies will be next year when they expire. Let alone what the actual policy costs are jumping up to."

— obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mbsi9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/n5p4pr7/

"Need clarification on underestimating income I plan on enrolling my mother in law for 2026 but not sure how to approach her income. I had spoken to broker and I was informed she should show 22k before deductions to get tax credit for 2026. Before I was able to show her income as 2400 a year and get the aca credits. I read posts saying that the repayments of credits are for those who overestimate income not underestimate. Also read the other way around. If I were to sign her up saying her income projected is 22k but let's say at end of 2026 it's 3k. Since the income was underestimated will she need to payback the subsidies? she doesnt qualify for medicaid because she been in USA 2.5 years and you need to be living 5 years to qualify for that"

— obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Filed for divorce in July. Wife refuses to sign joint return. Is there a way to not pay back subsidy? Been using marketplace for a number of years. Filed for divorce July 2025. Wife is refusing to sign joint return. Is there a way for me to file and retain the subsidy? If not will I be responsible for 50% and my wife be responsible for 50%? Any advice is appreciated."

— obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rt6ha2/filed_for_divorce_in_july_wife_refuses_to_sign/

"I'm adding to what Seaweed said in their post. I'm in a similar situation to you. I've been able to play with my assets to keep my income below 400%. Also, I only use about half my ACA credit so I don't have to worry about a repayment. Then at tax time, I receive the additional premium credit which helps fund the next year's monthly premium."

— obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/o7kq8hw/

"ACA. It's not that big a deal to estimate your income; just do your best and set some extra money aside in case you owe at tax time. Or if you prefer, estimate on the high end for your income and file for a refund at tax time. Going "straight through private companies" doesn't mean you're getting real, normal insurance direct from the source. It just means you're getting subpar, non-compliant insurance that leave you with few protections. I didn't understand this when I first had to get my own insurance. I called BCBS directly, because it's the insurance I had with my previous employer, and I wanted a quote for "what I had before." They sent me straight to healthcare.gov for their ACA plans."

— HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wkwkbf/looking_for_affordable_health_insurance/paz8zn7/

"marketplace, healthcare, overlap, tax, implications... I am not sure this is the right sub Reddit for my question but hopefully someone can help or shed light on my situation. it's pretty simple. I recently started a new job after working for a small business and purchasing my own independent insurance for many years. I did not select my new employer sponsored insurance plan until August 31 of this year even though I was hired July 1 of this year. I assumed that coverage began September 1 but upon completion of paperwork, realize it started August 1. I'm not really sure how that's possible but that is what my plan states. So, I didn't know I had to cancel my marketplace plan immediately and somehow thought that they just canceled each other out. That sounds really stupid when I say it out loud, but I thought if I got one coverage, it would just terminate the other coverage, but I realize now it does not work that way. So now when I get my 1095 a at the end of the year, it will show that I had a Marketplace plan with high discount for all of Aug and 9 days of Sept (unless I'm stuck with the whole month of September as well. It depends if they can prorate the days.) that I technically did not qualify for. I'm essentially on the hook for the contributed amount, correct? I don't qualify for the discount. I just don't understand why I have to pay back that money if I didn't use the plan (or can't because the other insurance is primary and Trump's the marketplace plan) because all of my appointments and prescriptions are gonna be rerun through the new insurance. I was told I had to do that manually regardless. Does anything I'm saying have truth to it? Am I missing something? if I do everything correctly and go through any insurance claim for an appointment or prescription during that timeframe to have my primary insurance run and pay the difference, what are my tax implications? If I do none of that, what are my tax implications? Does it eventually catch up to me or do I have to deal with it at the end of the year in some way shape or form? TLDR: I had marketplace insurance as well as employer sponsored insurance that overlapped. What happens on my 1095 a when it comes time to pay taxes? Will I suffer an expensive payback situation for credits that I received at the same time as my other plan was active? I mean expensive is relative. I think the credits are like maximum \$500 a month so if I was charged for two months it would be about \$1000. it's an extra thousand dollars that I don't have to put towards health insurance though."

— obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wdgszl/marketplace_healthcare_overlap_tax_implications/

"I assume your MAGI of 61250 is getting you the basic subsidies (MAGI up to 400% of poverty level) reducing the plan from \$800/mo+. I also assume that while you might have some of your income set aside for basic health care expenses, were you to encounter a major emergency, the \$21k OOP max would NOT come from your income. Meaning you're doing one of a few things 1) spending a well-funded HSA; 2) using cash you have lying around; or 3) would sell investments to cover the costs. IF you're doing #3, be very careful because depending on what you liquidate and how, if net proceeds from those liquidations put you over the subsidy CLIFF (around 84K - or \$23k above your expected MAGI), you will be repaying ALL those subsidies in early 2027!"

— obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v4frri/seems_like_a_good_deal_to_me_what_am_i_missing/ozb3r42/

"You should work with an insurance broker (no charge to you). I quit my job at 62 and I qualified for a low premium plan (with the ACA subsidies). What you qualify for/subsidies are based on your taxable income and not assets. Unfortunately costs went way up this year but probably still far less expensive than COBRA. I'll be on Medicare in a few months but I still have to make sure my taxable income for the entire year is low so I don't have to pay back the subsidies for the 1st half of the year. I am grateful for savings and the ability to pull from Roth investments to keep the annual income low enough."

— obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1so1ega/62_no_insurance/ogg9pki/

"I agree that there is no repayment limit over 400%, but whether the subsidy is almost gone would depend on the premium for the SLCSP in OPs county, so very age dependent. In my area, a 2 person tax household, both age 60, making exactly 600% of FPL in 2025 still qualified for \$1152 a month in subsidy. At age 40, it is only \$83 a month."

— obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rkj61c/obamacare_400_fpl/o8lq2a5/

"What, are you saying that if I estimate my income at \$20k 4-5 months before I even have my taxes done and it actually is 14k that I would have to pay back the subsidies? How the hell is that fair, we are talking about making \$14k, am I missing something?"

— obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n18jelr/

"Help with ACA If anyone could help me with this, I'd really appreciate it. My family of 4 (me, my wife, and 2 adult children 21 and 23, both in college), are on ACA/Obamacare. I'm employed but as an independent hourly IT contractor through my LLC (no benefits, paid weekly and pay quarterly taxes). My wife does not work. My gross income this year will be around \$134,000 (I expected \$125,000 and put that down as my income in 2026 and received the tax credits). But both my children were able to get paid internships over the summer. My older kid probably made about \$16K and the younger one about \$12K (both put the money towards student loans). We didn't anticipate this when we signed up for the ACA. Since this puts us at \$162,000, well over the \$128,000 (400% FPL for family of 4), what can I do to avoid having to repay a huge sum due to being over the threshold? I have an IRA and 401K and my wife also has one from the years she did work. Should I set them up for my kids too? Thanks for any advice."

— obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wq33vw/help_with_aca/

"subsidizing their education means the taxpayer is on the hook for universities who are going to raise their prices even further when the taxpayer test is presented to their ravenous mouths But even beyond that doctors are not going to suddenly be onboard with earning \$75,000/year just bc they don't have student loans to repay. You're within your rights to believe doctors should be forced to provide public service but you'd only see that there would be many fewer doctors for a while until they import tens of thousands more from countries with even less scrupulous education standards than here"

— obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1shtrhy/obamacare_is_a_temporary_structure_universal/ofggbyl/

Going without coverage and hoping nothing happens · 72 documents

"My family's health insurance is set to go from \$170 per month in 2025 to \$1560 in 2026 due to expiring ACA credits. A few clarifying points: - I earn approx \$125k as the sole provider for my family of 4 - I am self employed - This is the cheapest possible plan I could find anywhere - Coverage for this plan is terrible and helps me exactly \$0 with our family's actual health expenses I don't even know how I'm supposed to form thoughts around this. I can barely breathe let alone wrap my mind around this. How the hell am I supposed to survive in this country the way it is now? It seems like the world is actively punishing people who have families, or anyone who is not a multimillionaire. This is just one problem in a cornucopia of financial disasters handed to me as a millennial parent. This is not even mentioning how the new student loan rulings will add hundreds of dollars per month of financial burden, nor how I will forever be priced out of the housing market and am doomed to ever increasing rent month after month, or how food costs have practically doubled for my family over the past 5 years. How bad is it to go without health insurance in the new year? I literally have no idea what else to do..."

— HealthInsurance · 776 upvotes · None

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · None

"What you can do if your marketplace premiums for 2026 are too high I've seen this topic come up in recent weeks and want to offer some advice for folks on marketplace plans with premium hikes. This could also work for folks with employer group plans. I realize that this won't work for everyone in every situation but if you've come to a place where you need to consider alternative ways to approach your healthcare costs, this may be helpful. 1. switch to the least expensive marketplace ACA-compliant bronze-level high deductible HSA-eligible insurance plan to cover only catastrophic events like hospitalization. Use this the way you would use your car insurance: sparingly or not at all. Note that going without insurance is a very, very bad idea for reasons that are covered in this sub on a regular basis. 2. Open and contribute to an HSA to get tax savings on money you'll spend toward medical expenses. 3. SKIP DENTAL AND VISION INSURANCE. Honestly this applies to everyone on marketplace plans but dental and vision "insurance" are just glorified payment plans. They are not regulated the same way as ACA health insurance plans so insurers are allowed to charge premiums on those products that guarantee profit margins > 20%. Instead, work with your favorite local dentist and optometrist to pay directly for all your services, and put the money you would have spent on these premiums into your HSA. 4. If you need care: 4a. If you are someone who needs more than 1-3 office visits a year, shop around for a direct primary care provider in your area. Memberships for these are generally pretty reasonable when you factor in what you might have spent toward premiums on a silver or gold tier marketplace plan. 4b. Google specialty care options. For example, Cove offers a monthly membership for treatment of migraines that, when you add it up, is less expensive than a single trip to the neurologist plus a monthly RX from Walgreens. Companies like this exist for nearly everything. 4c. Become a smart shopper for your rxs. There are so many options outside of traditional insurance that can help you save money: GoodRx, Mark Cuban Cost Plus, LillyDirect, Hers/Hims, Nurx. 4d: Think of memberships you may already have that come with pharmacy or healthcare benefits: Costco is an obvious one but comb through other areas of your life. For example, my electric company is a co-op and offers members a discount program for dental, prescriptions, and gym memberships. 4e. Ask your current providers about direct pay arrangements. If you're paying \$200/month in premiums so that your therapist is in-network, but your therapist will happily take \$150 cash per monthly session, you'll come out \$50/month ahead by paying directly. If anyone has other suggestions, because I'm sure I've missed plenty, add them!"

— HealthInsurance · 372 upvotes · None

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · None

"HDHPs suck if you actually need them. Because our subsidy expired, we are now paying \$1200 a month for 2 people for a bronze plan with an \$8000 deductible per person. CO, both 52, \$160k income. We went from \$1200 buying us great gold coverage to \$1200 and paying for our own care literally overnight. As it happens, for a bit of uterine bleeding, I actually need the insurance this year. All of the procedures I need – ultrasound, biopsy, and hysteroscopy – are subject to the deductible. And after the deductible, they're only covered at 40% by Select Health. What kind of insurance is this? We're basically paying high premiums for the privilege of paying for our own healthcare. This was the cheapest Obamacare option we could find. Where are all the HDHPs with lower premiums? We worked with a broker, and there weren't any. The contract company that employs my husband had an HDHP where the premium was even higher. At these prices, we can't even afford to fund an HSA. We didn't see any HDHPs on the exchange with premium is less than \$1000 a month. How are people affording this? HDHPs are not a bargain anymore, it seems. We make well over six figures, but since so much of our income is going to healthcare premiums, we have to drain our savings over any healthcare we need. And if you have HDHP insurance, you can't even pay a lower cash price to the facility. You have to pay the higher insurance negotiated price, even if you're paying 100% of the cost. And if I want sedation for these procedures (don't even get me started about how painful in office gynecology is), it's even more expensive. So basically, anything between a well-woman visit (free) and cancer (chemo meets that deductible pretty quick) is going to give you medical debt. This is indescribably unbelievable. Wow, this sucks."

— HealthInsurance · 199 upvotes · None

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · None

"Is It Better to not Have Health Insurance or Choose a Very Expensive Plan? So these are the issues that we're facing if we have to choose a marketplace plan. Would you guys rather risk it and go without, or pay a lot for a plan? Here's my potential plan with a 50k income: BCBS PPO, 700/month, 9800 deductible, 11000 max oop. It would eat up my income, but if I don't have any major surgeries or a trip to the ER, then I'd be fine without. However, I'd hate to be uninsured if something happens. Realistically, what would you do? Can hospitals negotiate the price down if a bill is very expensive?"

— HealthInsurance · 47 upvotes · None

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · None

"I've just realized that my Ambetter ACA plan is dogsh1t First I see a primary care physician who doesn't want to continue to prescribe the maintenance sleep Rx that I have been on for over 30 years, telling me that I should see a psychiatrist. So I call up Ambetter saying this, but what do you know, there are only 3 psychiatrists in the plan, and none of them want to deal with anyone having insomnia issues. I have put in an escalation with healthcare.gov to allow me to get another plan (Blue Cross), which although it is \$300/m more, has my current primary-care physician in network. I have escalated wthis with Ambetter, and they are "working on it:, although they have not found a psychiatrist that will work out. I will be seeing my old doc as self-pay (\$130), also getting the Rx on my own. What the h3ll am I paying the \$80/mo for my plan for such garbage. And the ironic thing is that when I was on Medicaid, my primary-care physician was in network (I still had to pay for my Rx, since Medicaid doesn't pay for that Rx either)."

— obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/

"A freaking nightmare. We have to enroll by Dec. 15 for Jan. 1 effective date. I have a decent silver plan, but the premium will increase by 300 percent without subsidies, which means I will just sign up for a cheaper bronze plan if there is no change by the 15th. People like me don't want to be stuck in a lowered plan if we find out after the 15th that we will get subsidies and we don't want to risk going without insurance for a period. Knowing the GOP, they will deliberately delay this if they are going to offer subsidies just for the opportunity to be cruel."

— obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nghi12x/

"Something is irreparably broken with the way things are right now. No way should my healthy, middle-class family of 5 be expected to pay \$3,000+/month for a high-deductible insurance plan with pitiful coverage that's not accepted by most quality providers. Even if the subsidies are extended, I still have a huge issue with government tax dollars being funneled to health insurance companies to pay for these ridiculously high premiums. We've had to switch to cash pay with no insurance in the past, and cash-pay prices are reasonable, especially as compared to what's billed to insurers."

— obamacare · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oluqzl/thoughts_on_howwhen_the_shutdown_will_end_now/nmkopxl/

"I am in my 50s and cancelled. I have no insurance for the first time in my life and I work fulltime and always have. This is not sustainable. If I get sick I will either lose all of my life savings or die."

— obamacare · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qil7n2/my_premium_went_from_200_to_1500_and_now/o0slhth/

"These tax credits weren't part of the original ACA/Obamacare. They were added during the pandemic and then extended in the Inflation Reduction Act to help lower-middle class families who don't qualify for Medicaid but still struggle to afford the Obamacare premiums. When these tax credits expire people who earn more than ~\$12,00/year but less than ~\$60,000/year (as a single person— the income limits vary based on how much your state hates poor people and your family size) in some states will see an ~80% increase in their health insurance premiums. In most blue states a person earning under ~\$21,000 is eligible for Medicaid but in many red states the income limit for Medicaid eligibility is much lower. So in those states the people who are working at or near minimum wage won't be eligible for Medicaid but also have **really** tight budgets so even the ACA plans are too expensive without the additional tax credits and many will choose to risk being uninsured. This policy change will disproportionately affect those in deep red states that have resisted Medicaid expansion under the ACA because they hate their lower-income citizens (who, I'm sure by total coincidence, also tend to be people of color) and they hate Obamacare for... reasons. Alabama, Georgia, Florida, Mississippi, South Carolina, etc. These expiring subsidies were essentially a way to give Medicaid expansion to those resistant states temporarily during the pandemic and to close the "coverage gap" that exists in the states that hate their own citizens so much they won't take free money from the federal government. So really this is the story of two evils: the evil republicans in the state governments who refuse to expand healthcare coverage for their own citizens and their evil republican colleagues in the federal government who refuse to help the people who have been abandoned by their state representatives. But at least the billionaires will get a tax break! /s"

— obamacare · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1kminjg/obamacare_in_trouble/msamy5r/

"[US] How many of you are going without health insurance? Like everybody else my health insurance almost doubled this year, and I'm honestly not sure I can take another (probably) 20% increase next year. It's to the point where I'm sacrificing contributing to retirement to pay for health insurance (I'm 35, healthy, single and literally have never used my insurance) Are there any options out there other than marketplace for those who are self employed?"

— selfemployed · 23 upvotes · None

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

Plan switched or enrolled without consent · 5 documents

"There are a few parts of this that will cause issues. 1. There were clearly fraudulent brokers who enrolled "fake" people in order to get commissions. It seems like they identified policies that were submitted without a SSN, had never filed a claim, and did not respond to communication. 2. Because of this they are not allowing new brokers/agent to register and enroll people. This is going to cause a massive bottleneck in people who need help enrolling 3. They are adding more hoops to jump through in order to be someones agent and submit applications for them My theory....they are adding hoops and removing resources in order to cause issues with the federal marketplace in hopes to destroy the program or reduce enrollments."

— HealthInsurance · 361 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbm67px/

"My employer fired me after I challenged them of taking me off the health care insurance Hey everyone. I don't normally post stuff like this, but this whole situation has been insane and I could really use some outside perspective. I also want people to know how easily something like this can happen to them and the. The outcome of having health issues later. I worked for a company called Diamond Blade Warehouse (main office in Vernon Hills, IL, with multiple locations around the country). I was with them for almost three years. I left a different job to work there because I thought it'd be a good fit. Like any job, there were parts I liked good people on the sales side, some solid customers , but behind the curtain, it was a mess. I was a commission-based W-2 employee, meaning if I didn't hit commissions, I didn't get paid. No hourly, no base, no nothing. Just straight commission on a W-2... which already didn't sit right, but I needed the income. Earlier this year, out of nowhere, I was told I'd be switched to 1099. No paperwork, no conversation, no explanation. Just "you're 1099. "They just wanted the "benefits" of a contractor without actually making me one. Then on September 3rd, 2025, I got an email from accounting saying my health insurance coverage would end because they weren't applying my wages to the premium anymore. I replied, politely, that I wanted to keep my coverage and would pay out of pocket. I even jokingly said " I think you'd have to fire me to take away my benefits like that." Within ONE HOUR, my company email was disabled and I got a text message saying I was being terminated for "low sales." Convenient timing, right? And here's where it gets even worse. That same day, the COBRA plan administrator sent me a COBRA election notice that looked like it was printed off Google Images, wrong dates, wrong termination info, wrong deadlines. I tried responding, but their spam blocker was set so strict that my replies bounced. I literally had to switch email accounts just to contact them. They sent me a second COBRA notice the same day, also wrong. I asked for a corrected one and the administrator replied in ALL CAPS, basically yelling at me, demanding multiple months of payment upfront... even though the dates were wrong. Instead of fixing the spam blocker so I could communicate normally, management started relaying messages through my sales manager via text. It was like a weird game of corporate telephone. Completely unprofessional and honestly, absolutely ridiculous. Then comes the cherry on top: Months earlier, my manager texted me saying that the CFO, Bronwyn Jacobson, "didn't want me on the company's insurance" and was sweating him about it. In mid-August, she asked again if it was "ok to take me off." I never agreed. Two weeks later... terminated. I've already filed a complaint with the U.S. Department of Labor (EBSA) for COBRA violations, ERISA interference, retaliation, and misclassification. They're reviewing everything. I'm physically exhausted, financially strained, and emotionally worn down from dealing with this, but I'm speaking up because people deserve to know what companies pull when they think no one's looking. If any Redditors have advice, legal, emotional, or just practical, on navigating this, please drop it below. And if anyone's been through something similar, you're not alone. This one messed me up, and I don't want it happening to someone else."

— HealthInsurance · 105 upvotes · None

"I don't know if it's changed, but when I was on the marketplace a decade ago, the application hard stopped if you didn't put in an SSN. So how are there applications without SSN's? Which is one problem I have with the statement they made about it. Also, if they identify problematic brokers, why not kick them off but still allow new brokers to sign up especially this close to open enrollment for the year. This is going to cause a restriction and how many agents are allowed to assist people. I feel like this is just going to hurt consumers more than the potentially fraudulent brokers. Usually, when I heard stories about fraudulent brokers signing people up for the marketplace, it wasn't people that never existed. It was people that came to them looking for plans and then they would either back out of getting a marketplace plan and then the broker still just enrolled them, especially if they qualified for a full subsidy or close to a full subsidy. Or they would encourage people to understate their income so that they would get a bigger subsidy and people would be more inclined to sign up and then get surprised at tax time."

— HealthInsurance · 89 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbmia90/

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"This enrollment fraud stuff is very real. I had around 20 clients whose tax returns were stopped for needing a 1095-A from fraudulent enrollments. Usually these folks are less educated people and of course receive significant subsidies, I believe they are systematically targeted for this."

— obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uiunli/hhs_reports_on_aca_exchange_enrollment_in_2026/ounjqie/

A plan they can't use: deductibles and networks · 58 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"Dropping our ACA plan Today is the day my family is dropping our ACA plan. Our options were to stay on our same plan and be financially strained, or switch to a different plan with an absurdly high deductible. Neither option made sense for us. Luckily, my family is healthy right now. I'm just posting this for solidarity with all the other individuals and families in the same boat. Obviously, not having health insurance comes with a risk, but for us, that risk made more sense than continuing to pay into a broken system. We found a Direct Primary Care (DPC) provider near us, so we know we'll at least have basic, and great care. We are exploring other alternatives as well. Oh, and for those of you who are also exiting the marketplace this year, you must proactively do this or you will be automatically re-enrolled. Happy last day to enroll everyone!"

— HealthInsurance · 763 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄 "

— obamacare · 586 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1olp6mh/virginia_aca_rates_posted_today_share_your/

"What you can do if your marketplace premiums for 2026 are too high I've seen this topic come up in recent weeks and want to offer some advice for folks on marketplace plans with premium hikes. This could also work for folks with employer group plans. I realize that this won't work for everyone in every situation but if you've come to a place where you need to consider alternative ways to approach your healthcare costs, this may be helpful. 1. switch to the least expensive marketplace ACA-compliant bronze-level high deductible HSA-eligible insurance plan to cover only catastrophic events like hospitalization. Use this the way you would use your car insurance: sparingly or not at all. Note that going without insurance is a very, very bad idea for reasons that are covered in this sub on a regular basis. 2. Open and contribute to an HSA to get tax savings on money you'll spend toward medical expenses. 3. SKIP DENTAL AND VISION INSURANCE. Honestly this applies to everyone on marketplace plans but dental and vision "insurance" are just glorified payment plans. They are not regulated the same way as ACA health insurance plans so insurers are allowed to charge premiums on those products that guarantee profit margins > 20%. Instead, work with your favorite local dentist and optometrist to pay directly for all your services, and put the money you would have spent on these premiums into your HSA. 4. If you need care: 4a. If you are someone who needs more than 1-3 office visits a year, shop around for a direct primary care provider in your area. Memberships for these are generally pretty reasonable when you factor in what you might have spent toward premiums on a silver or gold tier marketplace plan. 4b. Google specialty care options. For example, Cove offers a monthly membership for treatment of migraines that, when you add it up, is less expensive than a single trip to the neurologist plus a monthly RX from Walgreens. Companies like this exist for nearly everything. 4c. Become a smart shopper for your rxs. There are so many options outside of traditional insurance that can help you save money: GoodRx, Mark Cuban Cost Plus, LillyDirect, Hers/Hims, Nurx. 4d: Think of memberships you may already have that come with pharmacy or healthcare benefits: Costco is an obvious one but comb through other areas of your life. For example, my electric company is a co-op and offers members a discount program for dental, prescriptions, and gym memberships. 4e. Ask your current providers about direct pay arrangements. If you're paying \$200/month in premiums so that your therapist is in-network, but your therapist will happily take \$150 cash per monthly session, you'll come out \$50/month ahead by paying directly. If anyone has other suggestions, because I'm sure I've missed plenty, add them!"

— HealthInsurance · 372 upvotes · None

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today- turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · None

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · None

"Income priced me out of subsidies. General advice requested. I'm 61 and recently retired. My income now prices me out of subsidies. Last year my BCBS Silver plan was \$568/month. Next year this plan would be \$1702/month. I'm 61 with pre-existing conditions. I take 7 prescription drugs. I see my PCP once a year, rheumatologist twice a year, and the occasional orthopedist if needed. Last year I spent \$1489 of my \$5000 deductible. Out of pocket expenses were \$2790 out of \$8000. The marketplace yields 52 total plans for consideration. Given my info above, what general advice would you give to me in selecting a plan. Ex — may as well choose a high deductible plan given my past usage. Any guidance is appreciated. I really liked it when I was employed and had two group plan options!"

— HealthInsurance · 186 upvotes · None

"Why isn't there an inexpensive very high deductible plan? So I've seen "catastrophic" plans on the marketplace and the cost is roughly the same as all the other plans which itself doesn't make sense to me. But why isn't there like a \$50k deductible plan that covers nothing until that amount and costs relatively little? It seems unlikely that one would need 20 days in the ICU or be put back together from a car accident. I realize there are ACA regulations that require preventative care but in theory this could be offered as non-ACA."

— HealthInsurance · 169 upvotes · None

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · None

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

"IL started Get Covered IL last year in anticipation of these subsidies going away. It migrated those already on the marketplace for 2026 and mine only increased by .26 for 2026. I have a high deductible and it's an HMO. When I checked on the marketplace, it would've been \$188 more per month."

— obamacare · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1omsjln/will_large_states_like_california_create_public/nmrqp1n/

"I completely empathize re the cost but I still think it's worth having. I absolutely have to have it because I have a serious illness. I'm 44f. My monthly is \$605 and my deductible is 12k which I will probably hit after a hospital visit last month. It completely sucks but not having it would suck 1000x more. As it is I try so hard to stay out of the hospital. Last week I collapsed in an urgent care because I waited too long to get help. Thankfully it's attached to a hospital so they called a code blue on me and brought me over lickity split. But I was focused on how much it would cost and whether I could get through it myself, not what I reasonably should have been considering. When I was on the floor of the hospital staring at the ceiling I was thinking oops. Guess I let this go too far. But I try hard to avoid it because it's so freggin expensive. That same visit I left AMA because it's so much more expensive if they admit me."

— obamacare · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/ospvrf7/

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the orange clown, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wb6cxw/when_i_dropped_my_health_insurance_the_health/

"That's the reason I only accept to work even with lower pay with a company with health insurance since plans on ACA are outrageous with extreme high deductibles and limited network . They need to have An option where people can purchase Medicare without subsidies at a younger age"

— obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1urupru/aca_insurers_propose_doubledigit_premium_hikes/owj2vkw/

"Getting blood work on ACA plans Not a huge deal in the grand scheme of things, but I generally get blood work once a year, so it's a predictable medical expense. This year it cost \$286 and I had to pay \$36 out of pocket with my employer provided health care plan. My doctor's office has a sign that basically says they test the blood in house but will provide a script if you want it sent to Quest or Lab Corp. When I look at my claims, the provider name is different than my doctor's office despite what the sign says. When I look up those providers, only one insurance company in the marketplace covers those. So I assume that means on the other plans, they would be out of network and I'd have to pay the full cost since they are HMOs and don't cover out of network. Is it possible there will be a discount even though it's out of network? I then looked up Quest on the marketplace, it looks like every city's location is listed and I see some are covered and some aren't with some plans (some don't cover any locations). But I assume I don't have control over which location my blood is sent to. So is there any way to ensure they are going to be covered. Is there any practical tips for how to handle this with the ACA plans or does it just depend on which insurance company we pick and can you figure out which is the best before you sign up?"

— obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vdjrvh/getting_blood_work_on_aca_plans/

"Also using ACA plan; key note are premiums, deductibles and out of pocket max. But I have shopped plans and one or two ER visits or a single surgery/major procedure or chronic illness yearly cost for healthcare ive found an average of 15k to well over 25k. (again yearly!) And thats just whats in network, not always including meds and out of network services including vision and dental being billed separately on many plans. Absolutely abhorrent. We pay so much more for worse healthcare. Where a tax of a fraction of a cost per individual would cover everyone."

— obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/osrrfc0/

"What do you do for Health Insurance? As someone who is self employed, how do you cover insurance? I have a High Deductible Health Plan through the marketplace. My plan this year is over \$1k a month and has a household out of pocket of \$11k before the insurance pays out anything. That means I pay a minimum of \$12k per year. I would have to spend \$23k before any help for medical bills would be provided. 🤔 I don't have a PCP because I'm super healthy & 30 years old and almost never see a doctor. If I do have a reason to visit, I run by a walk in clinic and pay out of pocket. I keep the insurance in case of an emergency, but that is SOOO MUCH MONEY just in case of an emergency. Does anyone have any better options?"

— selfemployed · 10 upvotes · None

"Both my ACA and employer plans have/had an excellent state wide network. Out of state hospitals would be out of network with my "good" employer insurance too."

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o4ov1l/aca_plans_not_accepted_by_leading_hospitals_and/nj3t4ms/

"The problem is how high the damn premiums are. The lowest option for my husband and I without a subsidy is a catastrophic premium of \$1,050 a month with the huge deductible of \$21,200 that pays nothing until we reach the deductible. My husband is our only source of income and he is an independent truck driver. You need folks like him to eat. So is this really how it was intended to work? I seriously doubt it."

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oodemw/aca_the_cliff_is_a_big_issue/nn3vg5t/

"That's how it is for me. The silver plan under Trump now costs \$400 a month for me so I went with bronze this year. My deductible is \$10,000. I can't afford the \$400 a month for silver but can't afford to use the bronze. But I have the cheaper bronze in case I get in an accident or go into the emergency room with appendicitis or something. Absolutely ridiculous this all is. I'm retired, (pathetic pension) work still to supplement my income and my employer offers no healthcare. I still have 8 years until I can get on Medicare."

— obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1twsb7i/dr_oz_says_roughly_35_of_enrollments_are_not_legit/ops96v8/

Lost Medicaid or earn too much for it · 9 documents

"Girlfriend had \$0 monthly premium; now will be \$890. She doesn't make \$700 a month... We're in Alabama. She has BCBS Blue Standardized Silver EPO. I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts. Apparently she is in the "Medicaid gap"... Not entirely sure what to do except tell her to drop it until we can find a better solution, as much as I hate saying that. We weren't planning on getting married, but I'm beginning to consider it so my employer can get her on family coverage under my policy... Next November...."

— HealthInsurance · 780 upvotes · None

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.

💙 "

— HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · None

"When Medicaid work requirements enter, we get 3% of those eligible getting coverage. That's quantifiable. The state of Georgia as a microcosm. Of what's to come. That's reality. Go fuck yourself"

— obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lv1xsc/heads_up_over_half_the_maga_murder_bills/n22ybrd/

"NC - losing medicaid for medically complex child Any moms on here with children on medicaid with congenital heart conditions/complex medical needs? I need your advice... I've just been told my daughter's medicaid won't be renewed even though my income has decreased from last year's renewal period. Marketplace coverage will cost \$600/mo and covers nothing. Her annual tests will cost upwards close to \$7-\$9,000 assuming her conditions stay stable and without issues. I called the tailored plan brokers and they told me it only covers behavioral/developmental conditions and that if our medicaid expires at the end of the month then there's no way she'd qualify. Am I missing any other outlets or resources? My case worker explains nothing as to why we're being rejected even though our income was much higher last year."

— Medicaid · 14 upvotes · None

"So wait, if someone does not actually work or volunteer 80 hours per month, but has enough money sitting in a bank account to generate \$580 per month in interest income, that would be enough to satisfy the Medicaid work requirement? Is this correct?"

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tug9bm/it_appears_that_expansion_medicaid_will_remain_a/opbzwgw/

"Thank you! I'm happy your mom has been able to afford her medicine. It's so sad that we pay so much and get so little in return. I try not to stress about it but fuck it's so hard not too. Then I'm scared it might go up next year and regardless i need my insurance for my family. I make too much for Medicaid I'm stuck in the middle. With my insurance my Ozempic is 800 and Farxiga is 400"

— obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vnce2d/a_shocking_92_percent_of_us_adults_are_not_going/p3ii1am/

"I lost my Medicaid due to this very reason. During Covid, I (and my children) qualified for Medicaid. When the restrictions kicked back in, I was unceremoniously dumped off of it without more than a months notice. I make \$100 over the limit. I applied for ACA, and quite literally cannot afford any of the plans offered. That \$100 I make over the limit? It's not enough to pay for any of the plans offered under ACA. So now I have no health insurance, a chronic illness that requires specialists and prescriptions to keep me from being bed bound, and I'm one serious health complication away from losing my house. We exist and there are a lot of us. Especially those of us that live rurally because we can't afford to live in big cities."

— obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lv1xsc/heads_up_over_half_the_maga_murder_bills/n2bz0c5/

"You can go start a business and not have to worry about insurance. That is not true. Because we own a business. We don't have enough employees to be required to provide health insurance, but without the ACA, my husband would be dead. He inherited a bad heart from both parents. He was in the hospital for 21 days and then about broke his financially, we had just started the business not that long before. The ACA isn't perfect but it's made for people just like me and my husband, we own a small business and we make too much for Medicaid but we can't pay full price for healthcare because it would be about \$3000 a month with a very high deductible. I'm glad to see that there is a red voter here that is willing to discuss and not just fight. That's what we need to be doing and that's what we always did, for hundreds of years. This hatred for each other is getting us nowhere. And we have no reason to hate each other other than which way we vote, it's almost like a form of segregation, oh we hate you because you vote red or we hate you because you vote blue I've lived in blue state and I've lived in a red state. There really isn't that much difference between them. Because that blue state had a lot of red voters and this red state has a lot of blue voters and it was once a swing state. I don't know if healthcare for all is the answer, but I do know we are paying a lot of middlemen a ton of money. And the CEOs of these healthcare industries, they own the pharmacy, benefit manager, they own the pharmacy, they're now starting to buy the doctors practices and they must do all they can to provide for their stockholders , they own every part of health insurance. How is that not a monopoly? Refreshing to talk with you. I know it seems like we are 1,000,000 miles apart, but we are definitely that way if we can't even talk and we haven't been talking for quite a long time. We need to start talking to each other again and not just hating. I have Republican friends, a lot of my friends are republican. There is exactly one couple that we can actually talk politics with without their being any animosity. We have lost one family member to politics, it was my uncle, and when he found out I was a Democrat, which was never hidden, but also never discussed , he would not talk to me. And I really needed him after my mom died unexpectedly. This shouldn't be happening in families or friendships. I could shake your hand through this device I would because we need more rational people on both sides. We may not agree, but we gotta start talking to try to find some middle ground. The politicians sure aren't doing that, it benefits them for us to be so divided. Remember, they work for us, all of us. We managed to make it work for hundreds of years and suddenly we can't talk to each other. I'm middle-aged, 51 years old. I've seen a few politicians. And there is a comment thread, they promised the moon just like in high school government, and we the people need to realize what they feasibly can do or can't do. I know I feel like the government is against the people. And it's not just because my party isn't in the highest office. I'm not happy with my own party. But I'm not happy with yours either."

— obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vs55qt/us_can_afford_universal_health_care_were_already/p4luzz8/

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— obamacare · 1 upvotes · None

Lost the job, COBRA too expensive, early retirement · 56 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"No longer eligible for medicaid I've (26m) had illinois medicaid for the past 3/4ish years. My redetermination period was to be completed by Aug 2025. I've submitted the redetermination letter through mail last month and called the automated number today to check the status for them to tell my benefits have ended because of exceeding income. I've always done the medicaid application/redetermination including my parents in my household with their income (retirement, neither of them work anymore). Prior to this year, only my father had income through retirement. However, this/last year my mother also started getting retirement benefits which apparently pushed the household income past the medicaid income cap for 3 people. So now I am no longer eligible for medicaid. Have I been fucking up this whole time when doing the redetermination including them in my household? They don't have to file taxes because their total income from unemployment benefits is still low enough where they don't have to so I'm not claimed as a dependent or anything. What do I do moving forward? Do I start an entirely new application on the website with only my information and none of my parents'? Or am I screwed now and have to buy health insurance through marketplace now? Edit: Thanks for the replies/help; I'll reapply without their information. Also, I guess I didn't really specify my financial situation in the original post like I thought I did. I left my job a couple months prior to this whole thing. I then moved back in with my parents shortly after and have been living very modestly though my savings. I don't have an income as of this very moment."

— Medicaid · 30 upvotes · None

"Yep; retired at 61 and controlled my MAGI such that I paid \$0 for a Silver plan. Benefit of being conservative over many years and having enough in brokerage / savings to cover expenses, vacations, etc. for four years before Medicare kicked in. (So now I actually pay more (~\$300/mo) for Medicare + plan premium than when on ACA. 🤔)"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpcfE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg>

"Manipulating income for Silver Plan w/ CSR So I've very tentatively looked into early retirement, meaning 5 years before Medicare eligibility and I was just tapping around on an AI asking questions and so I have a question to real people who might know something about this: The AI, Gemini, said that if you keep your income between \$15,060 and \$22,590 that you can get a subsidize silver plan with cost sharing reductions for next to nothing, relatively speaking. First question: is this still a thing, or was the AI trained on old information? Second question: My main source of income before Social Security and a pension would kick in would be income from a Roth IRA. Gemini said that income from a Roth IRA, since it's not taxable, would not count. So I could get a part-time job and earn within the range written above and then get additional income from my Roth IRA and still be eligible for relatively low cost health insurance through a silver plan with cost sharing reductions. Is this true? Thanks."

— obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti1dc8/manipulating_income_for_silver_plan_w_csr/

"Living off Cash (for a few years) I'll be 53 next year, and would like to quit my job and live off saved cash for 3-4 years before potentially rejoining the workforce. Since my income would be \$0 for those years, how would I go about getting health insurance? When I enter estimates in the ACA, they tell me to apply for medicaid. I also own a house that has an estimated value of 500k and have over 500k in retirement, but I don't want to touch the retirement until I'm 59. Would getting health insurance for my 3-4 years "off" be problematic because of my assets? And, would I have to receive medicaid or is there a way to still get a private insurance plan even with no income? I'm not trying to get "free healthcare," but if my income is zero for a few years, do I even have a choice? Thanks,"

— HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · None

"My premium is 2700 month with 16k dollars maximum. So if i break my leg I am only out about 48000 dollars. Hopefully if I break one leg next year I can break 2 legs and second one is free. What a great deal. This is really screwed up. I have to quit my job and get rid of my income. Then premium is only 250 a month. Black market income is what a lot of us will have to find."

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1omjomk/4x_increase_in_premiums/nmqgoz1/

"Yea, this was my situation last year. I lost my job due to a health issue and had to enroll with a marketplace plan. I had no clear indicator on what my income was going to be for the full year - as it wasn't clear when I would be returning to work. I hadn't yet made 15k (FPL) for the year, but on my estimate for income I just assumed I'd be out of work for 2 months and calculated that way. Figured that if I went back to work earlier, or got a better job - I'd just pay them the difference on my taxes. But after 4 major surgeries, I didn't work again at all last year (meaning I did not earn enough to 'qualify' for the program and would need to pay back the subsidies in their entirety if this provision was in place). After a couple months, I attempted to apply for short term disability, but was delayed/denied repeatedly. Under this provision, I would have ended up owing \$6,000+ on my taxes in addition to all of my other financial hardships."

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0yyfl6/

"Ambetter admitting to missing three P2P's and recording inaccurate data I have Ambetter through the ACA marketplace and have been trying since March to get ivabradine (Corlanor) 5 mg approved for Inappropriate Sinus Tachycardia (IST). The medication was denied, so my cardiologist and I started the appeal process. We submitted multiple documents and were repeatedly told some variation of, "We just need one more document and you should be approved." Over the next few months, I received conflicting information from different representatives. One rep told me my doctor never submitted an appeal, while another confirmed that the appeal had been received. I was also repeatedly transferred to an offshore team that often couldn't locate my account or case information and could only read from a script. Eventually, Ambetter told us a peer-to-peer (P2P) review was needed. My doctor scheduled and waited for three separate P2P calls. On each occasion, they reserved two hours of their time and never received a call from Ambetter. When I questioned this, I was initially told that my physician likely missed the calls. After pushing for escalation, I was given a complaint number and promised a callback. No one ever called. I later reached someone on the escalation team who seemed genuinely helpful. He reviewed the case notes and stated that he could see all three missed P2P reviews. He also found documentation indicating that my physician's office had supposedly been contacted before a P2P had even been approved, which didn't make sense chronologically. He told me he had rarely seen a case file this disorganized and said he would immediately contact the pharmacy medical director. After I was on hold for approximately 90 minutes, the call disconnected. The next day, I called back with all of my reference numbers and complaint information. The escalation team transferred me back to the main customer service line. Pharmacy transferred me back to escalation. Escalation then sent me back to the main line again. At one point, the pharmacy representative called for me and was literally transferred back into his own department. To make matters worse, I ended up in the ER during this process and nearly lost my job because my symptoms remained uncontrolled while I fought through these delays. At this point, I'm preparing to file a complaint with my states Department of Insurance. My physician's office has documentation of the missed P2P appointments. Has anyone dealt with anything similar with their insurance? Beyond filing with the state and pursuing external review, is there anything else I should be doing? I pay \$550 a month for just me. TL:DR: My insurance has no internal workflow/communication, recorded inaccurate data, and has no actual escalation team. I'm at a loss of how to navigate other than filing with the state."

— HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · None

"I wasn't anticipating making a lot when I quit my job. So I got the government subsidized health insurance and then towards the end of the year I got a new client and made a lot of money and did not make any changes. Low and behold, I owe the government approximately \$2500 back when I filed my taxes"

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed I TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=UgwC9G5F_HnwoQXN6lh4AaABAq

"Actually, before the BBB, I was on Medicaid, and I wasn't working, and had a 7-figure net liquid wealth. There are a lot of early retirees - at least the ones that had taken the cheese and done big Roth IRA conversions - who were doing this. Instead, I'm on an ACA plan that is worse than Medicaid, and that costs the feds more."

— obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1u7ye86/youre_not_put_on_this_pla_net_to_sit_at_home_and/os55gew/

"Covered california. I always supported aca for the pre existing conditions alone. Never thought i would need it but when i got laid off in 2019 i used it for 6 months because Cobra was ridiculous and unaffordable."

— obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o5lrn3/the_media_is_reporting_maj_ority_of_people_on_the/njcf5yg/

"I'm 58, I've had 4 different types of cancer. I have all sorts of health issues and can't work. My pension is \$558 per month after 27 years at a company. Can't get disability for a couple of years. My 62 year old husband has been laid off from 4 jobs in the last 6 years and I suspect he's getting laid off again within the next year. SS and our pensions won't be enough to live on and we're too young for Medicare. Won't be able to afford the Marketplace premiums either if he gets laid off. I'd like to leave the country but I don't think any country will admit me due to my health. We don't seem to have any options other than being uninsured."

— obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mbsi9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/n5q2ego/

"Going into my fourth month without a job. I need to cancel my plan if i reach 6 months of no work right? i lost my job in December and thought id find a job by february but rhings fell through. its been really difficult finding a new job and i feel hopeless I'll find one soon. im scared I'll have to pay back if i exceed 6 months without a job so its recommended i cancel then right? then if i find a job I'll have to wait until enrollment but better than paying this shit back without having \$\$"

— obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sigc4v/going_into_my_fourth_month_without_a_job_i_need/

"I retired at 47 and the ACA subsidies are returning to exactly the way they worked then. I surely didn't expect the enhanced subsidies to become permanent. I would love it if they did, but people who pursue early retirement have a plan for maximizing subsidies and this shouldn't be a major hurdle for them. Keeping your MAGI low as an early retiree isn't particularly hard and should have been planned for. I'm still hoping for the return of the enhanced subsidies as they make a lot more sense. The cliff was always such a terrible part of the original ACA."

— obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oodemw/aca_the_cliff_is_a_big_issue/nn3h71t/

"Come On! There's no incentive not to work. This is a complaint on Overall Healthcare. Been to the doctor lately? They're now working for metrics, google reviews and not for the patients. You can thank Private Equities for this pivot. Seriously, I don't think you have researched this issue enough. I have, having used the subsidy while I applied for jobs in between jobs. Let's Have Medicare For All and take out the insurance and middleman. Oh and the venture capitalists who now own 96% of all providers we rely on, especially in an emergency."

— obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wnlono/trump_officials_eject_7500_00_from_obamacare/pbjukri/

"Democrats should run on universal healthcare, despite the pushback they'll get from health insurance companies. Our healthcare system is absurd. Just consider FSAs. You have to estimate your health expenditure for the year to get a tax advantage? That is so ridiculously complex! I early retired last year and paid \$1k per month, just for myself, to continue my coverage. I don't think many people could afford that. This year the ACA is making my health insurance more affordable, but the whole system is just so stupid."

— obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qxil1k/us_healthcare_needs_fixing_but_theres_no/o3xpcvq/

"The ACA was not ever intended for early retirement, so the pain of the enhanced subsidies going away is really self inflicted. Having said that I was really hoping the enhanced subsidies would be extended for the current early retirees but also the ACA was my plan. Now I will just think of another way!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzNb723lBr-pBKrcyJ4AaABAg

"This is what I'm doing. I'm retiring at 60 (right around the corner). We recently stopped contributing to 401k and are stockpiling cash instead. This and other non-taxable or low-taxable assets will supplement our income before 65 so we will draw less from pre-tax retirement accounts, keeping AGI below the cliff level (~84,000/couple). ACA premiums will be \$700/month instead of \$3,000/month. I think we can swing this for at least two years, so, COBRA first 18 months, then this for two years, then might have to suck it up and pay the full ACA premiums. Unless Dems are able to restore the subsidies, which might change the equation."

— obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1woyyo6/for_people_retiring_before_65_how_are_you/pbrf0s3/

"Prior to the ACA, I was diagnosed with Menieres Disease and lost my job as a firefighter. Because I lost my job, I lost insurance. I could no longer afford the physical therapy I needed to regain my balance. I also had to go to the health department for birth control (I was newly married) and because I couldn't afford blood pressure meds they wouldn't let me have the pills that worked best for the PCOS. So I took what they gave me, thinking it wouldn't matter much. It did. It screwed up my system so bad that I gained 70 lbs, and it made the PCOS so bad that several years later, when we did have insurance again, we found out I was infertile. Now I have an autoimmune disorder, am obese, have Menieres, PCOS and a host of other issues that I could have followed up on or gotten checked out had we not gone 5 years with no coverage. (My husband's work didn't have insurance, and the high-risk pool would have been 3/4 of our take-home pay a month). My husband is now a diabetic. This means I am functionally trapped in my job until I'm like 68. You know over 20 more years. I can't get to where I can't work, or he will lose coverage. On top of that, we were never able to have kids. So indirectly, our health care system redirected our lives with a miserable, but not fatal illness. I was so happy when the ACA passed, and sickened when I heard family talk about how they didn't want "all those sick people" running up the costs. I AM one of those sick people...."

— obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lz67ob/reminder_what_life_was_like_before_affordable/n3659ba/

Lead Sources

HealthCare.gov or the state exchange · 41 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise... what do I do? 27F, entry level job after graduating college, trying to buy a house and start a family. Bit of a rant here... You saw the title. My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise. I am flabbergasted. I can't afford to pay over \$200/month more for my health insurance because I make an extra \$160/month?!?! In what world does that make sense?! There is a PCP in my area that does not take insurance, but provides most of the services I require for a \$90/month subscription. It's what I want to go with. They suggested I go with a catastrophic health plan in case of car wreck, etc. He said it should be about \$90/month. When I researched catastrophic health plans, the lowest premium is over \$200/month. I can't afford this AND pay rent AND pay car payment AND pay car insurance AND pay all my other bills AND save money for house/ children/ emergencies. It's safe to say I'm panicking. I payed the insurance for January but I couldn't save anything. I can't keep this plan. I'm currently feeling very defeated by a system that seems to be set up to keep the majority down... I'm so tired of this. Where is universal healthcare? What should I do? Where can I find a catastrophic health plan for around \$100 a month?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 137 upvotes · None

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · None

"GA here. I'm a very blue person(mood as well lately 😞) in a sea of red trump people. Just saw my new premium last night. Ours tripled. From \$229 a month to \$668. Admittedly, my husband is in the process of retiring, and I haven't plugged in our new numbers yet. But just wanted to give an example. Our state has implemented "GA Access?" For our insurance. But it's still Marketplace I believe and it still went up. I was diagnosed with triple negative breast cancer last year. I am done with active treatment and NED, for now 🙏 I'm so very thankful for Presidents Obama and Biden whose policies gave me a chance at survival. We are still paying on my lingering bills, and will be for a while. But I'm still so thankful to them. I've cried both times the current person was elected. What a horrible person. Through and through. Obama, I miss you so much. Joe, I hope you are successful with your cancer treatments and I thank you for your service as well."

— r/obamacare · 81 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1og3h64/the_new_aca_costs_are_coming_in/nle10fq/

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

"ACA rates went down for us?? My wife and I have used healthcare.gov for 4 years now. This past year our rates were \$620 a month. We just Checked and according to healthcare.gov our new rates for the same insurance (ambetter gold tier) is \$295 a month. I was expecting it to rise substantially. We are in Arkansas, 63 and 61 yrs old. Anyone else see a decrease???"

— r/HealthInsurance · 30 upvotes · None

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"Total healthcare coverage for everyone would be simple. Just switch everyone to Medicare with Plan G. Charge a flat rate and the money would be there and the insurance companies would be cut off at the knees from their current theivery of our money and our tax money thru subsidies. They currently get BILLIONS of dollars in subsidies to cover people. Thru the ACA AND thru the Medicare Advantage plans. That money would be better spent just covering everyone and cut out the damn middle man. The flat fee could be something very small like maybe 50 dollars. Or if that sounds too simple, put it on a sliding scale. or Use the IRMA rule. But this has been so obvious to me since I started getting coverage thru the marketplace and found out that my subsidy is about 1400 a MONTH that taxes are being paid to these scammers. And I have to jump thru all sorts of hoops to just get a damn test."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwKReZ8eEKFhxX5ehx4AaABAq>

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · None

"Some people have a low literacy level. Or aren't proficient in English. Or have a mental disability. Or lack access to the Internet. Or just find selecting an ACA marketplace plan to be confusing. I have a bachelor's degree. I've been a SNAP and Medicaid eligibility worker for over a decade. I still found it difficult to assist my daughter with choosing a marketplace plan, and figuring out which plan would be best for her needs."

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbns7id/

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · None

Employer / COBRA / spouse's plan · 27 documents

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come of it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · None

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · None

"ACA healthcare made it possible for me to retire. I keep my taxable income low and receive Gov subsidies on premiums. I consider the subsidies getting back some of the taxes I paid into the systems for the last 48 years. I had employer healthcare insurance for 30 years and never used one penny of it. Insurance companies made a mint off of my employer and me for decades. I never went to the Doctor until I turned 60 when I got Covid."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgzT3TgVH2azwWzdsxx4AaABAq>

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"I just talked to my Insurance broker last week (I'm on Cobra until 2/2027). FYI, the ACA only has HMO plans, no more PPO plans, she told me. I can't find any doctors who take the HMO plans, even the top tier ones."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwScHrO5XRAM7MD7Cp4AaABAq

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

"Covered california. I always supported aca for the pre existing conditions alone. Never thought i would need it but when i got laid off in 2019 i used it for 6 months because Cobra was ridiculous and unaffordable."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o5lrn3/the_media_is_reporting_majority_of_people_on_the/njcf5yg/

"I wish employers would get on board and put pressure on govt to reform the system too. Half of Americans rely on employer-sponsored healthcare. And employers, in their never-ending drive to save a buck and provide a bigger dividend to their shareholders (rather than actually innovate and produce like we used to) have been continually cutting health benefits for at least the last twenty years (my working adult years.) Premiums go up every year, percentage of cost shifted to employees grows every year, employees are made to jump through more hoops to get their spouse and children covered, covered services are reduced each year. Lately I've experienced employers offering to reimburse employees 20-30% of the cost of ACA insurance rather than offering their own sponsored plan. Further removing healthy people from the system and driving up costs. I get that business is competitive. But if this employer-sponsored healthcare system is unsustainable for employers, then they Also need to be lobbying for healthcare for all. It takes a Huge burden off the employers, who have to spend hours and effort every year reviewing and rolling out new plans. It allows them to shift at least some of their savings to higher wages, leading to happier and less-stressed employees. Another portion of savings could be pivoted to actual innovation and real production as opposed to paper profits that only benefit shareholders and CEOs. Plus happier and healthier employees are shown to be more productive for their employers, leading to more growth and greater future revenue. More retention, less turnover = more \$ Happy, healthy employees = more \$ How can we have so many gd MBAs in this country yet no exec can figure this out?!"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p24ajw/universal_care/npv3rvm/

"Question about tax credit Excuse some of my ignorance because I only switched to ACA plan for my family of 3 about six months ago after switching employers. I didn't pay a lot of attention to it before because I was on a workplace health plan for 10+ years, so Ive been playing catch up. My wife and I are both commission workers so I had to estimate our income when first applying. It came out to about 102k/year, and it seemed that I was told that we did not qualify for the APTC, although now I see that the limit is 106k. Our final gross income from 2025 may end up being lower than my estimation. It's possible that I was confused but I'm currently paying 700\$/mo right now, and my plan is going up to around 840\$/mo next year, but the eligibility summary is telling me that I actually am eligible for up to 247\$/mo from the APTC (as well as currently eligible, I think?). So I guess my question is, I am I think understanding now that the tax credit is only going away for those making over 400% of the federal poverty line, does that mean that I could still claim the 247\$/mo next year, as was as retroactively claim it for the previous 6 months or so when I do my taxes next year? I currently am not receiving any advanced payments. Thanks, sorry if this is a dumb basic question I should know already, but just trying to understand better."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Too many people and corporations profiting from healthcare to ever get universal healthcare. We spend more than every other developed country and are not in the top 5 for quality of care. The costs keep going up and we keep paying. The ACA might have been better if it wasn't gutted before it got passed. I went from 100% employer paid healthcare when I started working, to paying over \$2,000 a year for insurance that barely covers anything until I hit a \$2,000 deductible. I heard some people have family plans with \$8,000 deductibles or more and monthly premiums ridiculously high. I hear people knock "Obama care", but for millions of people it's their only option."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lgk8y8/rfk_jr_is_making_it_more_difficult_to_enroll_in/myzqc9m/

"Family currently on ACA but spouse got new job with healthcare but too expensive for family plan - please advise We are currently on a family health insurance plan on the ACA with generous subsidies (have been for several years now) as my spouse's old employer didn't offer insurance (I'm self employed and we have a kid in college). The business is closing so my spouse found a new job that offers insurance. They only offer one plan and it seems like decent insurance as it's better than what we have. The issue is that it's not affordable at all for all 3 of us to be on. For just my spouse it's around \$280ish per month but when adding all 3 of us that balloons to almost \$1900 per month which is insane to me:(After doing some research (thanks internet) it sounds like my wife pretty much has to take the insurance for herself as it shows as being affordable for us when using the online calculators. Of course when adding all of us on the employers insurance it comes back as not affordable. It doesn't make sense for my spouse to not take the employer insurance as doing so would cause us to lose the ACA subsidies it sounds like. Can my wife take the insurance from her employer and our kid and I stay on our ACA plan? I'm not sure we she can get on the employer's insurance immediately or if there is some sort of waiting period. We will have to find that out as maybe she can't sign up until 2027? Her new job also comes with a nice pay bump but it sounds like her income would still need to be included in the ACA subsidy calculation even though she would no longer but on an ACA plan correct? If so, the subsidy we currently receive would drop quite a bit but something is better than nothing I guess and it would still be way cheaper than having the 3 of us on her employer plan. It sure seems like her employer is subsidizing some of her insurance premium but not for any other family members - I guess that's par for the course these days? I think I have it correct in what we need to do here but I guess we need to get her all signed up for employer healthcare before dropping her from the ACA plan. Her income increase will most likely change our ACA subsidy amount for the rest of the year but I'll reconcile that at tax time I guess. Also we also get our dental benefits through the ACA but I believe my wife's new job offers dental but we didn't see any mention of it in the portal we were in. To be fair though, we backed out of the portal once we saw the pricing for the family plan, lol. If they do offer dental through her employer I would assume she's also obligated to take that as well and we could just drop her off the ACA dental plan we currently have? I'm not sure if there are affordability guidelines for dental offered through an employer so I guess that's another thing I have to look into. Honestly this all pretty overwhelming and frustrating so any help and guidance anyone can provide would be greatly appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1whx8qz/family_currently_on_aca_but_spouse_got_new_job/

"Question about ACA PTC + unmarried domestic partner employer coverage My partner and I are unmarried and file taxes separately. We live together and have children, whom I claim on my taxes. I've always claimed the children. My partner's employer offers health insurance and gives him the option to cover the kids (the coverage is considered affordable) and also has the option to add a domestic partner. I was told by a Vermont Health Connect eligibility specialist that because we aren't married, the offer of affordable domestic partner coverage doesn't disqualify me from remaining on my Marketplace plan and receiving a Premium Tax Credit like it would if we were married. I've also found IRS guidance saying that someone who can enroll in an employee's employer coverage but isn't a member of the employee's tax family is considered eligible for that coverage for PTC purposes only during months they actually enroll. So essentially, his employer's offer of domestic partner coverage would only disqualify me from receiving a premium tax credit if I was to enroll. Does this sound correct? Specifically, is an affordable offer of employer coverage to an unmarried domestic partner treated differently for PTC purposes than an offer to children? Vermont Health connect told me that my partner's affordable employer insurance offer for our children does make the children ineligible for a PTC. The children and I are not part of his tax family because he doesn't claim any of us as dependents. I'm mainly trying to make sure I haven't been receiving a PTC when I shouldn't have and understand why my partner's offer of affordable coverage makes our children ineligible, but not myself."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wp131z/question_about_aca_ptc_unmarried_domestic_partner/

An agent or broker · 18 documents

"2026 ACA PLANS... THIS IS CRIMINAL!!!! Look at this This is a plan for my client (family of 5) with an income of \$83,000. In 2025, they were paying \$14.97 a month for a bronze \$0 deductible plan. The cheapest plan now with a \$0 deductible is freaking \$487 A MONTH!!! That is just insane!!! Not only are Americans going to suffer with their health insurance this year but this will also affect many agents like me and I feel like that is also not being talked about enough. Already have a few that say they won't be renewing. This is criminal, the enhanced subsidies need to be extended!"

— r/obamacare · 603 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj7nbz/2026_aca_plans_this_is_criminal_look_at_this/

"HDHPs suck if you actually need them. Because our subsidy expired, we are now paying \$1200 a month for 2 people for a bronze plan with an \$8000 deductible per person. CO, both 52, \$160k income. We went from \$1200 buying us great gold coverage to \$1200 and paying for our own care literally overnight. As it happens, for a bit of uterine bleeding, I actually need the insurance this year. All of the procedures I need – ultrasound, biopsy, and hysteroscopy – are subject to the deductible. And after the deductible, they're only covered at 40% by Select Health. What kind of insurance is this? We're basically paying high premiums for the privilege of paying for our own healthcare. This was the cheapest Obamacare option we could find. Where are all the HDHPs with lower premiums? We worked with a broker, and there weren't any. The contract company that employs my husband had an HDHP where the premium was even higher. At these prices, we can't even afford to fund an HSA. We didn't see any HDHPs on the exchange with premium is less than \$1000 a month. How are people affording this? HDHPs are not a bargain anymore, it seems. We make well over six figures, but since so much of our income is going to healthcare premiums, we have to drain our savings over any healthcare we need. And if you have HDHP insurance, you can't even pay a lower cash price to the facility. You have to pay the higher insurance negotiated price, even if you're paying 100% of the cost. And if I want sedation for these procedures (don't even get me started about how painful in office gynecology is), it's even more expensive. So basically, anything between a well-woman visit (free) and cancer (chemo meets that deductible pretty quick) is going to give you medical debt. This is indescribably unbelievable. Wow, this sucks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 199 upvotes · None

"Health Insurance Carrier strongly recommending that I don't purchase insurance through healthcare.gov I just got off the phone with sales agent of the largest health insurance carrier in my state. I had previously applied through healthcare.gov and confirmed that I was ineligible for any tax credits/subsidies but found a plan I like. I then contact the health insurer directly to see if there was any difference in premiums by applying directly through them. The price is identical but I was told to purchase the plan directly anyway because there could be "miscommunication" between the marketplace exchange and the insurer. That seemed odd to me. As someone who supports the ACA and wants to ensure it lasts and improves, I would like to enroll through healthcare.gov. My thinking is that the program's success is measured in part by the number of users who shop/purchase through healthcare.gov. Is there any real downside to using the marketplace exchange?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 16 upvotes · None

"Help! ACA plan termination notice after reporting a change-in-life event I just received a notice today that my ACA plan has been terminated effective October stating "voluntary withdrawal" even though I never requested this, and I have always paid on time. For the life of me I cannot figure out why. The only thing I can figure out is that this is due to me reporting my daughter as married (by reporting the event as a change-of-life event). This was to remove just her, not all of us. I called Healthcare.gov and they are escalating this, but I'm worried that it won't get fixed. I asked the agent and she says this happens a lot so I'm wondering if anyone else has experienced this when it wasn't due to non-payment. Does anyone have any experience with this? My son is a hemophiliac and I'm worried that I need to start looking for a new job so that I can get other coverage. BTW: I'm not getting tax credits, in case that is relevant."

— r/HealthInsurance · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmwnck/help_aca_plan_termination_notice_after_reporting/

"NC - losing medicaid for medically complex child Any moms on here with children on medicaid with congenital heart conditions/complex medical needs? I need your advice... I've just been told my daughter's medicaid won't be renewed even though my income has decreased from last year's renewal period. Marketplace coverage will cost \$600/mo and covers nothing. Her annual tests will cost upwards close to \$7-\$9,000 assuming her conditions stay stable and without issues. I called the tailored plan brokers and they told me it only covers behavioral/developmental conditions and that if our medicaid expires at the end of the month then there's no way she'd qualify. Am I missing any other outlets or resources? My case worker explains nothing as to why we're being rejected even though our income was much higher last year."

— r/Medicaid · 14 upvotes · None

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, than 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and than switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

"I just talked to my Insurance broker last week (I'm on Cobra until 2/2027). FYI, the ACA only has HMO plans, no more PPO plans, she told me. I can't find any doctors who take the HMO plans, even the top tier ones."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwScHrO5XRAM7MD7Cp4AaABAq

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😊 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/

"A few years ago when my wife passed I went to an agent as I was clueless about health insurance. He walked me through and explained everything I was looking at. I've since become more comfortable with the process but still list him as my agent in appreciation for how he helped me."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rmyvm7/this_is_for_anyone_without_an_agent_on_their/o95pinv/

"Trust your insurer even less than ACA. They don't know shit. I've had pre-authorization for a medicine for years. Last December I go to fill it and it's like \$175 and I had already met my deductible and out-of-pocket maximum in January. I hadn't paid anything for it since January 2025. I call my insurance company, and I get an agent telling me it's a new law that Congress passed, and I called her out immediately because I follow politics closely, so I asked her to tell me what the law was, the new long she kept telling me I was incompetent. Even though she couldn't tell me the law of Congress had passed she just kept repeating it passed one. I don't usually do this, but I asked for her superior. She flat out told me that no, this is not a new congressional law, although it is a congressional law, but it was passed in 2022. I knew I was right. They had given me prior authorization for years, but only because the namebrand was cheaper than the generic. Then the generic lowered their price so low that they stopped covering the namebrand. I tried the generic and it was ineffective, and I had my first asthma attack in decades. I'm not trying to be picky, all my other meds are generics and it all is fine but this particular one, it just did not work for me. It's a maintenance asthma inhaler. So I have this prior authorization and it is useless. The pharmacy is even baffled by it. It's a DAR law, dispense as written. Well, of course it's going to be dispensed as written because I have a prior authorization. If I want that medicine, I have to pay \$175 for it, every month. So now I am on a different one and I will be going on blood pressure meds soon because it raises my blood pressure. I don't have high blood pressure, I never have until I started this medicine. It is effective, but I have to go on another medicine but it's a cheap one. They don't care about my health, they just care about the cost. I hate insurance. It is sorely needed. I had it almost all of my life and then we decided to move to Florida. I retired from my cushy corporate job, but I lost my insurance and I didn't have it for years. So I know what it's like to go without it and even though it's a pain in the ass, I would rather have it than not And I am hoping that nothing comes up for you in the next 10 days or so. My other message was a bit snarky and I apologize. I hate dealing with anything health insurance wise, no matter who I'm dealing with. They make it so much harder than it actually is"

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1st004d/aca_canceled_my_policy_without_my_permission_and/ohpu0tq/

"It is not open enrollment for ACA, so you would need a life event to enroll right now. And I hope no one sees this and uses it because I would be too afraid of what it might be. I'm trying to be kind. I used a broker many years to sign up for ACA, but they don't do much of what you told me, they just helped me pick a plan that might be best for me. I have no idea what they get, but I worked with the same one for years and her name happened to be the same as mine."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rmyvm7/this_is_for_anyone_without_an_agent_on_their/o94hc0r/

The carrier directly (Ambetter, Oscar, BCBS...) · 18 documents

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😬 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · None

""Get Covered Illinois"--2026 premium notices sent out today. This year, Illinois switched over to its own program, rather than using Healthcare.gov. 2026 premiums hit the street today. The unsubsidized premium for me and my wife (both in our early to mid-60s) is \$2,915.99, This represents a 17% premium increase from 2025. In Illinois, my carrier, Blue Cross/Blue Shield, had gotten approved for an average 27% premium increase across all of its policy forms; I'm not sure why we got the smaller percentage increase. I had thought that people our age would have been hit with the highest percentage increase in premiums. The automatic renewal letter that I got described my projected monthly subsidy, and my "monthly premium" (in other words, the subsidized premium). I figured out the total unsubsidized premium by adding those figures together. Because of the way that the numbers were laid out in the letter, it appears that the people who run the Illinois program believe that Federal subsidies will be renewed for 2026."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · None

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😊) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday. **UPDATE:** I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😊) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the

amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 😊 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 😊 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting , failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an"

— r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · None

"50% increase in premium wtf Ambetter Currently paying \$170 a month and the old premium was like \$450 before subsidies. Now the new premium is \$420 a month or \$700 after subsidies. How does something jump 50% in one year in the cost. Seems crazy. I thought I was gonna lose the tax credit but instead I just got burned by Ambetter increasing the premiums by 50%."

— r/HealthInsurance · 17 upvotes · None

"I already got my letter from bcbs telling me my insurance is going up in January because they are not extending credits . They need to know now ."

— r/obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1njh7e7/government_funding_battle_brewing_over_enhanced/neqb60x/

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · None

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, than 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and than switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

"I'm confused why the same plan my girlfriend and I choose went up for her, but stayed the same for me? We both signed up for Oscar Gold Elite last year and each have our incomes which are unfortunately low. Same jobs and same income for this year... But for some reason my premium for the same plan stayed at the exact same price of \$40, but hers more than doubled to \$100. We use our premium tax credits but she uses the insurance more than I do because she had asthma but does that have anything to do with it? I'm a bit confused because I don't understand this stuff very well despite watching many videos on it. Any help is greatly appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · None

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO

and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

"Im 33, my job doesnt offer health insurance. I bought a plan for \$130 a month directly through blue cross blue shield"

— YouTube · 9 Health Insurance Options for Early Retirement · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qt0r9YBsUzM&lc=Ugxt9DMCwoEBE4QubuF4AaABAq>

"Thank you - yeah, now that I'm digging around in doctor details in the provider search, I see in one example where a doctor who has his main office inside the medical department at the good hospital and the provider search says he is in-network yet "affiliated with a medical group that does not contract with the health plan", that the only place I can see him is if I travel to some VA Medicaid hospital 30 miles away where he does charity work once a month or something. So basically - it's beginning to appear that the only places that accept this fucking network are the doctors & hospitals who accept Medicaid. I am so enraged: I started this new job this month and I specifically asked in the job offer process whether they offered Blue Cross PPO plans, because in my city it's required to have a Blue Cross PPO plan or else you can't access any good doctors, and I was assured they did. My plan during the job offer negotiation was that I was either going to 1) turn down the job if there was no option for good insurance, or 2) tell them I have to turn them down unless we can negotiate a pay bump to compensate me for buying my own insurance off ACA so that I can get the good insurance. Now, because the fucking plan list they had deceptively said these were PPO plans - without the network details I can now see once I have all the details to dig into during open enrollment - I see my worst nightmare did indeed come true and I left a job with normal insurance and landed at one with zero options to ever see a good doctor again."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmng0o/basically_if_the_doc_is_an_innetwork_professional/pb8xu4/

"ACA. It's not that big a deal to estimate your income; just do your best and set some extra money aside in case you owe at tax time. Or if you prefer, estimate on the high end for your income and file for a refund at tax time. Going "straight through private companies" doesn't mean you're getting real, normal insurance direct from the source. It just means you're getting subpar, non-compliant insurance that leave you with few protections. I didn't understand this when I first had to get my own insurance. I called BCBS directly, because it's the insurance I had with my previous employer, and I wanted a quote for "what I had before." They sent me straight to healthcare.gov for their ACA plans."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wkwkbf/looking_for_affordable_health_insurance/paz8zn7/

Medicaid / CHIP · 15 documents

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

"A positive anecdote of using American/ACA health insurance We often hear mostly negative things regarding US health insurance online, particularly in regards to the ACA, so I thought I'd offer up a positive personal experience. Our daughter met with her new rheumatologist less than two weeks ago. Today we got the approval authorization for a year of her biologic infusion, which is off-formulary and medical exemption only. No arguing post-denial or justification to get insurance to pony up for an expensive drug that could easily make us net loss customers for them. Copay program from the manufacturer should bring our out-of-pocket cost down to \$0, but even without it our script-biased insurance would hold the drug copay to just \$300/year. This is also with a new insurer starting as a brand new patient. Took one week for her to get in to see her new PCP, took a few days for the referral to process, then three weeks for her to see the rheumatologist. This insurer and policy are also the absolute cheapest Silver in our market, meaning premium cost is significantly lower than even the benchmark plan. I appreciate more and more each year just how good of a healthcare/ACA market Austin has ended up being. Wife and I both needed to find a new PCP this year too due to switching insurance carriers and it only took a few weeks for us to get in as new patients. I hear people talk all the time about waiting months in other markets. Our new PCP was lovely too and didn't rush our new patient appointments at all despite us not really needing anything other than to establish service."

— r/obamacare · 46 upvotes · None

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · None

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · None

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceous of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · None

"NC - losing medicaid for medically complex child Any moms on here with children on medicaid with congenital heart conditions/complex medical needs? I need your advice... I've just been told my daughter's medicaid won't be renewed even though my income has decreased from last year's renewal period. Marketplace coverage will cost \$600/mo and covers nothing. Her annual tests will cost upwards close to \$7-\$9,000 assuming her conditions stay stable and without issues. I called the tailored plan brokers and they told me it only covers behavioral/developmental conditions and that if our medicaid expires at the end of the month then there's no way she'd qualify. Am I missing any other outlets or resources? My case worker explains nothing as to why we're being rejected even though our income was much higher last year."

— r/Medicaid · 14 upvotes · None

"Yep! I got charged over \$300 for a diagnostic Vit D test because my ACA insurance deemed it "medically unnecessary" (even though it came back low, they said it wasn't low enough to be necessary), so I didn't even get the contracted rate. I fought it. It took months to get it resolved, and while waiting the lab said I was past due and wouldn't do further lab work, and also kept sending me notices that they were sending me to collections (even though they knew I was appealing through insurance). In the end the insurance changed the category and I paid less than 50.. but SO lame."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/on2q8w9/

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · None

"I should first say that I can arrange my affairs to qualify for Medicaid or the ACA (it just depends on how much capital-gains I take vs. Roth distributions). I used to be on Medicaid, but with the upcoming change to Medicaid requiring work requirements (I consider myself fully retired), I wanted to get into an ACA plan (at the bare minimum 138% of poverty income rate); there was also some screwing things with Medicaid such as me not being able to get the plan to do mail-order Rx filling (an important thing since I travel a lot), to say nothing of getting my sleep Rx covered properly (I could get my Medicaid PCP to write the script, but I would have it filled at Health Warehouse), so presuming I could have gotten a proper PCP in the new ACA plan, I would be saving money on Rx. But since I can't get a proper PCP from the ACA plan - nor a psychiatrist that my PCP told me I had to see - I'm stuck going back to my old PCP as a self-pay patient, and getting the sleep Rx from the old mail-order place. And of course, I'm paying \$80/mo for the privilege of this rotten service. That said, I was able to get my annual blood test, and I will getting a feces test for colon cancer, from the new ACA plan (I would have gotten it no matter what plan I would be on). Yes, my new PCP sucks, and I have fired him (I told him that I don't trust him with my health management); I guess I could looks for another one, even a nurse-practioner, but how do you find one that will do the job. Do I say, "Hi, I am a subscriber with the AmWorse Premier plan, and I am looking for a PCP; one of the requirements I have for my PCP is that I get my 10mg Zolpidem Rx - that I have had for 30 years or so, and that I could prove for the last 12 years from my old PCP - which I consider an essential part of my health maintenance. If you run your practice such that you can't do this, then I cannot give you my business"."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omz7nsn/

"Not an ACA story, but I carried the BCBS PPO plan with the highest cost specifically because it offered flexibility in where we went for care & my daughter had multiple medical issues. The day before she was due to travel to Philadelphia/UPenn for surgery on a rare brain tumor, I got a call saying the hospital was in a dispute with BCBS over reimbursement rates & wasn't currently accepting BCBS...but we were of course welcome to pay cash for the CTs, MRI, surgery & hospital stay. Recently saw Trinity isn't currently accepting Humana. It's madness when people's lives are literally at risk."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o4ov1l/aca_plans_not_accepted_by_leading_hospitals_and/njwnczn/

"Part of the reason that health care was cheaper in the past, including the 70s and 80s, was that there was much less that the medical field could do for you. During the 1970s and 1980s, we got MRIs and other advanced diagnostic/imaging techniques, cardiac bypass procedures, and chemotherapy. Those developments have saved many lives, but are not cost-free. If your kid was diagnosed with leukemia in the 1970s, the doctors told you to let him have as much ice cream and as many pony rides as he wanted, until he died within the next six months. Now, that kid gets chemotherapy that saves his or her life. The treatment is very expensive. The prognosis for breast cancer is much better than it was fifty years ago, due to advances in treatment. The same is true with many other cancers. The development of colonoscopy has saved many lives through early detection of colon cancer (before colonoscopy, my grandfather died of colon cancer at 63). But, the last time that I had a colonoscopy, the total "sticker price"--anesthesia, GI doctor charge, facility charge--was about \$6,000.00 (Since my State mandates that insurers made the procedure available without a separate out-of-pocket charge, I paid nothing directly. But, of course, my fees for the procedure was "baked into" my health insurance premium, and into the premiums of all other policyholders. And my premium included the colonoscopy-related charges for all other insureds). Fifty years ago, a lot of middle-aged men died of "indigestion" while watching TV after supper. Now, they go on statins, get a cardiac cath procedure, and/cardiatic bypass, and keep living. In the time since the early 1980s, HIV has gone from being a death sentence to a treatable, chronic, condition. Starting around twenty years ago, and continuing to the present, a majority of HIV+ patients die of causes unrelated to their HIV+ positive status. Until the mid-90s, the average life span from the first onset of AIDS-related symptoms was 18 months. The strides that medicine has made in the last fifty years are breathtaking. But they do have an economic cost. The medical care that we got in 1970s was cheaper than it is now because it is a very different product, in ways that improve patient outcomes."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1w4vjg1/health_insurance/p85l6jw/

Health sharing ministries and short-term plans · 5 documents

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · None

"Finally found a decent deal this year at age 62 . I had health insurance first two years after retiring in 2014 (am a retired RN). Paid \$ 663/ month for health insurance the first year and \$ 677/ month the following year.They wanted to jack it up to \$ 913 /month when I turned 58.I said no,went without for 5 years.In the meantime I was able to get out of debt.Thank God,nothing catastrophic happened to me . This month I was able to obtain some decent health insurance at \$ 673/ month ,which includes some supplements to defray some out of pocket costs. Sounds expensive,but trust me in South Florida \$ 673/month is a deal. Since my RN pension is now supplemented by Social Security benefits,the premium hit is easier to take. Medicare in two years."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 22 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugwp_Ute8re04Vpyk8d4AaABAq

"[US] Health insurance as a solo small business owner is killing me financially, how are you handling it? Running a small boutique for a few years now and the one thing that never gets easier is health insurance. Coming from a corporate background where HR handled everything, I had no idea how brutal the individual market was until I was actually in it. Right now I'm paying more per month for my own coverage than I used to pay toward rent. And the deductibles aren't even that good. I looked at marketplace plans, looked at shortterm options, even went down the health sharing ministry rabbit hole for a while before deciding it felt too risky for my situation. What I keep running into is that the options are either expensive and okay, or cheaper and kind of terrifying. There's no middle ground that actually makes sense. For those of you running smaller operations, especially retail or service businesses where you're the only employee or close to it, what have you actually landed on? Did you find something through a professional association or a local chamber? Did you just accept the high premium and build it into your pricing? I track my finances pretty obsessively so I know exactly what this is costing me each year, and it's genuinely one of my biggest line items. Curious what other people have figured out."

— r/selfemployed · 10 upvotes · None

"We have a DPC membership for the everyday healthcare needs (annual wellness/sick visits, minor injuries or wounds like stitches, lab work, prescriptions, etc) and then we have a non-profit health share for the large medical bills. Both memberships are around \$700 for my entire family. I have used the health share since 2021 and they have paid for everything we have submitted (and within about 2 weeks) and we joined the DPC last December, so it has been a year. I have been sick and just texted my doctor last week for advice on what I can do to get rid of my annoying cough. It is nice to be able to have access to a doctor when needed and I can get seen if I need to (usually same or next day, depending on the situation). I realize this solution is not for everyone, but it has worked well for our family."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1pn63ub/us_my_health_insurance_just_doubled_curious_how/nuc8qjw/

"Regarding cancer, couldn't you theoretically go to a foreign country for that? Really the only concern is acute emergencies that cost over \$150k (NICU stay, full body burns, aneurysms, etc. falls here). What is the actual probability of facing these sorts of claims? I looked at the catastrophic plans and they are just as expensive as the Bronze marketplace plans. Is there any alternative?"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmmap5/why_not_health_cost_sharing_ministries/pba46qk/

Google and online research · 2 documents

"18 currently unemployed and need insurance To start off I've never used Reddit really so I'm not sure if this is appropriate here but it seems like the place to go. I turned 18 in June and haven't had health insurance for YEARS. It honestly wouldn't be a crazy issue for me if I wasn't dealing with some reproductive health issues and wanting birth control. I used to just go to the ER when things happened or visit Planned Parenthood but my mom seems against it now because of money. It'd be over \$1,000 per month for me to just be placed on her own plan so I'm at a wall. I went to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and I was told that I qualified for a marketplace plan yet open enrollment has closed. I don't believe I account for a special enrollment period because I never really had insurance to begin with. I don't understand what to do in my case. I still live with my mother, I have a job interview lined up but everything feels like a waiting game except I never actually get the medical attention I really need. I'm frustrated and just want to see an GYN or somebody that can help me, I'm very tired."

— r/HealthInsurance · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wdtqmh/18_currently_unemployed_and_need_insurance/

"I just found this thread after doing an online search for complaints about Imperial Insurance in Arizona. I made the mistake of signing up for Imperial through the health marketplace, effective January 1. My previous insurance, Banner Aetna, withdrew from the marketplace, so I had to find new insurance. I knew I was taking a chance with an untested insurance company, but everything else was so much more expensive. Well, you get what you pay for. I, too, never received any plan documents in the mail or even via email. Every piece of information about my plan I had to go looking for online. Well I did get a flimsy insurance card with a primary care doc I'd never seen. Changing that to my own PCP with Imperial took multiple calls. But that's not the worst of it. Please see next paragraph. Nowhere in my Imperial portal am I able to access my Explanations of Benefits, nor can I see any information about providers I've seen and what Imperial has paid or not paid for. Contrary to their claims, Imperial DOES NOT send out EOBs to its customers. At all. And they have contradicted themselves because after I complained to them, they actually admitted in an email to me that they only provide EOBs to providers! I'm flying blind here -- how do I know whether the amount on a bill from a provider is accurate and should be paid by me? I jumped through all the hoops and filed a complaint with the Arizona Department of Insurance and Financial Institutions in early March. A couple of weeks later they closed the case stating that "The information we reviewed indicates that Imperial has acknowledged your concerns, and they have communicated their finds with you in written correspondence." Ha. All Imperial did was copy some EOBs (not all of them) and mail them to me. I just hope and pray that I don't have any serious health event this year, as my trust in Imperial "Health" is nil."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q9bscn/imperial_health_on_aca/odyfwn8/

Dislikes

Premiums they can't pay after the subsidy loss

"The scariest part... from someone who works at a health insurance company I work at a large health insurance company, and lately all I hear about is the potential end of ACA subsidies, rising premiums, and skyrocketing healthcare costs. But the part no one's talking about? This could become the new normal. When has any industry ever raised prices and then actually brought them back down once people got used to paying more? Even if healthcare costs drop (and that's a big if), what incentive do insurers have to lower premiums when people are already paying the higher rates? It's like gas... people used to complain about \$2.50 a gallon. Now we celebrate it. That's the scary part. Prices rise, we adapt, and eventually we forget what "reasonable" even looked like. Unless wages start catching up, we're all in serious trouble."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2,664 upvotes · None

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🙄"

— r/obamacare · 586 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1olp6mh/virginia_aca_rates_posted_today_share_your/

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · None

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · None

""Get Covered Illinois"--2026 premium notices sent out today. This year, Illinois switched over to its own program, rather than using Healthcare.gov. 2026 premiums hit the street today. The unsubsidized premium for me and my wife (both in our early to mid-60s) is \$2,915.99, This represents a 17% premium increase from 2025. In Illinois, my carrier, Blue Cross/Blue Shield, had gotten approved for an average 27% premium increase across all of its policy forms; I'm not sure why we got the smaller percentage increase. I had thought that people our age would have been hit with the highest percentage increase in premiums. The automatic renewal letter that I got described my projected monthly subsidy, and my "monthly premium" (in other words, the subsidized premium). I figured out the total unsubsidized premium by adding those figures together. Because of the way that the numbers were laid out in the letter, it appears that the people who run the Illinois program believe that Federal subsidies will be renewed for 2026."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · None

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

"ACA not very affordable anymore ACA is not really affordable without the extra subsidy, but California fines you 100 per month for not having it. It's not really fair to fine people who truly can't afford it. I work front desk hotel. The cheapest plan for me is 200 per month. I have to pay 100% out of pocket until I reach 7200 for the year. Just 2 visits to the dermatologist is costing me 1400 on top of the 200 I already pay. If I want something with normal co-pays, it's going to cost me 400 per month. I make between 45K-50K, but the cost of living is so high in California that there isn't much left for stuff like health insurance. It's really not fair that California fines you at this point when the premiums have literally doubled in price. It's very frustrating."

— r/obamacare · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/

"People were getting ready to get hungry. The system is broken very broken. It's been broken for a long time. Once the individual mandate was killed the ACA was a goner. Ten percent plus premium increases a year are untenable. What we need is wide spread health care reform. Which no one will do because lobbying and campaign donations. I don't understand why working people are cheering the lack of subsidies. In Nj (I don't get subsidies) my plan is 2400 a month, 9k deductible, 18k out of pocket max. That's 50k a year for a couple in early/mid 50s. For a routine ER visit, expect a 2k balance bill. It is simply not sustainable."

— r/obamacare · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ot4yde/aca_vote_in_december/no2ky2e/

"It is an issue that will explode in their faces this fall if they don't extend the credits. I can't stress enough how immediately impactful and obvious it will be once consumers start looking at their 2026 rates if we go back to the 400% FPL cliff and lower subsidies for everyone under 400%. You can't bluster away the premium increase that hits people directly."

— r/obamacare · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1n8oh6a/house_republicans_launch_bill_to_extend_health/neghst2/

"A freaking nightmare. We have to enroll by Dec. 15 for Jan. 1 effective date. I have a decent silver plan, but the premium will increase by 300 percent without subsidies, which means I will just sign up for a cheaper bronze plan if there is no change by the 15th. People like me don't want to be stuck in a lowered plan if we find out after the 15th that we will get subsidies and we don't want to risk going without insurance for a period. Knowing the GOP, they will deliberately delay this if they are going to offer subsidies just for the opportunity to be cruel."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nghi12x/

"I remember. I have to point this fact out to people all the time. There is a whole group, mostly MAGA, who think the ACA caused it to happen. Prior to the ACA I had years of 30%+ premium increases."

— r/obamacare · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1urupru/aca_insurers_proposed_doubledigit_premium_hikes/owk0052/

"Self-employed independent white male. My premiums tripled. It's a big deal. I'll send you my address so you can make up the difference. I'll refund it when the 10 year (and counting) congressional fix that you refer to is implemented."

— r/obamacare · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ps7j5o/premiums_triple_congress_goes_homes/nv7gfug/

Deductibles too high to use the plan

"ACA premiums.... What's going on with ACA Marketplace insurance right now is absurd. The same plan I pay \$77 for (with tax credit) is now \$368. I currently have a \$150 deductible, \$1500 OOP max, \$250 ER copay, \$1 primary care visits, \$1-\$15 prescriptions, and a \$30 specialist, imaging and surgery copay. The same plan for 2026 now has a \$2700 deductible, \$8250 OOP max, \$1,000 ER copay AFTER deductible, \$30 primary care visit, and \$80 specialist, imaging and surgery copay... for almost quadruple the price. Without the tax credit, the plan premium is \$696.46 for next year. If someone hit their OOP max for the year with this plan without a tax credit, their healthcare would cost about \$16,000 for the year. If someone hit their OOP max with a similar tax credit as mine for the year, their healthcare would cost \$12,666. For the record, the projected income I gave on my application was \$38,000....."

— r/HealthInsurance · 665 upvotes · None

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · None

"2026 ACA PLANS... THIS IS CRIMINAL!!!! Look at this This is a plan for my client (family of 5) with an income of \$83,000. In 2025, they were paying \$14.97 a month for a bronze \$0 deductible plan. The cheapest plan now with a \$0 deductible is freaking \$487 A MONTH!!! That is just insane!!! Not only are Americans going to suffer with their health insurance this year but this will also affect many agents like me and I feel like that is also not being talked about enough. Already have a few that say they won't be renewing. This is criminal, the enhanced subsidies need to be extended!"

— r/obamacare · 603 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj7nbz/2026_aca_plans_this_is_criminal_look_at_this/

"Virginia ACA Rates Posted Today: Share Your Increase In Virginia and rates came up today. Self employed couple 59 & 61. This year our premium was \$1187/month. Same plan next year \$2,109/month. This is more than my mortgage payment and a \$922/month increase brings the total yearly cost to \$50,616. We will have to switch to a high deductible low quality Bronze plan with a \$7,500 deductible EACH with a monthly premium of \$1452/month. This is beyond belief. Continue contacting your elected officials people 🍊 "

— r/obamacare · 586 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1olp6mh/virginia_aca_rates_posted_today_share_your/

"My new ACA premiums and deductible - considering just not having health insurance for a few years. So I had a life event last month that required me to get ACA. My monthly premium was \$485 and my deductible was \$7600. Just got an email saying my current health insurance will not be offered next year. Instead my new premium will be about \$560 and my deductible will be about \$11000. Also it seems many of my co-insurance will be higher by about \$70. And I'm not sure what else has changed for the worse. At this point I'm seriously considering not having health insurance for a few years. It seems cheaper to just plan a 3-week trip overseas and get better healthcare for much cheaper. You heard me - better! I just don't want to enable this defunct healthcare system anymore. If I'm in an accident I hope EMTALA saves my broke behind - in both senses of the phrase. I'll pay what I can then declare bankruptcy. If not life threatening, I'll take it overseas. A roundtrip ticket to India costs \$1500, \$1000 if you wait a month or so. That's less than three months premium. Over a year I can save up \$7000 in premiums. Saving up for one year buys me a full check up and a vacation trip. What do you think? Anyone considering the same thing? For those with kids - you have my sympathies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 574 upvotes · None

"\$2600/mth, \$6k deductible for wife and I Blue Shield Bronze HSA PPO w/ \$6k deductible is looking like \$2650/mth for 2026, for wife and I (middle aged, in good health). This is a CoveredCA ACA plan, and I'm self-employed. This is completely unaffordable. Having already cut all our costs to the bone, I only have one option, which is to raise my rates, and hope that my competitors will also be raising theirs too so mine aren't extortionate. The only other thing I could do it seems is to become younger, which I'll try and organize, but seems to have some complex issues. This is going to massively, massively spike inflation."

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · None

"Sat through new job orientation in a deep red state and the cognitive dissonance was something else Just started a new job in a red state. Orientation day, 50+ new hires packed into a hall, and eventually we get to the health insurance and benefits section. That's when the room came alive. People complaining left and right about insurance companies ripping them off. My meds aren't covered. My deductible is insane. I can't get the care I actually need. Half the room had a story. And honestly, looking around, a lot of these folks clearly have real health issues and genuinely need coverage that works. Meanwhile HR is up there basically doing damage control, pitching workarounds and cheaper tiers like "this plan gets you more bang for your buck" which is corporate speak for "we know it's bad, here's how to make it slightly less bad." Here's the part that got me. Based on where I am and the conversations around me, most of this room votes red every single time. The same people furious about unaffordable meds and garbage coverage are voting for the party actively working to gut affordable healthcare. They'll rage at the insurance company all day but never connect it to the ballot they cast. Nobody in that room made the connection. Not one person. They see the symptom every day and keep voting for the disease. I just sat there quietly filling out my forms."

— r/obamacare · 325 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v5g93m/sat_through_new_job_orientation_in_a_deep_red/

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · None

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

"Going back to school for student medical insurance Many of us have increasing insurance costs, in my case it went from \$660/month last year with enhanced subsidies to \$1425/month this year with no subsidies so if retired or underemployed it becomes difficult to justify the costs. In my case I am a few years away from 65 but not wanting to work full-time (I am fortunate) due to my volunteer work I started looking for part time jobs with benefits. I was chasing a rabbit down a hole and found that as a part-time student within the UNC system I was eligible to also get student coverage. Some of the rules \-Have to be in a degree program \-Must attend on Campus \-Part-time = 6 credits Some numbers Not a student- ACA \$17,100/annual, \$2000 deductible max OOP \$8200 As a student \-Tuition/fees annually \$3872 (6 credits/semester) \-Medical insurance \$3168 (12-months) \$500 deductible max OOP \$4000 , campus clinic use unlimited with \$0 co-pay Total annual = \$7040 Additional student benefits (mandatory fees) \-Access to fitness center/pool \-Access to library \-Student discounts By going back to school I will save just under \$10k/annually So I enrolled and was accepted into a GIS program starting in Aug 26, not only will I be saving money but for me the structure of a schedule will help me fill in my week. Even if I became a full-time my annual costs would be \$11k/annual which would still be a savings over ACA only. I am fortunate to not need to work so YMMV, but thought I would share my adventure."

— r/HealthInsurance · 92 upvotes · None

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— r/obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

"I need OP to sit down as this may shock them. This is better than my current 2025 plan. I have no children, so just for me. I have zero health issues, and never go to the doctor. Even fifteen years ago I was spending \$150/month for \$3000 deductible as a young person. The idea of a \$15/month plan has never been close to a reality for me. I've never seen a \$0 deductible plan. My genuine concern is my plan will jump to \$600, \$700, even \$800/month and my deductible will go from \$12000 to \$15000 or more. This is back breaking to strained budgets."

— r/obamacare · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj7nbz/2026_aca_plans_this_is_criminal_look_at_this/nm1cx41/

"I had used e health before but never.... I had used e health before but never again. They advised me to take a policy that had absolutely zero help to me. They then apologize and fit me with a different policy. One again zero benefit. I went over all my providers etc over and over again to make sure i was covered. Now I find out my doctors and hospitals aren't in network! I am now stuck with this policy I pay for and can't use. I would never use again or recommend to anyone."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/67f12fd96111d20f324a40>

"I receive \$85.00 a month for over the.... I receive \$85.00 a month for over the counter products I might need. I was saving the \$85.00 dollars to put with the next month and buy something that cost \$139.00. Went to do it and found I lost that first months \$85.00. You HAVE to use the entire amount monthly or you lose it for that month. Secondly, they give you an online catalog to shop from. The prices are ridiculous. Many times they don't have a product you need. By the way you can use your monthly \$85.00 at CVS, WALMART, and a few others. Notice I said at. You can't use your benefits online with any other stores YOU MUST GO IN TO THE STORE. I'm disabled and can't get to the closest Walmart unless a neighbor is available. Before you go with EHEALTH consider the hassles. I hope this helps with your decision."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/66be3b5eb4e4754b27bfb97a>

"False representation. First of all they call me and they ring my phone off the hook and get me to take one of their plans and tell me that I'm going to have free medical and dental and vision and I have to talk to three people on the phone before that happens and when I finally do find out what I qualify for none of it I don't get free dental and vision I just get the medical and I'm promised a benefit card where I can buy food and gas That's the biggest lie I have ever heard in my life I've had this insurance three times and the card is not accepted anywhere and you have to do tutorials online to even earn money and you don't earn as much money as you lately people to believe. And you take my insurance away from me after telling me it's free after about 3 months you take it away and then a month later you calling me back again trying to get me back on it so what is the point in the purpose? I do not want any part of this company it's a scam from the get-go. You people lie about benefit cards and they're not worth deadly squat. And today I got a call from a lady trying to get sell me this insurance and I told her I said look I've already had this card in this insurance three times three times and all three times the card wasn't accepted anywhere. I said it's no good it's it's a light I can't use it why would I want something that I couldn't use? And that woman paused for a minute and she said you're right she said you are right. Then she puts me on the phone with another person which is a man and he asked me the same stupid questions that she did and says I'm going to have free dental and vision along with free medical care then he wants to put me on the phone with somebody else I mean that's ridiculous why why three people what is going on with that and by the time you get to the third person who tells you what you're qualified for you're not qualified for any of that stuff at all so why do you guys have to scheme to get people to sign up are you getting a cut for it or what"

— TrustPilot · ambetterhealth.com · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a6bc5e0b6e698f6a00f2097>

"If you're a woman - do NOT get Ambetter. . I'm self-employed and paying for Ambetter from the marketplace, which is commercial insurance and supposed to be decent for the co-pay about \$400. Everything about this insurance is bad. 1. ZocDoc, the largest online scheduling system for doctors, doesn't even recognise Ambetter in my state and I can't use the convenient website to schedule any of the appointments. I can't overstate how inconvenient that is. 2. Impossible to find providers - the website doesn't update them frequently, you have to call multiple times to find someone who actual is in network. The number of providers is so tiny you have to wait for weeks to get an appointment. 3. Doesn't cover anything! Refused to cover my yearly mammograms (prescribed by my doctor based on my personal medical history!) and covers literally ZERO of anything fertility-related. Not a single fertility test is covered. This insurance is a punishment for women, please stay away. I'm leaving 2 stars because customer service actually was trying to help me and I was able to reach a human being relative easy."

— TrustPilot · ambetterhealth.com · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69039842f7718f8c00735d85>

Owing money back at tax time

"Oops..incurred significant LT capital gains and now being asked to pay back subsidy for 2025. Can anything be done? I am retired at 54 filing jointly and our only income is through investments and dividends. I didn't think about the income estimate for my healthcare plan / subsidy in December when I sold some long terms stocks to reset my cost basis and take advantage of the 0% tax on LTCG. As I am now doing my taxes, I am being asked to pay back nearly \$10,000 in subsidies that I received through the year. Any ideas on how to reduce the MAGI and offset gains to future years? Thanks!"

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rzuj96/oopsincurred_significant_lt_capital_gains_and_now/

"Paying for ACA (Obamacare) We're about to go on ACA with no subsidies, it'll be about \$20k a year, \$1600 a month. [Healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov/>) hands the billing off to the insurance carrier (e.g., Blue Cross, Oscar, United, Kaiser). Does anyone have experience using a credit card for full yearly prepayment, or split monthly payments (for example using multiple cards to split the monthly payment) with specific carriers?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 13 upvotes · None

"Is it beneficial to slightly overestimate projected income, to avoid possibly having to pay back subsidies at tax return time? I am trying to get ready to pull the trigger and retire at 62.5 years old. I plan to calculate my income from my Roth IRA (and a tiny part time job). Is it safer to slightly overestimate my income when signing up for ACA, to hopefully avoid the potential of having to pay back anything if I go over what I projected?"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/

"pleasant surprise but want no surprise in tax planning re aca just finished with my 2025 taxes and i will be getting a massive refund while i was expecting to owe a small check to irs 2025 was my full year of r/fire : i have no w2 income and relied on my investment dividends, tax free interests. i fired in mid 2024; so i had half year of w2 income and when i enrolled for aca in late 2024 for 2025 plans i wasn't sure what to put in my income and i only put in estimated total for qualified dividends and omitted (tax free municipal) interest which made a big chunk of my total cash for the year. i believe that i got subsidized aca rate for 2025. later in 2025 during my tax planning session i understood that i was to include tax free interest when enrolling aca. as a result i anticipated that i would be repaying the aca subsidies when i file 2025 return. but i was getting a big tax credit instead; my refund has been approved. when looking over the return i can see that a large portion of the refund is labeled medical and i didn't itemized any medical expenses; i only included the "standard" (i forgot the form number now) sent by aca does anyone understand this? for 2026 enrollment my aca premium is big and totally unsubsidized i believe because i enter a bigger (including tax free interest) income compared to 2025. should i expect at least some credit when 2026 return is filed?"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sx0pb6/pleasant_surprise_but_want_no_surprise_in_tax/

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, than 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and than switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

"Yea, this was my situation last year. I lost my job due to a health issue and had to enroll with a marketplace plan. I had no clear indicator on what my income was going to be for the full year - as it wasn't clear when I would be returning to work. I hadn't yet made 15k (FPL) for the year, but on my estimate for income I just assumed I'd be out of work for 2 months and calculated that way. Figured that if I went back to work earlier, or got a better job - I'd just pay them the difference on my taxes. But after 4 major surgeries, I didn't work again at all last year (meaning I did not earn enough to 'qualify' for the program and would need to pay back the subsidies in their entirety if this provision was in place). After a couple months, I attempted to apply for short term disability, but was delayed/denied repeatedly. Under this provision, I would have ended up owing \$6,000+ on my taxes in addition to all of my other financial hardships."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0yyfl6/

"Yes, and that was the huge benefit of the Enhanced Tax Credit. I had to pay back the APTC 2 years in a row, almost \$60k total for family of 4 at the time, because went over MAGI by about \$2k both years. After the 2nd year it all but wiped out our savings."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wjwjed/planning_to_retire_at_62_have_you_priced_the_3/pakbti3/

"Going into my fourth month without a job. I need to cancel my plan if i reach 6 months of no work right? i lost my job in December and thought id find a job by february but rhings fell through. its been really difficult finding a new job and i feel hopeless I'll find one soon. im scared I'll have to pay back if i exceed 6 months without a job so its recommended i cancel then right? then if i find a job I'll have to wait until enrollment but better than paying this shit back without having \$\$"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sigc4v/going_into_my_fourth_month_without_a_job_i_need/

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO

and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

"I also have an income that fluctuates. During previous ACA enrollments, we are asked to provide estimated income for the upcoming year to determine tax subsidy eligibility. When I file my taxes a year later, (and include the data from my 1095-A form) any deviation in my estimated income will result in a change to my tax liability. If for some reason I made more than what my estimated income was, I will pay back that portion/percentage of the tax subsidy(and vice versa if I make less). The BBB has changed it to any income overage over the estimated income given upon application will trigger a FULL repayment of the ENTIRE subsidy. I'm having difficulty even finding information on what the subsidies will be next year when they expire. Let alone what the actual policy costs are jumping up to."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mbsi9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/n5p4pr7/

"Need clarification on underestimating income I plan on enrolling my mother in law for 2026 but not sure how to approach her income. I had spoken to broker and I was informed she should show 22k before deductions to get tax credit for 2026. Before I was able to show her income as 2400 a year and get the aca credits. I read posts saying that the repayments of credits are for those who overestimate income not underestimate. Also read the other way around. If I were to sign her up saying her income projected is 22k but let's say at end of 2026 it's 3k. Since the income was underestimated will she need to payback the subsidies? she doesn't qualify for medicaid because she been in USA 2.5 years and you need to be living 5 years to qualify for that"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · None

"Filed for divorce in July. Wife refuses to sign joint return. Is there a way to not pay back subsidy? Been using marketplace for a number of years. Filed for divorce July 2025. Wife is refusing to sign joint return. Is there a way for me to file and retain the subsidy? If not will I be responsible for 50% and my wife be responsible for 50%? Any advice is appreciated."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rt6ha2/filed_for_divorce_in_july_wife_refuses_to_sign/

"Devoted Health is engaging in bad-faith.... Devoted Health is engaging in bad-faith claims adjudication by intentionally weaponizing administrative obstacles to systematically withhold mandated Medicare benefits under National Coverage Determination (NCD) 150.3. Detailed Description: I am escalating this dispute because Devoted Health is utilizing intentional administrative barrier tactics to evade its federal statutory obligations under my Devoted Choice Giveback ("Pay Back") PPO plan. The plan explicitly affirmed my clinical eligibility for chronic low back pain acupuncture in a formal postal letter and established a precedent by successfully reimbursing session one. Their subsequent withholding of payments for five identical, consecutive sessions is not an operational oversight; it is a calculated non-delivery of baseline federal Medicare benefits. Devoted's out-of-state corporate management team is exploiting its remote structure to issue repetitive, bad-faith demands for "insufficient information". Because the billing codes, clinician credentials, and clinical documentation submitted for the unpaid sessions are completely identical to the approved first session, these demands constitute an intentional strategy to create a cycle of administrative exhaustion. By forcing a local Hawaii senior to finance a federally protected benefit out-of-pocket, Devoted Health is in direct, willful breach of its CMS contract. I request that CMS bypass the plan's failed internal grievance metrics, launch an immediate compliance audit into Devoted's Hawaii PPO reimbursement protocols, and compel immediate restitution. Devoted Health formally established eligibility criteria and authorized coverage for the chronic low back pain acupuncture treatments via written postal correspondence. Under established Medicare Advantage guidelines, an insurer cannot arbitrarily revoke or obstruct an active, written authorization when the subsequent medical claims present identical clinical indicators and treatment modalities. Arbitrary and Capricious Claims Processing: The plan's administrative team has acted inconsistently by successfully reimbursing the initial acupuncture session, yet denying or withholding payment for the subsequent 5 identical sessions. Because the exact same provider information, billing codes, and clinical documentation were submitted across all claims, the plan's repeated assertion that there is "insufficient information" constitutes an arbitrary administrative barrier. Improper Adjudication and Unreasonable Administrative Burden: By demanding additional, unspecified information for ongoing sessions that identical documentation already sufficed to cover, Devoted Health is creating an uncertified administrative hurdle. This violates CMS expectations for fair claims processing, shifting an unlawful financial and administrative burden onto the beneficiary after prior approval was secured. Violation of CMS Chronic Low Back Pain Coverage Mandates: National Coverage Determination (NCD) 150.3 dictates that Medicare covers up to 12 initial acupuncture sessions within a 90-day window for chronic low back pain. By withholding payment for 5 consecutive sessions within this approved window, Devoted Health is failing to deliver the baseline federal benefits mandated under its Medicare Advantage contract. Demand for Prompt Equitable Estoppel and Immediate Reimbursement: Because the beneficiary reasonably relied on Devoted Health's explicit written assurances and the initial successful reimbursement to continue necessary medical treatments, the plan is legally and equitably estopped from denying coverage. Devoted Health must immediately resolve this internal processing error, honor their written commitment, and issue full reimbursement for the 5 outstanding sessions to prevent further financial injury to the beneficiary. On top of it all, they have escalated the excessive stress on MY HEALTH."

— TrustPilot · Devoted Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a8d09f0594549203e916983>

"This company seems scammer on pay back program to be a scammer for.... This company seems to be a scammer for sure. The pay back program is a scam. RUN from this company as fast as you can run. Customer service is great, but don't have a claim."

— TrustPilot · Devoted Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69eea91c7998fc3575de2684>

"In 2025 I signed up for health care.... In 2025 I signed up for health care from Ambetter for the months April thru August as I was going on Medicare on Sept 1, 2025. I missed a payment in July (my debit card had been hacked and it had to be investigated to issue me a new card #) for the month of August, in August I made up the payment. In late 2025 I received refunds from Ambetter of my premium payments. I did not understand but didn't think anything of it as I was now on Medicare. In June 2026 I received a bill from my Primary Care doctor for three visits I had made in June, July and August 2025. When looking into this I found that Ambetter had canceled my membership, due to the 1 missed payment, all the way back to the beginning (April 2025) so in June, July, August I had no health coverage. In July 2026 I contacted Ambetter. I sent them proof that I had made all the necessary payments and was told that they can re-instate me to September 2025. In mid-August 2026 I received another bill from my PCP. I contacted Ambetter again and was told that I needed to repay my premiums that had been refunded (\$239.21) by August 8 and it was now August 24. I had never received communication that I was supposed to pay this by August 8 and they have never given me proof that they had told me this. I was told I could make the payment and see what happens. Well my reinstatement was denied because I had not made the payment by August 8. AGAIN I WAS NEVER TOLD THAT I NEEDED TO PAY BY AUGUST 8. I have filed a grievance with them over this affair. If that fails I will have to pay almost \$500 to my PCP through no fault of my own."

— TrustPilot · ambetterhealth.com · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a9c3c2750b54069d8dcfd95>

Narrow networks and doctors who don't take the plan

"Also using ACA plan; key note are premiums, deductibles and out of pocket max. But I have shopped plans and one or two ER visits or a single surgery/major procedure or chronic illness yearly cost for healthcare ive found an average of 15k to well over 25k. (again yearly!) And thats just whats in network, not always including meds and out of network services including vision and dental being billed separately on many plans. Absolutely abhorrent. We pay so much more for worse healthcare. Where a tax of a fraction of a cost per individual would cover everyone."

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/osrrfc0/

"I've been on the ACA since 2015 except this year as my honey got a job that covered his spouse for the first time. I've never had a claim denied, never had an abnormal wait time for a doctors appointment due to insurance. We have 3 major medical groups in our area, your ACA plan will put you into one of those groups. Thats it, then you are in line with everyone else that goes to that group of doctors/hospitals. My ACA plans never required approvals, I didn't pick those types of plans, I just had to be mindful of in network and out of network. My husband is on an employer plan and just had to wait several weeks to get in with a throat specialist and several more weeks for surgery as they are that backlogged...nothing to do with insurance, just staffing constraints. Now in some areas it can take months to get an appointment if you are new to the Dr. as they only allow for so many new patient visits per month. I wonder if that is the issue they are having. It can be a real concern when you are having to switch Drs a lot due to ever changing insurance on top of the fact of course those that don't take new patients."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pd4kh7/fed_up_with_fake_news/ns2kqlm/

"This is a tough one, because finding a new job as an answer only works if they make it clear upfront how much you'd pay for insurance, what coverage you get, and even who's in-network (if you have doctors and preferred hospitals you want to keep). It can be hard to get that clarified before employment. If you can swing all of that info in advance, and they have a great plan, it may be worth it to switch jobs for better/more affordable healthcare. Even then, a year or two down the road the company could change healthcare offerings. As to ACA plans, you may already know this, but you can't get subsidies at all for the family if you've declined insurance coverage through your work unless the work plan meets ACA's standards of being "unaffordable." If you haven't looked up how to figure that up, you may want to. Or not, since you said the local ACA plans you're seeing aren't great (and from what I've seen on Reddit, many doctors in Texas won't take an ACA plan, anyway. And you may not know that until you're on one, because if you are checking with them before you buy the plan, you need to specify you are talking about an ACA plan. They may take one by the same company with a similar name, but some won't take it if it's though Marketplace. So just keep that in mind when comparing). Unfortunately, the best answer, as many have alluded to, is changes in the system. But I sure haven't heard any elected officials going hard on healthcare costs ever since last year when votes to extended the expiring portion of ACA credits failed. We have another ACA enrollment coming up, and no one is saying squat about addressing it this year. And it already needed a lot more to happen than just extend those specific credits, the max oop and deductibles are too high. I don't know what the answer is for any of us."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wggh2p/can_i_make_my_healthcare_any_more_affordable/p9zouel/

"My company plan was a third of the price of the ACA plan, Cobra or Medicare. And when I changed I had to change several doctors. Most appointments are check ups so waiting isn't a big problem, but appointments I used to get in 3-5 days are now weeks, and some are months. A side note: there are some cheaper Medicare advantage plans available, but it means I have to go to all network doctors as many of mine don't take HMO's. So going it on your own you have Medicare A and B. A is free B is a few hundred dollars. The you need part D, part N (or G) and vision, dental and dermatology plans. That's what it takes to match what I had in my employee plan. If M4A is run like it is today, it's not less expensive or a good plan. Second note: mine was an individual plan, family plans got substantially more expensive."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vu7oma/people_with_existing_corporate_health_plans_and/p54f5gr/

"There is at least one major flaw in ACA. The idea behind ACA was to provide affordable access to healthcare. Unfortunately, it provides just affordable access to insurance, and that insurance is not accepted by many physicians. Seriously. I live in a major metro with a huge base of primary care physicians as well as specialists. And my experience has been that most doctors don't accept my ACA policy. I have to drive 45 minutes to get to my primary care physician, simply because he was the only doctor I could find who accepted my coverage. So when politicians pat themselves on the back for ACA, I submit that they haven't improved healthcare at all. They've just made it easy for us to find insurance."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvzBI8&lc=Ugwov4rykJWpFucCV-B4AaABAg>

"This is why PPO vs. EPO is only one part of the equation. PPOs can have narrow networks - the main difference is that they have some out-of-network benefits. I actually have a PPO as an individual ACA plan (also available through our state marketplace.) It has a narrow network but technically has out of network benefits (50% coverage after hitting a \$10k deductible, no max OOP) so it's considered a PPO."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wiau01/ppo_plan_network_is_same_narrow_network_as_epo/pa941t5/

"I've gotten 400 calls and texts in a week. And thats for fake insurance. Not ACA Iowa. I've been unemployed to take care of my sick dad. I'm 59 I never thought I wouldn't be not not get a job I guess I won't get insurance and use Good RX for my meds. I'm literally crying and devastated. Ageism it real. The non ACA is still \$500 plus most of medication not covered. MY doctors wont accept non ACA ll the way. I don't trust non ACA. I'm gonna have a heart attack if i can't find a web site where I don't get 40 calls and texts. I've been on cobra \$1000 per month so burnt \$18k I'm healthy."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgzSolhmdmdGTu0UPvF4AaABAq>

"Claims are a nightmare, reps need training, website needs to provide understandable informaiton. I have been calling in for EIGHT MONTHS about a claim that was double billed. Instead of fixing the claim, they split it into two claims and moved around random amounts of money so that neither I nor their own representatives can figure out what happened. THEIR ONLINE CLAIMS PAGE IS A NIGHMARE! So, I'm supposed to just "shut up" and pay whatever the hospital bills me. I had Aetna Medicare before and never had a problem. One of my providers that I really like won't take Aetna anymore, that's the only reason I switched. I'm going back to Aetna next year and I'll find a new provider. The reps are nice, but they struggle to be helpful, as each person I talk to tells me something different. I ask the right questions in the most basic way and still can't get a straight answer. It's just not worth it to have to call over and over and over again for months to try and get it figured out."

— TrustPilot · Humana · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a9b1821f755b887a714df2e>

"Medicare Advantage plan sucks. Medicare Advantage plan sucks. Very limited doctor choice that narrowed during the year, overwhelming paperwork, extreme hassles over required referrals to specialists, no customer service. Can't wait to escape from this hell."

— TrustPilot · UnitedHealthcare · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a9950f04670b34ee49383d8>

"I deal with devoted health here in.... I deal with devoted health here in Louisiana it's a new company I am in network with lcmc health I'm having no problems with devoted accepting my in-network doctors with lcmc health however when I am sent to a specialty doctor nobody wants to deal with them then they send you a list of doctors they deal with that is out of network lcmc then when you go see there out of network doctors and they send you to a specialty clinic not in especially clinics want to deal with the devoted health insurance plan I have a book written on this that I have sent to devoted health that I have archived to prove what I am saying I went to see a gastrologist Dr David Treen he is a well-known doctor with very high credentials however when Dr train sent me to a clinic that he was working with to have imaging done the clinic he works with does not want anything to do with devoted out matter of fact medical clinics that these doctors have set me too what to deal with devoted health if you had time to read a book I would let you read my text messages back and forth with devoted health how they say is we're sorry you're going through this I'm having to do the work that devoted out in my doctors should be doing because nobody wants to accept the voted Health here in Louisiana yes personal care providers in network with lcmc they accept devoted health and yes a couple of there specialty clinics deal with devoted out truly changed my life but when the specialty Clinic send you to another clinic you're running into a dead end Street the clinics that the doctors deal with does not accept the devoted Health Plan all you have to do is call Miss Sylvia at Dr bastian's office lcmc Health oakwood Clinic and she will let you know the problem she having trying to doctors especially clinics that will accept devoted health devoted health is a new broken insurance company that ask you to keep things in network which I tried to do until they pull me out of network sending any the doctors that they want me to deal with that a too damn far to travel especially at my age however I got there the doctor saw me Dr train then the clinic he sent me to send me back and says they do not accept devoted health insurance yes they are out of network however devoted pulled me out of lcmc network to go to the doctors they want me to go see however the doctors that I went to see that they wanted me to go see they sent me to the doctors in the clinic that they deal with and none of their associates want to deal with devoted health explain this to me all I can say come open enrollment I may be going back to People's Health devoted is dragging elderly people in with their perks oh yes they have good freebies and perks they even pay you to do a health assessment which is no problem because you do it on the phone then they give you a decent over the counter allowance and with the elderly people barely scraping by this sounds good however when it comes to medical specialty clinics nobody wants to deal with devoted health quit selling your plans with your perks I'll elderly people that are barely scraping by the perks look good a lot of people sign on to devoted health because of the perks however the healthcare part of devoted health sucks as stated your regular personal care providers except devoted but none of the specialty clinics they deal with except devoted health insurance if I could send you the text messages that has been sent to devoted already you would understand I promise you I have over 20 pages of responses to devoted out the dressing this problem and all they can say is we're sorry that I am going through this devoted needs to get on track because they suck thank you"

— TrustPilot · Devoted Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a21c05fc83eec34fdcd42d6>

Marketplace and Medicaid paperwork, verification, errors

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO

and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

"marketplace, healthcare, overlap, tax, implications... I am not sure this is the right sub Reddit for my question but hopefully someone can help or shed light on my situation. it's pretty simple. I recently started a new job after working for a small business and purchasing my own independent insurance for many years. I did not select my new employer sponsored insurance plan until August 31 of this year even though I was hired July 1 of this year. I assumed that coverage began September 1 but upon completion of paperwork, realize it started August 1. I'm not really sure how that's possible but that is what my plan states. So, I didn't know I had to cancel my marketplace plan immediately and somehow thought that they just canceled each other out. That sounds really stupid when I say it out loud, but I thought if I got one coverage, it would just terminate the other coverage, but I realize now it does not work that way. So now when I get my 1095 a at the end of the year, it will show that I had a Marketplace plan with high discount for all of Aug and 9 days of Sept (unless I'm stuck with the whole month of September as well. It depends if they can prorate the days.) that I technically did not qualify for. I'm essentially on the hook for the contributed amount, correct? I don't qualify for the discount. I just don't understand why I have to pay back that money if I didn't use the plan (or can't because the other insurance is primary and Trump's the marketplace plan) because all of my appointments and prescriptions are gonna be rerun through the new insurance. I was told I had to do that manually regardless. Does anything I'm saying have truth to it? Am I missing something? if I do everything correctly and go through any insurance claim for an appointment or prescription during that timeframe to have my primary insurance run and pay the difference, what are my tax implications? If I do none of that, what are my tax implications? Does it eventually catch up to me or do I have to deal with it at the end of the year in some way shape or form? TLDR: I had marketplace insurance as well as employer sponsored insurance that overlapped. What happens on my 1095 a when it comes time to pay taxes? Will I suffer an expensive payback situation for credits that I received at the same time as my other plan was active? I mean expensive is relative. I think the credits are like maximum \$500 a month so if I was charged for two months it would be about \$1000. it's an extra thousand dollars that I don't have to put towards health insurance though."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wdgszl/marketplace_healthcare_overlap_tax_implications/

"You need to look it up. I believe the cheapest work plan for the employee only has to cost more than 9.96% of your income to be unaffordable, but I'm not 100% sure on all the specifics there, this is off the top of my head. BUT I don't know what metric they are using to calculate income in that instance, and you need to know for sure what you are figuring up 9.96% of. As in, does the plan have to be more than 9.96% of your MAGI, which is what you use to determine ACA subsidies, or what? And is it only going by the employee only plan, which is what I think I read before, or the cost of a family plan? That's why I say, I'd look it up, get the exact metric to follow, and even then, if you believe your insurance meets the "unaffordable" standard, I'd call the Marketplace CS to verify this. It is a world of hurt if you get that wrong. Also, I have no idea what the family glitch is."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wggh2p/can_i_make_my_healthcare_any_more_affordable/pa11ax3/

"I totally get why you'd be furious cause I would be too. I suggest calling both your insurer and the marketplace right away and report it as an error under the ACA. Ask them for retroactive reinstatement so that they can still cover you for any care during the gap once the case is fixed. Remember to keep a record of everything and follow up regularly."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1st004d/aca_canceled_my_policy_without_my_permission_and/oieub95/

"My broker Carlos R Hernandez. My broker Carlos R. Hernandez signed me up for Cigna health insurance. At least I thought he did. After months of waiting and multiple phone calls, I never received ID cards. I could not log into mycigna.com. I could not log into the Colorado marketplace at connectforhealthco.com. Turns out Carlos entered my information incorrectly. My zip code was wrong. My address was wrong. My email was wrong. After multiple phone calls to Cigna and the Colorado Marketplace, I was finally able to track down all of these errors. I told Carlos. He invited me to find another broker. That is the only good advice Carlos provided!"

— TrustPilot · HealthMarkets · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/65bc12c06eb9707ce31b6ad1>